SEKHUKHUNE
DISTRICT MUNICIPALITY

REVIEW OF THE DISTRICT SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

FINAL REPORT

JUNE 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND 7
1.2. STUDY AREA 7
1.2.1. Regional Locality 7
1.2.2. Local Context 7
1.3. PROJECT BACKGROUND 8
1.4. PROJECT OBJECTIVES 8
1.5. PROJECT METHODOLOGY 9
2. POLICY REVIEW AND LEGISLATION 14
2.1. GLOBAL POLICY CONTEXT 14
2.1.1. The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) 14
2.2. CONTINENTAL POLICY CONTEXT 15
2.2.1. Agenda 2063: The Africa We Want 15
2.2.2. The New Urban Agenda 16
2.3. SUB-CONTINENTAL POLICY CONTEXT 17
2.3.1. SADC Vision 2050 18
2.3.2. SADC Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan (RISDP) 19
2.3.3. SADC Regional Water Policy 2005 19
2.3.4. SADC Climate Change Strategy 20
2.3.5. SADC Industrialisation Strategy, 2015 – 2063 20
2.4. NATIONAL LEGISLATION 21
2.4.1. Constitution of the Republic of South Africa 108 of 1996 21
2.4.2. Municipal Systems Act 32 of 2000 21
2.4.3. Spatial Planning and Land Use Management Act 16 of 2013 22
2.4.4. Medium-Term Strategic Framework, 2019-2024 23
2.4.5. National Development Plan, 2023 24
2.4.6. National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy, 2019 24
2.4.7. Agricultural Policy Action Plan 2015 25
2.4.8. Industrial Policy Action Plan 2014-2015 25
2.4.9. Comprehensive Rural Development Programme (CRDP) 26
2.4.10. Sustainable Human Settlement: Breaking New Ground 2004 27
2.4.11. Nine-Point Initiative Plan 27
2.4.12. National Spatial Development Framework (NSDF) 28
2.4.13. National Transport Master Plan (MATMAP 2050) 30
2.5.14. National Growth Path 31
2.5. PROVINCIAL LEGISLATION 32
2.5.1. Limpopo Development Plan 2020-2050 32
2.5.2. Limpopo Provincial Spatial Development Framework (PSDF) 33
2.5.3. Limpopo Multi-Year Human Settlement Development Plan 2019-2024 34
2.5.4. Limpopo Revitalisation of Agriculture and Agro-Processing Value Chain Plan, 2021 34
2.5.5. Limpopo Industrial Master Plan 2020-2030 35
2.5.6. Limpopo Tourism Growth Strategy 35
2.5.7. Limpopo Green Economy Plan 35
2.6. DISTRICT POLICIES 36
2.6.1. Adjacent District Spatial Development Frameworks 36
3. DISTRICT SPATIAL STRUCTURE 41
3.1. SPATIAL STRUCTURE 41
3.2. ADMINISTRATIVE BOUNDARIES 42
3.2.1. Ward Boundaries 42
3.2.2. Traditional Authorities 42
3.3. MOVEMENT NETWORK 44
3.4. SOCIO-ECONOMIC ANALYSIS 45

3.4.1. Engineering Services 47
3.4.1.1. Basic Service Provision 47
3.4.2. Community Facilities 52
3.4.2.1. Educational Facilities 53
3.4.2.2. Government and Municipal Services 53
3.4.2.3. Health Care Services 53
3.4.2.4. Safety and Security 54
3.4.3. Economic Analysis 54
3.4.3.1. Retail and Industrial 54
3.4.3.2. Mining Activity 55
3.4.3.3. Agriculture Activity 57
3.4.3.4. Tourism Activities 59
3.4.3.5. District-wide Economic Profile 60
3.4.3.6. GVA Growth Analysis 60
3.4.3.7. Employment Sector Contribution per Local Municipality 63
3.4.3.8. Labour Market 64
3.4.3.9. Affordability Level 65
3.4.3.10. District-wide Export Cycle 66
3.5. ENVIRONMENTAL FEATURES 68
3.5.1. Topography and Hydrology 68
3.5.2. Geology 68
3.5.3. Vegetation, Nature Reserves and Protected Areas 69
3.5.4. Climate Change 69
3.5.4.1. Current Drought Levels 69
3.5.4.2. Projected Drought Risk Level 70
3.6. SETTLEMENT VULNERABILITY 72
3.7. KEY CHALLENGES AND ISSUES 75
3.7.1. Local Municipal Key Challenges and Issues 75
3.8. DISTRICT-WIDE KEY CHALLENGES AND ISSUES 80
3.8.1. Spatial and Economic Development 80
3.8.2. Roads and Transport Infrastructure 81
3.8.3. Engineering 81
3.8.4. Community Facilities 81
4. SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK 82
4.1. DISTRICT SPATIAL CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK 82
4.2. DISTRICT DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVES 84
4.2.1. Development Objective 1: Preservation of the Natural Environmental and Ecological Network 86
4.2.2. Development Objective 2: Define Nodal Hierarchy and Promote Spatial Integration 94
4.2.3. Development Objective 3: Enhance the Movement Networks and Infrastructure to Ensure Efficient Trade, and Urban and Rural Connectivity 101
4.2.4. Development Objective 4: Development of Productive Regions 104
4.2.5. Development Objective 5: Human Settlement and Spatial Transformation 117
5. IMPLEMENTATION FRAMEWORK 124
5.1. LEGISLATIVE REQUIREMENTS: 124
5.2. SPATIAL ALIGNMENT TO CAPITAL INVESTMENT FRAMEWORK 125
5.3. DISTRICT SDF PROJECT LIST 127

FIGURES

Figure 1.1: Regional Context
Figure 1.2: Local Context
Figure 2: SADC Member Countries
Figure 3.1: National Spatial Development Framework – NSDF Priorities
Figure 3.2: National Spatial Development Priorities
Figure 3.3: NSDF – Eastern Escarpment Transformation Corridor

Figure 3.4: NSDF – Transformation Corridor Opportunities and Challenges
Figure 3.5: National Transport Master Plan (NATMP)
Figure 4.1: Limpopo SDF – High Impact Catalytic Programmes
Figure 4.2: Limpopo SDF – Central Region Spatial Focus Areas
Figure 4.3: Limpopo SDF – Composite SDF
Figure 4.4: Limpopo SDF – Proposed Passenger Rail Network
Figure 4.5: Limpopo SDF – Priority Housing Development Areas
Figure 5.1: Mopani District Municipality SDF, 2025 Composite Plan
Figure 5.2: Capricorn District Municipality SDF, 2025 Consolidated Plan
Figure 5.3: Waterberg District Municipality SDF, 2021 Composite Plan
Figure 5.4: Nkangala District Municipality SDF
Figure 6.1: Spatial Structure and Settlement Pattern
Figure 6.2: Settlement Concentration
Figure 6.3: Informal Settlements
Figure 6.4: Ward Boundaries
Figure 6.5: Traditional Authorities
Figure 6.6: Traditional Council Offices
Figure 7: Movement Network
Figure 8.1: Population per Local Municipality (2011-2022)
Figure 8.2: Education Level per Local Municipality 2011-2022
Figure 8.3: Basic Engineering Services per Local Municipality 2022 (%)
Figure 8.4: Bulk Infrastructure Projects
Figure 9.1: Educational Facilities Distribution
Figure 9.2: Government and Municipal Services
Figure 9.3: Health Facilities
Figure 9.4: Safety and Security Services
Figure 10.1: Retail and Industrial Activity
Figure 10.2: Mining Activity
Figure 11.1: Agricultural Activities – Crop Production
Figure 11.2: Agricultural Activities – Livestock Production
Figure 12.1: Tourism Activities
Figure 12.2: Conceptual Trade Connections
Figure 13.1: Topography and Natural Features
Figure 13.2: Geological
Figure 13.3: Drought Risk Levels (1995-2024)
Figure 13.4: Drought Risk Levels (2025-2065)
Figure 13.5: Projected Average Temperatures
Figure 14: Spatial Conceptual Framework
Figure 15: Critical Biodiversity Areas and Ecological Network
Figure 16.1: Development Objective 2 Nodal Hierarchy
Figure 16.2: Development Objective 2 Nodal Hierarchy – Retail and Community Facilities
Figure 17.1: Development Objective 3 Priority Corridors and Strategic Linkages
Figure 17.2: Development Objective 3 Proposed Passenger Rail Network
Figure 18: Development Objective 4 Agricultural Initiatives
Figure 19: Development Objective 4 Tourism Initiatives
Figure 20: Development Objective 4 Industrial Initiatives
Figure 21: Development Objective 5 – Human Settlement
Figure 22: Composite District SDF
Figure 23.1: Nodal and Movement spatially represented Projects
Figure 23.2: Productive Area spatially represented Projects

DIAGRAMS

Diagram 1: Project Methodology
Diagram 2: Summarised Legislation and Policy Structure
Diagram 3.1: Sustainable Development Goals
Diagram 3.2: Sustainable Development Goals – Strategic Goals
Diagram 4.1: Agenda 2063
Diagram 4.2 The New Urban Agenda
Diagram 5.1: Summarised SADC Critical Development Priorities
Diagram 5.2 SADC Vision 2025
Diagram 5.3: SADC Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan
Diagram 6: SPLUMA Principles
Diagram 7: The Comprehensive Rural Development Programme Concept
Diagram 8: NSDF – Five Frame to achieve a desired future spatial pattern
Diagram 9: Urban-Rural Region Model and Rural-Rural Region Model
Diagram 10.1: Population (Census SA 2001 - 2022)
Diagram 10.2: Age Group Project

Diagram 10.3: Dwelling Type
Diagram 10.4: Household Engineering Service
Diagram 11: Commodities produced within the District
Diagram 12.1: GVA Growth Analysis at National, Provincial, District Level
Diagram 12.2: GVA per Local Municipality in the Greater Sekhukhune District Municipality
Diagram 12.3: District Municipality's Sectoral Contribution to GVA in 2024
Diagram 12.4: Broad Sectoral Contribution to GVA in 2024
Diagram 12.5: Broad Economic Share of GVA in 2024, (Province, DM and LM)
Diagram 12.6: Employment per Sector
Diagram 12.8: Gini Coefficient for the Greater Sekhukhune District Municipality.
Diagram 12.9: Food Poverty Line
Diagram 13.1: Local Municipal--Settlement Vulnerability Level
Diagram 13.2: District-wide Settlement Vulnerability Level
Diagram 14: Spatial Development Objectives
Diagram 15: Environmental Preservation Strategies
Diagram 16.1: Wildfire Mitigation
Diagram 16.2: Drought Mitigation
Diagram 16.3: Population Projections (2022-2030)
Diagram 17.1: Relationship between Major Rural Market and Small Rural Market
Diagram 17.2: Conceptual Design of a Thusong Centre
Diagram 17.3: Planned Jane Furse Wastewater Treatment Plant
Diagram 17.4: Informal Trading Formalisation Strategy
Diagram 18.1: Adapted Agri-Park Model
Diagram 18.1: Adapted Agri-Park Model
Diagram 18.2: Agri-Hub Model
Diagram 18.3: Conceptual Design of Farmers' Production Support Units
Diagram 19.1: Aloe vera farming and product formulation Value Chain
Diagram 19.2: Snail Value Chain
Diagram 19.3: Mushroom Value Chain
Diagram 20.1: Tubatse SEZ Conceptual Design
Diagram 20.2: Tubatse SEZ Proposed Layout Plan
Diagram 20.3: Proposed Required Skills in the FTSEZ
Diagram 21: Inter-relationship of Capital Expenditure Framework (CEF)
Diagram 22: Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM Housing Demand (2026-3036)
Diagram 23: Makhuduthamaga LM – Housing Demand (2026-3036)
Diagram 24: Elias Motsoaledi LM – Housing Demand (2026-3036)
Diagram 25: Ephraim Mogale LM – Housing Demand (2026-3036)
Diagram 26: Spatial Alignment with CIF

TABLES:

Table 1.1: Traditional Authorities
Table 1.2: Bulk Water Projects
Table 1.3: Approved and Construction Water Infrastructure Projects
Table 1.4: Community Facilities
Table 2: List of Mines in the District Municipality
Table 3: CBA Map Classifications and Land Use Management Guidelines
Table 4: District Nodal Hierarchy
Table 5: CSIR Guidelines for Community Facilities
Table 6.1: FTLM – Planned Housing Projects
Table 6.2: MLM – Planned Housing Projects
Table 6.3: EMLM – Planned Housing Projects
Table 7: Status of Sector Plans and Recommendations
Table 8: SDM revenue sources for a single year
Table 9: Cost of SDM's required revenue for Medium Term Infrastructure Services
Table 10.1: Project List – Environmental Projects
Table 10.2: Project List: Nodal Point Projects and Movement Network
Table 10.3: Project List

ACRONYMS:

AH	Agri-Hub
CBA	Critical Biodiversity Areas
CBD	Central Business District
COGTA	Cooperative Governance and Traditional Affairs
CRDP	Comprehensive Rural Development Programme
CSA	Critical Support Areas
DM	District Municipality
DMR	Department of Mineral Resources and Energy
DPME	Department of Monitoring and Evaluation
DRC	Democratic Republic of Congo
DWS	Department of Water and Sanitation
EMF	Environmental Management Framework
FET	Further Education and Training
FPSU	Farmer Production Support Unit
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
GIS	Geographic Information Systems
GVA	Gross Value Added
HPAA	High Potential Agricultural Areasc
ICT	Information and Communication Technology
IDP	Integrated Development Plan
IPAP	Industrial Policy Action Plan
IPP	Independent Power Producers
IRP	Integrated Resource Plan
IUDF	Integrated Urban Development Framework
KNP	Kruger National Park
K2C	Kruger 2 Canyon
KV	Kilo Volt
LED	Local Economic Development
LM	Local Municipality
MDGs	Millennium Development Goals
MDM	Mopani District Municipality
MTEF	Medium Term Expenditure Framework
MTSF	Medium Term Strategic Framework
MVA	Mega-Volt Ampere
NATMAP	National Transport Master Plan
NBA	National Biodiversity Assessment
NBF	National Biodiversity Framework
NBSAP	National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan
NDP	National Development Plan
NEMBA	National Environmental Management: Biodiversity Act 10 of 2004
NEPAD	New Partnership for Africa's Development
NFEPS	National Freshwater Ecosystem Priority Areas
NGOs	Non-Governmental Organisation
NHI	National Health Insurance
NLTA	National Land Transport Act 5 of 2009
NMPP	New Multi-Products Pipeline Project
NPAES	National Protected Area Expansion Strategy
NPC	National Planning Commission
NSDF	National Spatial Development Framework
NSDP	National Spatial Development Perspective
NSSD	National Strategy for Sustainable Development
NU	Non-Urban
PLAS	Proactive Land Acquisition Strategy
PA	Protected Area
PICC	Presidential Infrastructure Coordinating Commission
PSC	Public Service Commission

PSDF	Provincial Spatial Development Framework
R&D	Research and Development
RISDP	Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan
RUMC	Rural Urban Market Centre
SADC	Southern Africa Development Community
SANRAL	South African National Roads Agency Limited
SDF	Spatial Development Framework
SDG	Sustainable Development Goals
SDI	Spatial Development Initiative
SDM	Sekhukhune District Municipality
SEP	Socio-Economic Profile
SGD	Strategic Grid Plan
SIP	Strategic Infrastructure Projects
SPD	Spatial Development Program
SPLUMA	Spatial Planning and Land Use Management Act 16 of 2013
SWSA	Strategic Water Source Area
TDP	Transmission Development Plan
UNESCO	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation
UNFCCC	United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
VIP	Ventilated Improved Pit latrines
WCWDM	Water Conservation and Water Demand Management
WWTW	Waste Water Treatment Works

SEKHUKHUNE
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SECTION ONE

INTRODUCTION

1. INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND

The project aims to review the Spatial Development Framework (SDF) for the Sekhukhune District Municipality to guide future development, improve spatial coordination, and align with national and provincial plans, as well as those of adjoining municipalities and the respective internal municipalities. The SDF will be reviewed in light of the legislative requirements set out in the Spatial Planning and Land Use Management Act, 2013 (Act No. 16 of 2013).

The SDF review will also consider the district's historic and cultural context, the formation of the district's rural settlement pattern, and the associated spatial challenges and opportunities. The district municipality similar to most parts of the province, encompasses extensive areas characterised by low-density rural settlements/villages that are spatially dispersed, and linked to towns and economic areas by a prominent road. In that context, the SDF review is relevant to underpinning measures to create spatially integrated areas that are well serviced and where communities can access job opportunities and social services. Furthermore, economic industries are able to function and contribute to the local economy.

As such, the district municipality is reviewing the 2018 spatial development framework to ensure the SDF remains a credible, up-to-date document that reflects current trends and potential opportunities for the municipality, its communities, and the local economy. In doing so, the policy will guide present and future development within the municipal area of jurisdiction, where the spatial decision-making framework has strong resonance and implications for spatial growth and development outcomes and processes.

The SDF policy has a set of objectives, strategies, and policy guidelines that direct development and opportunities to ensure that the envisaged long-term urban and rural development planning and target deliverables are realised.

1.2. STUDY AREA

1.2.1. Regional Locality

The Sekhukhune District Municipality lies within the Limpopo Province, and is strategically placed in the province in the far southern extent, bordering the Mpumalanga Province to the north. As graphically shown in **Figure 1.1**, the district, together with the Mopani, Vhembe, Capricorn, and Waterberg District Municipalities, collectively forms the Limpopo Province. Notably, the Sekhukhune district has the smallest land area among the five districts.

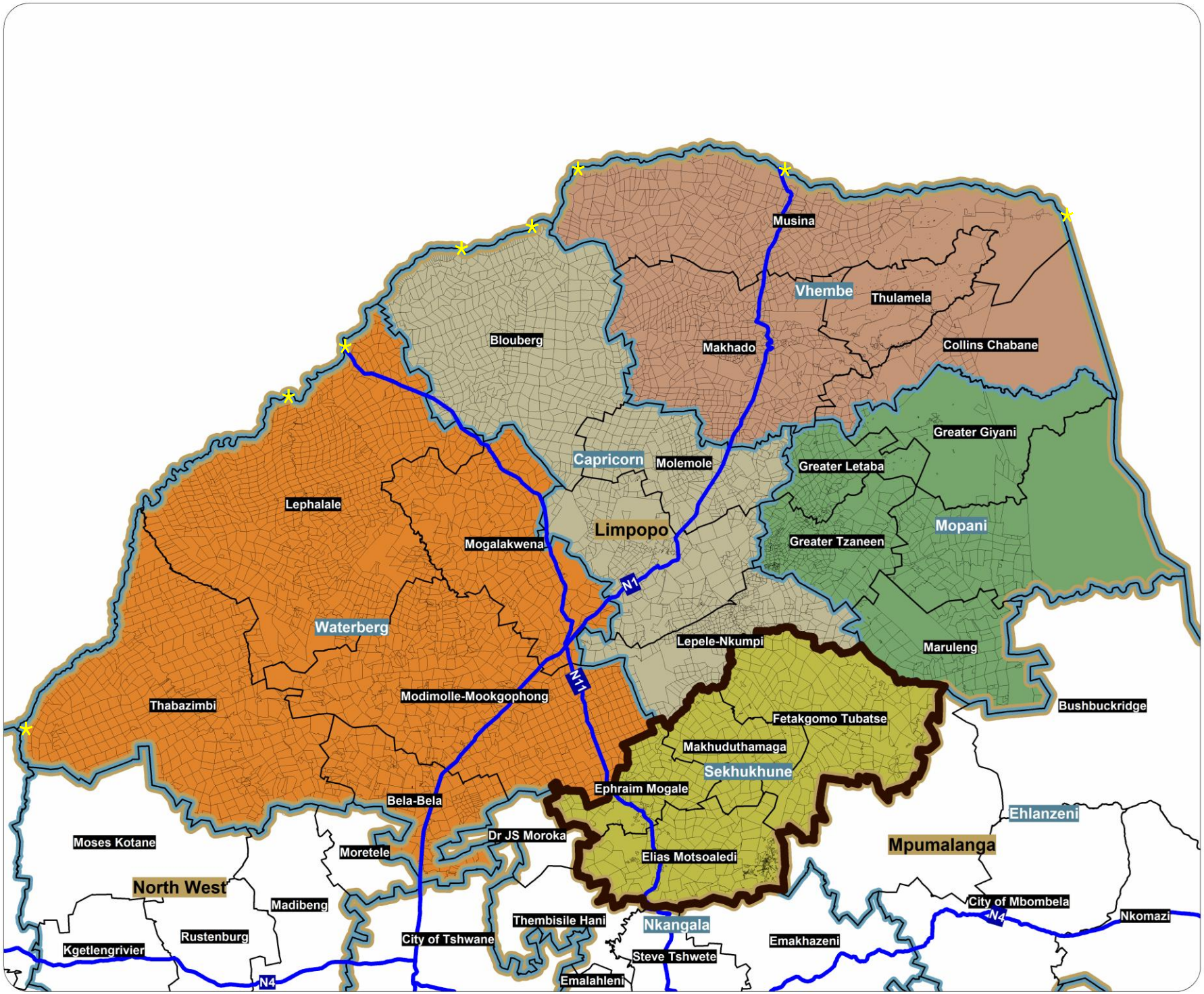
The Sekhukhune District Municipality is connected to its neighbouring districts primarily through a network of national roads, which facilitate regional accessibility and economic integration. Although traversing the south-western corner of the SDM, the N11 serves as a key corridor linking the Sekhukhune District to the Waterberg District to the west. Further south, the N11 via the SDM links to the Mpumalanga Province, specifically the Nkangala District Municipality and then to the Gauteng Province.

To the north, the N1, although not passing directly through Sekhukhune DM, is accessible via connecting regional routes and links the district indirectly to both the Capricorn and Vhembe Districts, serving as a major north-south trade and transport route. Given the limited access to national roads in the district municipality, the network of regional roads plays a critical role, particularly the link between the Sekhukhune DM and the Mopani District.

1.2.2. Local Context

As illustrated in **Figure 1.2**, the district municipality comprises four local municipalities, namely Elias Motsoaledi and Ephraim Mogale, both located in the southern part of the district, and Makhuduthamaga and Fetakgomo-Tubatse, situated in the central and northern areas, respectively. These municipalities are linked by an established network

Figure 1.1: Sekhukhune Regional Context



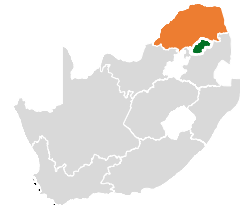
SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

REGIONAL CONTEXT

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Mopani District Municipality
- Vhembe District Municipality
- Capricorn District Municipality
- Waterberg District Municipality
- Border Posts
- National Road



N

0 7,5 15 30 45 60 75 km

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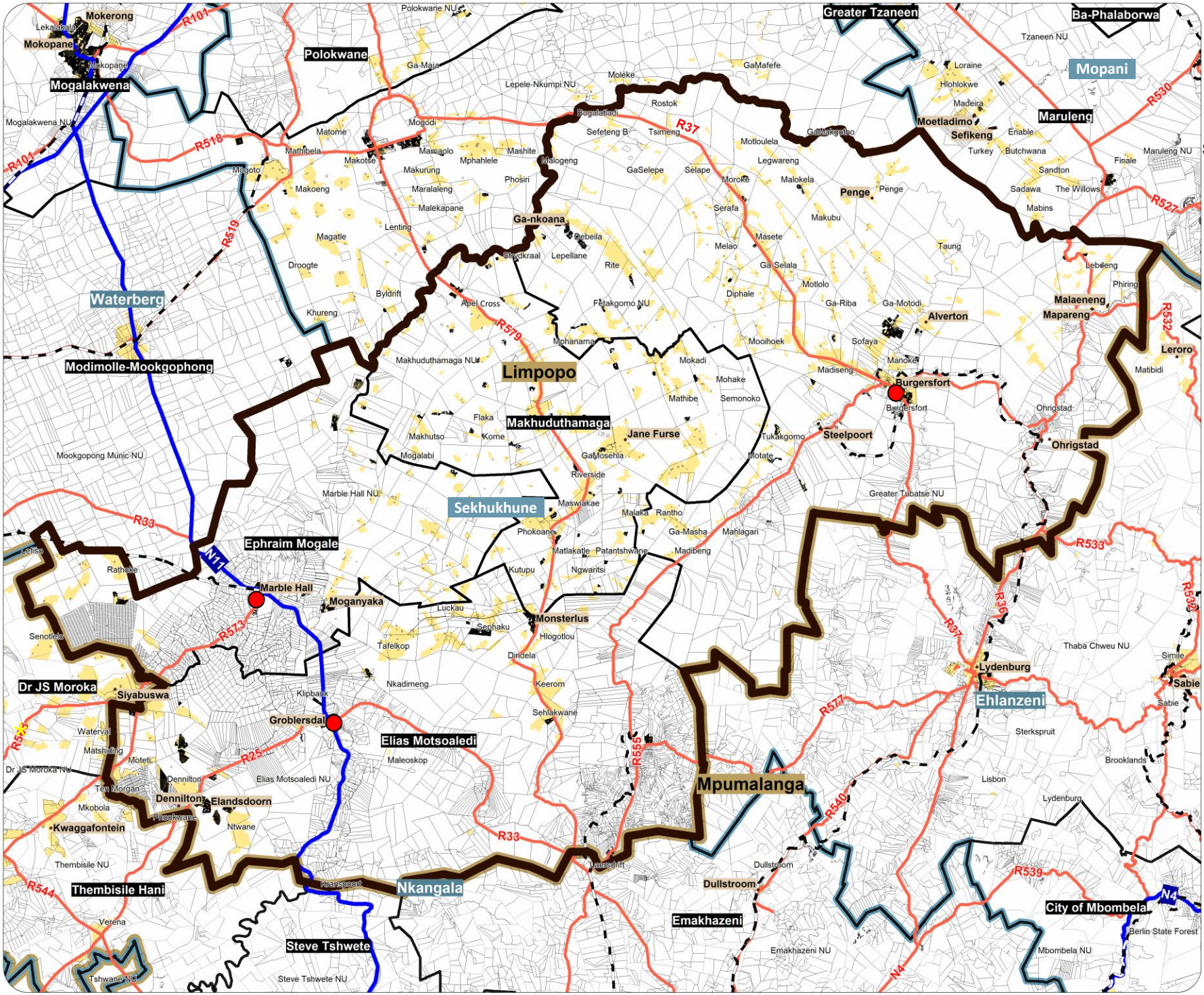
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Figure 1.2: Sekhukhune Local Context



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

LOCAL CONTEXT

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral (Erven, Farm, Parent Farm)
- Main Towns
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway line

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of regional roads that support internal connectivity and spatial integration within the district and between rural settlement areas.

- In terms of spatial connectivity between the various municipalities, the Elias Motsoaledi LM is connected to Ephraim Mogale via the N11, which leads to the Polokwane CBD in the north, and further to Musina and the Beitridge border post to the state of Zimbabwe.
- The R37 traversing the northern parts of the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM is one of the prominent regional connectors feeding into the N1 route near Polokwane. As such, it strengthens the linkage between Sekhukhune DM and the Capricorn DM.
- The R33 and R25 routes provide vital access to surrounding rural settlements and traverse through Elias Motsoaledi LM, both routes intersect with the N11. Both the Elias Motsoaledi and Ephraim Mogale municipalities border the Makhuduthamaga LM in the north-east, and are connected to Elias Motsoaledi LM via route R579, and connect to the Ephraim Mogale LM through lower-order roads.
- Notably, while Makhuduthamaga and Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipalities are both connected to Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality via regional roads such as the R579 and R555, there is no direct regional road linking Makhuduthamaga and Fetakgomo-Tubatse to each other.

1.3. PROJECT BACKGROUND

The aim of the District Spatial Development Framework is to give direction to spatial development within the district, as well as achieve the following:

- Ensuring compliance with the SPLUMA legislation and principles;
- Aligning spatial development frameworks of municipalities within the district and adjoining municipalities;
- Aligning spatial development within the district with national and provincial spatial initiatives and plans;
- Coordinating land use management actions within the district.

The SDF review aims to ensure the document remains current and provides an informed overview of the district by incorporating recent development projects and initiatives, while also guiding future development and supporting economic growth. Thus, ensuring the district's progress in all aspects to secure tenure, improve quality of life, create an economically viable environment, and build investors' confidence.

As such, the spatial development framework will explore and deliberate on the future development of the municipal space economy in the context of the district, and incorporate initiatives underlined in provincial and national space economies. Consequently, it will embrace the spatial plans of adjoining local municipalities.

1.4. PROJECT OBJECTIVES

The Sekhukhune SDF is designed to guide spatial development by aligning with local, district, provincial, and national policies. Its key objectives include:

- Ensure coordination and alignment with municipal SDFs, the provincial SDF, and any other relevant regional planning frameworks;
- Develop a spatial representation of the District Municipality's land development policies and strategic objectives within a broader planning context.
- Formulation and analysis of socio and spatial data to comprehend the extent of socio-economic dynamics and inform future planning;

- Sectoral Integration: Coordinating the spatial alignment of sector plans from local and provincial departments;
- Address spatial inequality and fragmented, inefficient land use patterns, particularly where disadvantaged communities are disconnected from economic opportunities;
- Outlining desired land use patterns across urban and rural areas, including areas unsuitable for certain types of development, and taking cognisance of the natural environment;
- Promote land use conflict management by way of balancing competing land demands between agriculture, mining, urban growth, and conservation/tourism areas;
- Identify and promote Urban-Rural Linkages by ensuring functional spatial and economic relationships between urban centres and rural hinterlands;
- Identifying areas for strategic public and private investment in both rural and urban settings;
- Devise an economic strategy to enhance the district's economic footprint through sustainable development approaches;
- The framework to guide public and private investment toward designated priority areas, aligning capital investment programmes of the district and relevant government departments in a coordinated manner that upholds the five SPLUMA development principles
- Ensure that spatial priorities and investment focus areas will be closely linked to the District Budget through the Sekhukhune Integrated Development Plan (IDP.

1.5. PROJECT METHODOLOGY

An integrated, holistic system approach is necessary to ensure the long-term sustainability of development in the planning area. The methodology for compiling the Spatial Development Framework is discussed below and encompasses the following phases/ or major components:

- **Phase 1:** Inception
- **Phase 2:** Policy Context and Status Quo Analysis
- **Phase 3:** Spatial Challenges and Opportunities
- **Phase 4:** Spatial Proposals
- **Phase 5:** Implementation Framework

The project inception report starts with a project kick-off meeting with the Sekhukhune District Municipality. In this phase, the service provider submits an inception report to the project management team of relevant officials. The Project Management Team oversees the implementation of the SDF process and the timely finalisation of tasks by the service provider and government officials. Furthermore, we will approve the Project Inception Report, which will be reviewed to reach an agreement on the scope and work plan.

Diagram 1 presents the summarised project methodology for the review of the Sekhukhune Spatial Development Framework, summarised below in six (6) phases.

Diagram 1: Project Methodology

Phase 1: Inception

The inception meeting will provide an opportunity to identify a list of documents gathered from the project team to request any relevant documents or data from the client and/or the various local municipalities. The highlighted phases form part of the upcoming project phases till project completion.

A reviewed draft spatial vision, to focus on "keeping the end in mind", is formulated considering the existing spatial vision of the district and the spatial visions of local municipalities within the district. Alignment with the IDP vision is also necessary. The spatial objectives, derived from the spatial development policy and legislative framework, provide the basis for aligning and integrating development policies and legislation within the Sekhukhune District SDF. The relevance of these objectives to the future spatial development of the Sekhukhune District Municipality is summarised.

Typical structures that should be in place to ensure proper consultation are as follows:

- Steering Committee
- Representative Forums (IDP and others)
- Ward Committees (headed by the Ward Councillor)
- Executive Committee Stakeholders to be interacted with:
- Administrative level: The Municipal Manager, Head of Departments and Cluster Managers;
- Political level: Executive Mayor, Mayoral Committee and Portfolio Councillors; and
- Community level: IDP Forum, Steering Committees.

Phase 2: Policy Context and Vision Directives Outcome

This phase will cover aspects entailing policy review and legislation derived from national, provincial, district, and local policies. To collectively incorporate and synergise all relevant plans and initiatives from the different governmental spheres. Additionally, the phase will encapsulate development strategies such as precinct plans, human settlement policies, and other collaborative governmental development initiatives. Spatial development policies and initiatives address the spatial implications of the following strategies and plans for the district municipality.

The national, regional, and provincial development strategies, sector policy directives (e.g., fiscal, environmental, infrastructural, transport, and human settlement), and other collaborative governmental development initiatives will be considered. At a National context, the section will encompass plans such as the National Development Plan: Vision 2030, the National Spatial Development Framework, the National Infrastructure Plan, and other relevant policies. The Provincial Context will allude to the Provincial strategic plans, policies, and initiatives. As well as municipal level policies such as the IDP, Sector Plans, Precinct Plans, SDFs of local municipalities, and other relevant policies and initiatives.

The draft spatial vision is formulated with consideration of the district's existing spatial vision and the spatial plans of the respective local municipalities. Alignment with the IDP vision is also necessary. The spatial objectives, derived from the spatial development policy and legislative framework, provide the basis for aligning and integrating development policies and legislation within the Sekhukhune District SDF. The relevance of these objectives to the future spatial development of the Sekhukhune District Municipality is summarised.

Phase 3: Status Quo Analysis, Spatial Challenges and Opportunities

The status quo will encompass the spatial dynamics within the District Municipality and its neighbouring districts, the socio-economic profile, and will evaluate the municipality's economic competitiveness against the District's economic performance. Below further elaborates on the information to be captured in Phase 3.

The Status Quo Report will highlight the following aspects:

- Regional and local movement networks, such as roads and rail infrastructure, connecting the community to prominent areas of employment and social services;
- The location of prominent economic nodes and nodal hierarchy, as these will serve as the major marketplace for the distribution of goods and services;
- Settlement patterns of both Urban and Rural environments to comprehend their spatial relationship, and /or degree of dispersion;
- Distribution and level of service of engineering services; Water resources; Bulk Water infrastructure; Internal Bulk infrastructure; Water Treatment Works; Waste Water Treatment Works (WWTW)); Service needs (Water needs; Sanitation needs; Electricity and required added capacity;
- Rationalise the various economic sectors (such as retail, agriculture, industry, mining, etc.) that are widespread throughout the province, their extent of development within the municipal space, and the extent to which they contribute to the economy (GDP) and labour absorption.
- Gathering information on regional land ownership and land claims for future development and security.
- Land Use Composition of existing development uses and amenities, as well as the extent of utilisation and quality of existing facilities.
- Environmental features such as the topography, river systems, soil potential, and wetlands contribute to the broader spatial structure and their influence on emerging and subsistent farmers.
- Evaluate the existing level of basic services, bulk distribution, and service capacity, as well as the level of backlogs (if any), to determine their impact on development and the local economy.
- Planned and projected infrastructural services to serve the rural communities/ village settlements.

Phase 3 (Status Quo Analysis) will conclude with a summary highlighting the main challenges, constraints, and opportunities related to spatial dynamics, service delivery, socio-economic conditions, and other factors. Community Needs Indicators will cover the analysis of needs and constraints in towns and villages, social and economic challenges, and key elements of the enabling environment, such as access to water, electricity, sanitation, telephone services, refuse removal, and housing types and requirements.

Comprehending the spatial challenges and opportunities derived from the analysis of the biophysical, socio-economic, built, and institutional environments, sector plans, and community needs analysis is provided, which is key to understanding and establishing strategies to improve local social and economic conditions.

Phase 4: Spatial Proposals

This phase will include developing the district's spatial vision and drafting spatial proposals. The Spatial Vision will be informed by Spatial Objectives derived from relevant development policies, legal frameworks, research, and spatial analysis.

Encapsulated in the phase, the spatial vision is founded on critical policy directives, spatial analysis, and stakeholder input, promoting sustainable urban and rural development, identifying priority development areas, and coordinating public and

private investment. Ultimately, this provides the foundation for more detailed planning and implementation through the Spatial Development Framework (SDF).

The development of the spatial vision and identification of key issues will require active participation through a structured stakeholder engagement programme and bilateral meetings with individual stakeholders during the formulation of the SDF. Meaningful consultation and strong stakeholder buy-in are crucial to the successful development of the Spatial Development Framework (SDF). This collaborative approach helps identify key issues, establish a shared spatial vision, and address planning precinct priorities. The effectiveness and implementation of the SDF rely heavily on the commitment and support of all stakeholders involved.

The detailed Spatial Development Framework (SDF) phase involves a thorough assessment and planning process to guide spatial growth and development. From the analysis phase, the phase considers all existing data across the district and its local municipalities. Thus, it formulates a detailed Spatial Development Framework plan which integrates infrastructure plans, environmental considerations, and service delivery requirements.

The outcomes of the detailed spatial plan aim to shape future development, inform investment decisions, and foster coordinated growth throughout the district. It emphasises key priority development areas and initiatives that will improve economic development, while ensuring the needs of communities are met to achieve an equitable society.

Phase 5: Implementation Framework

This phase focuses on translating the spatial development framework into actionable steps, ensuring that the strategies outlined in the framework plan are effectively implemented through project listing and prioritisation.

Identified projects are prioritised into short-, medium-, and long-term projects, and key responsible departments and organisations are identified to ensure implementation. This is done to manage the financial resources necessary to implement the spatial development strategies proposed in the PSDF. It links the broader spatial goals to specific infrastructure projects, land use initiatives, and development programs that require long-term funding and investment.

The phase provides the concrete, actionable blueprint needed to move from planning to realisation. It ensures that the plans and projects within the SDF are attainable through funding, implementation, and ongoing monitoring, thereby driving the region's spatial and economic development.

Phase 6: Finalisation and Approval

Based on the comments received, the District Spatial Framework will be amended and will accordingly serve as the final draft document, after being presented and submitted to the Council for approval.

Included in the phase is the preparation of both soft and hard copies of the report and maps, as well as incorporating the GIS training manual into the project.

SEKHUKHUNE
DISTRICT MUNICIPALITY

SECTION TWO

POLICY

2. POLICY REVIEW AND LEGISLATION

The section below outlines the legislative and policy review, originating from the global policy context and cascading down to the national, provincial, and municipal levels, subsequently assessing the respective local municipalities and localised spatial policies. **Diagram 2** depicted below, highlights the summary of the legislation and policy structure to be addressed in the legislation and policy review.

Diagram 2: Summarised Legislation and Policy Structure

2.1. GLOBAL POLICY CONTEXT

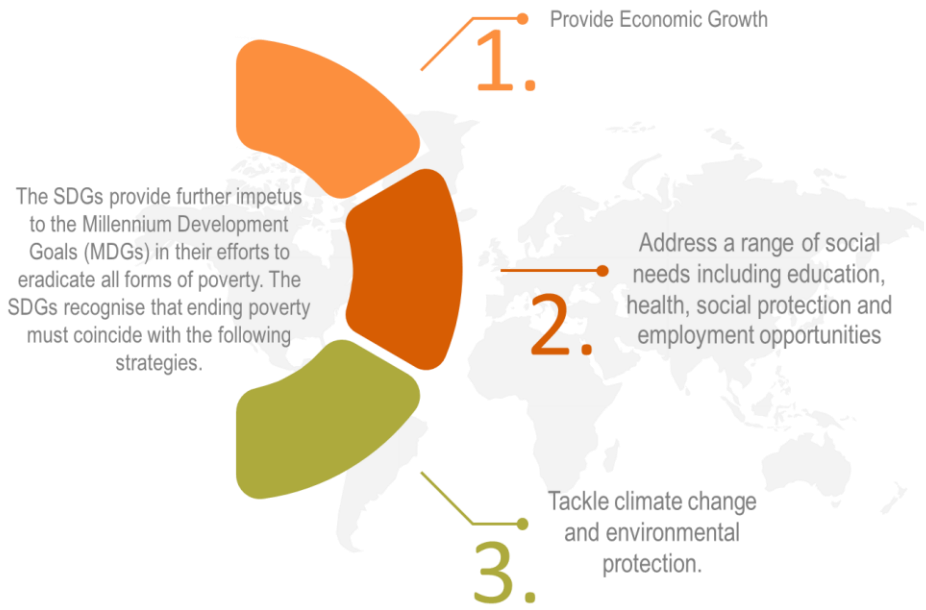
2.1.1. The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

The United Nations Sustainable Development Goals require the mobilisation of efforts to end all forms of poverty through sustainable economic growth, to fight inequality across social needs, including education, health, social protection, and employment opportunities, and to tackle climate change and ensure environmental protection.

Diagram 3.1: Sustainable Development Goals

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) acknowledge that eradicating poverty is a foundational step toward achieving the following three strategic goals.

Diagram 3.2: Sustainable Development Goals



CONTINENTAL POLICY CONTEXT

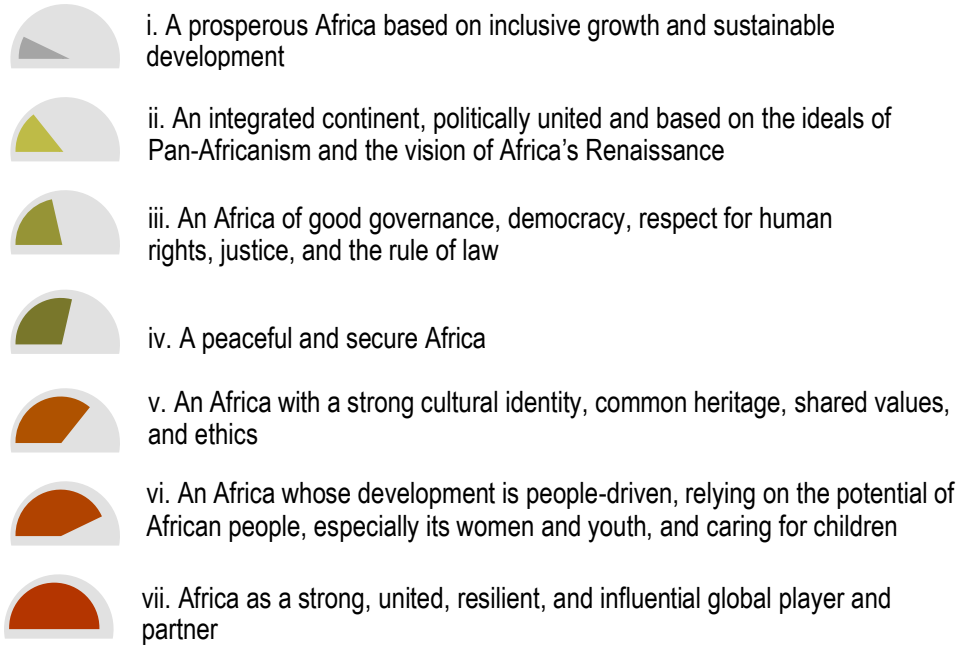
2.2. CONTINENTAL POLICY CONTEXT

2.2.1. Agenda 2063: The Africa We Want

Agenda 2063 is Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into a global powerhouse of the future. The framework focuses on a social, economic and political renaissance that links the past, present and future. Overall, Agenda 2063 seeks to strengthen industrialisation, which is linked to agriculture and food security and aims to build on the continent's comparative advantages, such as its human development potential, natural resources and geographic location.

To become an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa, driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, Agenda 2063 provides a strategic framework based on the following seven (7) aspirations:

Diagram 4.1: Agenda 2063



i. A prosperous Africa based on inclusive growth and sustainable development

ii. An integrated continent, politically united and based on the ideals of Pan-Africanism and the vision of Africa's Renaissance

iii. An Africa of good governance, democracy, respect for human rights, justice, and the rule of law

iv. A peaceful and secure Africa

v. An Africa with a strong cultural identity, common heritage, shared values, and ethics

vi. An Africa whose development is people-driven, relying on the potential of African people, especially its women and youth, and caring for children

vii. Africa as a strong, united, resilient, and influential global player and partner

2.2.2. The New Urban Agenda

The mandate of the New Urban Agenda (NUA), as adopted at the United Nations Conference on Housing and Sustainable Urban Development (Habitat III), provides a global framework for sustainable urban development, focusing on the following main core elements.

Diagram 4.2: The New Urban Agenda

1. Social and Ecological Responsibility
- Ensure land use serves social and ecological purposes, progressively realizing the right to adequate housing, water, sanitation, and equal access to public goods and essential services.

2. Inclusive and Participatory Urban Spaces
- Foster civic engagement, social cohesion, and inclusive public spaces that support cultural, generational, and political participation, especially for vulnerable groups.

3. Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment
- Promote full and equal participation of women and girls in all areas, ensure decent work and pay equity, and eliminate discrimination and violence.

4. Sustainable Economic Development
- Use urbanization to drive inclusive, sustainable economic growth and transformation, recognizing the role of both formal and informal economies.

5. Territorial and Urban Integration
- Act as hubs for integrated urban and territorial development across regions and administrative boundaries.

6. Sustainable Mobility
- Support inclusive, age- and gender-responsive urban mobility and efficient transport systems that link people and economic activities.

7. Resilience and Climate Action
- Implement disaster risk management, enhance resilience to hazards, and address climate change through mitigation and adaptation.

8. Environmental Protection
- Conserve ecosystems, water, and biodiversity while promoting sustainable consumption and production practices.

SYNTHESIS: IMPLICATIONS OF CONTINENTAL POLICIES AND INITIATIVES

The implications of global and continental policies for the District Municipality are significant for spatial development, particularly in efforts to eradicate poverty, trade agreements, and mutual agreements governing the use and sharing of water resources. They encourage the district to pursue economic growth by harnessing urbanisation as a catalyst for spatial transformation and increased productivity, and by promoting value-added, resource-efficient activities. This approach involves strengthening local economies and recognising the informal sector's contributions, while facilitating a gradual and inclusive transition to the formal economy.

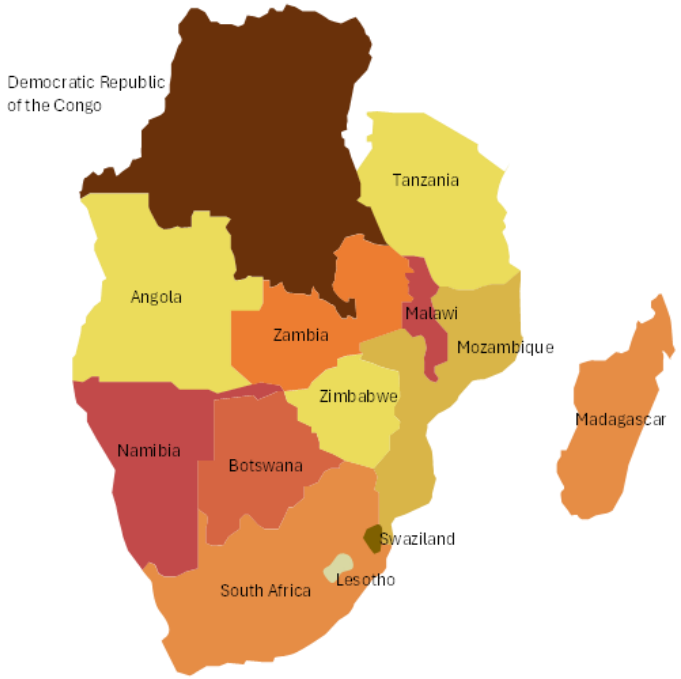
In addition, the emphasis is on addressing climate change and protecting natural systems, such as water resources, ecosystems, and biodiversity, through conservation, restoration, and minimising environmental impact. Integrating spatial and economic policies with global frameworks positions the Sekhukhune District Municipality within a broader international development context.

SUB-CONTINENTAL POLICY CONTEXT

2.3. SUB-CONTINENTAL POLICY CONTEXT

The Southern African Development Community (SADC), which encompasses several states in the southern region of Africa, namely the countries of Angola, Botswana, Comoros, Democratic Republic of Congo, Eswatini, Lesotho, Madagascar, Malawi, Mauritius, Namibia, Zambia, Zimbabwe, Botswana, South Africa, Swaziland, Mozambique, Seychelles, Tanzania, collectively form the southern regional organisation.

Figure 2: SADC Member Countries



In forming this regional organisation, the SADC, it is intended to coordinate development and critical responses to address regional development priorities. Thereby, ensuring regional-wide efforts and challenges are addressed and jointly shared.

Diagram 5.1: Summarised SADC Critical Development Priorities

The following represents policies and frameworks governing the alliance between these SADC member states, guiding their cooperation, regional and resource integration and development across each state.

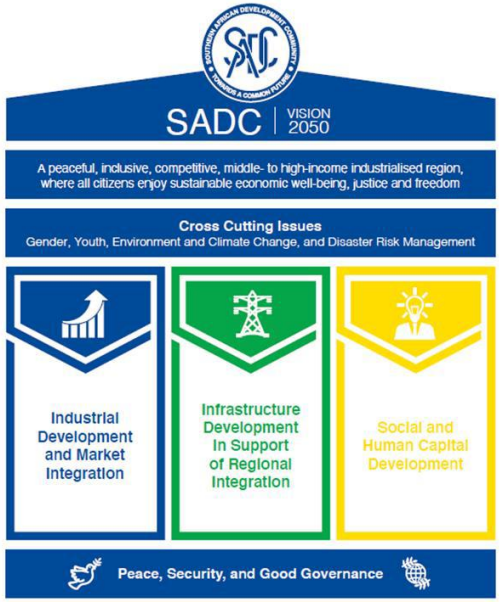
- SADC Policies and Plans
- SADC Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan (RISDP)
- SADC Strategic and Policies
  - SADC Regional Water Policies 2005
  - SADC Regional Agricultural Policy
  - SADC Industrial Strategy, 2015 – 2063
  - SADC Climate Change Strategy

2.3.1. SADC Vision 2050

The SADC Vision 2050 does not provide any spatial objectives – rather, it represents a high-level vision for the SADC region, addressing cross-cutting issues including Gender, Youth, Environment and Climate Change, and Disaster Risk Management. It does not make any locational or country-specific mentions. The vision is expressed in three pillars based on a firm foundation of Peace, Security and Good Governance, and premised on three interrelated vision pillars, namely:

- Industrial Development and Market Integration
- Infrastructure Development in support of Regional Integration
- Climate change.

Diagram 5.2: SADC Vision 2050



2.3.2. SADC Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan (RISDP)

The Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan (RISDP) 2020-2030 is a regional integration development framework that operationalises the SADC Vision 2050 by setting priorities, policies, and strategies to achieve the long-term goals of the Southern African Development Community.

Diagram 5.3: SADC Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan (RISDP)

In the South African context, the strategic priorities outlined in the SADC Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan (RISDP) are to some extent reflected in national and provincial policies. These frameworks aim to transform the legacy of apartheid-era spatial planning by promoting integrated development and ensuring equitable distribution of resources to achieve economic inclusivity. These priorities have been further localised at the district and municipal levels to ensure context that is implementable. While also effectively emphasising intergovernmental coordination and inclusive stakeholder engagement to foster collaborative development efforts across the country.

2.3.3. SADC Regional Water Policy 2005

The SADC Regional Water Policy (2005) is a framework that provides guidelines for managing the region's water resources across boundaries, ensuring equitable distribution to advance regional development, economies, and livelihoods. The Limpopo River Basin distributes water to three other SADC member countries: Botswana, Mozambique, and Zimbabwe. Moreover, parts of the country, including the entire Sekhukhune District Municipality.

The Limpopo River Basin is primarily semi-arid, characterised by an extremely unpredictable climate, subject to severe droughts and flooding. The basin's water resources are already over capacity, and food production is still significantly reliant on rainfall. The vulnerability of large rural populations, many of whom are impoverished and rely on natural resources (land and water supply) for their livelihoods, is gradually compromised. The capacity to resolve poverty and withstand shocks is further constrained by undiversified economies and limited public and private resources. Overall, these factors make the Limpopo River Basin highly at risk for long-term change and climate-related hazards. Climate projections indicate that the basin will experience substantial warming, accompanied by prolonged dry periods and increased frequency of droughts.

As a result, the SADC Water Policy consists of the following nine thematic areas that address the water resources management issues and challenges or are aimed at optimising the development opportunities:

1) Regional Cooperation in Water Resources Management
2) Water for Development and Poverty Reduction containing
3) Water for Environmental Sustainability
4) Security from Water-related Disasters
5) Water Resources Information and Management
6) Water Resources Development and Management
7) Regional Water Resources Institutional Framework

8) Stakeholder Participation and Capacity Building

This resource not only sustains a rich diversity of natural ecosystems, but also economic industries spanning from domestic and industrial water supply to social and sanitation management for the region's population.

2.3.4. SADC Climate Change Strategy

The Climate Change Strategy shall guide the implementation of the Climate Change Programme over a Fifteen-year period (2015 - 2030). The Strategy provides a short, medium to long-term framework for implementing comprehensive and concrete climate change adaptation and mitigation programmes and projects. With that, the goal of the SADC Climate Change Strategy is to provide a regional framework for collective action and enhanced cooperation to address climate change issues, thereby improving local livelihoods, achieving sustainable economic growth, and contributing fairly to the preservation of a global good.

Below highlights priorities which the SADC Climate Change Strategy and Action Plan aim to achieve;

- Provide a broad outline for standardised and coordinated Regional and National actions to address and respond to the impacts of climate change in line with global and continental objectives;
- Devise adaptation tools to address climate change, however, bearing in mind the diverse levels of vulnerabilities each state experiences within the region;
- Establish means to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, taking into consideration the respective capabilities of the member states;
- Supports nationally and regionally appropriate mitigation actions given the mitigation's potential opportunities for sustainable development; and
- Enhance the region's ability and capacity to mobilise resources, access technology, and build capacity to facilitate adaptation and mitigation actions.

In terms of the Sekhukhune District Municipality, all local municipalities lack fully integrated specific climate adaptation plans and budgets within their municipal policies, such as in the IDP, spatial policies to mitigate against climate change;
The district lacks adoption of best practices like climate budgets and institutional climate champions in most local areas;

Lack of municipal capacity building, education, and info-sharing to enable informed local decision making that would (i) assist farmers during the drought season to maintain livestock and production, and (ii) help communities protect and maintain the environment.

2.3.5. SADC Industrialisation Strategy, 2015 – 2063

The framework is a long-term vision to transform the region's economy through the promotion of industrialisation and integration of its resources, enabling SADC members to compete on a global scale.

The following represents key objectives of the SADC Industrialisation Strategy;

- Transform and Diversify the Regional Economy, by way of progress SADC economies from heavy dependence on raw material exports toward establishing regional value-added production and industrial diversification, particularly in manufacturing and agro-processing;
- Enhance Regional Economic and Development Integration through establishing industrial linkages and regional value chains to deepen trade integration and economic cooperation among Member States;

- Formulation and linkages of Regional Value Chains between the members of state in order to support and advance the regional economy, and cross-border production, and
- Establish Intra-Regional Trade by way of encouraging cross-border production and transfer of goods and reducing trade barriers through aligning trade standards and customs that ease trade relationships. The objective also recognises the importance of investing in regional movement infrastructure to ensure an efficient movement of goods.

SYNTHESIS: IMPLICATIONS OF SUB-CONTINENTAL POLICIES AND INITIATIVES, SPATIAL LINKAGES, AND RESOURCE SHARING

At the sub-continental level, the district municipality's solid base in the agricultural sector, particularly in crop and livestock production, positions the district as one of the most significant contributors to Africa's agro-processing goals and further expansion, ensuring food security and inclusive industrialisation.

The district's platinum mining belt traversing the northern regions, holds substantial potential to contribute to the African economy by fostering new niche industrial value chains, skill sets, and locally manufactured products. However, realising this potential will require prioritising improved infrastructure to support the sector's growth and success.

The Olifants and Tubatse rivers form part of the transboundary Limpopo River Basin, the district's water use, environmental management, and respective activities along these tributaries must align with regional frameworks that promote equitable and manageable utilisation of shared resources. This emphasises water abstraction, pollution, and ecosystem protection, particularly given the district's intensive mining operations.

NATIONAL LEGISLATIONS

2.4. NATIONAL LEGISLATION

2.4.1. Constitution of the Republic of South Africa 108 of 1996

The Constitution states that developmental local government should provide for a democratic and accountable system of governance for communities. It also encourages municipalities to provide services to communities in a sustained manner, promoting social and economic development. It promotes a safe and healthy environment and encourages the involvement of communities and community organisations in local government matters. Within its financial and administrative capacity, a municipality must strive to achieve the objectives outlined in this subsection.

In terms of its implications on the Sekhukhune District SDF. The spatial policy encompasses a set of normative principles that guide SDF in creating liveable, equitable, sustainable, resilient, and efficient spaces, while supporting economic opportunities and social cohesion.

2.4.2. Municipal Systems Act 32 of 2000

The requirement for municipalities to prepare a Spatial Development Framework (SDF) was introduced through the Municipal Systems Act (MSA), Act 32 of 2000. The MSA defines the SDF as a municipality's Integrated Development Plan (IDP) core component. It also mandates that the SDF must be aligned with the municipality's land use management system. The accompanying MSA Regulations specify the required content of an SDF and reinforce its role in linking spatial planning with land use decisions.

Before the MSA, South African spatial planning primarily relied on Guide Plans and Structure Plans. While helpful in setting spatial vision, these earlier planning tools often failed to connect with municipalities' fiscal and operational realities. A key advancement introduced by the MSA was its requirement that the SDF include a capital investment framework, directly tying spatial planning to the municipal budget and broader development programmes.

The enactment of the Spatial Planning and Land Use Management Act (SPLUMA), Act 16 of 2013, and the Land Use Planning Act (LUPA), Act 3 of 2014, further expanded the scope, content, and legal authority of SDFs. SPLUMA provides detailed guidance on what should be included in an SDF, while LUPA outlines the procedural steps municipalities must follow during its preparation.

One of the most critical developments introduced by SPLUMA is found in Section 22(1). This provision states that a Municipal Planning Tribunal or any decision-making authority cannot approve a land development application that is inconsistent with the municipality's SDF, unless justified by site-specific circumstances. If no such justification exists, the SDF must first be amended before the application can be approved.

This represents a significant shift in the legal status of the SDF. Under the MSA, the SDF functioned mainly as a guiding policy document. SPLUMA, however, elevates the SDF to a legally binding planning instrument, ensuring that municipal land use decisions are aligned with long-term spatial planning goals and that ad hoc, inconsistent development is curtailed.

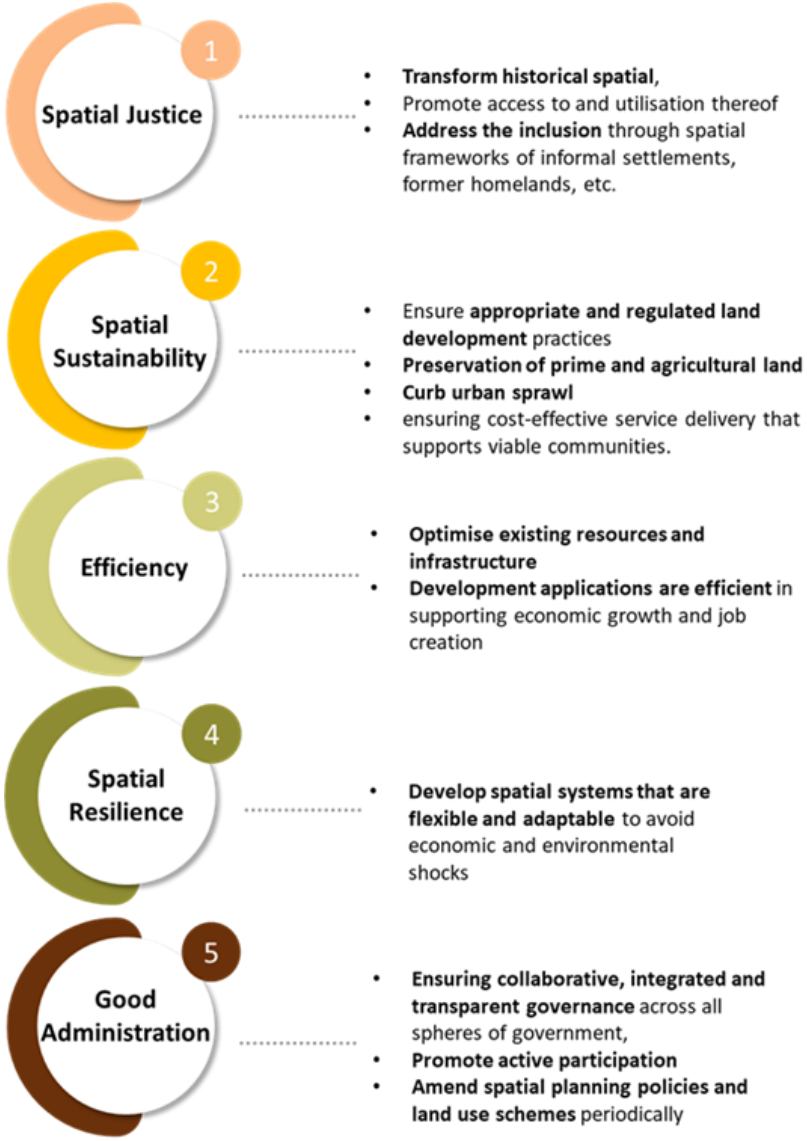
Integration between the SDF and other sector plans is critical. The SDF needs to be guided by the spatial requirements of these plans and, in turn, spatially reflect where these requirements will be met. All of this must happen with an understanding of the existing levels of infrastructure provision within the municipality and where any shortfalls exist. Additionally, the SDF needs to address the cost of providing infrastructure to meet any shortfalls in the short and medium terms. The Act influences the SDF and should be considered as another baseline when proposals are being made in the project's later phases.

2.4.3. Spatial Planning and Land Use Management Act 16 of 2013

The Spatial Planning and Land Use Management Act (SPLUMA), Act No. 16 of 2013, is South Africa's primary legislation governing spatial planning, land use management, and land development. It establishes a coherent and uniform system that applies across national, provincial, and local spheres of government, these are highlighted in **Diagram 6** below. As such, the frameworks are grounded in five core development principles: spatial justice, spatial sustainability, efficiency, spatial resilience, and good administration. These five principles not only guide the formulation and adoption of the SDF but also the development of any related policies or bylaws concerning land use and spatial planning. Below provides a description of each principle;

Consequently, the review and update of the Sekhukhune District Municipality's SDF will be directly informed by SPLUMA's key provisions. These provisions aim to support efficient, integrated, and sustainable spatial planning and land-use management across the municipal area. In implementing this SDF, the SDM must ensure that its strategic objectives align with the SPLUMA development principles while integrating national and provincial spatial policies and plans that apply to or influence the district. This alignment is critical to fostering coherent development and maximising the impact of planning efforts across governance levels.

Diagram 6: SPLUMA Principles



2.4.4. Medium-Term Strategic Framework, 2019-2024

The MTSF 2019-2024 promotes alignment, coordination and ultimately full integration of all development planning instruments into an integrated framework bearing results without duplication, role conflict and development contradictions, better coordination of implementation through the district-based delivery model. it provides a mechanism for alignment of various development planning frameworks (IDPs, SDF and APPs).

It will bring much needed focus on government development planning, which provides for partnerships, coordination of state entities, social compacts, and an active citizenry. It will also aim to fast-track spatial transformation to ensure that project locations address spatial inequalities and priorities. The main aim of the framework in rural areas is to improve land administration and spatial planning for integrated development, with a bias towards rural areas. Sustainable rural enterprises and industries are characterised by strong rural-urban linkages, increased investment in agro-processing, trade development, and access to markets and financial services. It also improves the integration and coordination of rural development across all spheres of government and between government departments through the implementation of synchronised rural development strategies.

MTSF also has a spatial dimension that supports national and local development. The drive towards spatial transformation seeks to redress the Apartheid spatial planning system. This is articulated in the strategic interventions in Priority 5 of the MTSF. The specialisation of the MTSF will be achieved inter alia through the National Spatial Development Framework (NSDF) and the District Development Model. The National Spatial Action Areas provide the guidance for an improved, inclusive and cohesive spatial logic that aims to ensure spatial justice and more effectively address the three-way threat incurred in most parts of the country namely poverty, unemployment, and inequality.

2.4.5. National Development Plan, 2023

The National Development Plan (NDP) is a strategic framework to eliminate poverty and reduce inequality in South Africa by 2030. The NDP alludes to the following key priority areas;

- **An economy that will create increased job creation** and initiatives tailored to local resources and sectors, such as agriculture, tourism and manufacturing, as well as promoting small businesses to unlock rural economies;
- **Improving infrastructure** to advance the quality of life and enabling business growth;
- **Encourage the adoption of low-carbon initiatives**, a green economy and a climate-resilient development and infrastructure;
- **Advocate for an inclusive settlement planning,** better public transport, and equal access to services, helping to integrate fragmented communities and improve urban-rural linkages;
- **Provide access to quality education, skills development programs and training**, and digital learning to increase access for all;
- Ensure **quality health care** in both urban and remote rural areas;
- **Social protection**, particularly for vulnerable populations through social grants, housing support, nutrition programs;
- **Foster safety in communities** through the implementation of community safety forums, crime prevention programs to reduce high levels of crime;
- **Build a capable, transparent and accountable public sector** by way of ensuring administrative efficiency, employing capable human resources, providing the necessary skills, and ensuring service delivery**;**
- **Implementation of anti-corruption policies**, encourage law enforcement and community engagement platforms so as to build trust and accountability; and
- **Transforming society and uniting** through inclusive governance, cultural programs, and community dialogues, to build social cohesion and cooperation.

With that, the NDP recognises the need for new spatial norms and standards that include densification, the transformation of human settlements, improved public transport, locating jobs where people live, upgrading informal settlements, and addressing critical gaps in the housing market. The plan strongly advocates for a review of the current planning system, with a focus on ensuring that municipalities develop spatial restructuring strategies with precise implementation mechanisms and identify priority precincts for spatial restructuring. The plan stresses the need for a balanced approach between rural and urban development.

2.4.6. National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy, 2019

The National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy serves as the cornerstone of climate change adaptation in the country, reflecting a unified, coherent, cross-sectoral, and economy-wide approach to climate change adaptation. To achieve its mandate, the strategy outlines priority areas for adaptation to guide adaptation efforts and inform resource allocation. These include the following critical priorities;

- Build climate resilience and adaptive capacity to respond to climate change risk and vulnerability;
- Promote the integration of climate change adaptation response into development objectives, policy, planning and implementation;
- Build intergovernmental coordination to jointly address climate risks across all government spheres, outlining the roles of each institution

and ensuring support, particularly for local municipalities as implementing agents

- Increase access to information to build awareness, and further research and innovation that would support climate-adaptive solutions

The National Climate Change Adaptation Strategy (NCCAS) requires municipalities to develop Spatial Development Frameworks (SDFs) that, among other objectives, identify the long-term risks associated with specific patterns of growth and development, and outline the policies and strategies needed to mitigate those risks. The strategy (NCCAS) supports this process by providing climate risk profiles and recommended adaptation actions that can be integrated into SDFs to promote climate-resilient planning.

A number of national policies and legislations promote the mainstreaming of climate change adaptation into spatial and developmental plans. Disaster Management Act, 2002 (The strategy can support compliance with the Act by providing information that can be used to expand municipal disaster management plans to include risk assessments and risk mapping for functional areas and in areas with vulnerable populations, and by providing adaptation actions to reduce these risks).

2.4.7. Agricultural Policy Action Plan 2015

The intention of the Agricultural Policy Action Plan (APAP) is to drive inclusive growth, job creation, and food security in South Africa's agricultural sector by transforming and revitalising agriculture, agro-processing, and related industries. The policy promotes food security by advocating for increased commercial and subsistence production, diversifying agricultural commodities through value chains, and promoting access to land and markets to increase agriculture's contribution to the Gross Domestic Product (GDP).

The Agricultural Policy Action Plan aligns itself with the New Growth Path (NGP), the National Development Plan (NDP) and Industrial Policy Action Plan (IPAP), IPAP seeks to assist in the achievement of outcome 4, decent employment through inclusive growth, and that of outcome 7, comprehensive rural development and food security. The goals of the policy is to address issues such as biosecurity, food security, reducing rural poverty, and increasing economic value through cash crops, improved food distribution, or food processing.

The policy implementation in the SDM SDF aims to ensure a profitable and competitive small and medium agro-processing industry that will significantly contribute to reducing poverty, unemployment, and inequality, as outlined in the NDP, IDP, and NSDF.

2.4.8. Industrial Policy Action Plan 2014-2015

The policy aims to diversify South Africa's economy by reducing dependence on traditional commodities and non-tradable services. This involves promoting increased value addition per capita**,** notably by expanding the use of innovative and unconventional equipment, goods, and services that are competitive in domestic and international markets. A critical focus of the policy is on fostering a more labour-absorbing industrial path**,** emphasising labour-intensive, tradable sectors and developing economic linkages that drive job creation. The policy also promotes an inclusive industrialisation model from raw materials to end-user products, encouraging greater regional participation and accommodating the historically disadvantaged and marginalised population in the formal industrial economy. Additionally, it contributes to regional industrial development in Africa, with a strong focus on building productive capabilities across the continent**.**

In that, the policy will guide the spatial redevelopment of industrial activities within the District Municipality. Such redevelopment aims to optimise the location benefits for key sectors and enable them to maximise the advantages inherent in clustering.

In this manner, the District Municipality can facilitate a business environment where efficiency and productivity across all spheres are maintained at internationally competitive levels.

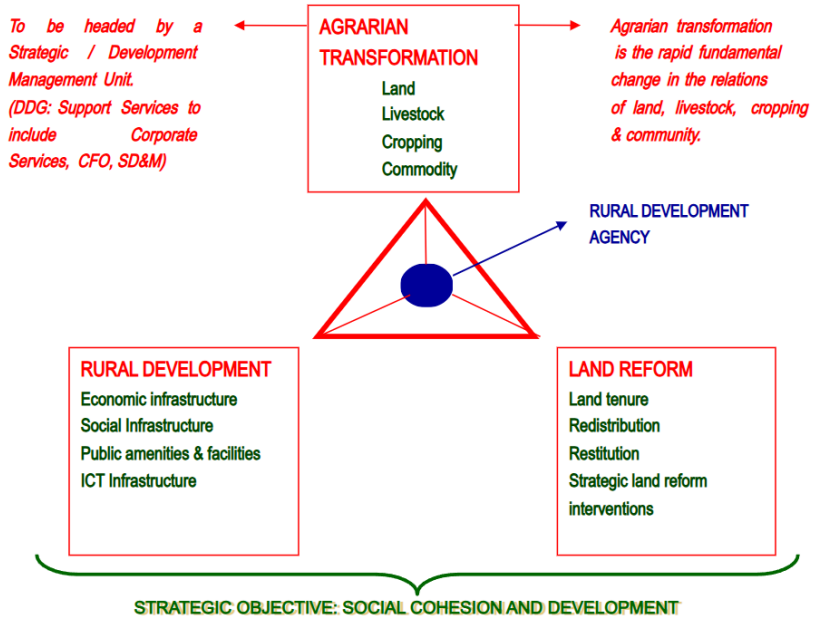
2.4.9. Comprehensive Rural Development Programme (CRDP)

The Comprehensive Rural Development Programme (CRDP) is an initiative that aims to revitalise rural areas by addressing infrastructure deficits, stimulating economic development, and empowering local communities. The objective of this initiative is to ensure secure land tenure, improve the quality of life in rural areas through effective service delivery, and ensure stable livelihoods and food security.

The CRDP focuses on transforming rural areas to achieve social cohesion and inclusive economic growth. Its primary objectives include achieving the following. Refer to **Diagram 7, which** depicts the three key strategies listed below;

- **Agrarian Transformation:** Promoting sustainable agricultural practices to enhance food security and create employment opportunities;
- **Rural Development:** Improving access to basic services, infrastructure, and economic opportunities in rural communities;
- **Land Reform:** Facilitating equitable land redistribution and ensuring its productive use.

Diagram 7: The Comprehensive Rural Development Programme Concept



Source: Department of Rural Development and Land Reform

The Sekhukhune Spatial Development Framework (SDF) is shaped by three key strategic thrusts, each aimed at fostering sustainable rural development, economic growth, and land reform:

1. Agrarian Transformation

- Promote the development of rural and agro-industries, cooperatives, local markets, and cultural initiatives.

- Support increased agricultural production and the sustainable use of natural resources, including exploring diverse plant and animal species for food and economic purposes.
- Strengthen agricultural value chains to boost local economies.

2. Rural Development

- Improve access to community and social infrastructure, focusing on well-resourced clinics.
- Develop and rehabilitate infrastructure essential for economic growth, such as:
    - Transport and distribution networks
    - Agricultural facilities
    - Water and energy infrastructure
    - Storage, market, retail, and telecom systems
    - Invest in social infrastructure; health, education, etc.

3. Land Reform

- Advance restitution, tenure reform, and land redistribution in a fair and sustainable manner.
- Expand land access for previously disadvantaged individuals.
- Establish Agri-villages to promote local economic development on farming land.
- Ensure the availability of accurate land claims data and maintain a reliable property registration system.
- Provide land-related information and spatial planning services to assist government and private sector entities in planning, development, and investment activities.

2.4.10. Sustainable Human Settlement: Breaking New Ground 2004

This policy marks a shift in focus from the government's earlier approach of simply providing housing to a more comprehensive strategy aimed at creating sustainable human settlements that address the social and economic needs of communities in their daily lives. The new human settlements plan strengthens the Department of Human Settlements' vision of building an integrated and inclusive society by developing sustainable, well-planned communities and delivering quality housing and service delivery. It emphasises accelerating housing delivery as a key tool for poverty alleviation while also positioning housing as a driver of job creation and a means for all citizens to access property as a source of wealth and empowerment.

The housing policy aims to assist the SDF in addressing housing needs and backlogs by identifying areas for residential intensification, infill and redevelopment, new residential expansion areas that would be supported by public transport, service delivery and increased accessibility to social and economic opportunities. It also promotes access to housing opportunities, which include secure tenure, basic services, and support for achieving incremental housing improvements in living environments with requisite social, economic, and physical infrastructure.

2.4.11. Nine-Point Initiative Plan

The Nine-Point Plan was introduced in 2015 to address the structural challenges that have hindered the performance of the country's domestic economy and its ability to meet economic and development advancement. Its primary objective is to stimulate economic growth through Science, Technology, and Innovation (STI), positioning it as a key driver for immediate and long-term development and focusing on addressing key challenges such as electricity shortages, revitalising agriculture, and advancing marine industrial innovation, achieving the following;

- Strengthening the National System of Innovation (NSI)

- Aligning publicly funded research institutions with government priorities
- Building the research and innovation capacity needed at each phase of the plan
- Leveraging knowledge and innovation to drive sustainable economic development

The policy directly relates to Sekhukhune, particularly by focusing on unlocking the potential of SMMEs, cooperatives, and township and rural enterprises. These sectors are critical for local economic development and job creation in the district. The plan also prioritises resolving energy constraints, which seriously challenge national growth and local livelihoods. In response, the Local Spatial Development Framework (LSDF) for Sekhukhune has identified the need to promote solar energy projects in Limpopo to address electricity shortages. This aligns with the SDF's role in guiding the efficient allocation of resources, infrastructure planning, and supporting sustainable energy initiatives

.

Additionally, the plan supports broader development through investments in ICT infrastructure, broadband rollout, and essential services like water, sanitation, and transport, all of which are critical enablers of spatial and economic transformation within the Sekhukhune District.

2.4.12. National Spatial Development Framework (NSDF)

The National Planning Commission in 2010, followed by the adoption of the National Development Plan (NDP) 2030 in 2012, laid the foundation for long-term strategic planning in South Africa. Chapter 8 of the NDP, titled *Transforming Human Settlements and the National Space Economy*, specifically highlights the need for a National Spatial Development Framework (NSDF) to guide spatial transformation and development throughout the country.

NSDF Vision Statement:

"All Our People Living in Shared and Transformed Places in an Integrated, Sustainable and Competitive National Space Economy"

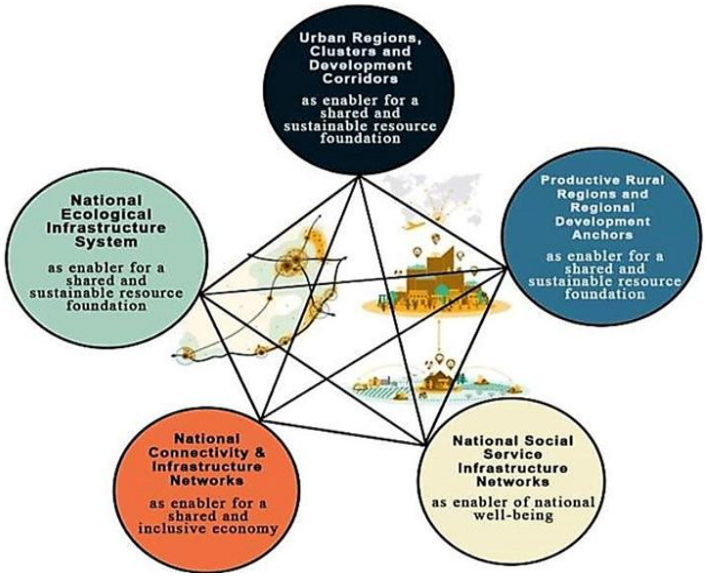
NSDF Mission Statement:

"Making our Common Desired Spatial Future Together Through Better Planning, Investment, Delivery and Monitoring"

The National Spatial Development Framework (NSDF) aims to accelerate spatial transformation and promote equitable development outcomes across South Africa. It does so with full recognition of two critical imperatives: (1) the urgent need to redress the enduring spatial legacy of apartheid, and (2) the magnitude of transformation required, particularly in terms of planning approach, resource allocation, and state capacity. The NSDF seeks to reverse segregated development patterns and significantly enhance the spatial quality, liveability, vibrancy, and economic potential of areas where Black communities reside. To support this, the plan provides a mandate to ensure more inclusive, equitable and balanced spatial development.

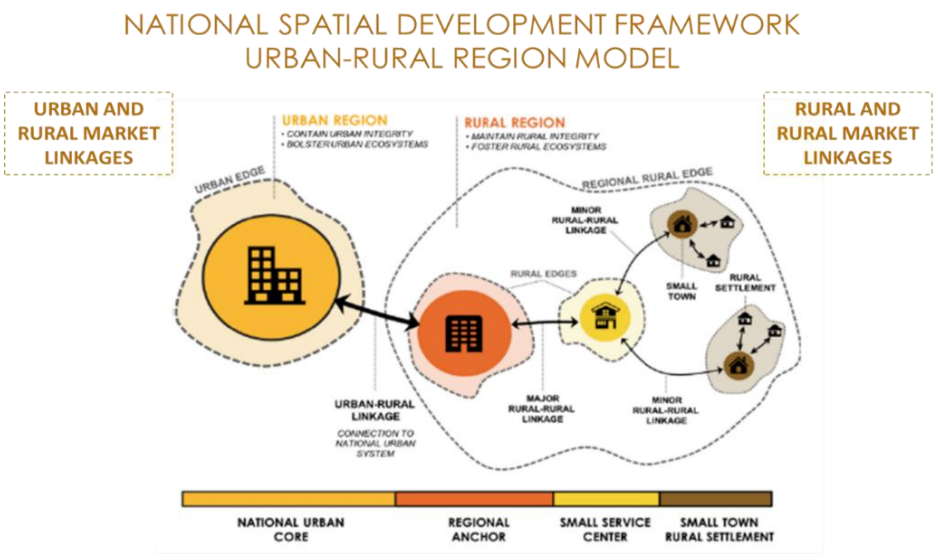
The *Spatial Development Vision and Mission* that is proposed for the country, based on these drivers, builds on the overarching goal of *equity, unity and connectedness,* and reads as follows:

Diagram 8: NSDF – Five Frame to achieve a desired future spatial pattern



The National Spatial Development Framework advocates for the concept of nodal development through linkage support between nodal hierarchies to ensure socio-economic advancement and ensure that lower-order nodes and rural economic markets continue to flourish. **Diagram 9** below illustrates the Conceptual Urban-Rural Market Linkages and Rural-Rural Market Linkages, which are connected via the National Urban System's 'strategic movement corridor,' binding these distinct nodes/markets.

Diagram 9: Urban-Rural Region Model and Rural-Rural Region Model

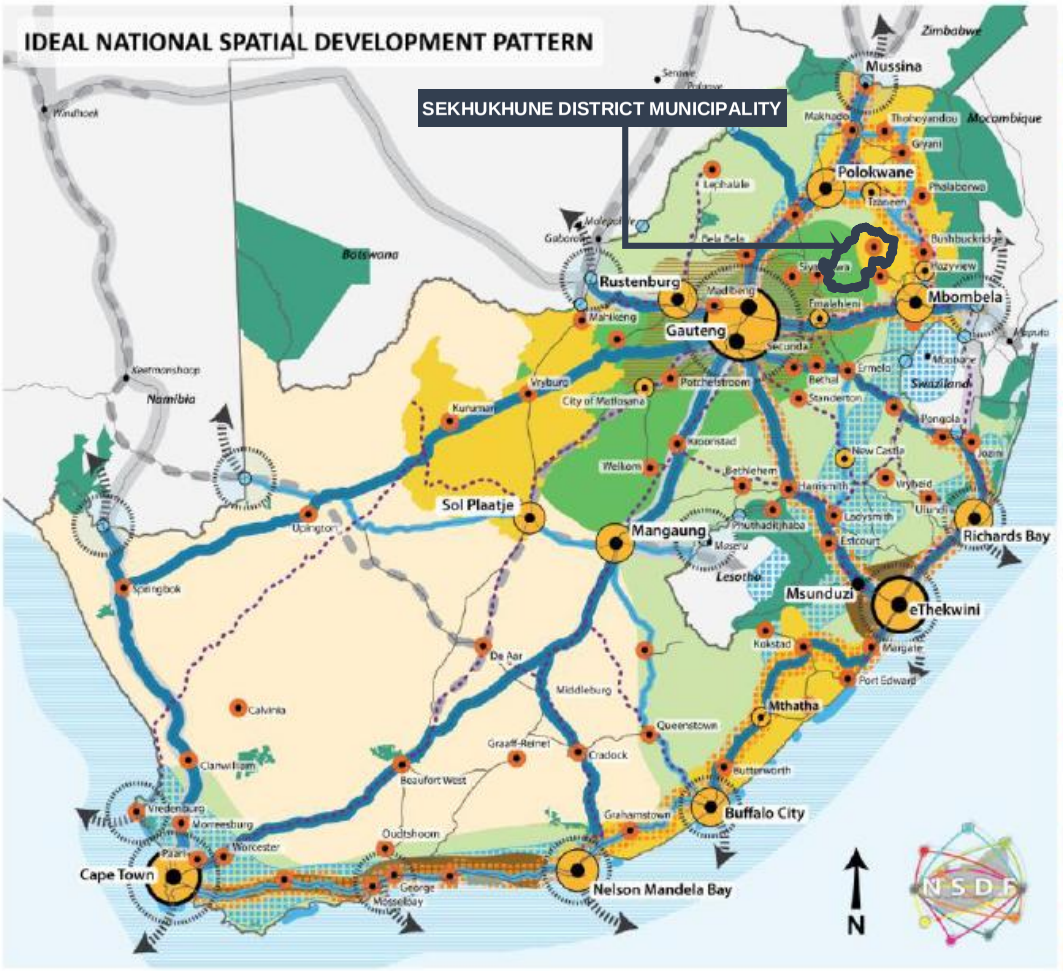


Source: National Spatial Development Framework

Additionally, it recognises the significance of rural markets, which offer resources and a labour force needed by urban areas to sustain the economy and its population. This creates a symbiotic relationship between urban and rural markets, with rural markets serving as the backbone of production and urban markets driving demand. With the enviable population increase in urban areas, rural areas suffer from the pressure of production, and more so, the need to introduce innovative agricultural practices that will ensure output, improve efficiency, and delivery of products.

The NSDF classified the district municipality as one of the country's Resource Production Heartlands, as shown in **Figure 3.1**. Thus, noting the following investment guidelines for Sekhukhune District;

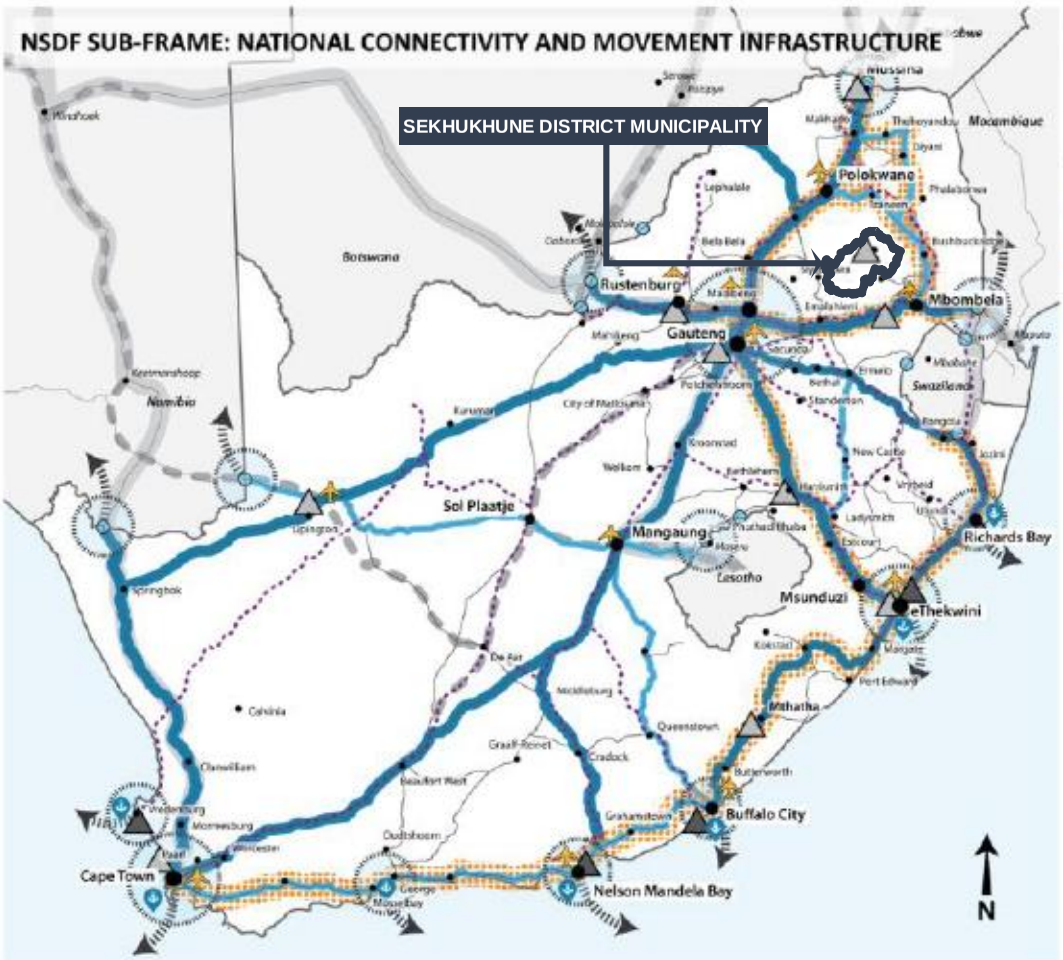
NATIONAL SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK (NSDF) 2050



NATIONAL SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT PRIORITIES

- National Urban Regions
- National Urban Nodes
- Regional Development Anchors
- National Coastal Corridor
- National Transformation Corridor
- National Innovation Belt
- Key National Development Corridors
- Import/Export Nodes
- Key National Roads
- Key Regional Roads
- Key Rail Routes
- Inter-regional Road Corridors
- Inter-regional Rail Corridors
- Border Posts
- Agri-Enterprise and Small-scale Farming Resource Region
- National Resource Production Heartland
- Arid-Agri Region
- Ocean & Aqua Culture Production Region
- Eco-Resource Production Region
- National Protected Areas and Transfrontier Parks
- Marine Protection Area

3.1



NATIONAL SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT PRIORITIES

- Inter-regional Road Corridors
- Inter-regional Rail Corridors
- Key National Roads
- Key Regional Roads
- Key National Development Corridors
- Key Rail Routes

- Import/Export Nodes
- Harbours
- Roads
- International Airports
- IDZ (Industrial Development Zones)
- Special Economic Zones

3.2

- Safeguarding high-value agricultural land by applying "rural edges" at the boundaries between regional rural areas and urban regions and nodes, while effectively managing competing land uses;
- Preserving high-value agricultural land, ensuring that it is well utilised, and managing competing development pressures in support of (1) national food security, (2) economic growth, and (3) social stability; and
- Guiding the development of land with high agricultural production potential, while promoting small-scale agriculture and the growth of resource-based enterprises.

The policy furthermore emphasises the importance of supporting stressed rural regions centered on mining, and, in the case of SDM, areas such as Burgersfort, Steelpoort, Roossenekal and Marble Hall, where mining occurs. Accordingly, a Special Economic Zone is proposed in the central district, as shown in **Figure 3.2.**

The National Transformation Corridor is highlighted as one of the National Strategic Action Areas and is demarcated in the northern parts of the district, mainly in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM and Makhuduthamaga LM, as the Eastern Escarpment Transformation Corridor (see **Figure 3.3**). The purpose of the National Transformation Corridor is to ensure consolidated development, support regional development anchors, support national resource production regions, ensure connectivity and movement infrastructure, and preserve ecological areas and water resources.

Accordingly, within the Transformation Corridor, Burgersfort, together with Lydenburg, which lies on the borders of the local municipality, has been identified as a Regional Development Anchor. Several Rural Service Centres are also identified to support the surrounding local communities, namely Madiseng, Driekop, Penge, and Bogalatladi, which all lie within the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, specifically along the R37.

As depicted in **Figure 3.4**, the identified Eastern Escarpment Transformation Corridor constitutes one of the three (3) Transformation Corridors identified nationally. The corridor highlights key development opportunities earmarked along these transformation corridors, as well as development constraints and challenges that need to be addressed. Critical opportunities identified, relevant to the Sekhukhune District Municipality, include international and domestic tourism, rural enterprises and small-scale manufacturing, agro-processing and beneficiation, game farming and related industries, as well as large-scale manufacturing and the establishment of Special Economic Zones. Key challenges highlighted include limited economic diversification and the impacts of climate change, particularly on water availability and rising temperatures.

2.4.13. National Transport Master Plan (MATMAP 2050)

The National Transport Master Plan (NATMAP) is a long-term strategic framework designed to guide the development of South Africa's transport system up to 2050. It aims to create an integrated, efficient, and sustainable transport network that supports economic growth, social development, and environmental sustainability. The plan aims to enhance connectivity and access between urban and rural environments, providing a strategic framework for future road and rail infrastructure investments. This alignment ensures consistency with national development goals and spatial policies.

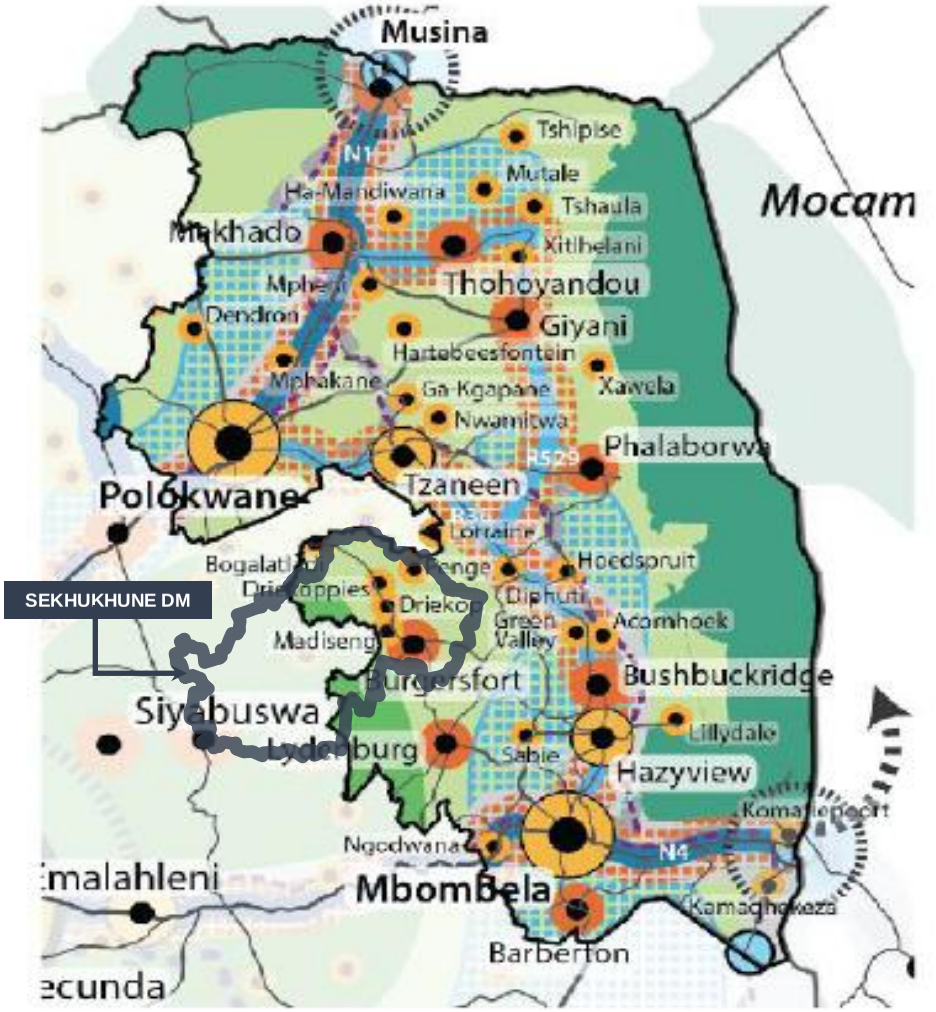
The following were indicated in the NATMP policy concerning the Sekhukhune District Municipality;

Highlighted Groblersdal as an Outer Core and as such a large town with several service functions and a peri-urban agglomeration posing characteristics of both urban and rural features. With that, the proposed highlights for the district include the construction of a Provincial Passenger Rail linking the City of Tshwane Metropolitan Municipality with the Sekhukhune DM through Groblersdal and Jane

NATIONAL SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK (NSDF) 2050

NATIONAL TRANSFORMATION CORRIDORS

EASTERN ESCARPMENT TRANSFORMATION CORRIDOR



Legend

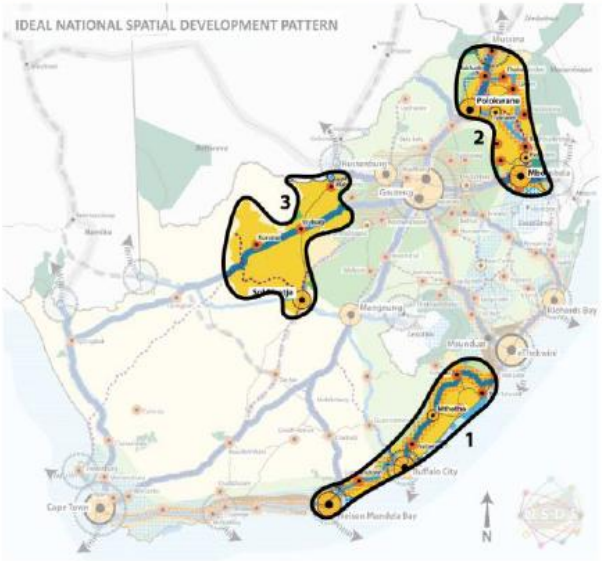
- National Urban Nodes
- Regional Development Anchors
- Rural Service Centres
- Key National Development Corridors
- Agri-Enterprise Small-Scale Farming Resource Region
- National Resource Production Heartland
- Eco-Resource Production Region
- National Protected Areas and Transfrontier Parks
- Import/ Export Nodes
- Import/ Export Nodes
- Key National Roads
- Key Regional Roads
- Key Rail Routes
- Inter-Regional Road Corridor
- Inter-Regional Rail Corridor

3.3

NATIONAL TRANSFORMATION CORRIDORS

DEVELOPMENT OPPORTUNITIES/PROSPECTS

- Human Capital Development, Youth, People, Service Demand
- International& Local Tourism
- Rural Enterprises & Small Scale Manufacturing
- Small-Scale Agglomeration-Based Service & Trade Economies
- High value & Small Scale Agriculture Potential
- Strategic National Ecosystem Areas
- Strategic National Water Source Production Areas
- Agro-Processing & Beneficiation & Game Farming & Industry
- Forestry & Related Beneficiation
- Ocean-Related Fishing & Related Enterprises
- Large Scale Manufacturing
- Special Economic Zones



National Transformation Corridors:
(1) Coastal Transformation Corridor, (2) Eastern Escarpment Transformation Corridor, and (3) Northwestern Transformation Corridor

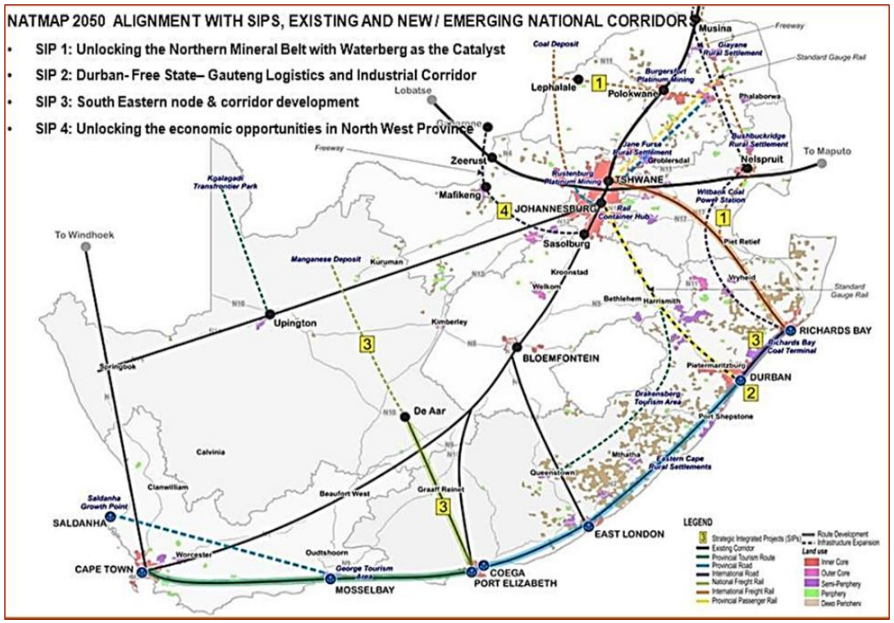
DEVELOPMENT OBSTACLES/CHALLENGES

- Scattered Dense Rural Settlement, Service Sustainability
- Inadequate & Weak Health, Education Services & Housing
- Sprawling Growing Urban and Need for "New Cities"
- Lack of Economic Diversification
- Resource limit, Stressed Ecosystems Catchments CBAs SWSs
- Small Scale & High Value Agriculture Potential Not Harnessed
- Climatic Impact: Water availability, Temperature increase
- Rural-to-Rural Transport, Market & Infrastructure Gaps
- Municipal Service Infrastructure Backlogs & Maintenance Gaps
- Communication Infrastructure Coverage Gaps
- Inadequate Government Capability, Municipal Financial Viability
- Out-Migration, Social Vulnerability, Dependencies & Poverty
- Challenges re Governance, Land Management, Access to land

3.4

Furse Rural Settlement, extending north-eastward into the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM and the Greater Giyani LM.

Figure 3.5: National Transport Master Plan (NATMP)



The NATMP also recommends establishing a provincial road to directly connect Gauteng Province with the Sekhukhune District, passing through Groblersdal, Jane Furse, and Burgersfort. This route would support regional traffic, including commuter and freight transport, while improving mobility and facilitating movement across the central part of the district municipality.

2.5.14. National Growth Path

The New Growth Path (NGP) aims to promote sustainable economic growth and eradicate poverty by expanding employment opportunities, increasing household incomes, and enhancing equity and income distribution. It supports the growth of domestic and regional markets while enhancing the global competitiveness of South African goods and services by placing emphasis on exports to regional and emerging markets.

The NGP prioritises sectors with high job creation potential, primarily driven by the private sector, to ensure strong and inclusive growth over the next decade. At the core of the strategy is a significant infrastructure investment, seen as a key catalyst for stimulating employment and economic activity across various sectors.

The framework identifies five key investment areas, namely energy, transport, communication, water, and housing. This statement expresses that investment in these key areas will create jobs in the construction, operation, and maintenance of infrastructure. The new growth path views the infrastructure programme as a catalyst to develop a local supplier industry that manufactures components for the build programme.

With that, the Sekhukhune District Municipality Spatial Development Framework needs to spatially accommodate the Job Drivers of the New Growth Path and the Industrial Policy Action Plan, which involve infrastructure development for employment and development, including:

i. Industrial areas
ii. Infrastructure
iii. The Comprehensive Rural Development Programme (CRDP) attends to a large rural population
iv. Tourism, agriculture, mining, and agro-processing strategic interventions (Job Driver 2)
v. The green economy aims to ensure the conservation of the environment, providing employment opportunities in the mining, agricultural, and tourism sectors.

The objectives of sustainable development to support the alleviation of poverty need to form an integral part of decision-making at the Sekhukhune District Municipality. The optimal integration of social, economic, institutional, political, physical, and engineering services into decision-making is a prerequisite for coherent growth. The plan influences the SDF and should be considered another baseline when proposals are made in the later phases of the project.

SYNTHESIS: IMPLICATIONS OF NATIONAL POLICIES, INITIATIVES AND PROJECTS

National legislation and policies are significant, as they collectively provide the legal, institutional, and policy foundation for development planning, governance, and service delivery, which the district must consider and implement within its jurisdiction. So as to align with national priorities and forge the national vision to promote a developmental local government, spatial transformation and justice, and cooperative governance.

These national policies promote long-term economic growth, poverty reduction, and improved access to infrastructure and basic services, while placing particular emphasis on adaptive planning to safeguard food security and sustain livelihoods in the district. Collectively, national legislations and policies trickle down (District-Municipal spheres) to guide and support equitable socio-economic transformation in Sekhukhune District's predominant rural areas, and help prioritise projects and decision-making.

PROVINCIAL LEGISLATION

2.5. PROVINCIAL LEGISLATION

2.5.1. Limpopo Development Plan 2020-2050

Vision

"The Limpopo Development Plan envisions a "resilient, vibrant, and prosperous Province"

The LSDF plays both a directive and coordinating role in planning and implementation in the province. It sets the strategic direction for sector planning and municipal planning in the province. The framework aligns with the National Development Plan (NDP) Vision 2023, the National Spatial Development Framework (NSDF), and the Medium-term Development Plan (MTDP) priorities. To realise the objectives outlined in the above-mentioned policies and other higher-level strategic policies such as the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), and the African Union's Agenda 2063, the Limpopo Development Plan aligns with and reinforces these priorities at the provincial level, while also articulating a spatial vision that reflects the province's spatial context. To facilitate alignment between planning and implementation, this tool guides the spatial targeting of investment and spending in the province.

The LSDF provides a strategic link between national and municipal spatial planning, interpreting the NSDF into provincial realities to address economic and socio-economic imbalances.

The following presents the aim of the Limpopo Development Plan;

- Establish a strategic framework that supports inclusive economic growth, social advancement, and environmental preservation;
- Align provincial initiatives with national development priorities;
- Promote coordinated planning and resource mobilisation throughout the province and across sectors;
- Stimulate industrialisation and job creation; and
- Promote equitable development to benefit all communities.

2.5.2. Limpopo Provincial Spatial Development Framework (PSDF)

The Limpopo Provincial Spatial Development Framework was developed as one of the requirements mandated by SPLUMA. The aim of the Limpopo Spatial Development Framework (LSDF) is to promote social, economic and environmental sustainability throughout the province and to ensure that it is relevant to the development needs of all the dispersed urban and rural communities in the Limpopo Province that it represents. It envisions a provincial spatial structure where the natural environment and valuable agricultural land in rural areas are protected for future generations, with a strong, diverse and growing economy focused around a range of nodal areas that offer its residents high-quality living environments and good job opportunities in a sustainable manner.

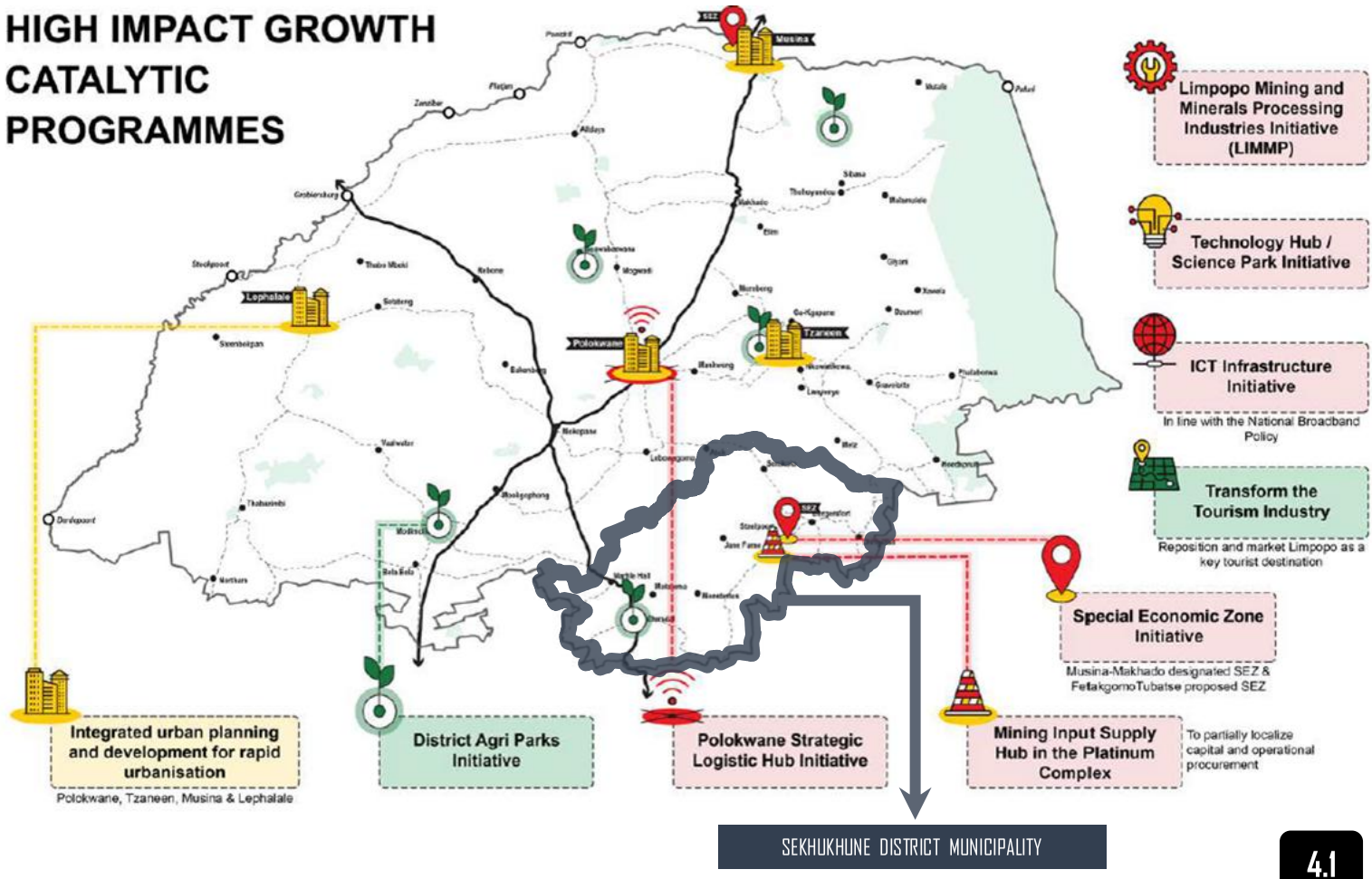
The spatial development objectives of the Limpopo Spatial Development Framework are the following:

- Capitalise on the Province's strategic location within the SADC region to facilitate trade links and regional cooperation on resource sharing;
- Capitalise on, and improve regional and local connectivity to establish a connected network of nodes and settlements;
- Provide a strategic and coherent rationale for public sector investment, including engineering, community and economic infrastructure, to optimise service delivery;
- Encourage urban and rural spatial restructuring and sustainable human settlement as a necessity;
- Aggressively protect and enhance the province's natural resources, including scarce fresh water sources and high biodiversity landscapes;
- Ensuring the preservation of the province's valuable agricultural land as a scarce resource and national asset;
- Consolidate and enhance the province's ecotourism product;
- Encourage and institutionalise the sustainable development of its massive mineral potential and encourage diversification and industrialisation through green economy initiatives; and
- Create an enabling environment for both large- and small-scale business development (retail, office, commercial, industrial).

In terms of the development proposals specific to the Sekhukhune DM,

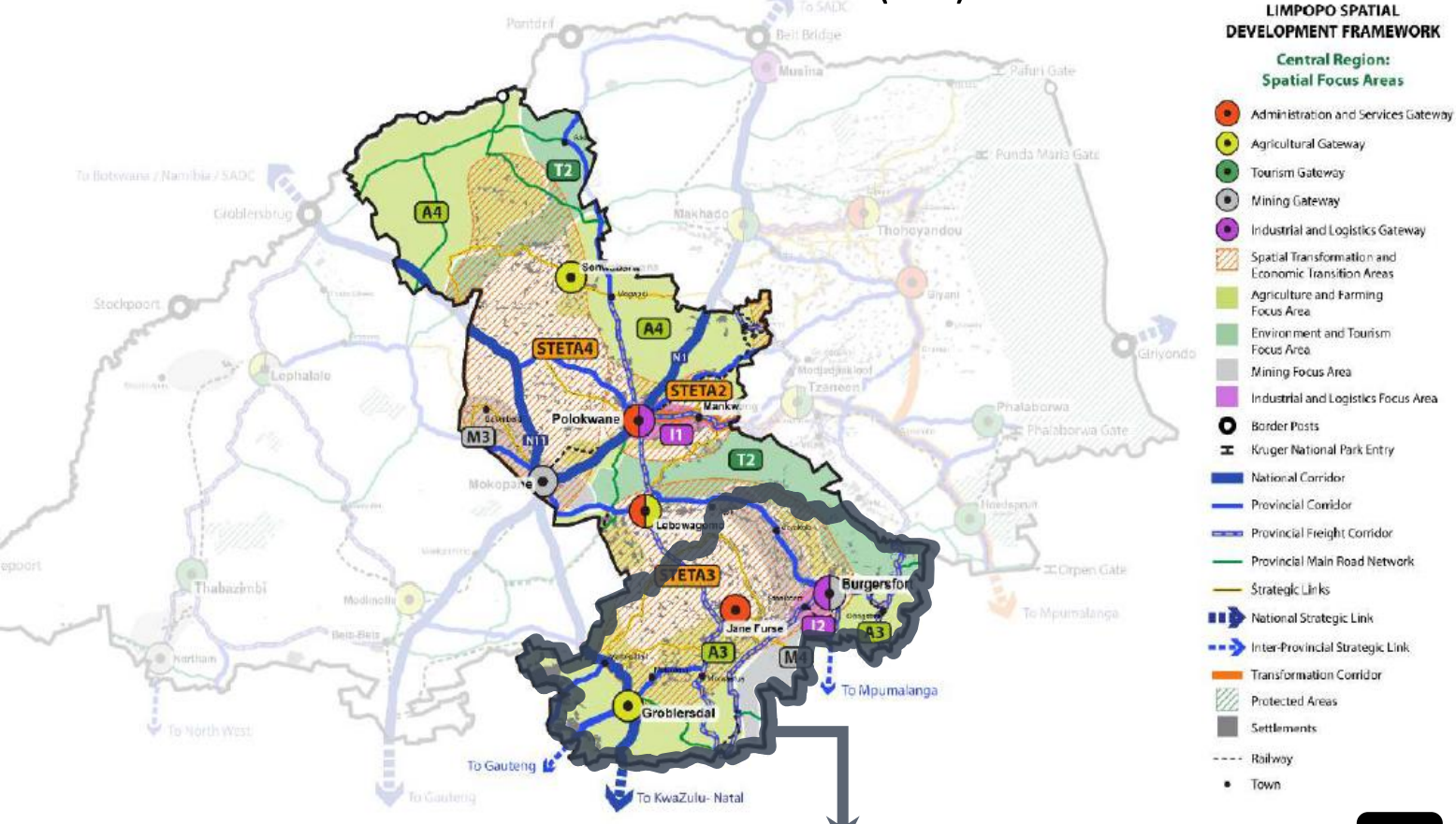
- **Figure 4.1** depicts catalytic programmes of high-impact growth projects. As shown, an Agri-Park is proposed in the district, earmarked in Groblersdal. From a mining perspective and an industrial perspective, a Special Economic Zone and a Mining Input Supply Hub are proposed in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM. This will help maximise input from surrounding mining industries to optimise the utilisation and value addition of local mineral resources, while simultaneously creating opportunities for the local economy;
- In terms of spatial focus areas in the district, as shown in **Figure 4.2**. Burgersfort is classified as a Provincial Urban Node and, owing to the prominence and anticipated expansion of the mining and industrial sectors in the region, the Burgersfort-Steelpoort area has been identified as a Mining Gateway within the district. Groblersdal has been identified as an

LIMPOPO PROVINCIAL SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK (2024)



4.1

LIMPOPO PROVINCIAL SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK (2024)



4.2

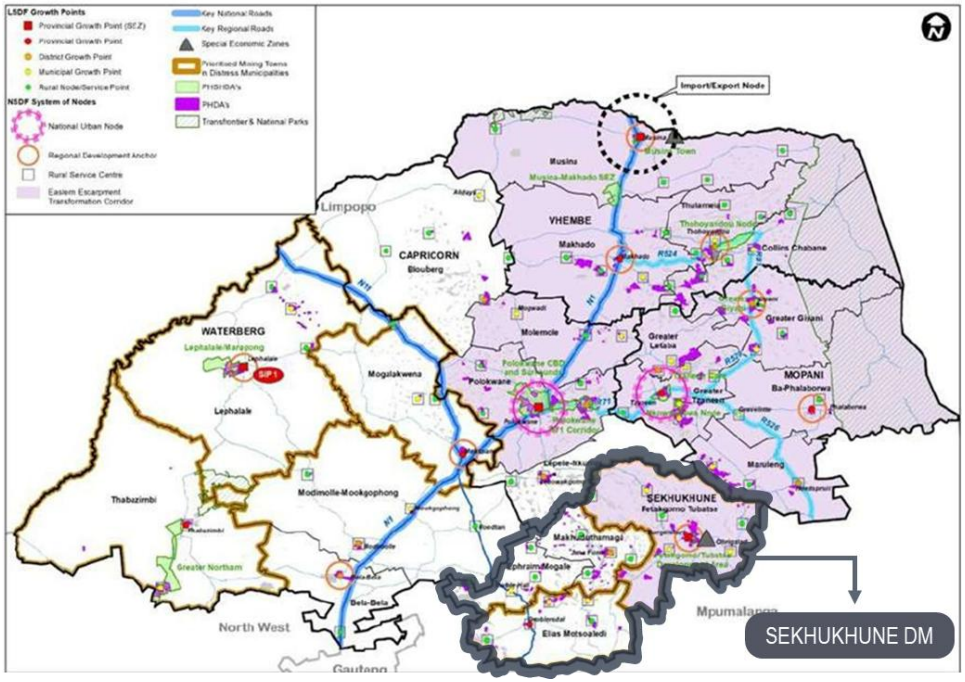
Agricultural Gateway, with support from the Marble Hall area. The Jane Furse area is proposed to function as an Administration and Services Gateway, given its central location within the district and its role in serving a large number of rural settlements.

- Pertaining to the nodal hierarchy at the provincial perspective for the district. Burgersfort is shown as a Provincial Growth Point, and the towns of Groblersdal and Jane Furse are both classified as Regional Development Anchors, see on **Figure 4.3.**
- It is shown that most parts of the district are agriculturally focused at commercial and subsistence scales. The area between Marbel Hall-Jane Furse and parts of Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM is classified as a Spatial Transformation and Economic Transition Area, implying that the area should be strategically targeted for human settlements and infrastructure investment to bring about spatial integration and boost the local economy.
- **Figure 4.4** illustrates the proposed Passenger Rail Network referred to as the Moloto Corridor, which is suggested through the central parts of the Sekhukhune district with a ring-rail network in the northern parts between Jane Furse and Burgersfort linking to Lebowakgomo. Accompanying the rail network are proposed Main Railway Terminals, located in the three distinct areas, namely, Groblersdal, Jane Furse and Burgersfort.

2.5.3. Limpopo Multi-Year Human Settlement Development Plan 2019-2024

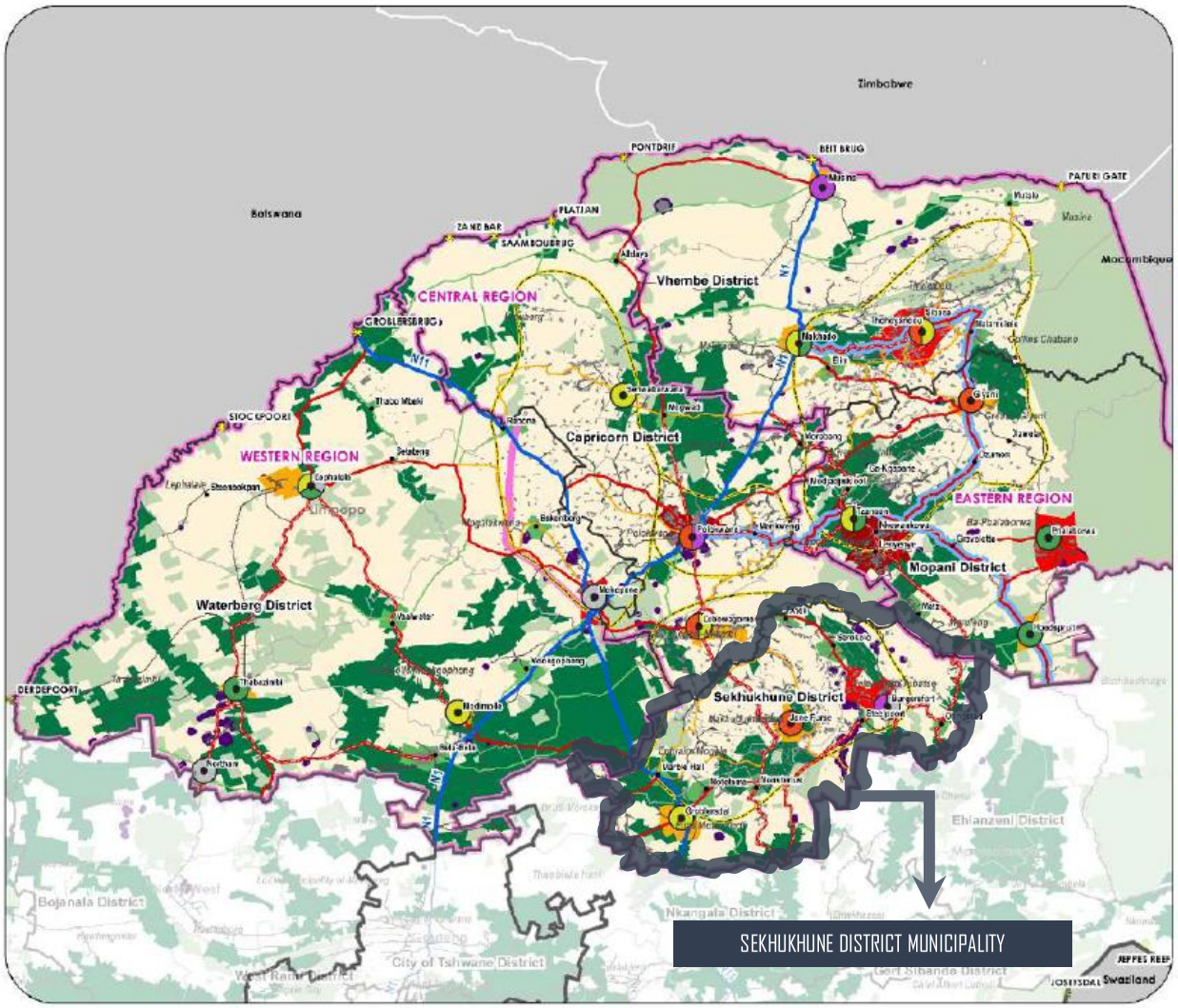
The MYHSDP aimed to address the province's human settlement challenges by aligning development with other provincial plans and promoting sustainable and integrated settlements. The plan recommended the following; align human settlement development with other national and provincial initiatives related to spatial targeting, consolidation and prioritised investment to help alleviate poverty and promote spatial integration. As depicted in **Figure 4.5** several priority housing development areas are identified in the Sekhukhune district predominantly close to the towns; Burgersfort, Groblersdal, Jane Furse, and a few around the Marble Hall and also along the regional routes.

Figure 4.5: Priority Housing Development Areas



2.5.4. Limpopo Revitalisation of Agriculture and Agro-Processing Value Chain Plan, 2021

The goal of the Limpopo Revitalisation of Agriculture and Agro-processing Value Chain (RAAVC) Plan, approved in June 2021, is to increase agricultural production, promote agro-processing, and foster economic growth. This should result in job creation, improved



LIMPOPO
PROVINCIAL GOVERNMENT
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

Limpopo Spatial Development Framework

Composite SDF

Nodes
- National Urban Node
- Provincial Urban Node
- Regional Development Anchor
- Local Service Centre

Infrastructure Network
- National Corridors
- Provincial Freight Corridors
- Provincial Corridors
- Provincial Main Road Network
- Strategic Links
- Transformation Corridors
- Railways

Productive Regions
- Productive Regions
- Agriculture Area
- Proposed High Potential Agricultural Areas
- Environmental & Tourism Area
- Mining Areas
- Administration and Services Gateway
- Agricultural Gateway
- Tourism Gateway
- Mining Gateway
- Industrial and Logistics

Spatial Transformation
- Spatial Transformation and Economic Transition Areas
- Settlements

Sources:
Municipal Demarcation Board, 2018
DALRRD, 2021

Scale (A3) - 1 : 1,700,000
0 20 40 80 Kilometers

Contact:
Office of the Premier
Mewanang Building
40 Hans van Rensburg Street
Polokwane
Tel: 015 287 6000

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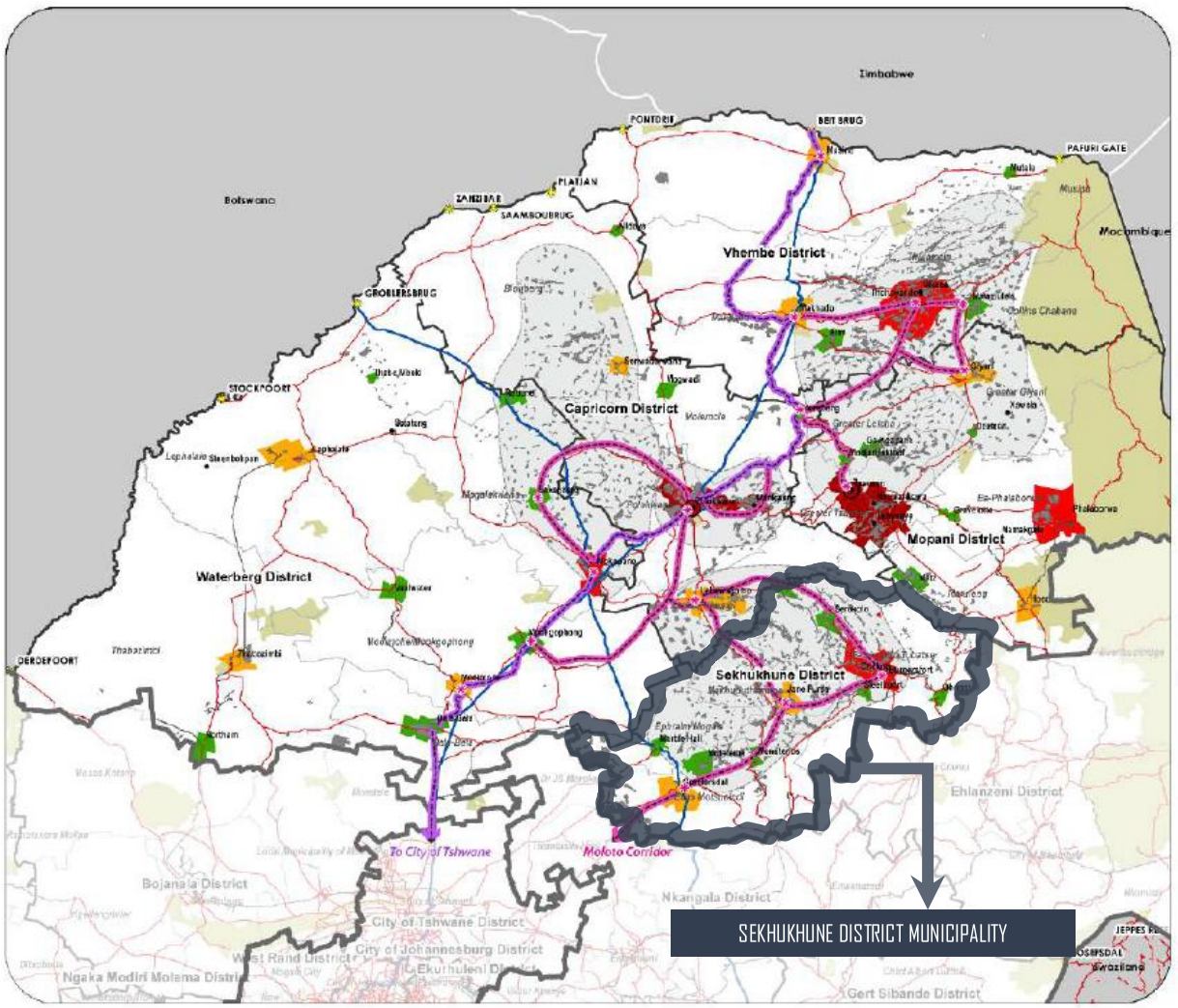


LIMPOPO
PROVINCIAL GOVERNMENT
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

Limpopo Spatial Development Framework

Proposed Passenger Rail Network

- Border Posts
- Main Towns

Nodes
- National Urban Node
- Provincial Urban Node
- Regional Development
- Local Service Centre
- National Roads
- Provincial Roads
- Railways
- Settlements

Nodal Areas
- National Urban Node
- Provincial Urban Node
- Regional Development
- Local Service Centre
- District Municipalities
- Local Municipalities
- Nature Reserves

Proposed Passenger Rail
- Primary Railway Line (Existing)
- Proposed Passenger / Commuter Railway Line
- Proposed Main Railway Terminals
- Spatial Transformation and Economic Transition Areas

Sources:
Municipal Demarcation Board, 2018
CSIR, 2019
NSDF, 2022

Scale (A3) - 1 : 1,700,000
0 20 40 80 Kilometers

Contact:
Office of the Premier
Mewanang Building
40 Hans van Rensburg Street
Polokwane
Tel: 015 287 6000

4.4

food security, enhanced rural livelihoods, increased foreign exchange earnings from exports, and a significant contribution to the provincial socio-economic recovery.

2.5.5. Limpopo Industrial Master Plan 2020-2030

The Limpopo Industrial Master Plan is a strategic framework aligned with the Limpopo Development Plan (LDP) and the National Development Plan (NDP). Its aim is to stimulate industrial growth, create jobs, and improve the province's economy by focusing on key sectors like mining, agriculture, and tourism. The plan also emphasises the development of Special Economic Zones (SEZs) and Industrial Parks, including the development of the Musina-Makhado SEZ.

2.5.6. Limpopo Tourism Growth Strategy

The strategy is a holistic and integrated tourism plan closely aligned with the Revised National Tourism Sector Strategy (2016-2026). Its aim is to leverage the province's unique tourism assets for economic growth and development, while addressing current issues specifically related to the tourism sector environment in the Limpopo Province. With a focus on promoting ecotourism and sustainable tourism practices. The plan was a comprehensive framework designed to harness the province's tourism potential, promote sustainable development, and contribute to the province's overall economic prosperity.

2.5.7. Limpopo Green Economy Plan

The plan has short-term, medium-term, and long-term goals, which include creating jobs and improving environmental quality as short-term objectives. Medium-term goals involve creating enabling conditions for green growth and production patterns, and building a new economic/environmental paradigm for Limpopo as the long-term goal. The Limpopo Green Economy Plan focuses on the local production and consumption, encompassing the efficient use of energy, water, and care of natural and created resources. The Limpopo Province has the potential to be the national pioneer in the Green Economy due to:

- The perfect geographic situation to develop a variety of green industries andeconomies of scale.
- The invaluable mineral resource base for local beneficiation.
- Unexploited biodiversity resources for green tourism and payment for ecosystemservices
- Vibrant young population to enthusiastically engage in new, innovative, and developmental economic activities.

SYNTHESIS: IMPLICATIONS OF PROVINCIAL POLICIES AND INITIATIVES

Provincial policies play a pivotal role in the district in that they provide a coordinated, strategic vision that guides spatial planning, infrastructure investment, and socio-economic development. These frameworks promote consolidated settlement patterns, efficient service delivery, and targeted development within identified main economic nodes and corridors, while supporting key economic sectors such as mining, agriculture, and tourism. They also emphasise environmental management strategies, spatial equity, and improved access to social and economic opportunities, and serve as key instruments for aligning municipal planning and informing land use management and development decision-making within the district.

DISTRICT POLICIES

2.6. DISTRICT POLICIES

2.6.1. Adjacent District Spatial Development Frameworks

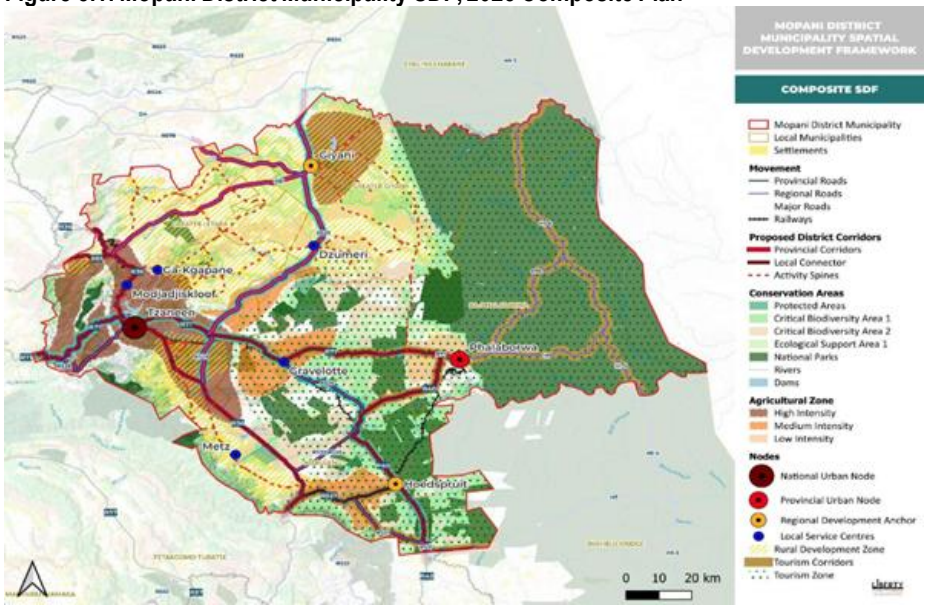
The Sekhukhune District Municipality within the province is bordered by four other district municipalities namely Capricorn LM to the north, Mopani to the east, Ehlanzeni to the south-east, and Waterberg to the north-west. Additionally, it also borders Nkangala to the south. The following section outlines the key spatial development proposals identified in the Spatial Development Frameworks of the adjacent district municipalities.

I. Mopani District Municipality – Spatial Development Framework (2025)

The Mopani District SDF outlines the following spatial development proposals;

- Emphases the importance of preserving and effectively managing the ecological network and national resources and protected areas, by way of-implementing identified development strategies. These encompass identifying conservation areas and designating specific development controls that would aim in their conservation.
- Concentrating economic activities and social services in the identified nodes and ensure an effective nodal connectivity via a well-coordinated transportation networks. In terms of nodal hierarchy, Tzaneen is classified as a National Urban Node; Hoedspruit and Giyani are identified as Regional Development Anchors. Lower Service Centres identified to serve surrounding rural settlements are namely, Modjadjiskloof, Ga Kgapane, Metz, and Gravelotte.
- The framework seeks to promote equitable development across both urban and rural areas within the district municipality by ensuring that service delivery, infrastructure investment, efforts towards spatial transformations and skills development are directed to both environments.
- Expressed the importance of strengthening of tourism in Maruleng, Ba-Phalaborwa, and Greater Giyani through infrastructure investment; such as adequate roads, signage and services, by private-sector investment regarding a range of accommodation, attractions and marketing. Furthermore, manufacturing and trade should be advocated for with alternatives of repurposing and using underutilised (yet suitable) buildings for industrial, manufacturing, and office space to maintain a growing local economy.

Figure 5.1: Mopani District Municipality SDF, 2025 Composite Plan

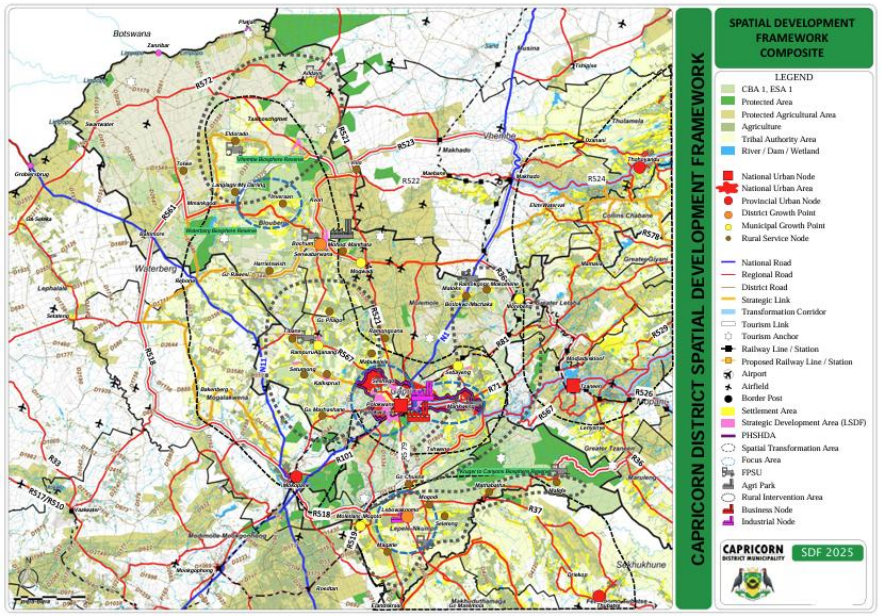


II. Capricorn District Municipality (2025)

The SDF addresses the following spatial proposals for the district municipality;

- Proposed the protection and management of the natural environment and natural resources which includes containing and managing urban sprawl through enforcing guidelines and manage land development, ecological network, and water resources;
- Promote the integration of urban and rural settlements through infill development, densification, and redevelopment to support coordinated spatial transformation through improve movement and accessibility, and service delivery;
- Highlight the importance of the district's strategic location along national and provincial transport routes, including the N1 national road and freight rail network, which strengthens regional connectivity and creates opportunities for logistics, trade, and economic development. Further proposes that freight rail network be upgraded and passage rail services be investigated between Polokwane-Mokopane; Polokwane-Gauteng a new high-speed rail to be examined; Mankweng-Polokwane-Seshego and lastesly between Polokwane-Jane Furse Moloto passenger rail.
- Facilitate the establishment of human settlements to be effectively managed to maximise the efficient use of existing land and infrastructural services. The municipality should promote compact, higher-density, mixed-use developments, particularly along public transport corridors and around transport nodes, to enhance walkability, reduce urban sprawl, and support sustainable spatial development. These includes the nodal areas of Lebowakgomo Focus Areas, Morebeng Node, Botlokwa Node, Mohodi Rural Focus Area, etc. Furthermore, provide a cluster of community facilities within the nodal areas to promote accessibility, and provide a wide diversity of offerings within the nodes.
- Align infrastructure planning and implementation with land use management and settlement upgrading programmes to support coordinated, efficient, and sustainable development.
- From an agricultural focused initiatives, an Agri Park is proposed in Senwabarwana. Lower-order Farmers Production Support Units (FPSUs) should be established at strategically located rural nodes to provide accessible agricultural support services to surrounding farming communities, ideally within a 30 km service radius. The following areas are proposed to contain a FPSU are earmarked in Eldorado, Bochum, Rampuru/ Aganang, Ramokgopa, Mankweng, and Mafefe.

Figure 5.2: Capricorn District Municipality SDF, 2025 Consolidated Plan

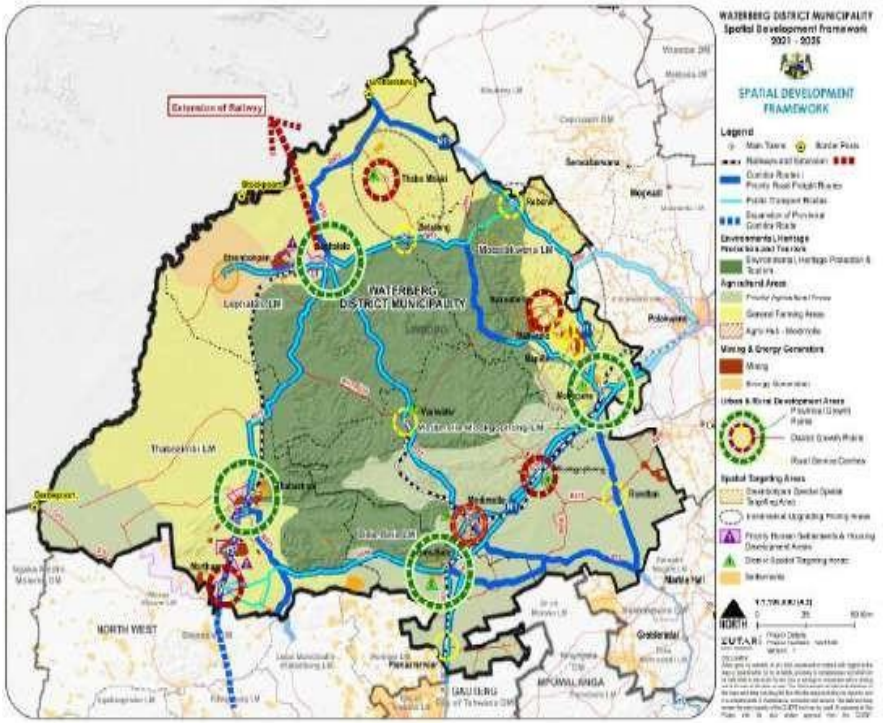


III. Waterberg District Municipality (2025)

The Waterberg SDF highlights the following spatial proposals;

- Emphasised the strengthening the settlement hierarchy by prioritising investment and higher-order services in major urban centres while enhancing rural service centres to improve access to essential facilities, public services, and economic opportunities.
- Promote an integrated human settlements to encourage compact urban form, infill development, mixed-use land development, and improved access to social amenities, economic opportunities, and essential services.
- Prioritise investing in strategic growth nodes based on their comparative advantages.
- The framework expressed the support of rural livelihoods by improving access to basic services, agricultural support infrastructure, and economic opportunities within rural settlements.
- Promote t integrating infrastructure planning by coordinating the provision of water, sanitation, electricity, roads, and social facilities with planned settlement growth.
- Promote eco-tourism and conservation of the natural environment by way of protecting the Waterberg Biosphere, ecological corridors, biodiversity areas, and other environmentally sensitive landscapes while supporting the development of wildlife and eco-tourism.
- Alluded to supporting logistics and industrial development along strategic transport corridors and freight routes to leverage regional connectivity, and strengthen economic growth.

Figure 5.3: Waterberg District Municipality SDF, 2021 Composite Plan



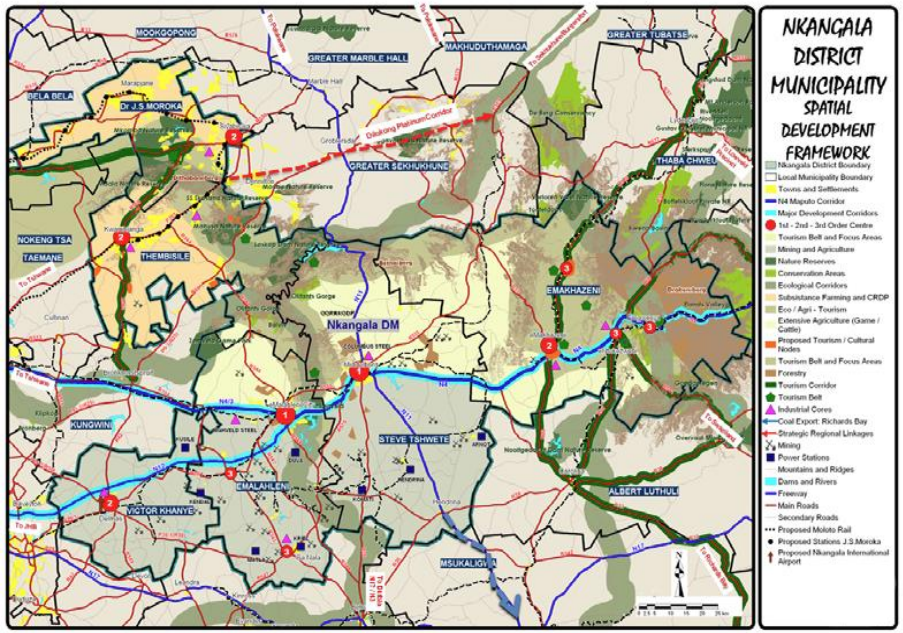
IV. Nkangala District Municipality

The Nkangala District Municipality's Spatial Development Framework (SDF) guides spatial planning and development within the district, and thus highlights the following spatial proposals;

- The district is strategically located, bordering Gauteng and hosting the Maputo Corridor, which offers significant economic development potential.
- The SDF addresses issues like land use management, infrastructure development, environmental sustainability, and economic development.

- The SDF recognises a hierarchy of service centres within the district, with the nodes of Middleburg and Emalahleni as primary service centres; Delmas and eMakhazeni towns classified as secondary centres, providing services and economic opportunities to the surrounding rural areas.
- Protect high-potential agricultural land and support agricultural value chains, irrigation development, and agro-processing to strengthen rural economies.
- Conserve the natural environment and eco-tourism activities, biodiversity areas, ecological corridors, and other environmentally sensitive landscapes while encouraging nature-based tourism. This includes promoting strategic tourism nodes and corridors, including Belfast, Dullstroom, and the R36 and R540 routes, to strengthen regional tourism, improve visitor access, and support local economic development. Tourism development should capitalise on these strategic gateways and scenic routes while protecting the district's rural character, natural landscapes, and cultural heritage from inappropriate development and over-commercialisation.
- Promote integrated land use management to coordinate residential, commercial, industrial, agricultural, conservation, and infrastructure development across the district. In order to ensure mining, agriculture, forestry, tourism, and industrial development while balancing economic growth with environmental protection and responsible land use management.
- Support industrial and logistics development along strategic transport corridors, particularly the N4 and major freight routes, to advocate investment opportunities along these which evidently create employment.
- Capitalise on the district's strategic location between Gauteng, Mozambique, and neighbouring districts to strengthen regional trade, investment, and economic integration

Figure 5.4: Nkangala District Municipality SDF, 2021 Composite Plan



V. Ehlanzeni District Municipality

The Ehlanzeni District SDF identifies the following key spatial developments proposals;

- Strengthen higher-order services while improving the role of secondary towns and rural service centres and prioritising critical investment capacity to ensure growth potential and opportunities.
- Promote effective land use management by enforcing urban edges to contain urban expansion, particularly where rural settlements encroach on environmentally sensitive areas, while encouraging compact development through infill and densification, optimising existing infrastructure, and supporting urban growth.

- Promote integrated human settlements through compact urban development, infill development, mixed land uses, and improved access to employment opportunities, public transport, and social facilities.
- The district to support economic diversification in sectors such as agriculture, forestry, mining, manufacturing, logistics, tourism, and agro-processing sectors in areas with high development potential to strengthen the local economy.
- Improve spatial integration by reducing historical spatial inequalities, strengthening linkages between areas of economic opportunity and communities, and promoting coordinated development across the district.
- Align infrastructure investment equality in urban and rural environments to support planned settlement development, ensure security in community livelihood and improve economic growth.

SEKHUKHUNE
DISTRICT MUNICIPALITY

SECTION THREE

STATUS QUO

3. DISTRICT SPATIAL STRUCTURE

The section below highlights the spatial structure of a district municipality, alluding to the physical attributes of the municipal landscape, including its natural features and the built environment. This will ultimately provide a lens through which to assess these different attributes and, accordingly, their interrelationship, which collectively constitute the makeup of the district's landscape.

3.1. SPATIAL STRUCTURE

Figure 6.1 illustrates the spatial structure and settlement pattern within the district, which is predominantly dispersed. This scattered distribution is largely a legacy of apartheid-era planning, the various traditional structures, and the influence of the area's ecological footprint traversing the northern and eastern extents. The majority of the population is predominantly in the central and north-western areas, while the eastern escarpment along the northern boundary has restricted further expansion in that direction. It is evident that the majority of the population is concentrated in the central and northwestern parts of the district, and the presence of the eastern escarpment along the northern boundary has constrained further expansion in that direction.

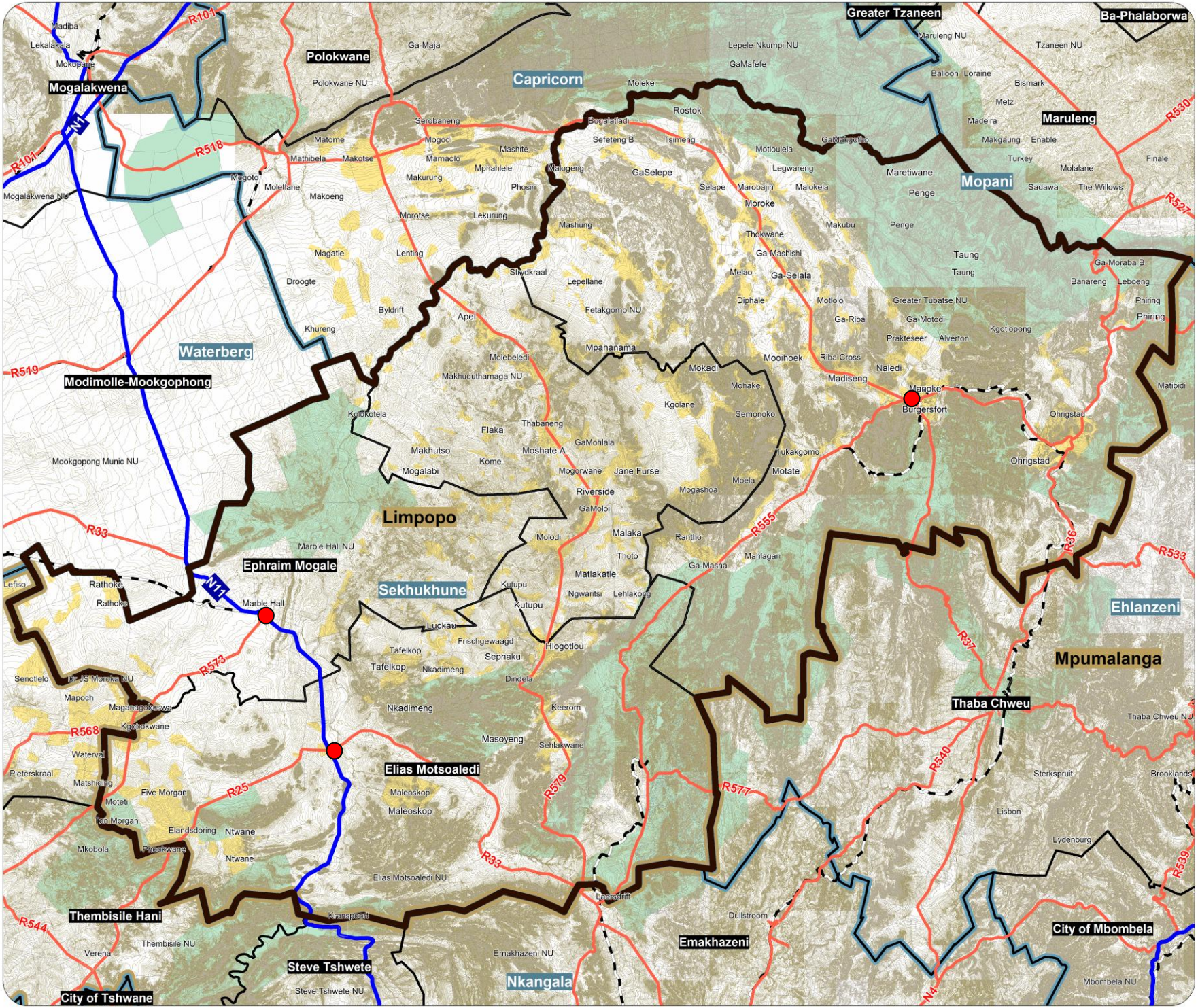
A continuous pattern of human settlement is evident in the northern parts of Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality, extending northward along the R579 and R555 regional routes into Makhuduthamaga and further into Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality. Subsequently, a continual settlement pattern forms in a north-westward direction, extending into the Lepelle-Nkumpi Local Municipality. Less developed areas, with little or no settlement are realised in parts of the Elias Motsoaledi and Ephraim Mogale, where it is most predominated by agriculture. Only a relatively small settlement cluster is evident in the far southern part of the district along the municipal borders.

The mountainous terrain has a significant influence on settlement patterns, acting as a natural constraint on where people settle and shaping the prospects for future development. Notable mountain ranges are most prominent in the northern parts of the district, south of the R37, within the Fetakgomo-Tubatse and Makhuduthamaga municipalities, as well as along the eastern boundary of Elias Motsoaledi, where protected areas such as the De Hoop Nature Reserve and the Kwaggavoetpad Nature Reserve are located.

Shown in **Figure 6.2** is the distribution of development intensity across the district municipality, highlighting areas ranging from densely developed to less developed. As shown, the most densely developed areas are located along national and regional routes. These include Groblersdal in Elias Motsoaledi, the Jane Furse business node in Makhuduthamaga, and the town of Burgersfort in Fetakgomo-Tubatse. The second tier of development is observed in areas such as the town of Marble Hall, the Glen Cowie and Phokwane business nodes, as well as along the R597 corridor, which also displays higher settlement density. Overall, the majority of the district is characterised by densely populated rural settlements spread across the central parts of its landscape.

In terms of informal settlements, the district is predominantly characterised by rural settlement patterns, particularly within the northern parts of Elias Motsoaledi and Ephraim Mogale local municipalities, as well as most areas of Makhuduthamaga and Fetakgomo-Tubatse local municipalities. Despite this predominantly rural character, areas located in close proximity to established towns and economic centres have experienced varying degrees of informal settlement development. This trend is attributed to the closest of employment opportunities and the access social services, and public transport.

Figure 6.1: Spatial Structure and Settlement Pattern



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

SPATIAL STRUCTURE AND SETTLEMENT PATTERN

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Nature Reserves
- Protected Areas
- Contours
- Main Towns
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway line

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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Sekhukhune District Municipality
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Groblersdal
0470

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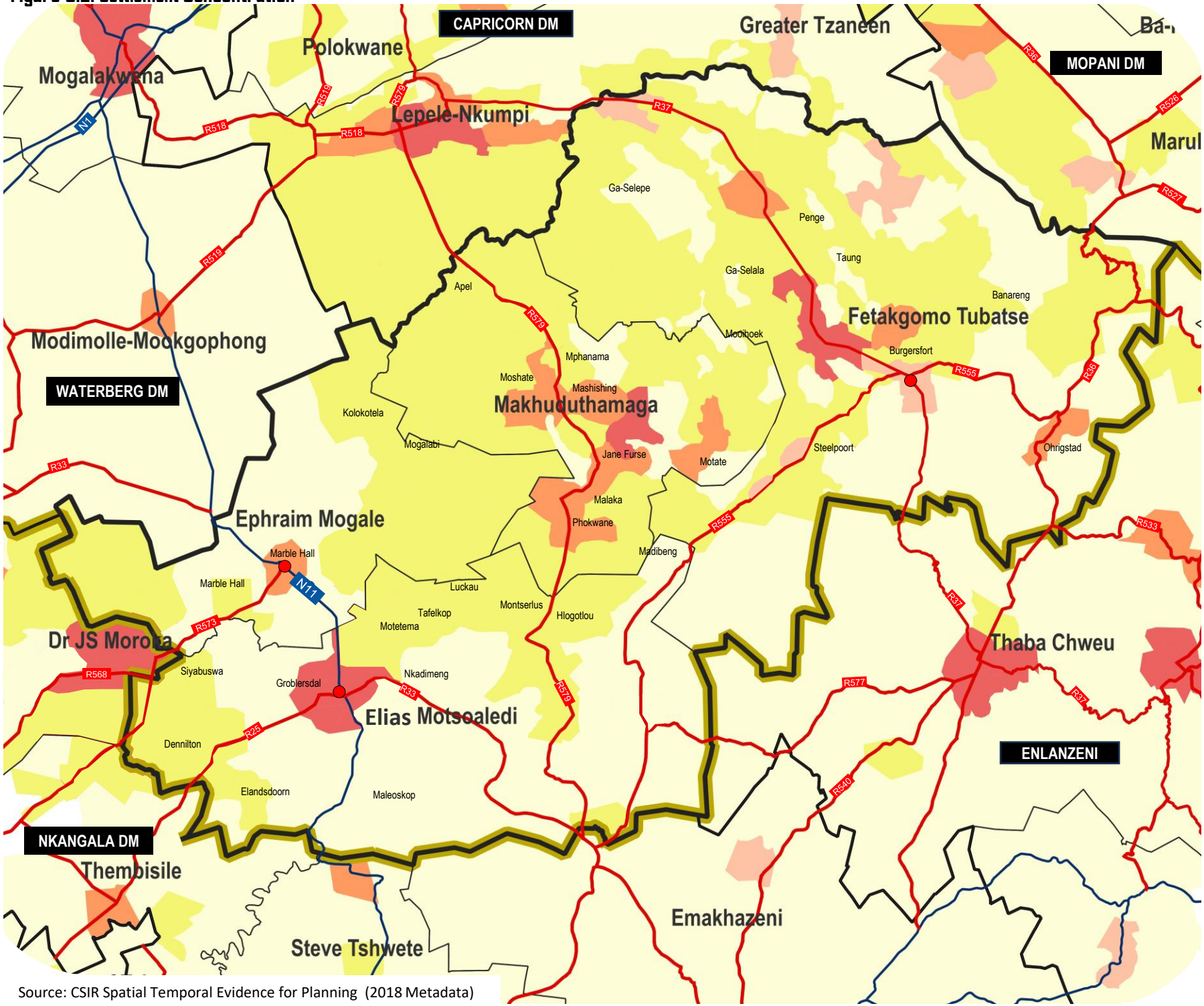
Figure 6.2: Settlement Concentration



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

SETTLEMENT CONCENTRATION

Legend

Roads
- Primary
- Secondary
- SDM Boundary
- Local Municipalities
- District Municipalities
- Provincial_boundry

- Sparsely Populated Rural Settlement Areas
- Dense Rural Settlement Areas & Villages
- Local Towns/Settlement Nodes
- Regional Service Centres

N

0 10 20 km

6.2

Source: CSIR Spatial Temporal Evidence for Planning (2018 Metadata)

As illustrated in **Figure 6.3**, the highest concentration of informal settlements is evident within the Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality, particularly in and around Elandsdoorn, Groblersdal town, Motetema, and the Roossenekal area, which is influenced by nearby mining activities. Smaller concentrations of informal dwellings are also present within the Ephraim Mogale and Fetakgomo-Tubatse local municipalities, mainly in areas situated close to town.

3.2. ADMINISTRATIVE BOUNDARIES

3.2.1. Ward Boundaries

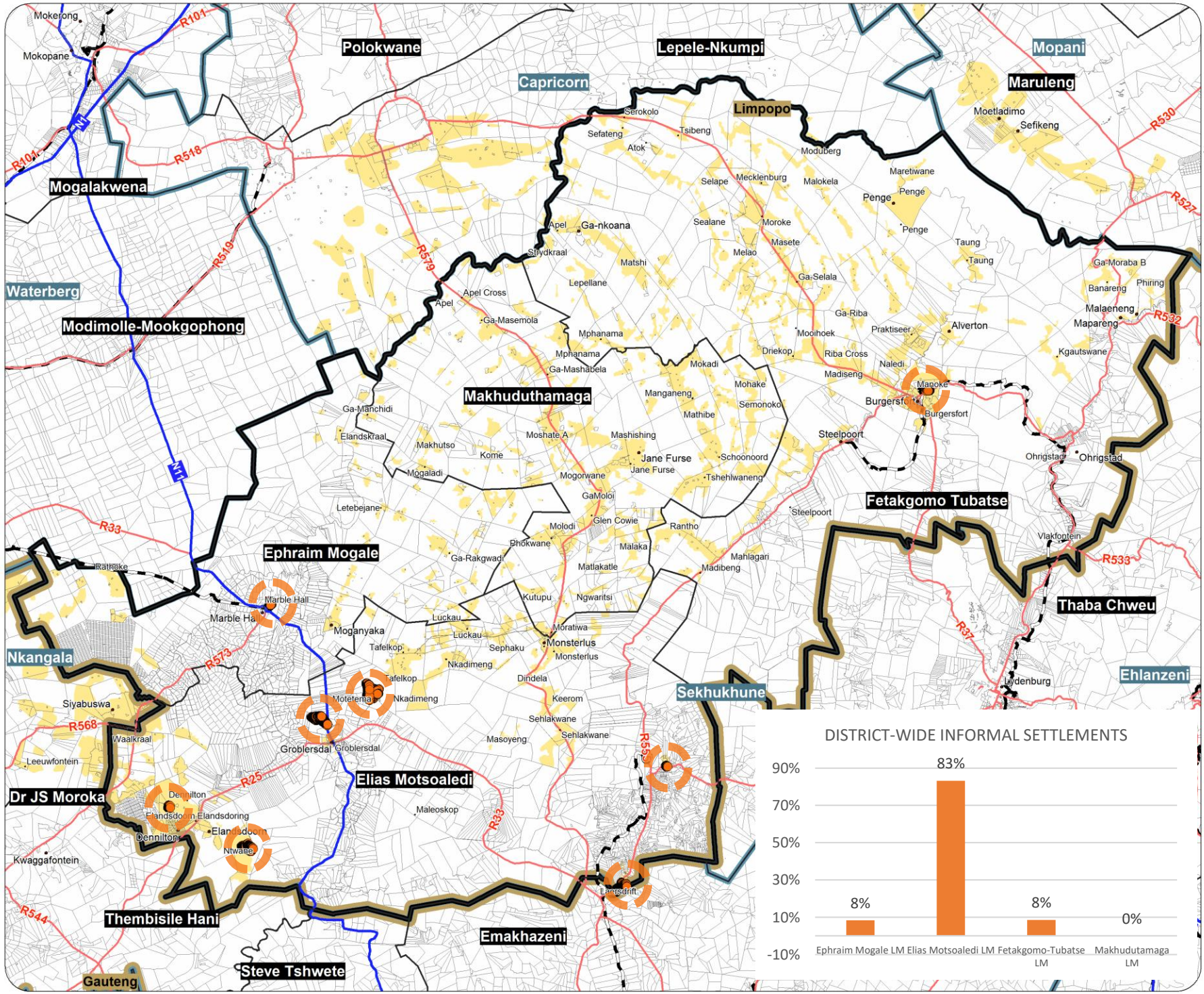
In terms of ward boundaries, **Figure 6.4** shows that the district comprises a total of 117 wards. Fetakgomo-Tubatse has the highest number with 39 wards, followed by Elias Motsoaledi and Makhuduthamaga, each with 31 wards. Ephraim Mogale has the fewest, with 16 wards. Collectively, these wards encompass a total of 764 villages.

3.2.2. Traditional Authorities

As shown in **Figure 6.5**, the Sekhukhune District is home to 74 traditional authorities, previously also known as bantustans, which are mainly located north-east of the district in the Fetakgomo Tubatse LM and Makhuduthamaga LM, and some in the western and south-western parts of the district in Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoledi local municipal areas. Traditional authorities within the Sekhukhune District Municipality administer approximately 48% of the municipal area, which encompasses 658,887 hectares of land. Accordingly, **Figure 6.6** displays the locations of the traditional offices of the respective traditional authorities.

Per the local municipality, the traditional authority land in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM covers approximately 329,850 ha of the municipal area, representing 58% of the land within the municipality under their administration. In the Makhuduthamaga LM, traditional authority land accounts for 83% of the land, equivalent to 176,393 ha in land area. Land under traditional leadership in Elias Motsoaledi LM covers 83,876 ha, which constitutes about 22% of the municipal area. In Ephraim Mogale, 34% of the land is within the traditional authority's jurisdiction. That is, 68,758 ha of land is under the leadership of traditional authorities.

Figure 6.3: District-Wide Informal Settlements



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

INFORMAL SETTLEMENTS

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral (Erven, Farm, Parent Farm)
- Main Towns
- Informal Settlements
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway line

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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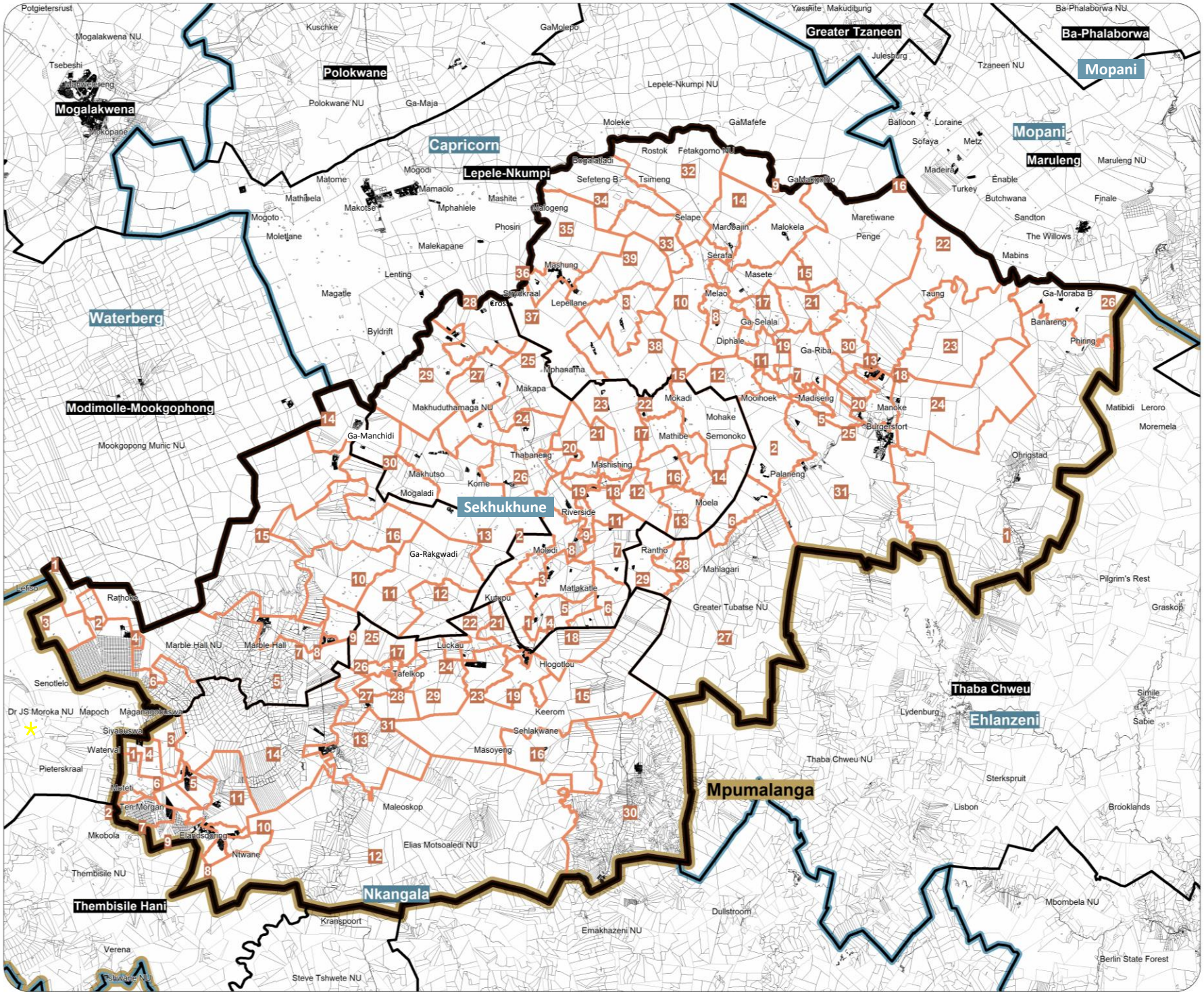
Tel: 013 262 7300

Figure 6.4: Municipal Wards



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

MUNICIPAL WARDS

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms, Parent Farm)
- Municipal Wards

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
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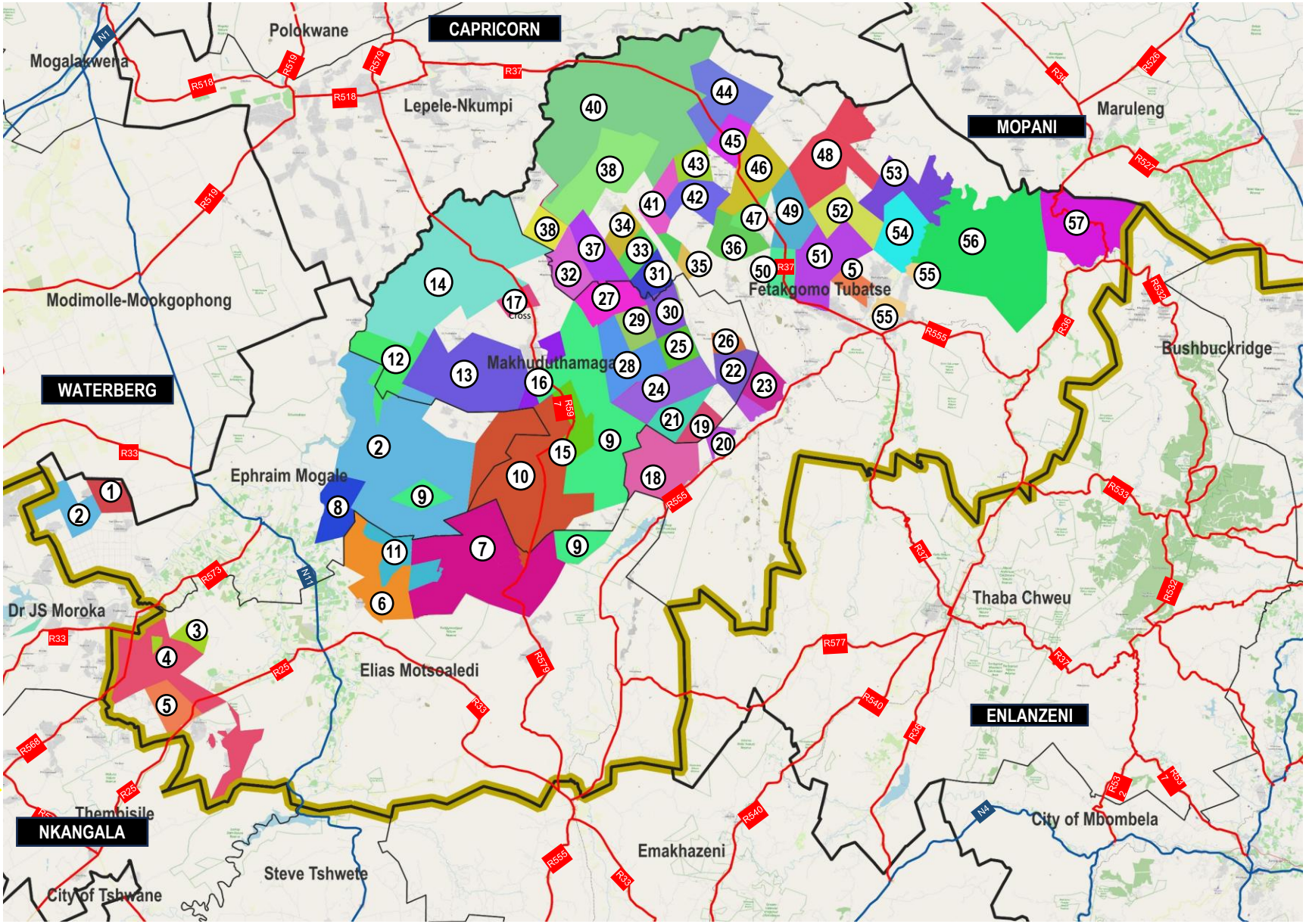
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Figure 6.5: Traditional Authorities



Trad Auth

- Amandebele amoletlane
- Ba-Bina-Noko-Ba -Mampuru
- Ba-Kgwete-Ba-Kgautswane
- Babina-Noko ba Mohlaletsi
- Bahlakwane-ba-Malekane
- Bahlakwane-Ba-Maphopha
- Bakoni ba ga matlala(Lehwelereng)
- Bakoni-Phuti
- Bakopa
- Bakutswe-Ba-Makofane
- Bakwena
- Banwana
- BaPedi ba Ramaube
- Baroka ba Mashabela
- Baroka-ba-Nkwana
- Batau-Nchabeleng
- Bengwenyama-ya-Maswazi
- Dinkwanyane
- Hlakwana-Rantho
- Koni-Legare
- Koni-Maloma
- Koni-Seopela
- Kwena Madihlaba
- KWENA_MADIHLABA
- KWENA_MASHABELA
- Kwena-Mafolo
- Magadima-Ntweng-Ba-Magakala
- Maila-Mapitsane
- Maila-Segolo
- Maisela-Mahlabephoko
- Maisela-Moswatse
- Maisela(Manotwane)
- Mampane
- Manoke
- Marota-Bogashwa
- Marota-Madibong
- Marota-Marulaneng
- Marota-Mathibeng
- Marota(Tsatane)
- MASEMOLA
- Matlala
- Matlala a Dichoeng
- Mogaswa-Manamane
- Mogaswa(Dihlakaneng)
- MOROANGOATA
- Moutse
- Nareng-Thokwane
- Ndebele
- Pedi Mamone
- Phokwani
- Pulana Maroga
- RAHLANGANE
- Ratau-Makgane
- Ratau(Makgane)
- Roka Phasa-Phokgane
- Roka-Lebea
- Roka-Motshana
- Roka-Radingwane
- Roka-Selepe
- Roka(Makgalanotho)
- Roka(Malepe)
- Roka(Mashishi)
- Swazi-Mnyamane
- Tau-Mankotsane
- Tau-Nkadimeng
- Tau-Tswaledi
- Tau(Kgaphola)
- Tau(Phahlamohlaka)
- TISANE
- Tlokwa-Magolego
- Tswako(Lekentle)
- Twako-Maepa

SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

TRADITIONAL AUTHORITIES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Boundary
- Regional Road
- National Road

Client Contact:
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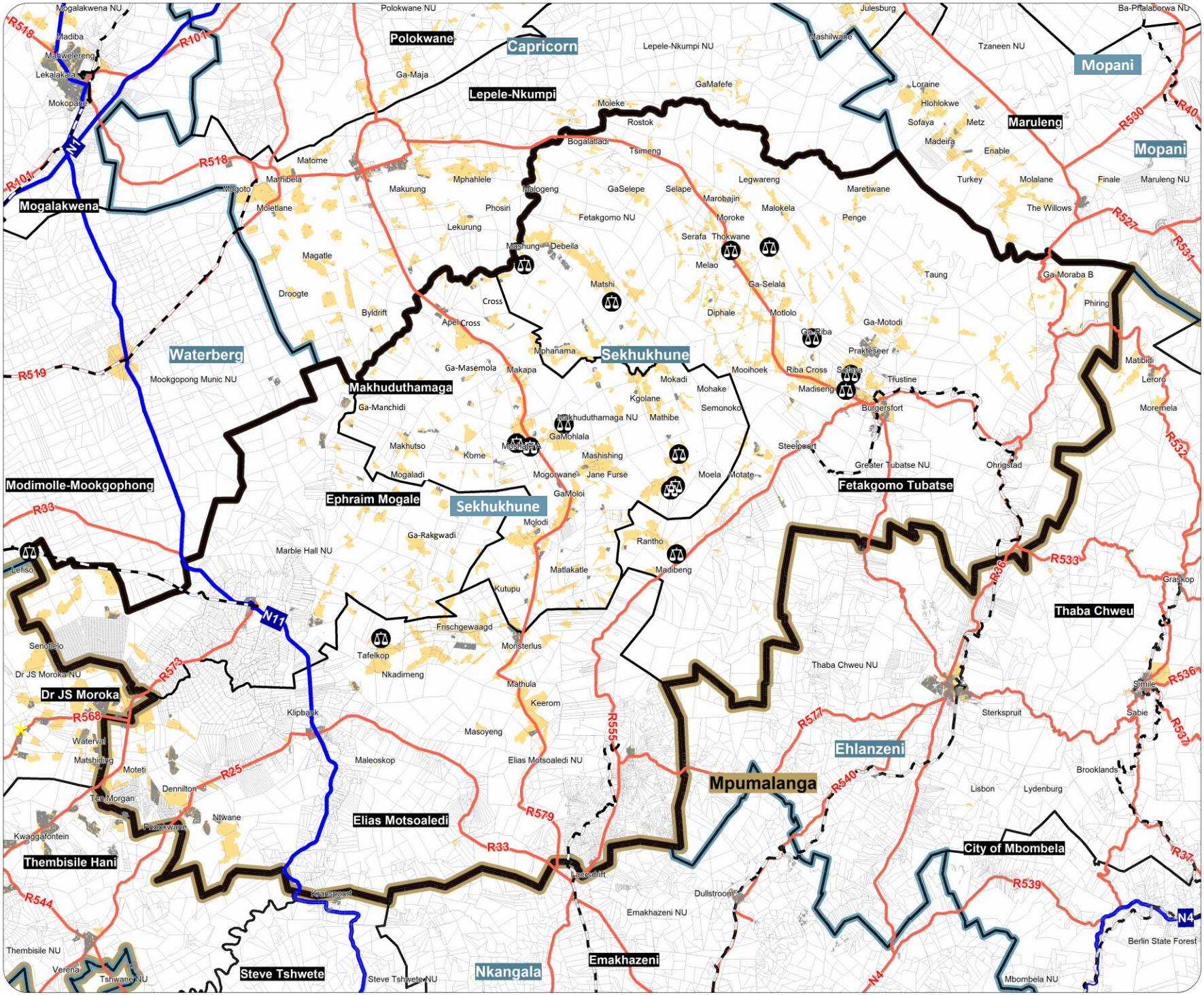
Figure 6.5 : Traditional Authority Offices



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

TRADITIONAL AUTHORITY OFFICES

Legend

- Cadastral
- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Traditional Authority Offices
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway line

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
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0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Table 1.1: Traditional Authorities

No:	Traditional Authority
1.	Amandebele Amoletlane
2.	Matlala
3.	Bakoni ba ga Matlala (Lehwelereng)
4.	Banwana
5.	BaPedi ba Ramaube
6.	Bakopa
7.	Ndebele
8.	Rahlangane
9.	Pedi Mamone
10.	Phokwani
11.	Bakwena
12.	Mampane
13.	Moroangoata
14.	Masemola
15.	Kwena Madihlaba
16.	Tisane
17.	Kwena Mashabela
18.	Hlakwana-Rantho/Twako-Maopa/Bahlakwane-ba-Malekane/Bahlakwane-ba-Maphopha
19.	Koni-Maloma
20.	Ba-Bina Noko ba Mampuru
21.	Mogaswa-Manamane
22.	Bengwenyama-ya-Maswazi
23.	Roka Phasa-Phokoane
24.	Tau-Tswaledi/Koni-Legare/Ratau (Makgane)/Mogaswa (Dihlakaneng)
25.	Koni-Seopelo/Maila-Mapitsane/Tau-Nkadimeng
26.	Tlokwa-Magolego
27.	Marota-Madibeng/Maila-Segolo
28.	Matlala a Dichoeng
29.	Marota-Marulaneng
30.	Marota-Mathibeng
31.	Marota (Tsatane)
32.	Tau (Kgaphola)
33.	Tau (Phahlamohlaka)
34.	Babina-Noko ka Mohlaletsi
35.	Tswako (Lekentle)
36.	Tswako-Mohlala
37.	Roka-Radingwane
38.	Maisela-Mahlabaphoko
39.	Batau-Nchabeleng
40.	Baroka-na-Nkwana
41.	Roka-Lebea
42.	Boroka-ba-Mashabela
43.	Swazi-Mnyamane
44.	Roka (Makgolanotho)
45.	Magadima-Ntweng-Ba-Magakala
46.	Nareng-Thokwane
47.	Roka (Mashishi)
48.	Roka (Malepe)
49.	Kwena-Mafolo
50.	Pulana Maroga
51.	Bakoni-Phuti
52.	Bakutswe-Ba-Makofane
53.	Roka-Motshana
54.	Marota-Bogashwa
55.	Manoke
56.	Ba-Kgwete-Ba-Kgautswane
57.	Dinkwanyane

3.3. MOVEMENT NETWORK

The movement infrastructure is key in shaping the economic and social landscape of a district municipality. It serves as the backbone for forging spatial integration, increasing access to economies, enabling the efficient movement of goods and people, and fostering trade. The section below alludes to the district's movement network and its significance to the district's economy and respective trade areas, communities and access to social services.

As shown in **Figure 7**, the N11 is the most dominant route in the district, facilitating trade and the movement of goods, such as agricultural products, minerals, and manufactured goods, between the provinces of Mpumalanga and Limpopo. Furthermore, it is a vital organ that enables connection and access between local businesses, farming enterprises in and around the Groblersdal and Marble Hall regions, and larger markets based in Polokwane and Middleburg, as well as various parts of the country via the N11 (KwaZulu-Natal Province) and the N4 and N12 to the Gauteng Province. Furthermore, the route plays a key role in transporting raw materials and equipment to the mining operations in the regions.

Regional accessibility is predominantly facilitated via three roads that traverse the district in a northwest–southeast alignment (N11, R579, and R37). Route R555 traverses the district from south to north along the eastern borders. Together these roads constitute the leading freight and logistics corridors connecting the district's economic activity areas to prominent provincial nodes and economic activity areas, e.g. Mookgopong, Mokopane, Polokwane, Lydenburg and Middelburg.

The presence of the Klein Drakensberg and Strydpoortberge hinders connectivity to the north into Maruleng and parts of Lepelle-Nkumpi. More specifically, the N11 Freeway connects the towns of Marble Hall and Groblersdal with Mookgopong and the N1 Freeway towards the north-west. From there, the road leads to Mokopane and eventually links to Botswana via the Groblersbrug border post. To the south, the N11 connects Marble Hall and Groblersdal with Middelburg, which is situated along the N4 Maputo Corridor.

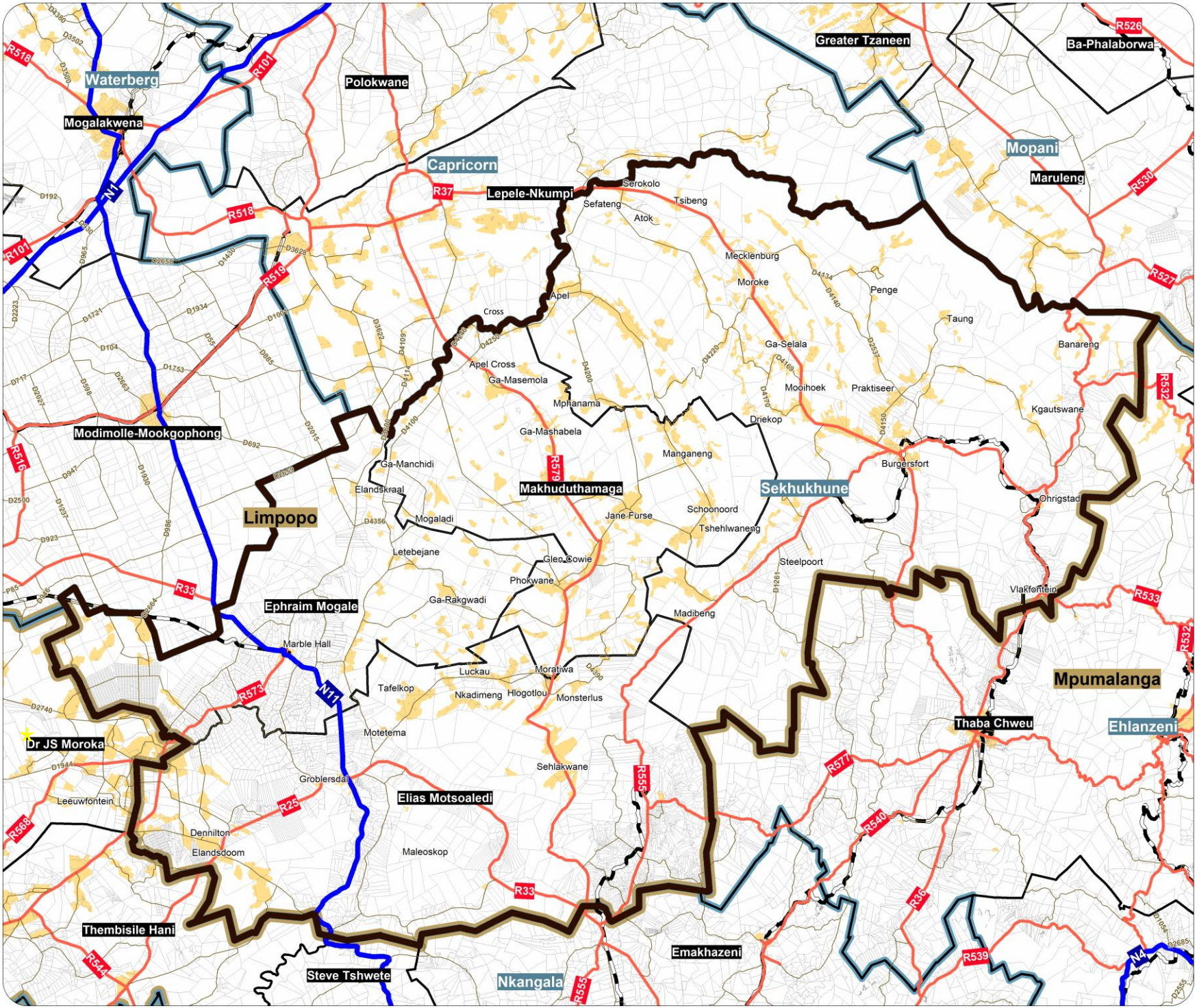
- **The R579** traverses the central extent of the district and serves to connect Jane Furse and Monsterlus with Lebowakgomo to the north and Sehlakwane and Stoffberg to the south.
- **The R37** traverses the northern extents of the district, and serves to connect Burgersfort with Lebowakgomo towards the north-west and Lydenburg towards the south-east. T
- **The R555** traverses the eastern extents of the district and serves to connect Steelpoort and Burgersfort with Stoffberg towards the south-east. Routes R37 and R555 form the Dilokong Platinum Corridor.
- **Route R36** serves to connect the Burgersfort/ Steelpoort area with Ohrigstad, and down to Lydenburg to the south and to Hoedspruit in Maruleng to the north.

Although the majority of the urban centers and smaller towns are located along these roads, a vast number of settlements within the western, central, and eastern extents of the district are only accessible via secondary gravel roads

The three railway lines include:
The railway line entering the SDM from the south, next to Stoffberg, from where it continues northwards for approximately 30km, eventually ending at an abandoned mine near Mapochs Mine.

- The railway line entering the SDM from the west, near Nutfield, from where it continues eastwards to Marble Hall.
- The railway line entering the SDM from the east, passing near Ohrigstad and Burgersfort, and terminating near Steelpoort (near the Tubatse mine).

Figure 7: Movement Network



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

MOVEMENT NETWORK

Legend

- Cadastral
- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Local Road
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway line

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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The general condition of roads within the SDM is poor. Severe damage, such as potholes and edge cracking, can be observed along most roads. Road damage is particularly prevalent along the following sections of road:

- The R33 between Groblersdal and Stoffberg;
- The R555 between Stoffberg and Roossenekal;
- The R579 between Nebo and Stoffberg; and
- The R25 between Dennilton and Groblersdal.

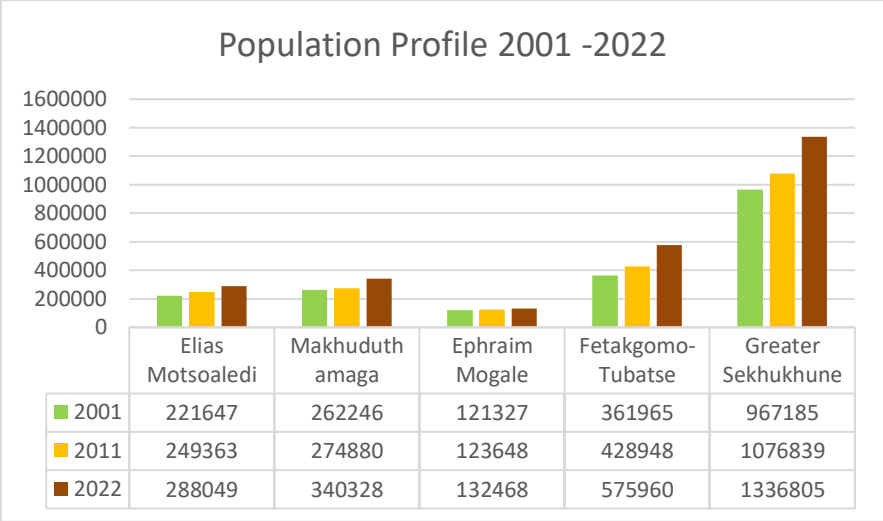
3.4. SOCIO-ECONOMIC ANALYSIS

The following section provides a socio-economic analysis of the district and its respective local municipalities, focusing on population distribution, educational attainment, age demographics, access to basic household services, and dwelling types. In order to establish an understanding of the extent of existing service delivery and identify gaps.

Population Demographics

Figure 8.1 and **Diagram 10.1** illustrates that the Fetakgomo Tubatse Local Municipality experienced the most notable population growth between 2011 and 2022, with an estimated increase that brought its total population to 147,012. Makhuduthamaga Local Municipality recorded the second-largest population gain, growing by approximately 65,448 individuals over the same period. In contrast, Elias Motsoaledi LM and Ephraim Mogale LM showed the smallest increases, with their populations rising by 38,686 and 8,820, respectively, over the 10-year period.

Diagram 10.1: Population Profile 2001 - 2022

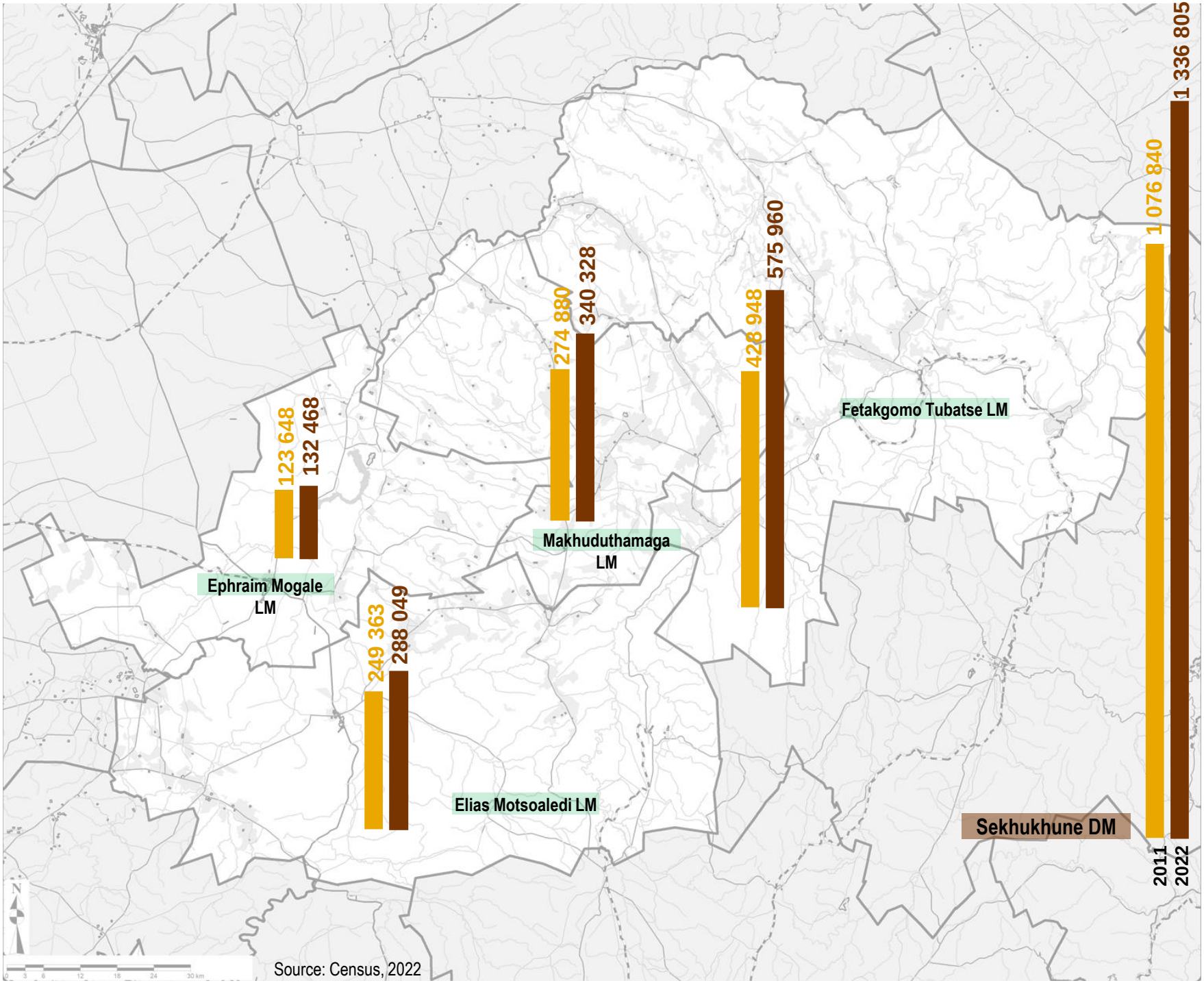


	Elias Motsoaledi	Makhuduthamaga	Ephraim Mogale	Fetakgomo-Tubatse	Greater Sekhukhune
2001	221647	262246	121327	361965	967185
2011	249363	274880	123648	428948	1076839
2022	288049	340328	132468	575960	1336805

Age Profile

The age distribution across all four local municipalities in the Sekhukhune District reveals a predominantly working-age population (**Diagram 10.2**). Individuals aged 15–64 make up approximately 57% to 62% of the population, with Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM recording the highest proportion at 62%. This suggests a strong potential labour force that, if properly empowered through education and economic opportunities, could drive local development.

Figure 8.1: POPULATION PER LOCAL MUNICIPALITY 2011-2022



SEKHUKHUNE District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

POPULATION PROFILE PER LOCAL MUNICIPALITY 2011-2022

Legend

- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- 2011
- 2022

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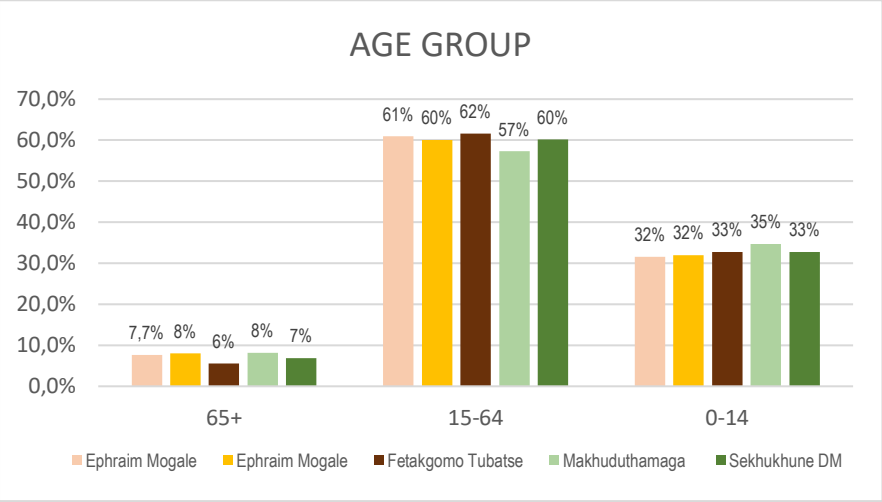
Diagram 10.2: Age Group Project



Source: Census, 2022

Children aged 0–14 years represent about 35% of the population across all municipalities, highlighting the ongoing demand for education and child-focused services. The elderly population (65 years and older) comprises a smaller share, between 6% and 8% indicating that the district has a relatively youthful demographic overall.

Educational Level

Education is essential for increasing people's chances of finding fulfilling work and, consequently, reducing poverty and reliance on social grants. An illiterate population is well-equipped with the essential skills needed in the labour market, which opens up more economic options and increases their level of financial independence. Below is outlined the educational profile across the municipalities in the Sekhukhune District for the year 2022, with a focus on higher education, Grade 12 completion, and the prevalence of informal schooling (refer to **Figure 8.2**).

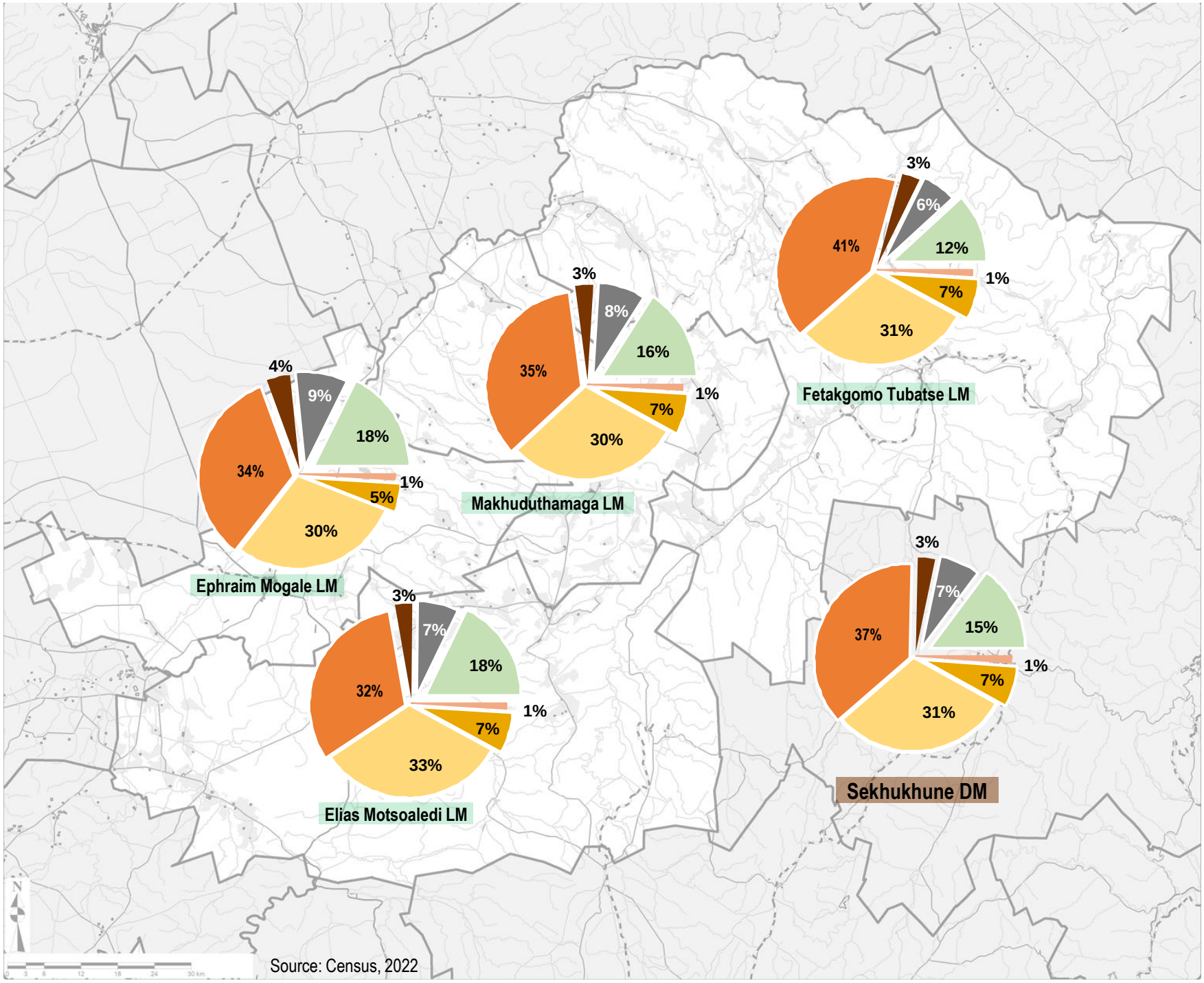
In terms of higher education (post-Grade 12 qualifications), the district recorded an overall rate of 7%. Fetakgomo-Tubatse, Makhuduthamaga, and Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipalities each matched this district average. Ephraim Mogale LM had the lowest proportion of residents with higher education, at just 5%. Regarding Grade 12 attainment, 31% of the district's population had completed this level. Elias Motsoaledi LM led with 33%, followed by Fetakgomo-Tubatse at 31%. Ephraim Mogale and Makhuduthamaga LMs each reported 30%.

The proportion of the population with no formal schooling stood at 15% district-wide. Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi LMs recorded the highest rates of no schooling at 18% each, followed by Makhuduthamaga at 16%, and Fetakgomo Tubatse LM at 12%.

Dwelling Types

As shown on **Diagram 10.3**, the majority of the district's population (approximately 95%) resided in formal dwellings. In terms of housing per local municipality, the municipalities of Ephraim Mogale and Makhuduthamaga had the highest proportions, with 97% of their populations living in formal housing. The Fetakgomo-Tubatse and Elias Motsoaledi LMs each reported 95%.

Figure 8.2: LEVEL OF EDUCATION



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

HIGHEST EDUCATION LEVEL PER LOCAL MUNICIPALITY 2011-2022

Legend

- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- No Schooling
- Some Primary
- Completed Primary
- Secondary
- Grade 12
- Higher Education
- Other

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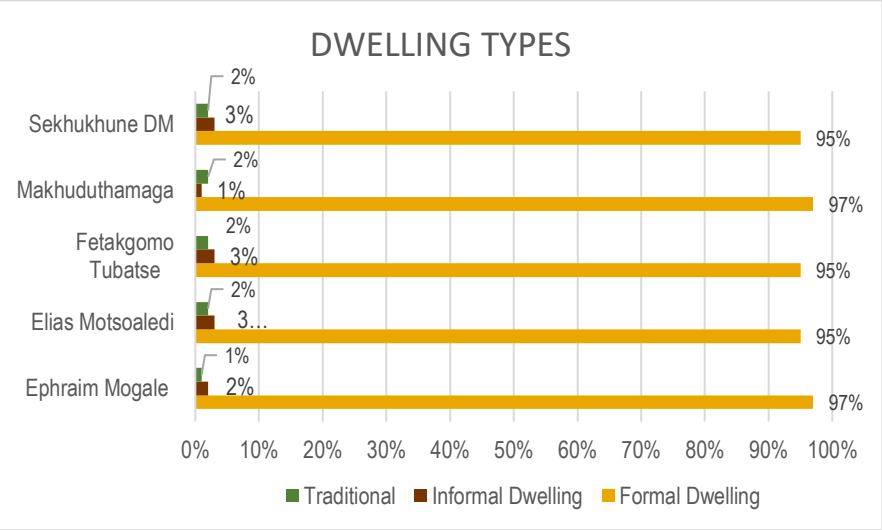
Diagram 10.3: Dwelling Type



Source: Census, 2022

Informal dwellings accounted for just 3% of the district's total. Makhuduthamaga LM had the lowest proportion at 1%, followed by Ephraim Mogale at 2%. Fetakgomo Tubatse LM and Elias Motsoaledi LM both reported a 3% increase. Traditional dwellings made up 2% of all housing in the district. Ephraim Mogale LM had the lowest share at 1%, while Makhuduthamaga, Fetakgomo-Tubatse, and Elias Motsoaledi each aligned with the district average of 2%.

3.4.1. Engineering Services

The provision of engineering services forms the basis of spatial development, economic growth, and improved quality of life. This section provides an overview of the existing engineering services within the municipality, assessing the current capacity in order to determine the extent of insufficiency and level of capacity required for future growth and economic expansion.

3.4.1.1. Basic Service Provision

- **Household Water Supply**

This section examines the level of basic service provision across the Sekhukhune District Municipality and its local municipalities, with a focus on access to water, refuse removal, energy, and sanitation, and a specific emphasis on water accessibility in 2022 **(Diagram 10.4** per local municipality, and **Figure 8.3** depicts the summarised services provision in the district.

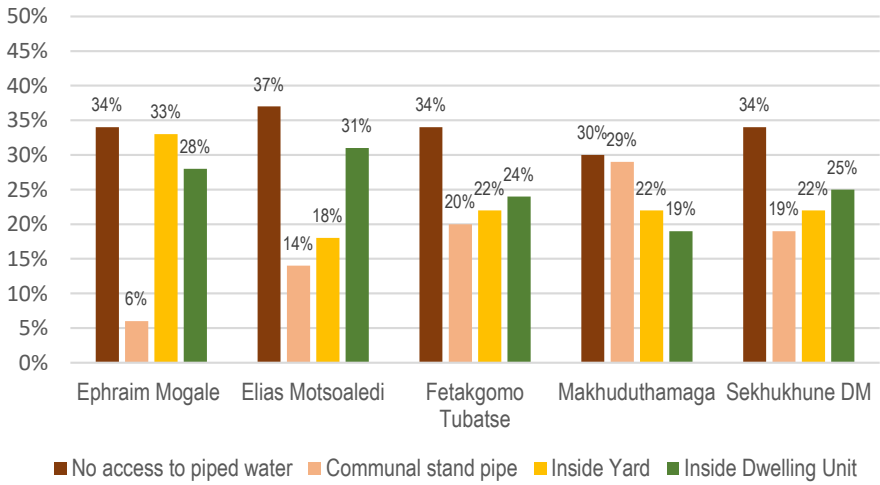
Only 25% of the district's population had access to water inside their dwellings. At the municipal level, Elias Motsoaledi LM recorded the highest in-house water access at 31%, followed by Ephraim Mogale LM (28%), Fetakgomo Tubatse LM (24%), and Makhuduthamaga LM with the lowest at 19%.

An additional 22% of the population across the district obtains access to water within their yards. Ephraim Mogale LM led this category with 33%, while the other three municipalities, namely, the Fetakgomo Tubatse LM, Elias Motsoaledi LM, and Makhuduthamaga LM, each reported 22%. Regarding access through communal standpipes, the district reported an average of 19%. Makhuduthamaga had the highest share at 29%, likely due to limited bulk water infrastructure. In contrast, Fetakgomo Tubatse LM stood at 20%, Elias Motsoaledi LM at 14%, and Ephraim Mogale at just 6%. Finally, 34% of the district's population accessed water from other sources (e.g., rivers, boreholes, or water tankers). The local municipality of Elias Motsoaledi LM reported the highest proportion in this category at 37%, followed by Ephraim Mogale LM and Fetakgomo Tubatse LM at 34% and Makhuduthamaga LM at 30%.

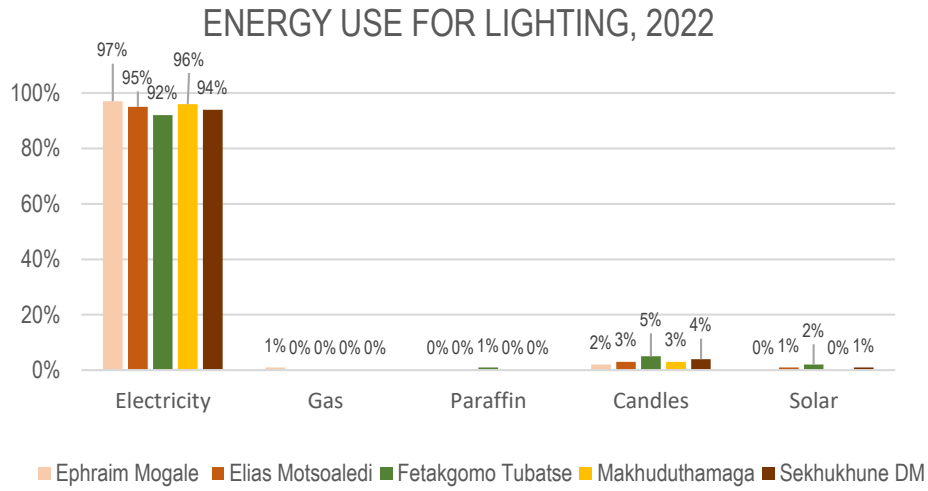
- **Bulk Water Supply**

The District Municipality serves as both a Water Services Authority and a Water Services Provider, as mandated by the Water Services Act (No. 108 of 1997). Its

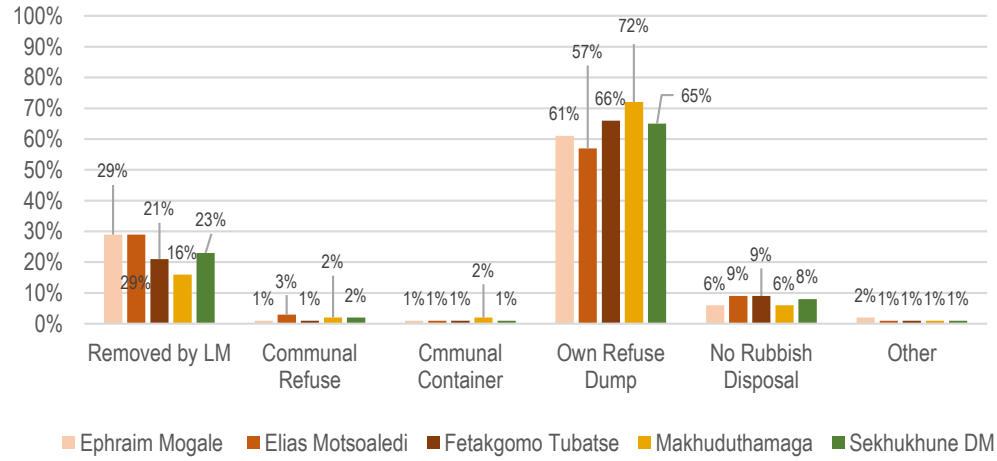
ACCESS TO PIPED WATER, 2022



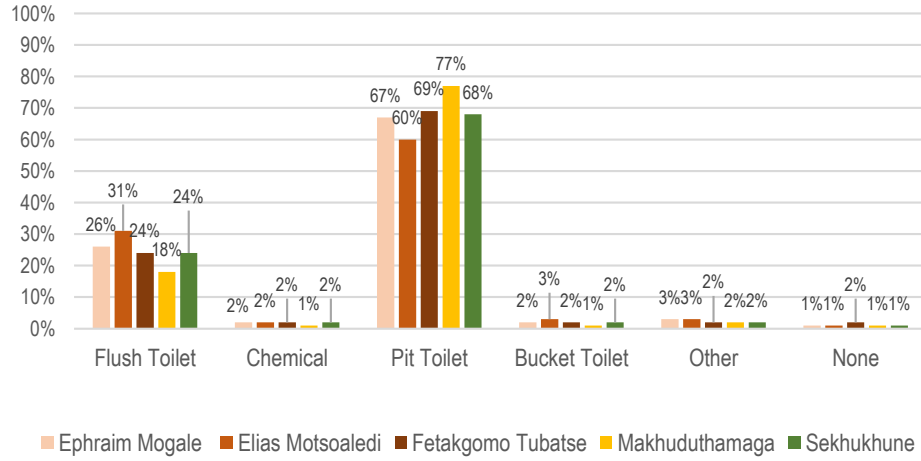
ENERGY USE FOR LIGHTING, 2022



REFUSE, 2022

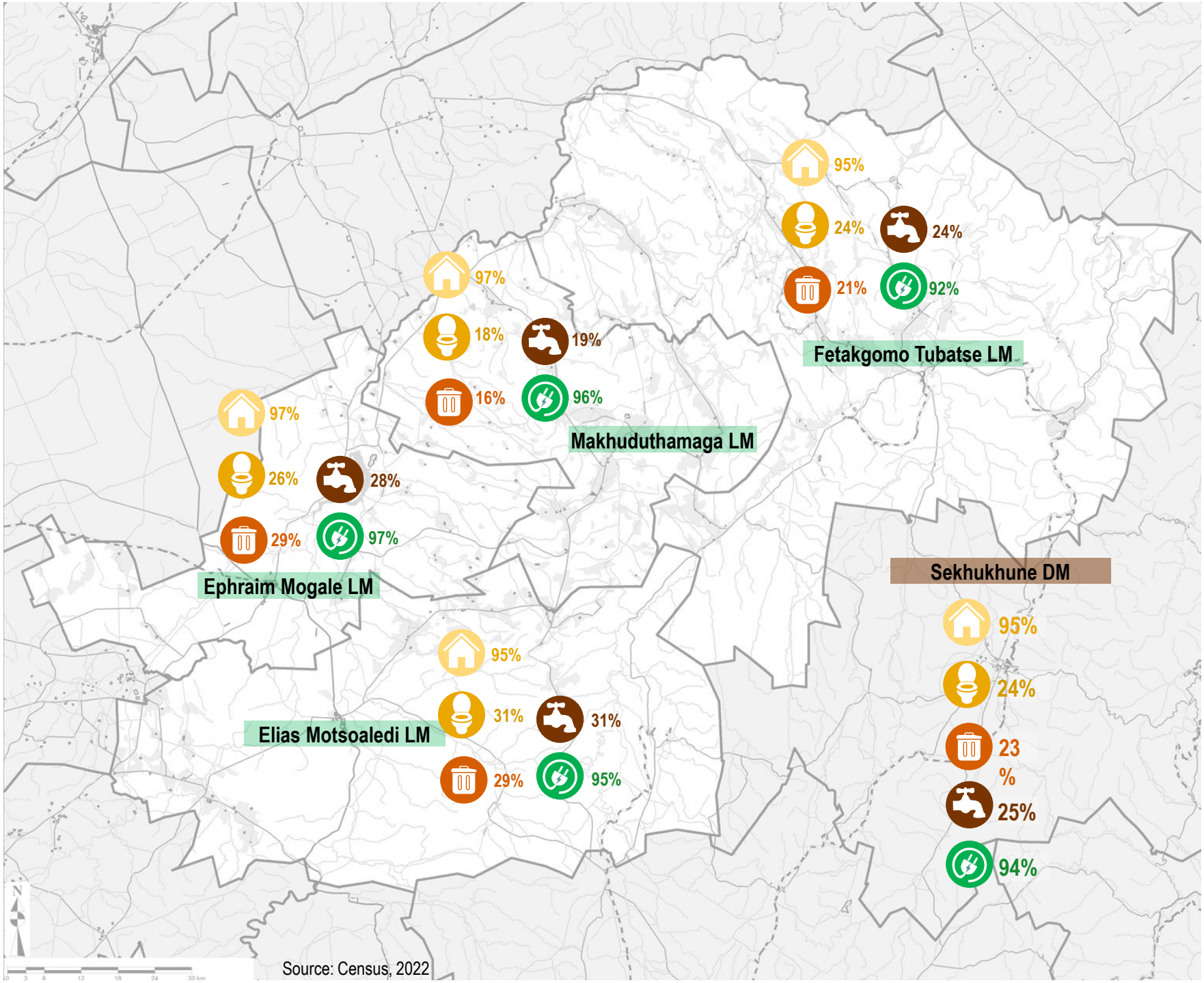


SANITATION, 2022



Source: Census, 2022

Figure 8.3: Basic Engineering Services



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

BASIC ENGINEERING SERVICES PER LOCAL MUNICIPALITY 2022 (%)

BASIC SERVICES

Legend

- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Formal Dwelling
- Flush Toilet
- Weekly Refuse Disposal Services
- Piped water in Dwelling
- Electricity for Lighting

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core service delivery function is the provision of water across the district. Water is supplied to 811 villages through 45 water supply schemes. Full water services are currently provided in the main towns of Burgersfort, Marble Hall, Groblersdal, Steelpoort, and Ohrigstad, which also benefit from additional high-level services, including refuse collection and road infrastructure.

In the district's extensive rural areas, groundwater remains the primary source of water. Where necessary, water tankers supplement the supply. Villages within the Flag Boshielo Water Scheme area tend to receive better water services than other rural parts of the district.

Recent progress includes extending the water supply from the De Hoop Dam to several villages, including Mpelegane, Maepa, Ratau, Maphopha, Rantho, Masha, Malekana, and Maseven. This marks a positive step in expanding dam-based supply to more remote areas. Groundwater remains a vital water resource, relied upon by over 75% of the district's communities. It contributes approximately 25.61 megalitres per day (or 9.35 million cubic meters annually) to the district's total daily water demand of 52.42 megalitres, just below 50%.

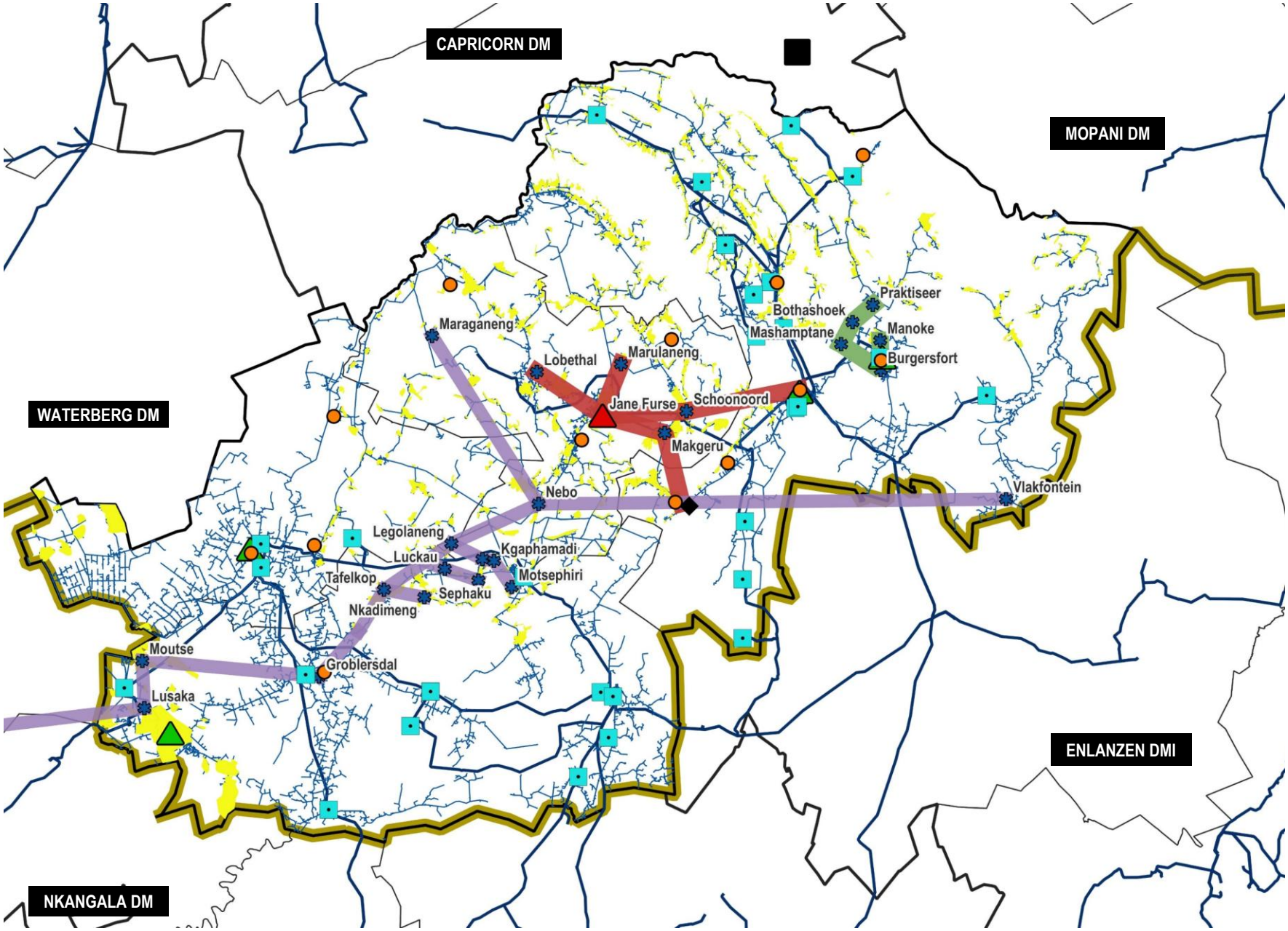
Table 1.2 below marks a positive step in expanding dam-based supply to more remote areas, listing planned bulk water projects in the district to improve water supply. These projects have been further spatially mapped and displayed in **Figure 8.4**.

Table 1.2: Bulk Water Projects

BULK WATER SUPPLY PROJECTS					
	PROJECT NO:	**PROJECT NAME**	**SCHEME NAME**	**PROJECT SIZE**	**PROJECT STATUS**
1.	LPR019 and LPR021	Moutse Regional Bulk Water Supply Scheme	Kwandebele/ Renosterkop/ Elias Motsoaledi WS	Regional	Ongoing
	LPSRB15-RBIG-22b	Functional Phase 2 (Stages 07 and 08). Functional Phase 3 (Stage 09 to 12)		Small	Construction
2.	LPR010	Groblersdal Lukau Bulk Water Supply	Groblersdal/Lukau	small	Completed
3.	LPR026	Nebo BWS - De Hoop Augmentation/ North/ South/ Steelpoort	De Hoop/Nebo Plateau RWS	Small	Feasibility
	LPR011-RM012	Nebo Bulk Water Supply: Steelpoort River Pipeline to Jane Furse Command Reservoir and Schoonoord Command Reservoir		Large	On hold
	LPSRB04-RBIG-03	De Hoop Augmentation		Large	Defects and viability period
	LPSRB03-RBIG-09	De Hoop Augmentation: Phase 3C Magnet Heights to Schoonoord Bulk Pipeline		small	Conceptual
4.	LSRBD04-SDMM031	Nkadimeng RWS: Jane Furse to Marulaneng Bulk pipeline		Small	
5.	LPR012/ RM07	Mooihoek Tubatse RWS	Lower Steelpoort Tubatse WS	Mega	Construction
6.	LPR007-SDM14FS	Ohrigstad Bulk Water Supply	Orighstad WS	Large	Feasibility

Source: Department of Water and Sanitation

Figure 8.4: BULK WATER INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

BULK WATER INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- High Voltage Substation
- Medium Voltage Line
- High Voltage Line
- Rural Settlements
- PowerPlant
- Future WWTW
- Existing WTW
- Existing WWTW
- Future WTW
- Bulk Water Supply Areas
- Moutse Regional BWS
- Nebo BWS
- Mooihoek-Tubatse BWS

N

0 10 20 km

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- **Bulk Water Project Description:**

I. According to the Department of Water and Sanitation, the Moutse Regional Bulk Water Supply Scheme project in the Elias Motsoaledi LM is planned to supply potable water to the Moutse East and Moutse West villages from the existing Groblersdal Water Treatment Works. The project comprises 15 contracts (stages/sub-projects), which include upgrading the Groblersdal Water Treatment Works from its current 22 Mℓ/day capacity to 40 Mℓ/day, constructing bulk pipelines, a pump station, a 10 Mℓ Lusaka reservoir, and undertaking mechanical and electrical works.

II. Groblersdal Lukau Bulk Water Supply will supply water to several communities situated along the route D1547 from Groblersdal to Nebo. The water supply will be extracted from the Olifants River at Groblersdal and purified at the Groblersdal water purification treatment plant. Thereafter, the water is pumped to Motetema, then to three (3) reservoirs located at the entrance of Tafelkop. In addition to Tafelkop, water will be distributed to several villages, including Legolaneng, Maraleng, Kga-Phamadi, Motsephiri, Luckau, Sephaku, Vlakfontein, Maretheng, and Nkadimeng. The system will also be able to supply water to villages presently supplied from the Flag Boshielo scheme.

III. The Nebo Bulk Water Supply: Steelpoort River Pipeline to Jane Furse Command Reservoir and Schoonoord Command Reservoir will encompass several phases. Firstly, the construction involved a 30.55 km reinforced concrete and face-brick pipeline to reinforce concrete and face-brick pump stations, the supply and installation of six high-lift pumps and motors, control panels and switchgear, telemetry, and the installation of one 1.76 MW and one 2 MW power connection points from Eskom. The project will transport water to Jane Furse, an estimated 25 Mℓ reservoir (MIG) from Phase 3B and Phase 3E. Phase 2C: River Crossing towards Ga-Malekana Water Treatment Works (MIG) is a sub-phase for Phase 2C for De Hoop. It is 300 m length steel pipe of 600 mm diameter. Phase 3B: The construction of about 9,45 km of steel pipe from Jane Furse to Marulaneng.Phase 3E: Construction of approximately 18 km of 300 mm diameter and 100 mm diameter ductile iron pipe from Jane Furse to Lobethal. Phase 3C: The construction of a 5km pumping Main Pipeline from the T-off of Makgeru to the proposed new 10 Mℓ reservoir at Schoonoord and about 18km of gravity Main Pipeline.

IV. De Hoop Augmentation is planned to double the rising main and pump stations from Malekane WTW to Jane Furse. The project, however, does not include land acquisition.

V. De Hoop Augmentation: Phase 3C Magnet Heights to Schoonoord Bulk Pipeline project will encompass the construction of a 6.5km pumping main pipeline from the T-off of Makgeru to the proposed new 10 Mℓ reservoir at Schoonoord and about 18.1km gravity main Pipelines.

VI. Nkadimeng RWS: Jane Furse to Marulaneng Bulk pipeline project will entail the construction of a 9.45 km steel pipe from the 25 Mℓ Jane Furse Reservoir to Marulaneng.

VII. The Mooihoek Tubatse Regional Water Scheme forms part of the Lower Steelport Tubatse Water Supply project, which will encompass the construction of a 14 km pipeline by Esorfranki and approximately 82 manholes. This project involves constructing a 14 km steel pipeline with 82 reinforced concrete chambers within the pipeline, starting from the Mashamothane intersection pipe. The route is from Mashamothane, Bothashoek to Praktiseer.Phase 4: Bulk water supply in Burgersfort and to Manoke and Dresden. The distribution network will consist of approximately 30 km of steel pipe, varying in diameter from 800 mm to 250 mm, and three reservoirs.

VIII. The Ohrigstad Bulk Water Supply, the project covers 29 rural villages and one formal village. The Implementation Ready Study proposed that the boreholes be refurbished, new ones developed and linked to the reticulation

Accordingly, the following highlights water infrastructure projects that are currently approved and underway in the district, along with their current status. Notably, several projects have been delayed as a result of needing further financial allocation, administrative challenges, and slow project progress, while others are currently underway.

Table 1.3: Approved and Construction Water Infrastructure Projects

	PROJECT NAME/DESCRIPTION	STATUS
1.	03 Water Licenses Applied	Incomplete
2.	Refurbishment of 3 WWTWs (Burgersfort, Penge, Phooko Booster pump station)	Incomplete
3	Review of the Water and Sanitation By-Law	Incomplete
4	Registration of two servitudes	Incomplete
5	Erection of 3 steel tanks	Incomplete
6	2 setting dams, construction of 1,5km of external pipeline, construction of a retaining wall, and the Department of Agriculture offices.	Slow Progress
7	11km of pipeline construction	Slow Progress
8	Moutse East and West water reticulation phase 1	Slow Progress
9	Moutse East and West water reticulation phase 2	Delayed
10	Mampuru Bulk Water Scheme	Incomplete
11	Olifantspoort South Regional Water Supply Phase 6	Delayed
12	Ga-Maphopha Command Reservoir	Incomplete
13	Refurbishment of Leeufontein WWTW	Progress delayed
14	Refurbishment of Dennillton WWTW	Delayed
15	Lebalelo Central RWS Sub-scheme 1A	Delayed
16	Nebo BWS Commission Malekana to Jane Furse Pipeline	Duration extended
17	Development of IRS on the De Hoop, Nebo Plateau scheme up to Zaaiplaas	Incomplete
18	Moutse BWS project (7-12)	Incomplete
19	Moutse BWS project 13 & 14	Incomplete
20	Maeba Water Intervention project- Phase 5	Delayed
21	Commissioning of Moutse Bulk	Delayed
22	Ga-Marishane village water supply	Delayed
23	Eenzama water supply (works package 1)	Delayed
24	Kgotlopong water intervention (work package 1)	Delayed

- **Energy Access**

According to 2022 data (as shown on **Diagram 8.3**), electricity access across the Sekhukhune District Municipality and its four local municipalities exceeds 90%, indicating a strong overall level of energy service provision. This high coverage means that only a small portion of the population relies on alternative energy sources such as candles, gas, solar, and paraffin.

Among these alternatives, candles are the most commonly used, accounting for approximately 4% of the district's overall energy usage. Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality reported the highest reliance on candles compared to the other municipalities.

- **Refuse Removal**

Refuse removal data from 2022 indicates that the majority of the Sekhukhune District Municipality's population manages waste independently, with 65% using their own refuse dumps. Among the local municipalities, the Makhuduthamaga LM reported the highest usage of its own refuse dumps at 72%, followed by the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM at 66%, and both the Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi municipalities at 61%. The local municipality's refuse collection services were used by 23% of the district population. Ephraim Mogale had the highest proportion of municipal refuse removal at 29%, followed by the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM at 21%, and the Makhuduthamaga LM at 16%.

A further 9% of the district population reported having no refuse removal service. The highest percentages were recorded in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM and the Elias Motsoaledi LM (9% each), while Ephraim Mogale and Makhuduthamaga municipalities reported slightly lower at 6% each.

Other forms of waste disposal, including communal refuse sites, communal containers, and miscellaneous methods, accounted for small shares of the total, each averaging around 1% to 1.75% across all municipalities. These statistics highlight a heavy reliance on independent waste removal, indicating a limited capacity of formal refuse collection services in the district.

As shown, the overall service provision within the district municipality is relatively decent, with electricity provision at 94% and housing provision at approximately 95%. All four municipalities showed an average provision of above 97%. Water, refuse, and sanitation were the lowest, with each reporting 25% in terms of water supply inside dwelling units, waste removal by the authority at 23%, and flush sanitation at 24%, respectively. The municipality showing the highest provision of the three was Elias Motsoaledi LM, followed by Ephraim Mogale LM, Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, and Makhuduthamaga LM, which reported the lowest provision.

Sanitation Facilities

Based on 2022 data, pit latrines remain the most common form of sanitation in the Sekhukhune District Municipality, used by 68% of the population. The Makhuduthamaga LM recorded the highest usage at 77%, followed by the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM at 69%, Ephraim Mogale LM at 67%, and Elias Motsoaledi LM at 60%. This widespread reliance on pit latrines suggests a shortage of bulk sanitation infrastructure across the district.

Access to flush toilets is limited, with only 24% of the district's population using this type of sanitation system. The Elias Motsoaledi LM has the highest proportion at 31%, followed by the Ephraim Mogale LM at 26%, the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM at 24%, and the Makhuduthamaga LM with the lowest at 18%. These statistics align with earlier data on water access, highlighting that areas with better access to water, such as the Elias Motsoaledi and Ephraim Mogale local municipalities, also tend to have higher sanitation service levels.

Additionally, the district reported that approximately 2% of the population uses bucket toilets, while about 1.75% rely on chemical toilets. Overall, the data indicate

that sanitation levels are closely linked to water accessibility and infrastructure availability within the district.

3.4.2. Community Facilities

The section below discusses the distribution of community facilities widespread in the district. These include, amongst others, education, government and municipal services, health, safety, and security services, distributed across the Sekhukhune District Municipality.

The table below provides a summary of community facilities per Local municipality and the entire District Municipality. Each category is discussed in detail in the sections that follow and presented spatially.

Table 1.4: Community Facilities

	COMMUNITY FACILITIES					
	Community Facilities	LOCAL MUNICIPALITY				
		Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM	Makhuthamaga LM	Elias Motsoaledi LM	Ephraim Mogale LM	TOTAL
Government /Municipality	Government / Municipal Offices	14	12	20	7	53
	Court	3	1	1	0	5
	Post Office	5	7	7	4	23
	Community Halls/ Centre	13	3	1	6	23
Health Care Service	Clinics	34	12	11	11	68
	Hospital	4	3	1	1	9
Safe and Security Services	Police Station	7	4	7	4	22
	Fire Station	1	0	1	0	2
Education	Primary	232	169	103	71	575
	Secondary	182	136	94	58	470
	Combined School	4	1	6	0	11
	Special School	0	3	2	0	5
	Tertiary	3	0	5	1	9
	Library	2	1	2	1	6

3.4.2.1. Educational Facilities

Pertaining to educational facilities (refer to **Figure 9.1**), the district currently holds 1,076 educational facilities within the district, ranging from primary schools to special schools (schools for students with special needs). Of these, 575 are primary schools, with the majority located in Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM with 232, followed by Makhuduthamaga with 169, Elias Motsoaledi with 103, and Ephraim Mogale with 71. There are 470 secondary schools in the district. These are located in Fetakgomo-Tubatse, which has 182, Makhuduthamaga, 136, Elias Motsoaledi, 94, and Ephraim Mogale, 58. The district also has 11 combined schools, with Elias Motsoaledi hosting the largest number at 6, followed by Fetakgomo-Tubatse with 4, and Makhuduthamaga with 1.

In terms of higher-order educational institutions, the district has nine tertiary educational facilities, with the majority located in Elias Motsoaledi, followed by Fetakgomo-Tubatse with three and Ephraim with only one. Makhuduthamaga has no educational facilities. Despite not having any tertiary facilities, Makhuduthamaga registered the same highest percentage of population with higher education as Elias Motsoaledi and Fetakgomo-Tubatse, which happen to have the highest number of tertiary facilities. This suggests that educational desire in Makhuduthamaga is just as strong as that of Elias Motsoaledi LM and Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM. Additionally, the district has five special schools; two are located in Elias Motsoaledi, three in Makhuduthamaga, and one in Ephraim Mogale.

There are also six libraries, two in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM and Elias Motsoaledi LM, and one each in Makhuduthamaga and Ephraim Mogale. Despite lacking tertiary facilities, Makhuduthamaga was among the highest municipalities in terms of individuals possessing higher education, as indicated in the 2022 data under the 'education level' section in the socio-economic analysis. Data also shows that there is a relatively high level of individuals with secondary education, and it is the municipality with the least schooling, second to none other than Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM. There is an educational need in Makhuduthamaga LM that needs to be catered to. Figure 9.1 illustrates the distribution of these educational facilities across the various municipalities in the Sekhukhune district municipality.

3.4.2.2. Government and Municipal Services

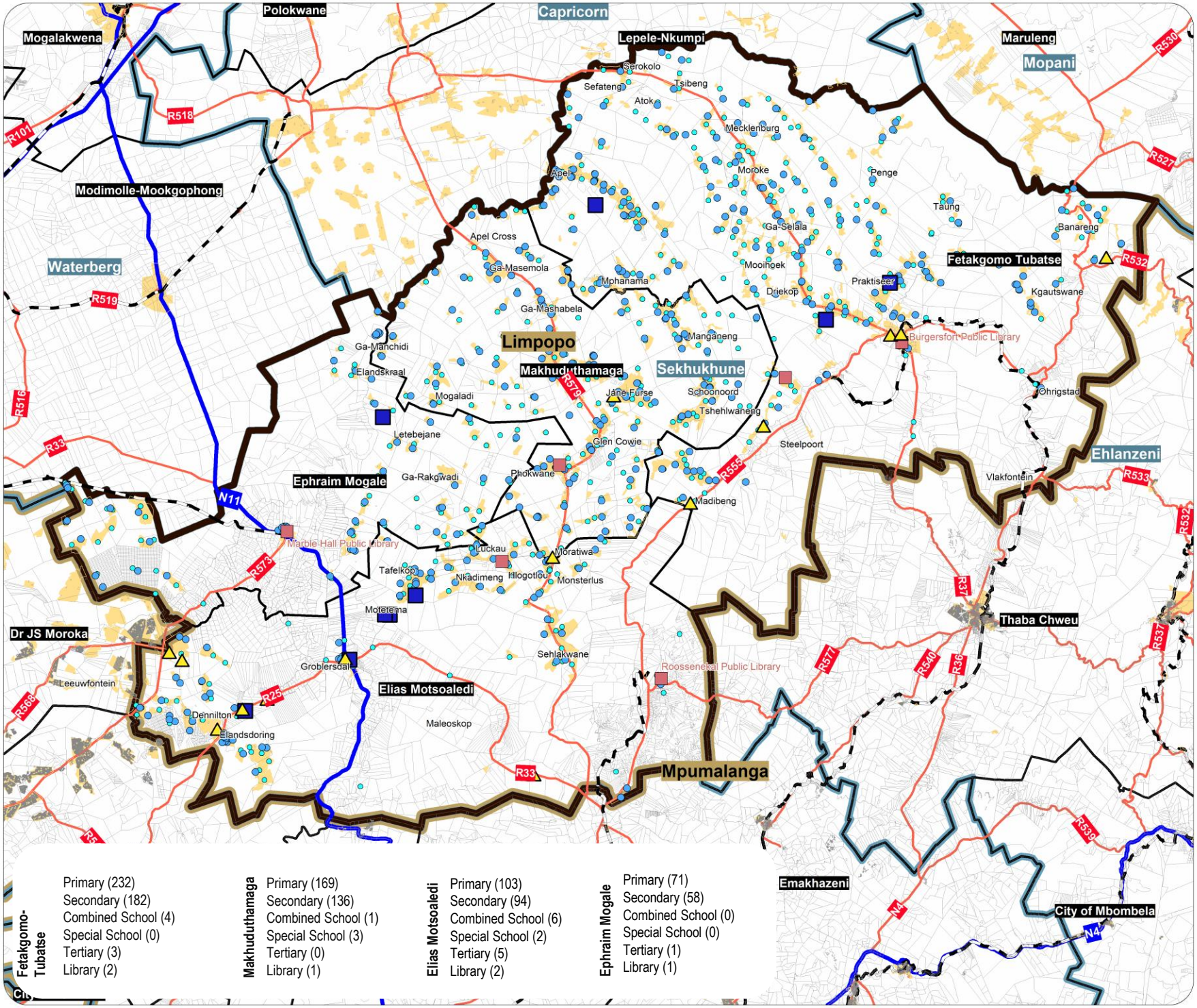
Government and Municipal services appear to be fairly distributed within the district municipality, and as depicted on **Figure 9.2**, these are most clustered in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM and Makhuduthamaga LM. These facilities include government and municipal services, such as government and municipal offices, community halls, courts, and post offices. With regards to municipal offices, there are an estimated 53 municipal offices in the entire district municipality, with approx. 20 in the Elias Motsoaledi LM, an estimated 14 in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, 12 in the Makhuduthamaga LM, and roughly 7 in the Ephraim Mogale LM. There are 23 community centres, with 13 located in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, 6 in Ephraim Mogale, 3 in Elias Motsoaledi, and 1 in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM.

In terms of magistrate courts, there are 3 in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM and one each in Makhuduthamaga LM and Elias Motsoaledi LM. None was found in Ephraim Mogale. In total, the district has a recorded total of 5 magistrate courts. Pertaining to post offices, approximately 23 post offices are established in the district municipality, with 7 each found in the Makhuduthamaga LM and the Elias Motsoaledi LM. An estimate of 5 post offices are located in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM and 4 in the Ephraim Mogale LM. Figure 9.2 shows that a lot of these facilities are located in and around major towns such as Groblersdal, Marble Hall, Burgersfort, and Jane Furse. It also shows that rural settlements are not far from these services, especially community centres, post offices, and SASSA offices.

3.4.2.3. Health Care Services

Figure 9.3 reflects the distribution of medical facilities in the district. A higher number of hospitals and clinics can be seen in the municipalities of Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM and Makhuduthamaga LM, subsequently, these two municipalities hold the highest

Figure 9.1: Educational Facilities Distribution



Fetakgomo-Tubatse	Makhuduthamaga	Elias Motsoaledi	Ephraim Mogale
Primary (232)	Primary (169)	Primary (103)	Primary (71)
Secondary (182)	Secondary (136)	Secondary (94)	Secondary (58)
Combined School (4)	Combined School (1)	Combined School (6)	Combined School (0)
Special School (0)	Special School (3)	Special School (2)	Special School (0)
Tertiary (3)	Tertiary (0)	Tertiary (5)	Tertiary (1)
Library (2)	Library (1)	Library (2)	Library (1)

SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

EDUCATIONAL FACILITIES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral (Erven, Farm,
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway Line
- Primary
- Secondary
- Combined School
- Tertiary Institution
- Public Library

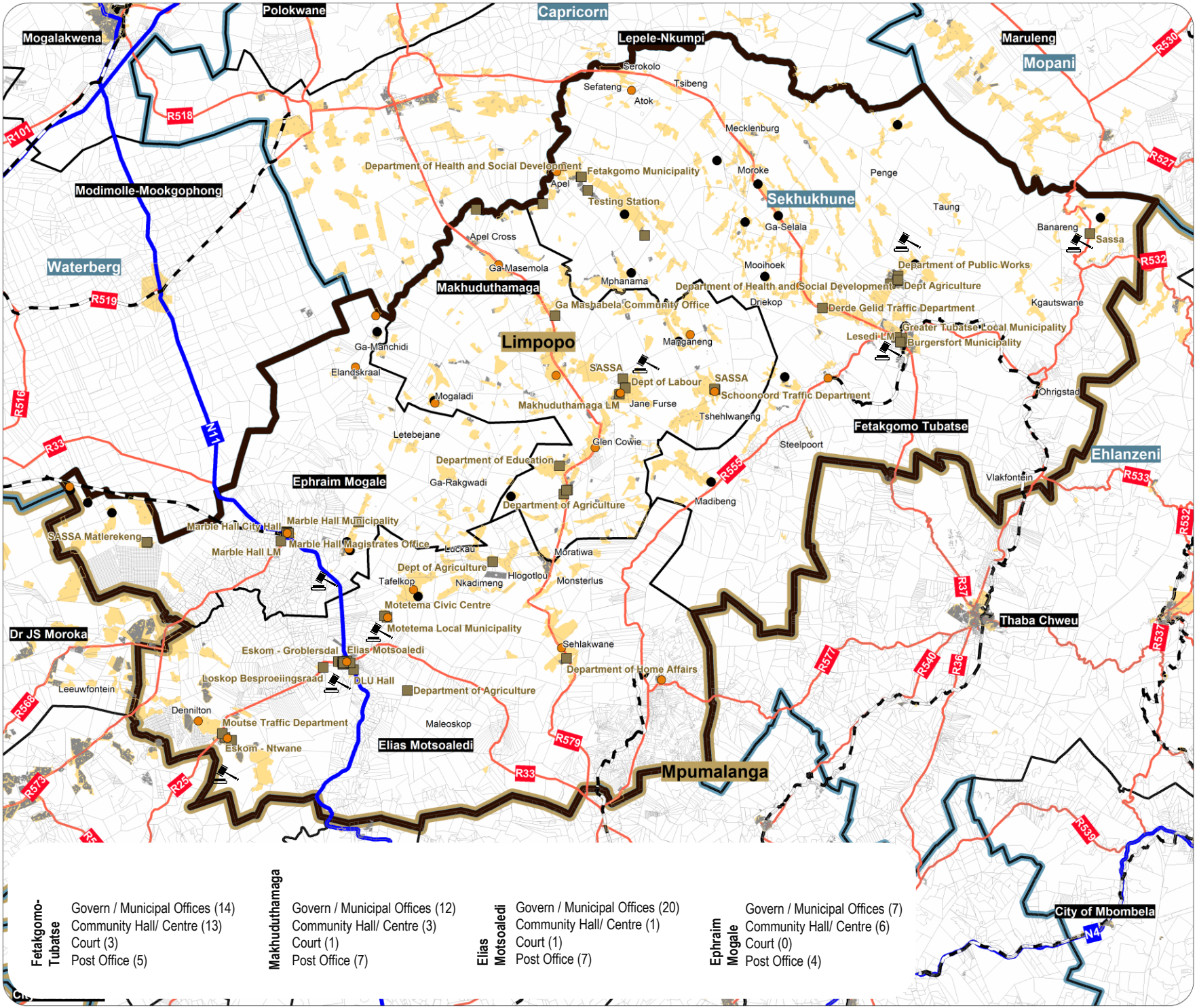
N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Figure 9.2: Government And Municipal Services



Fetakgomo-Tubatse
- Govern / Municipal Offices (14)
- Community Hall/ Centre (13)
- Court (3)
- Post Office (5)

Makhuduthamaga
- Govern / Municipal Offices (12)
- Community Hall/ Centre (3)
- Court (1)
- Post Office (7)

Elias Motsoaledi
- Govern / Municipal Offices (20)
- Community Hall/ Centre (1)
- Court (1)
- Post Office (7)

Ephraim Mogale
- Govern / Municipal Offices (7)
- Community Hall/ Centre (6)
- Court (0)
- Post Office (4)

SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

GOVERNMENT AND MUNICIPAL SERVICES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral (Erven, Farm, Parent Farms)
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway Line
- Government / Municipal Offices
- Court
- Community Hall / Centre
- Post Office

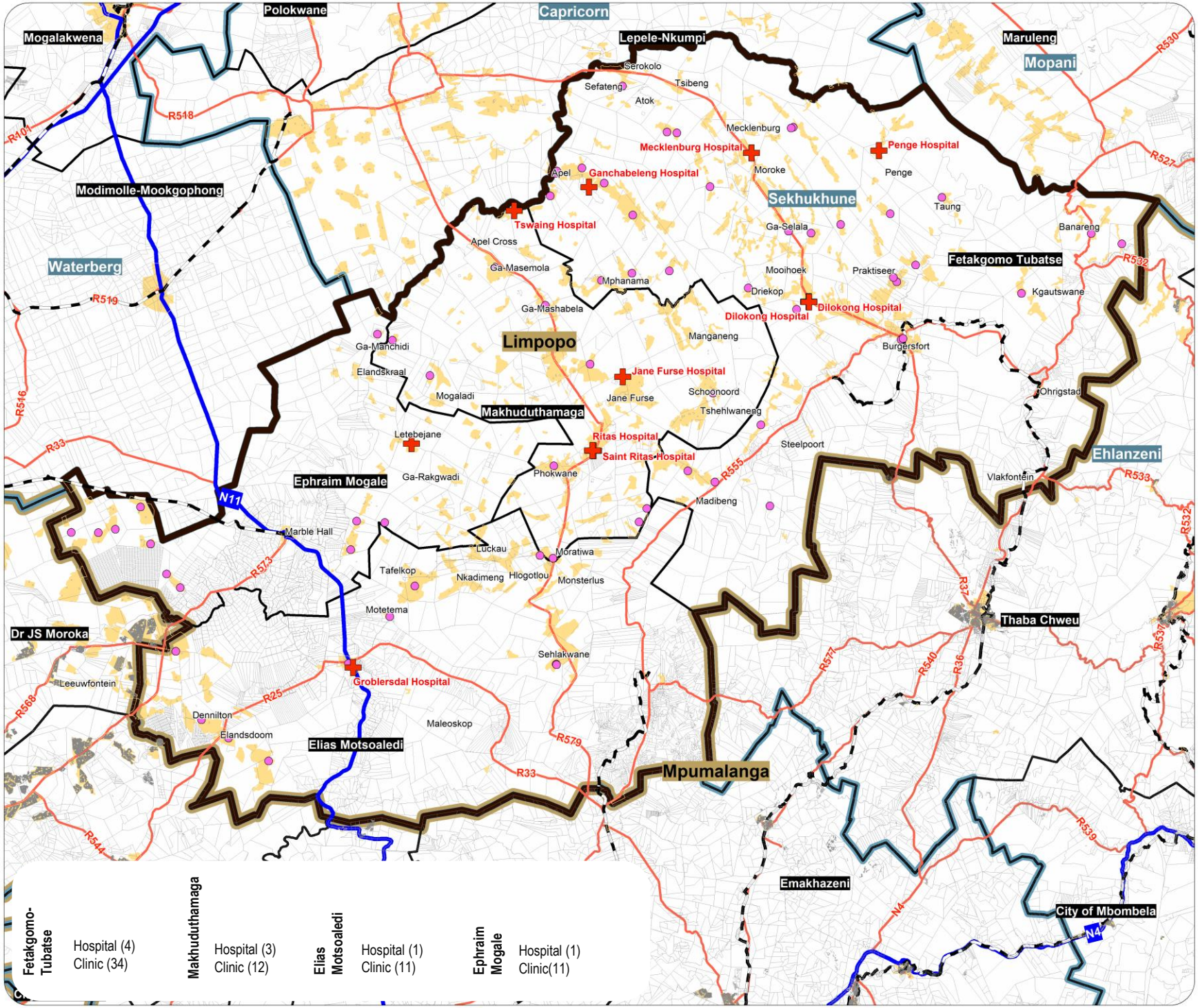
N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Figure 9.3: Health Care Facilities



Fetakgomo-Tubatse	Hospital (4) Clinic (34)	**Makhuduthamaga**	Hospital (3) Clinic (12)	**Elias Motsoaledi**	Hospital (1) Clinic (11)	**Ephraim Mogale**	Hospital (1) Clinic(11)

SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

HEALTH CARE FACILITIES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Hospital
- Clinic

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

population size according to the 2022 census data. The Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM has 4 hospitals and 34 clinics, while Makhuduthamaga has 3 hospitals and a total of 12 clinics.

The other municipalities, namely Elias Motsoaledi LM and Ephraim Mogale LM, both equally have 1 hospital and 11 clinics each. As shown, these facilities are well provided within the respective rural settlement fabric. Additionally, areas with the highest settlement configuration comprise more medical facilities than areas with the least settlement formation. It can be seen that these services are provided in and around areas of rural settlements, making accessibility relatively easy. There are also some rural settlements located further away, meaning that they have to travel long distances to access these services. However, there are other factors that can hinder this accessibility, such as road conditions and poor mobile service reception in times of emergencies.

3.4.2.4. Safety and Security

The safety of the people living in the district is ensured through the use of facilities such as police and fire stations, see **Figure 9.4**. The district has a total of 22 police stations and 2 fire stations. Fetakgomo-Tubatse and Elias Motsoaledi each have 7 police stations, while Makhuduthamaga and Ephraim Mogale each have 4. The two fire stations are located in the town of Burgersfort in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, and Elias Motsoaledi LM, specifically in the Groblersdal town.

Although police stations are distributed across the district, in and around major towns and rural settlements. The response in terms of emergencies is a serious concern that puts the safety and security of communities at risk, especially with the high crime in South Africa. The available fire stations are insufficient to service the entire district, particularly given the hot climates in these areas, which can sometimes lead to wildfires. These facilities become particularly important, especially considering that the region has a limited water supply and is heavily reliant on boreholes and tankers. In the event of a fire, people risk losing their possessions.

3.4.3. Economic Analysis

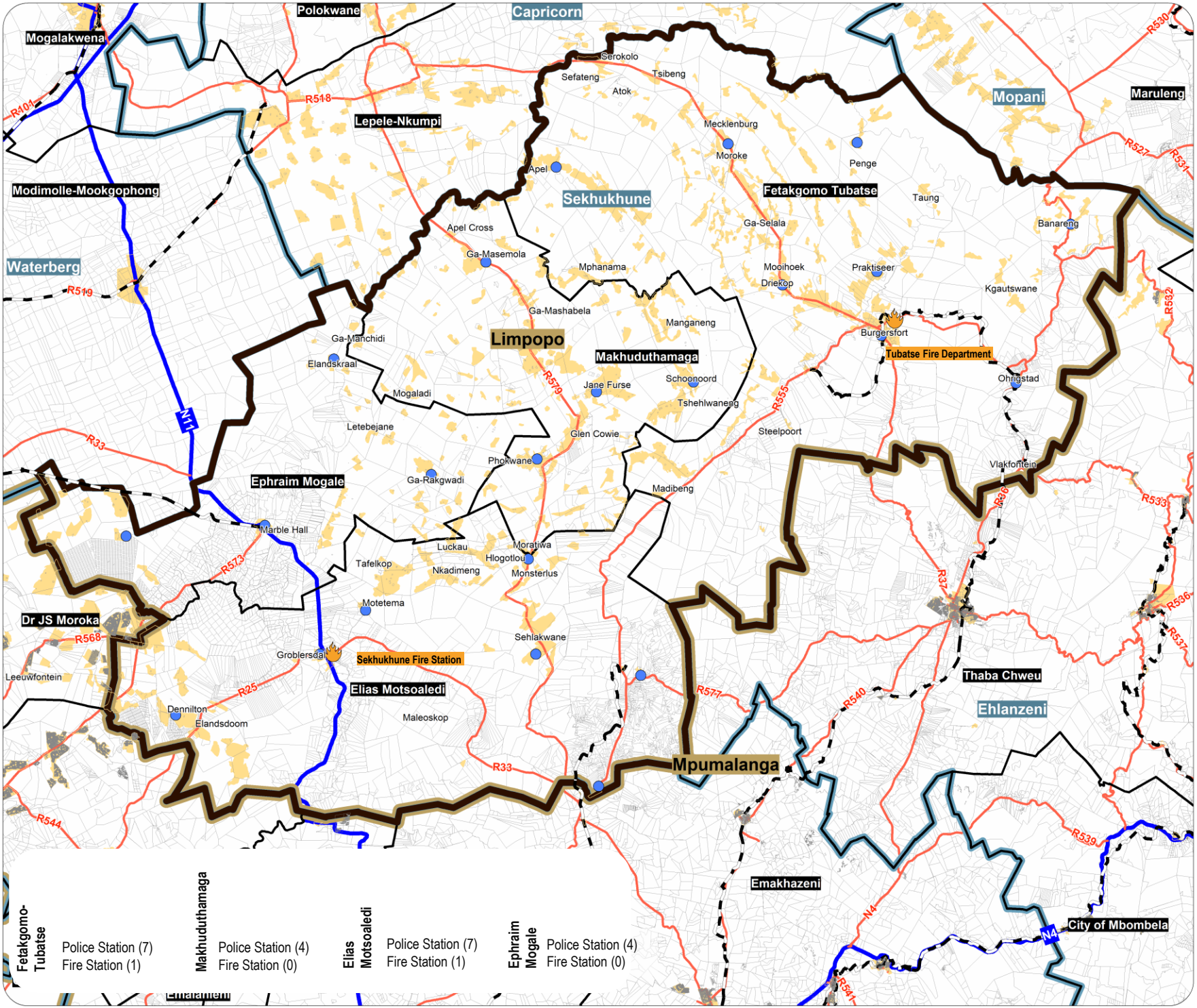
3.4.3.1. Retail and Industrial

Figure 10.1 depicts the extent of retail and industrial prevalence in the district municipality. As shown, the majority of both retail and industrial activity is concentrated along the N11 route, regional routes namely the R579, R37 and R555, and with additional activity along the D1547 and D2219 between Groblersdal-Motetema and Jane Furse. Most of the municipality's retail and industrial footprint is concentrated along a single route or within specific strategic points in the LM, rather than being evenly distributed throughout the municipal area. As a result, large portions of the municipality remain underdeveloped, with limited retail and industrial activity. However, this is not the case in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, where retail and industrial activities, although primarily concentrated along the R37 and R555 routes, are relatively well distributed in both the east–west and north–south directions. In contrast, economic activity within the Ephraim Mogale LM is only concentrated at a strategic point located at the intersection of the N11 and R573 routes.

Retail activity in the district is most prominent in the Elias Motsoaledi LM, with approx. 40%, followed by Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, which contains roughly 29% of the retail space, and the Makhuduthamaga LM, which accounts for 20% of retail space in the entire district.

Apart from mining activity, the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM encompasses the largest industrial activity, containing approx. 55% of the district's total industrial footprint. This is followed by the Ephraim Mogale LM, which holds approximately 32% of the industrial activity, while the Elias Motsoaledi LM has around 11%. The

Figure 9.4: Safety And Security Services



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

SAFETY AND SECURITY SERVICES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral (Erven, Farm, Parent Farm)
- Police Station
- Fire Station

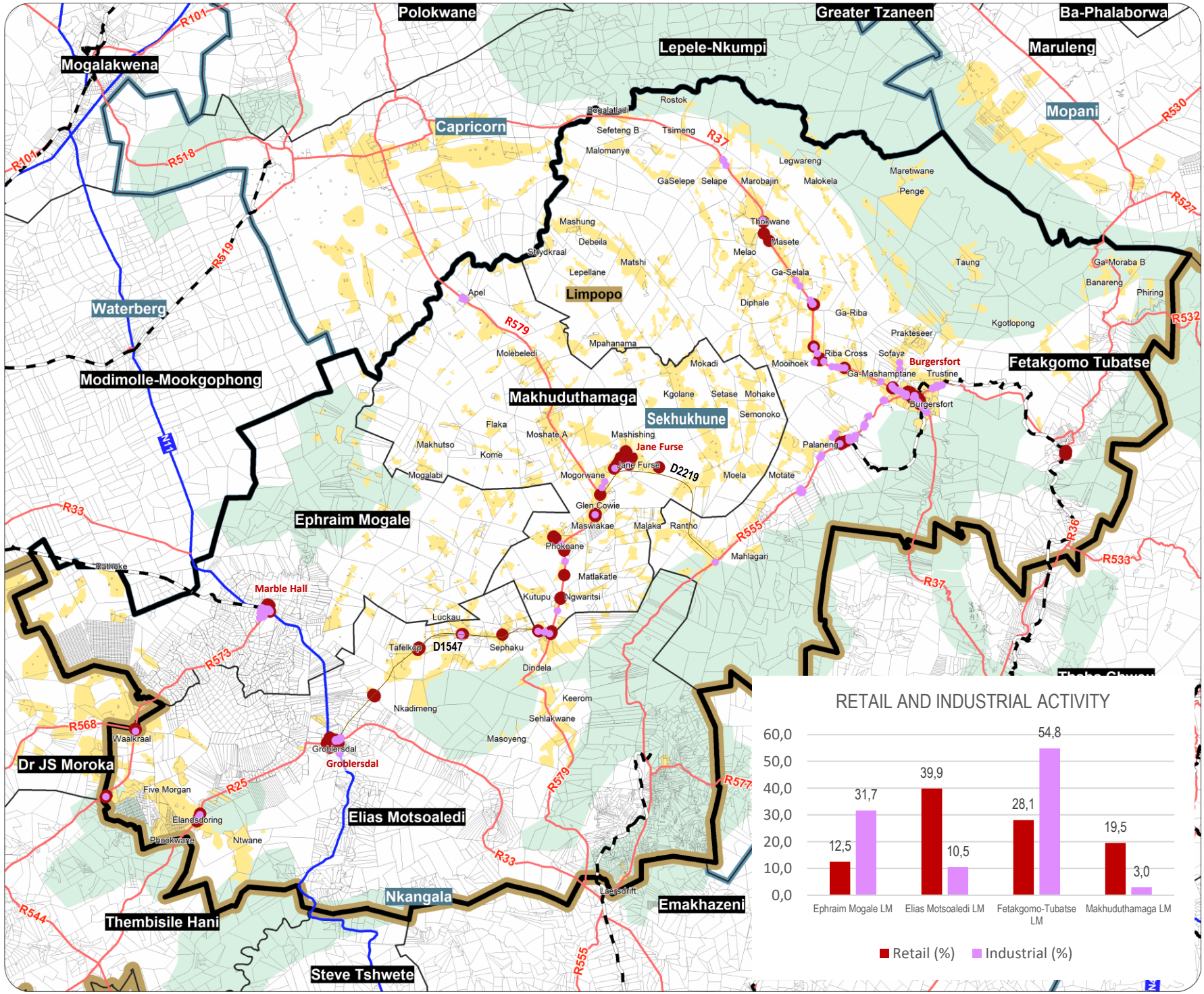
N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Figure 10.1: Retail and Industrial Activity



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

RETAIL AND INDUSTRIAL ACTIVITIES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms, Parent Farm)
- Ecological Network
- National Road
- Regional Road
- Local Access Road
- Railway Line

RETAIL AND INDUSTRIAL ACTIVITY

- Retail Activity
- Industrial Activity

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Makhuduthamaga LM has the least amount of industrial activity of approximately 3%.

3.4.3.2. Mining Activity

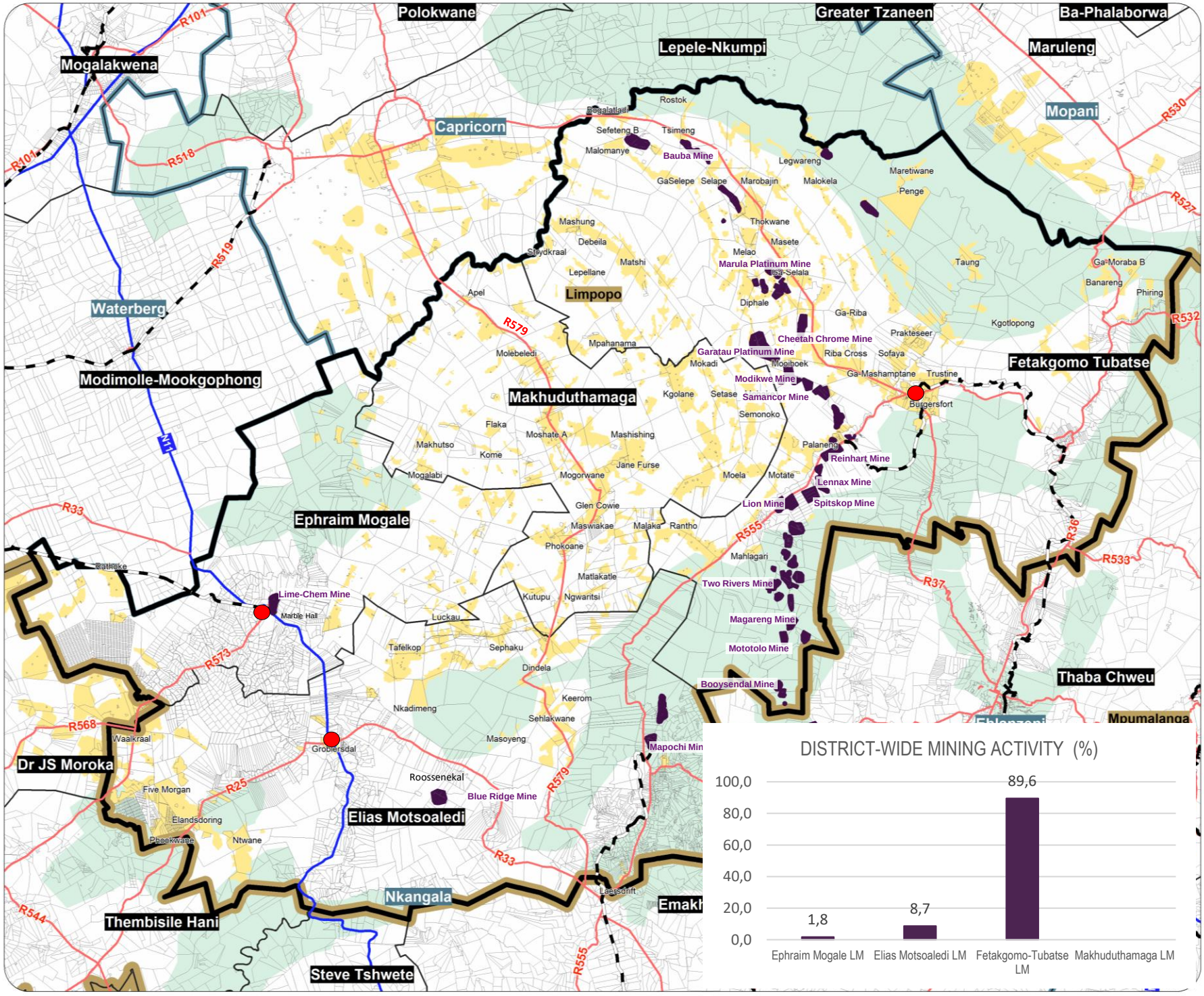
As shown in **Figure 10.2**, mining activity in the district municipality cuts across the north-eastern part of the Bushveld Complex, an immense geological structure that contains the largest reserves of platinum group metals (PGM) in the country, of which the platinum group is a family of six (6) metals namely, platinum, palladium, rhodium, iridium, osmium, and ruthenium. This sector is most dominant in the Sekhukhune District Municipality, particularly within the Dilokong Corridor. Minerals such as chromite and platinum are the primary minerals mined, making a significant contribution to both the local and national economies.

The bulk of mining activity takes place in the Fetakgomo Tubatse Local Municipality and holds 90% of the district's mining activity. With some mining prospects in Elias Motsoaledi (approx. 8%) and the remaining 2% in the Ephraim Mogale local municipalities. Mining is the economic lifeblood of the area as the sector accounts for 34.5% of the municipality's total GVA, and 55% of the municipality's total labour force is traced to the mining sector. In the Ephraim Mogale municipality, limestone/dolomite is mined in the area, of which limestone and dolomite products are used in five principal industries in South Africa, particularly cement manufacturing, metallurgy (steel refining), agriculture (fertilisers, fungicides, and animal feed), aggregate and lime manufacture. With mining operations gradually explored and developed within the Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi LMs. Notably, if mining is widely developed in the two municipalities, this could lead to land use conflicts between mining activities and existing agricultural land. Furthermore, new mining activities may result in increasing pressure being placed on environmentally sensitive areas found within the north-eastern and south-eastern extents of the district.

The mining value chain encompasses primarily exploration, extraction, mining, processing, refining, fabrication, and production stages. Within the district itself, mining participants primarily engage in the extraction stage, with very limited processing operations. Minerals and potential jobs are exported for beneficiation to overseas companies, with very little beneficiation occurring in the district and in South Africa as a whole. In order to benefit sustainably from its mineral resources, the district will need to develop its industrial capabilities in the value-creation stages of its core mineral endowments.

In terms of operational mines, the district holds approximately 27 operational mines with 47 licences issued. It is recorded that there are several non-operational mines (an estimate of eighteen (18) mines) as a result of the unavailability of water, and a lack of off-take agreements for their commodities. Of the listed non-operational mines, an estimate of thirteen (7) pending applications.

Figure 10.2: Mining Activity



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

MINING ACTIVITIES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms, Parent Farm)
- Towns
- Mining Activity
- Ecological Network
- National Road
- Regional Road
- Railway Line

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

The list below outlines the mines within the district, including both currently operational and non-operational sites.

Table 2: List of Mines in the District Municipality

NAME OF MINE	TYPE OF ORE	TOWN / VILLAGE	STATUS
FETAKGOMO-TUBATSE LOCAL MUNICIPALITY			
SAMANCOR Chrome Ltd (Lanex)	Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
SAMANCOR Chrome Ltd (Doornbosch)	Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
Spitzkop Platinum Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Operating
SAMANCOR Chrome Ltd (Tweefontein)	Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
Blackchrome Mine	Chrome, PGM's	Burgersfort	Operating
Rustenburg Platinum Mines Ltd (De Brochen)	Platinum, all minerals	Burgersfort	Operating
Zavel Investments (Pty) Ltd	Dimension Stone	Burgersfort	Operating
SAMANCOR Chrome Ltd	Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
Impala Platinum (Pty) Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Operating
Impala Platinum (Pty) Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Operating
Rhino Minerals (Pty) Ltd	Andalusite	Burgersfort	Operating
SAMANCOR Chrome Ltd (Spitzkop)	Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
Rustenburg Platinum Mines Ltd (Modikwa Mine)	Platinum	Burgersfort	Operating
Attaclay (Pty) Ltd	Attapulgite, Bentonite	Burgersfort	Operating
Saringa Slate	Slate	Burgersfort	Operating
Xstrata South Africa (Pty) Ltd (Glencore)	Platinum &Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
Two Rivers Platinum (Pty) Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Operating
Assmang Ltd	Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
Micawber 278 (Pty) Ltd (Northam Boosendal)	PGM's, Copper, Cobalt, Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
Sefateng Chrome Mine (Pty) Ltd	Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
Vanadium Resources (Pty) Ltd	Vanadium, Iron, Titanium	Burgersfort	Operating
Bauba A Hlabirwa Mining Investments (Pty) Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Operating
BCR Minerals (Pty) Ltd	Chrome	Burgersfort	Operating
De Grooteboom (Pty)Ltd	Chrome, PGM's, Gold	Burgersfort	Operating
Phokathaba Platinum (Pty) Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Nkwe Platinum	Platinum	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Mintirho Mining Ltd	All minerals	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Bokoni Platinum Mines (Pty) Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Rustenburg Platinum Mines Ltd (Twickenham Mine)	Platinum	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Dilokong Chrome Mine	Chrome	Burgersfort	Non-operational

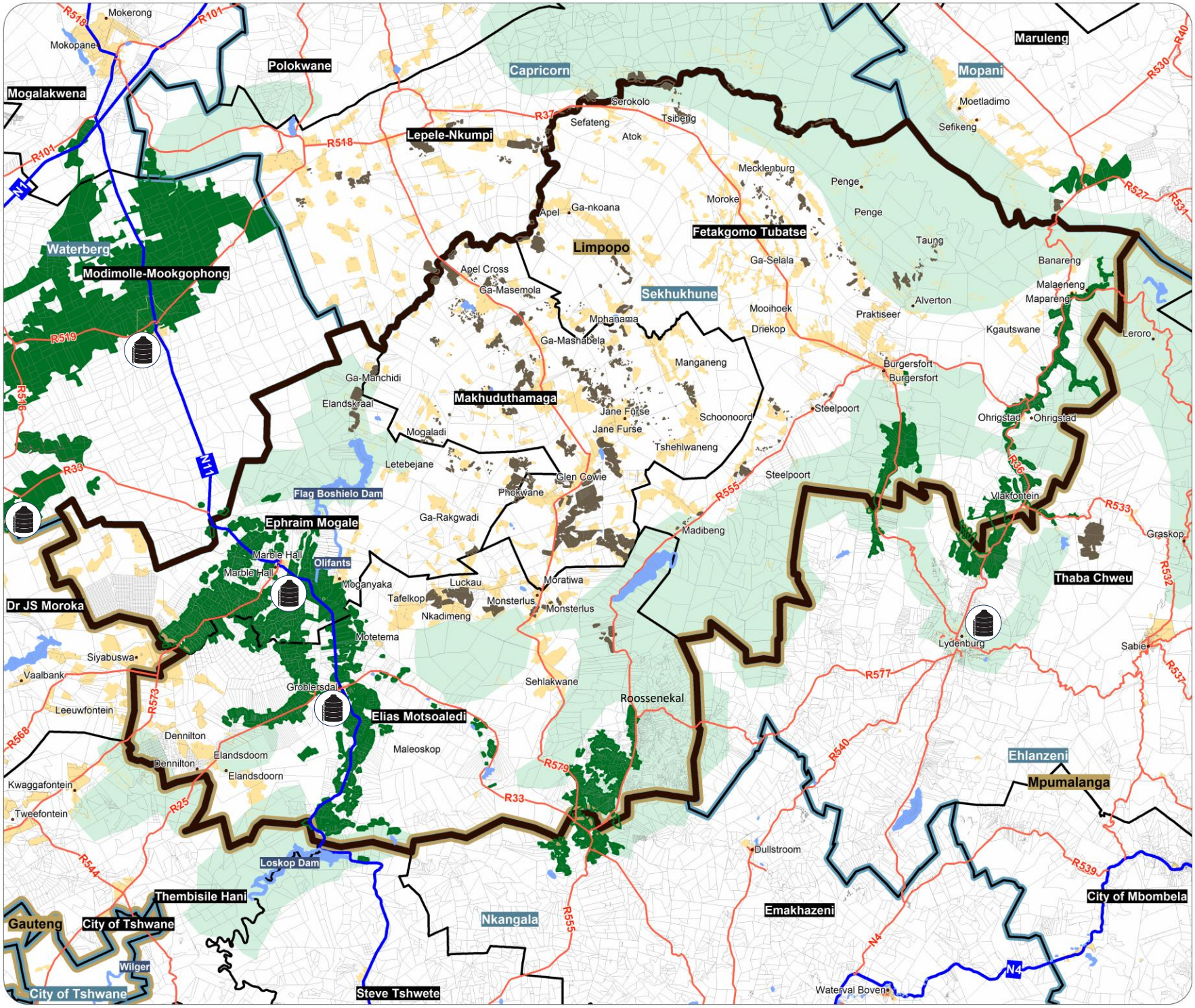
Bokoni Platinum Mines (Pty) Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Lion's Head Platinum (Pty) Ltd	PGM's, Copper, Nickel, excluding Chrome	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Chromex Chrome	Chrome	Burgersfort	Non-operational
SAMANCOR Chrome Mines (Jagdlust)	Chrome	Burgersfort	Non-operational
SAMANCOR Chrome Mines (Scheiding)	Chrome	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Tjate Platinum Corporation (Pty) Ltd	Titaneferous, magnetite	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Rakhoma Mining (Pty) Ltd		Burgersfort	Non-operational
Lesego Platinum (Pty)	Platinum	Burgersfort	Non-operational
Bokoni Platinum Mines (Pty) Ltd	Platinum	Burgersfort	Non-operational
SAMANCOR Chrome Mines (Jagdlust)	Chrome	Burgersfort	Non-operational
ELIAS MOTSOALEDI LOCAL MUNICIPALITY			
Braggite Resources (Pty) Ltd (Blue Ridge)	Platinum	Groblersdal	Non-Operational
Machero Quarries	Granite, Sand & Stone	Groblersdal	Operating
Evraz Highveld Steel and Vanadium Ltd (Mapochus Mine)	Vanadium	Groblersdal	Non-operational
Oppermann Kinders CC	Dimension Stone	Groblersdal	Operating
EPHRAIM MOGALE LOCAL MUNICIPALITY			
Lime Chem Mine	Lime	Marble Hall	Operating
Lyttelton Marble Hall Mine	Dolomite	Marble Hall	Operating

3.4.3.3. Agriculture Activity

Figure 11.1 illustrates the extent of agricultural activity in the form of crop farming across the district. As shown, extensive areas in the southern and far north-eastern regions are dominated by commercial-scale crop production. The local municipalities of Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi exhibit significant crop production, with commercial activities concentrated between the Loskop Dam and Flag Boshielo Dam, particularly along the Elands and Olifants tributaries. Additional sections of commercial crop production are evident in the far south-eastern areas of the district, notably south of Roossenekal. In the north-eastern part, commercial farming is mainly concentrated along the Steelpoort River within the Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality. Crop production in the Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi municipalities primarily includes maize, tobacco, grapes, citrus, and soya beans, while cotton is predominantly cultivated within the Ephraim Mogale Local Municipality. Accordingly, only the towns of Groblersdal and Marble Hall have grain milling infrastructure. The Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM mainly produces maize, wheat, vegetation production, and soya beans along water sources.

The central and northern regions of the district are primarily utilised for subsistence agriculture, which coincides with the concentration of rural settlements in these areas. The main subsistence crops cultivated include maize, vegetables, and wheat. This form of farming is primarily aimed at household consumption, with limited surplus sold as small-scale commodities. Although the district has a substantial amount of arable land, the extremely hot and dry weather conditions make it challenging for agricultural growth, as this requires significant investment in production, including large amounts of money and machinery. In contrast, the peripheral areas along the eastern and southern boundaries of the district are characterised by commercial agricultural activity due to the water sources found in the outer parts of the district.

Figure 11.1: Agriculture – Crop Farming



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

AGRICULTURAL – CROP FARMING

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farm, Parent Farm)
- Rural Settlement
- Commercial Crop Farming
- Subsistence Crop Farming
- Silos
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway Line
- Dam
- Ecological Network

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

The majority of disadvantaged farmers within the district are not part of the mainstream agriculture sector but rather conduct farming activities on communal land or within their yards on a small-scale level in the rural parts of the municipality. This type of farming is characterised by low production, limited access to land, inadequate access to inputs, and, most importantly, restricted access to credit.

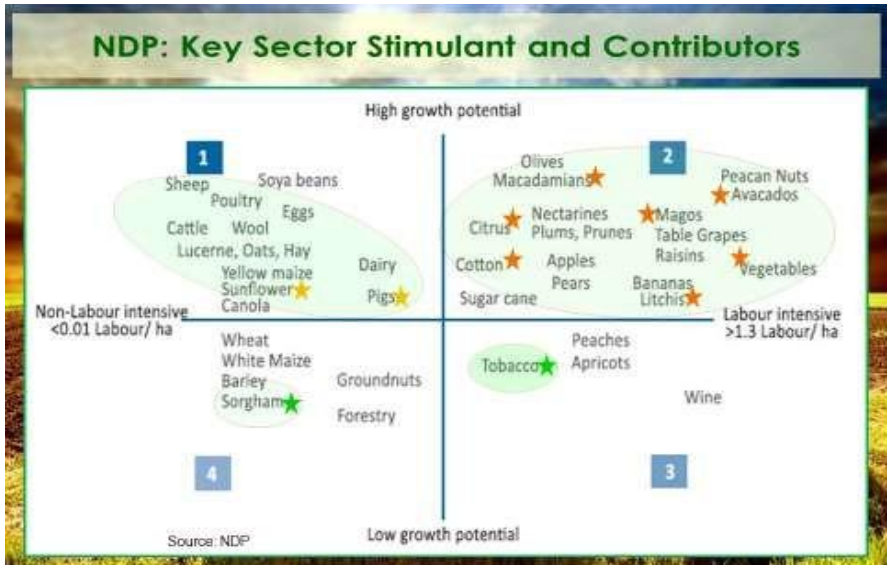
To assist local subsistence farmers, investments in irrigation infrastructure should be advocated for to ensure a reliable water supply in the rural settlements. This becomes particularly important as the district faces issues of unreliable rainfall and the threat of drought, which affect crop yields and food security. Efforts are currently underway to support farmers and enhance their farming practices. This includes the establishment of vegetable and fruit markets and nurseries to equip farmers with necessary inputs, as well as considering alternative commodities.

Livestock Farming

Subsistence-scale livestock farming is widespread across the district, with the Makhuduthamaga Local Municipality accounting for the largest share at 60% of total subsistence livestock production, as shown in **Figure 11.2**. This is followed by the Ephraim Mogale and Marble Hall Local Municipalities, each contributing 17%, and the Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality, which contributes 13%. The Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality records the lowest number of livestock in the district. Livestock farming is primarily focused on the production of chickens, cattle, and goats.

The district operates three abattoirs, located in Groblersdal, Marble Hall, and Kgautswane.

Diagram 11: Commodities produced within the district

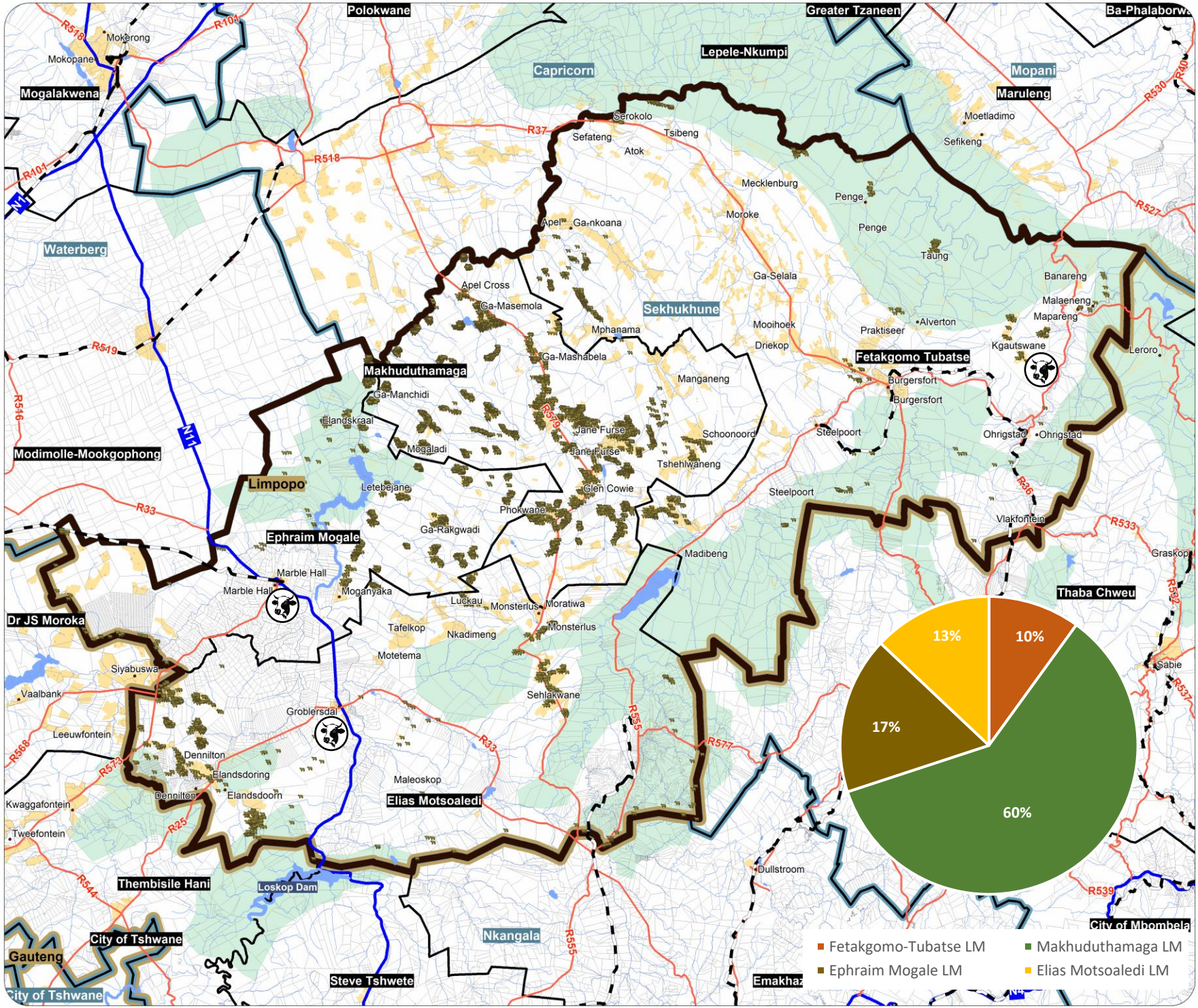


Source: National Development Plan (NDP)

According to the above diagram, Sekhukhune District is suitable for the production of Maize, Sorghum, Dry Beans, Cotton, Citrus, Table grapes, Vegetables (Tomatoes), Poultry, and Livestock. Commodities that have high value and are labour-intensive, as stipulated in Quadrant 2, are vegetables, citrus, table grapes, and cotton. These commodities offer significant potential for job creation due to their labour-intensive making them critical for addressing unemployment in the district.

Cattle and poultry, as indicated in quadrant 1, have high growth but are non-labour-intensive. Livestock in the District is primarily raised under extensive conditions in communal areas; consequently, overgrazing occurs due to farmers' overstocking. Cattle also face a risk of disease outbreak and theft as they are not kept in designated camps.

Figure 11.2: Agriculture – Livestock Farming



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

AGRICULTURAL – LIVESTOCK FARMING

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farm, Parent Farm)
- Rural Settlement
- Livestock Farming
- Abattoir
- Ecological Network
- Dams
- Rivers
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway Line

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

There is also a risk of inbreeding, which affects the quality of the breed and leads to low production. Livestock farmers sell their stock informally in the community during weddings, funerals, and traditional ceremonies. Many farmers are unable to access formal markets such as abattoirs or auctions, often due to poor livestock quality and the sale of aged animals, which reduces market value.

Drought also negatively affects cattle farmers, as many of them lose their stock during these periods. As a means to provide support, the Limpopo Department of Agriculture provides animal health advice and infrastructure support to livestock farmers within the district through vaccinations, dipping, and monitoring the movement of livestock to control diseases.

Small-scale poultry farmers also sell their live chickens informally to community members. Approximately large-scale broiler producers (owning approximately 40,000 capacity houses) are currently contracted to Kroons abattoir in Pretoria, as there is no operational abattoir in the district or nearby. The Department will continue to support smallholders with poultry houses to improve their production capacity and quality.

Maize and sorghum, as indicated in quadrant 4, are low-growth and non-labour-intensive crops, primarily produced for food security. The Sekhukhune district is endowed with good soil and water, which have great potential to strengthen the agricultural sector. The nature of agricultural activities by smallholder farmers indicates a diverse range of production, primarily focused on livestock, with significant cropping of tobacco, wheat, cotton, soybeans, citrus, paprika, pumpkin, peas, vegetables, grains, table grapes, dry beans, watermelons, and Lucerne. The agricultural capability of the district is highly dependent on the availability and consistency of water supply.

Citrus production stands out as a key contributor to the district's economy, predominantly driven by commercial farmers. The Department of Agriculture is actively supporting smallholder farmers interested in citrus through technical guidance and partnerships. The Citrus Growers Association also contributes by offering capacity-building initiatives and assisting in the development of business plans. Given the high costs associated with orchard establishment, additional funding is being sought from various stakeholders to support emerging farmers. A notable initiative includes the development of a citrus orchard for small-scale producers in the Ephraim Mogale Local Municipality.

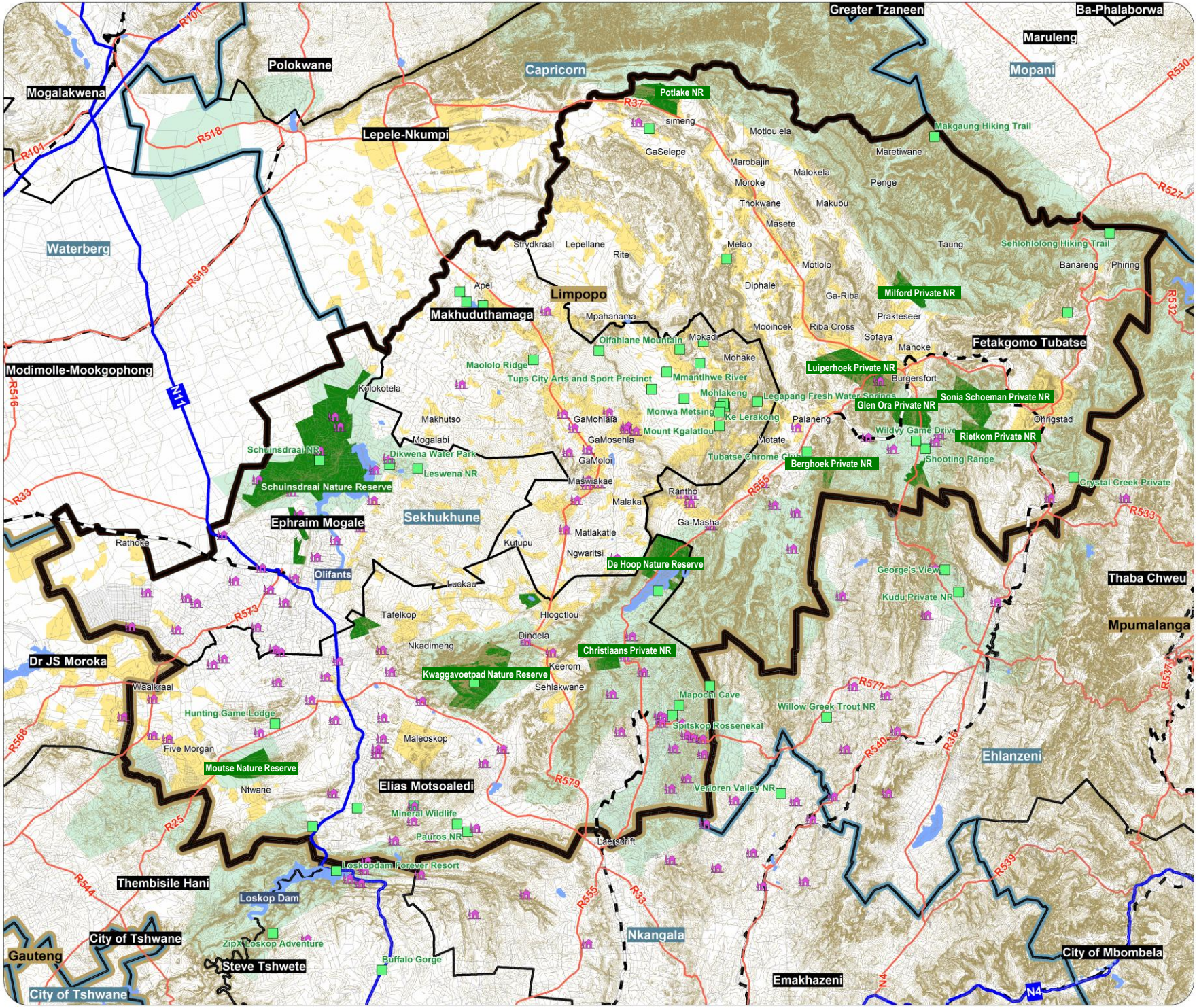
3.4.3.4. Tourism Activities

The Sekhukhune District is quietly distinguished by its rich natural beauty, cultural heritage, and agricultural landscape. Nestled within this setting are scenic destinations such as Flag Boshielo Dam, Schuinsdraai and Potlake Nature Reserves, and the Maleoskop Resort, offering opportunities for nature-based and cultural tourism, see **Figure 12.1**. While many of these attractions remain under-promoted, they continue to draw visitors who are drawn to the district's unique ecotourism experiences and unspoiled character. Is it mentioned that the district recently established the Kamoka Open Africa Route, which could potentially be linked with the existing African Ivory and Cultural Heartland routes and the planned Great Limpopo Route.

Tourism in the district municipality presents a quietly emerging opportunity rooted in the area's rich natural landscapes, cultural heritage, and unique rural, agricultural landscape. Although not extensively marketed, the district's scenic settings, nature reserves, and cultural landmarks hint at a broader potential for ecotourism and heritage-based experiences, continuing to attract many visitors in the area.

As reflected in the district's growing tourism profile, beyond its established nature reserves, a variety of attractions ranging from hiking trails and natural springs to

Figure 12.1: Tourism Activity



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

REVIEW OF THE SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

TOURISM ACTIVITY

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farm, Parent Farm)
- Rural Settlement
- Overnight Accommodation
- Site Attraction / Activities
- Protected Areas
- Dam
- Ecological Network
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway Line

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

cultural villages, shooting ranges, and game drive experiences add depth to its tourism offering. These diverse activities have, in turn, contributed to a vast increase in overnight accommodation prevalent in the southern and central regions of the district.

Despite existing tourism attractions and facilities, and although tourism has been identified as one of the significant growth sectors in the SDM, the district lacks a major product to draw a significant volume of holiday tourists to the area. A major drawcard could, however, firmly place Sekhukhune on established tourist routes to the Blyde River Canyon and Kruger National Park.

3.4.3.5. District-wide Economic Profile

The following section discusses the viability of economic sectors in the district, particularly the Gross Value Added (GVA), which measures the value of goods and services produced in a region, which in part aids governments and businesses in assessing their level of efficiency in their production, which ultimately contributes to employment and improved wages when there is increased growth in the GVA.

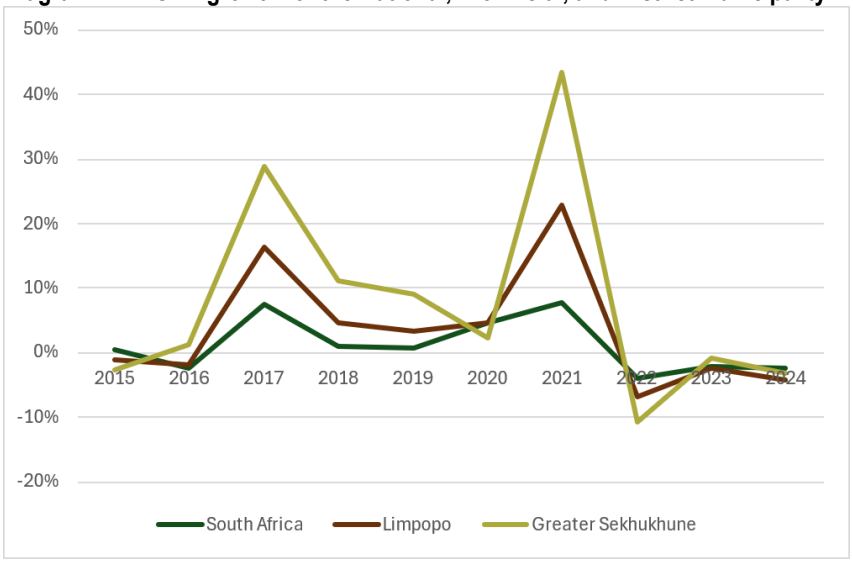
3.4.3.6. GVA Growth Analysis

The section below will analyse sectoral contributions to Gross Value Added (GVA) and associated growth trends, as well as an employment profile by sector. Additional indicators such as the food poverty line, Gini coefficient, and location quotient will be used to understand income inequality, poverty levels, and economic concentration within the district. This report aims to build a clearer picture of the socio-economic dynamics in the region by highlighting key structural and spatial characteristics of the local economy.

The accompanying **Diagram 12.1** highlights annual GVA growth trends for South Africa, the Limpopo Province, and the Sekhukhune District from 2015 to 2024. The province itself contributed approximately 7.5% to South Africa's total Gross Value Added (GVA) in 2022. Within the province, the Greater Sekhukhune District Municipality accounted for around 13.9% of Limpopo's total GVA.

The District's GVA growth shows significant volatility, with sharp increases observed in 2017 and 2021, followed by a notable decline in 2022 and sustained low growth thereafter. This instability reflects the district's economic vulnerability, particularly its dependence on sectors such as mining and agriculture, which are sensitive to fluctuations and unstable weather patterns that affect agricultural output.

Diagram 12.1: GVA growth for the National, Provincial, and District Municipality



Source: Quantec EasyData.

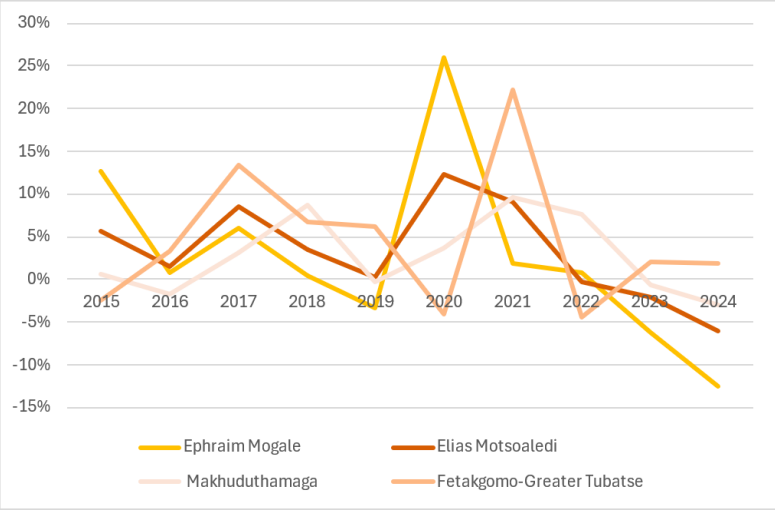
In terms of GVA per local municipality, an analysis of Gross Value Added (GVA) across the local municipalities in the district, as shown in **Diagram 12.2**, reveals varied sector performance trends over the years. Between 2016 and 2017, the dominant economic sectors in Ephraim Mogale, Elias Motsoaledi, and Fetakgomo-Tubatse local municipalities showed steady growth. However, this was followed by

a decline in 2019 across all three municipalities. Among them, Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM experienced a less severe downturn, indicating a relatively more resilient economic base.

At the peak of the COVID-19 period (2019–2020), Ephraim Mogale LM recorded a steady incline and a significant 26% growth trend. Amongst the other three municipalities, Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM tracked with a sharp performance in 2021 (23%), showing strong post-pandemic resilience.

In contrast, Elias Motsoaledi LM experienced a decline in 2020, and likewise Makhuduthamaga LM experienced a similar pattern of a 10% decrease in its GVA in 2021. Considering the recent trends (2023–2024), Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM continues to show steady growth, whereas the other three municipalities are experiencing a gradual decline in GVA, highlighting disparities in economic recovery and sectoral performance across the district.

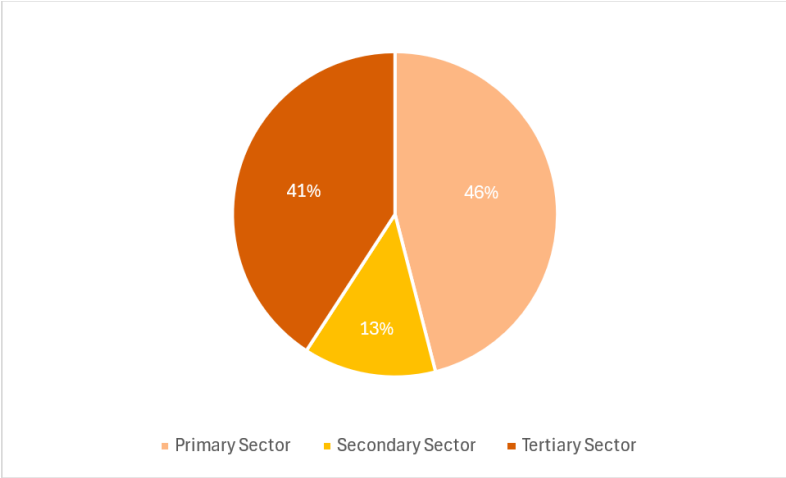
Diagram 12.2: GVA per Local Municipality in the Sekhukhune District Municipality



Source: Quantec EasyData.

The diagram below illustrates the contribution of each sector to the Gross Value Added (GVA) of the Greater Sekhukhune District Municipality in 2024. These are all ten economic sectors in the country, grouped under the primary, secondary, and tertiary categories.

Diagram 12.3: Sekhukhune District Municipality's Sectoral Contribution to GVA in 2024



Source: Quantec EasyData, 2024.

The Primary Sector is classified as one which requires the extraction and harvesting of natural resources. This includes activities that rely directly on natural resources, such as Agriculture (crop and livestock production), Forestry, Fishing, Mining and Quarrying. Whereas, the secondary sector involves manufacturing and industrial production, where raw materials from the primary sector are processed or transformed into finished or semi-finished products, such as manufacturing, construction, etc. Lastly, the tertiary sector involves services rather than goods. It includes all intangible economic activities that support production, distribution, and consumption.

Based on the above-mentioned diagram, it is noted that the Tertiary Sector contributes approximately 41% towards Gross Value Added (GVA) in the year 2024.

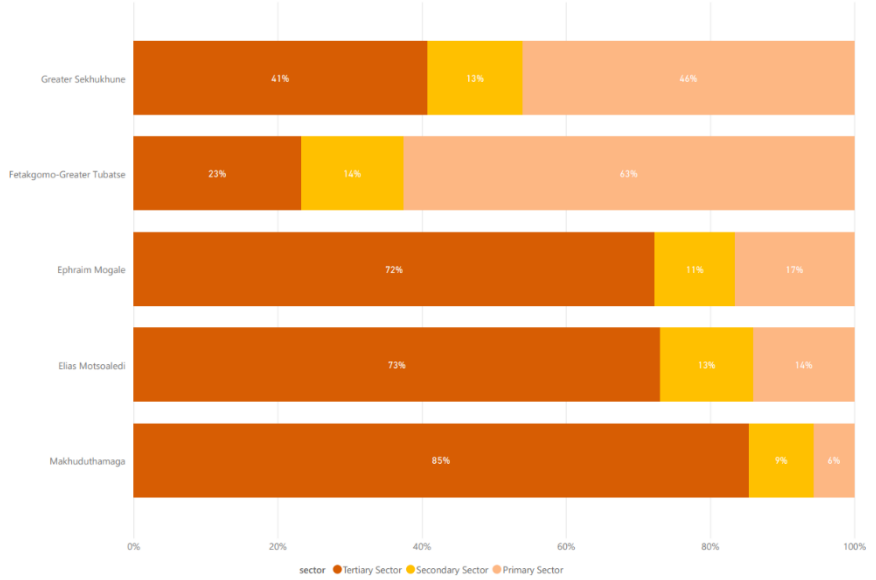
The following diagram illustrates the broad economic sector share of the District Municipality within the Limpopo Province. **Diagram 12.4** illustrates the dominant economic sectors contributing to Gross Value Added (GVA) across Limpopo Province, the Sekhukhune District Municipality, and its four local municipalities, categorised into the primary, secondary, and tertiary sectors.

At the district level, Mining and Quarrying account for 43% of Sekhukhune's total GVA. Notably higher than the provincial average of 26%. The sector's dominance is most pronounced in Fetakgomo–Tubatse Local Municipality, where mining alone contributes a substantial 61% of local GVA, largely due to extensive platinum mining operations in the area.

In contrast, the Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi municipalities reflect more diversified economies, with key contributions from Community, Social and Personal Services (21% and 22% respectively), alongside significant roles played by the General Government and Wholesale and Retail Trade sectors.

The Makhuduthamaga LM exhibits a strong dependence on the tertiary sector, particularly Community, Social and Personal Services, which make up 35% of its GVA, indicating a predominantly service-oriented local economy.

Diagram 12.4: Broad Sectoral Contribution to GVA in 2024



Source: Quantec EasyData, 2024.

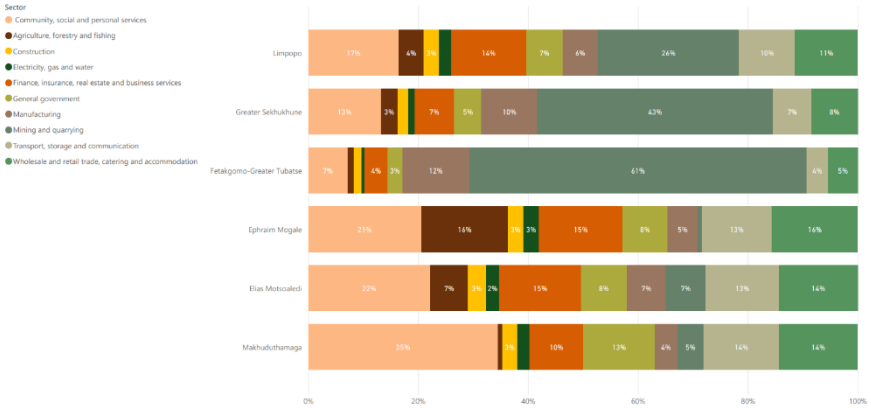
The diagram below illustrates the key economic sectors that contribute to Gross Value Added (GVA) in Limpopo Province, specifically in the Greater Sekhukhune District Municipality and its four local municipalities. In Sekhukhune District, Mining and Quarrying emerges as the dominant sector, accounting for 43% of the district's total GVA, substantially higher than the provincial average of 26%. This dominance is most pronounced in Fetakgomo–Tubatse Local Municipality, where mining contributes an impressive 61% of the local GVA, as a result of the extensive mining activity linked to the platinum belt that runs through the area. Consequently, linked to the mining in the municipality is manufacturing at 12% and is also foremost in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse municipality.

In contrast, the municipalities of Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi display more diversified economies. In both areas, Community, Social, and Personal Services

lead, contributing 21% and 22%, respectively, alongside significant input from the General Government and Wholesale and Retail Trade sectors. The Makhuduthamaga LM exhibits a clear dependence on the service sector, with Community, Social, and Personal Services accounting for 35% of its GVA, underscoring a predominantly service-oriented local economy. The agricultural sector is the smallest contributor to GVA in the district, accounting for just 7%. However, within the municipalities of Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi, agriculture contributes a notable 15%, which is significantly higher than both the district and provincial averages.

As shown, the Tertiary Sector is the strongest contributing sector in most local municipalities in 2024. The following diagram illustrates the broad economic sector share of the Local Municipalities within the Greater Sekhukhune District Municipality during 2024.

Diagram 12.5: Broad Economic Share of GVA in 2024, (Province, DM and LM)



Source: Quantec EasyData, 2024.

3.4.3.7. Employment Sector Contribution per Local Municipality

The following section outlines the employment profile across each local municipality, offering insight into labour market dynamics and the distribution of economic participation within the district.

As depicted, the Greater Sekhukhune's economy is service-driven, with Community, Social and Personal Services (27%) and Wholesale and Retail Trade (20%) being the dominant sectors. The local government and education sectors are key employers, while smaller contributions from finance (9%) and government (7%) indicate a moderate level of administrative and economic services.

I. Fetakgomo– Tubatse Local Municipality

This municipality reflects a more diversified economy. While Wholesale and Retail Trade (18%) and Mining and Quarrying (22%) are leading sectors, the area also features notable contributions from Community Services (22%) and Construction (10%). This mixed economic profile points to both primary sector activity and expanding urban service functions, especially around Burgersfort.

II. Ephraim Mogale Local Municipality

Ephraim Mogale LM has a strong public-sector presence, with Finance, Insurance, Real Estate and Business Services (31%) and Community Services (24%) leading the economic structure. Wholesale and trade also contribute 18%, suggesting this municipality is a key administrative and commercial node in the district, likely centred around Marbel Hall.

III. Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality

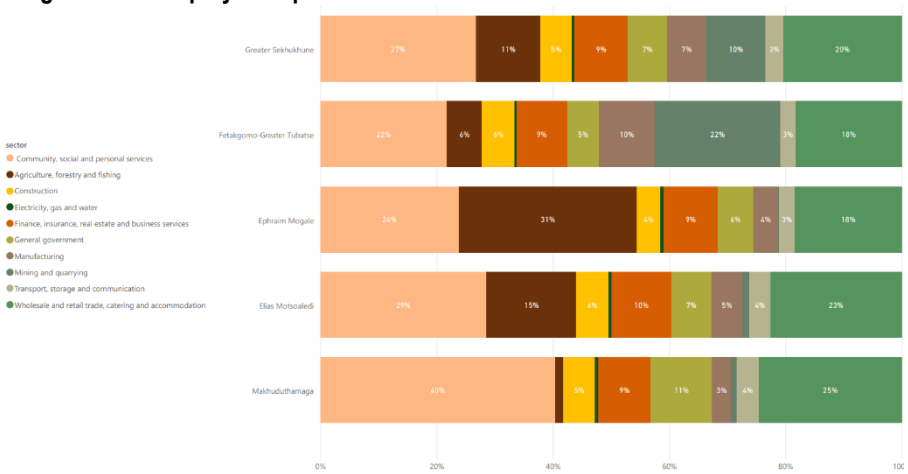
The municipality's economy is broadly balanced, with significant shares in Community Services (29%), Wholesale and Retail Trade (23%), and Electricity, Gas and Water (10%). The area shows strong government presence and essential

services, pointing to regional service delivery infrastructure and commercial support functions.

IV. Makhuduthamaga Local Municipality

The Makhuduthamaga LM is the most service-reliant municipality, with Community Services (40%) and Wholesale and Retail Trade (25%) making up two-thirds of the local economy. This suggests a dependency on public employment and basic retail trade, with a limited presence from higher-value sectors such as finance or manufacturing.

Diagram 12.6: Employment per Sector



Source: Quantec EasyData, 2024.

3.4.3.8. Labour Market

The section below highlights the employment status rates in the district. between 1996, when South Africa became an independent state, and 2022. Although there is still a high number of people unemployed since 1996, this trend is expected to continue through 2024.

With business operations increasingly shifting from human-driven interaction and production to technology- and machine-based systems, unemployment has continued at a relatively steady rate. This trend reflects the district's ongoing efforts to stabilise employment levels and support job creation. In 1996, unemployment was recorded at approximately 65%, and it increased slightly to 70% in 2001, representing a 5% increase in the number of people unemployed. With the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic, which emerged in 2020, the number of unemployed individuals decreased to 59%, which was slightly higher in the past 10 years (2011) at 61%.

In 2024, the district experienced a 5% increase in the number of unemployed people between 2022 and 2024. This could be a result of many businesses experiencing the aftershock of the pandemic, which led to some closures and others reducing their workforce.

Diagram 12.7: District Employment and Unemployment (%)

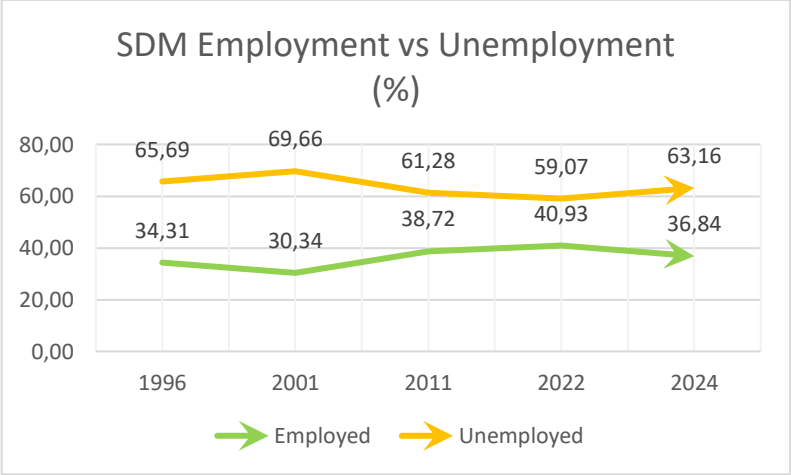


Diagram 12.8: District Employment and Unemployment - Population

Employment Status	1996	2001	2011	2022	2024
Employed	63152	70620	128794	106000	110428
Unemployed	120891	162120	203842	153000	189292
Total	184043	232740	332636	259000	299719

Source: Stats SA, 2011 & Quantec EasyData, 2024

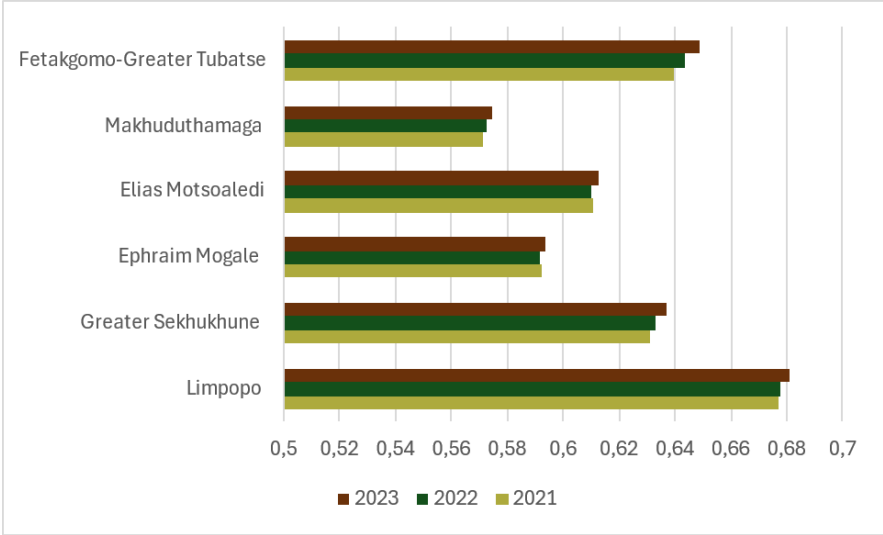
3.4.3.9. Affordability Level

The Gini Coefficient is a statistical tool that evaluates income inequality within a population, with values ranging from 0 (perfect equality) to 1 (extreme inequality). As per Quantec EasyData (2024), these coefficients were derived using per capita income and poverty headcount data.

The diagram below presents Gini Coefficient trends for Limpopo Province, the Greater Sekhukhune District Municipality, and its four local municipalities from 2021 to 2023. The province records the highest level of inequality, with a Gini coefficient of 0.68. A large portion of the population resides in areas distant from economic opportunities and continues to experience inadequate access to basic services. Although the Fetakgomo–Tubatse LM encompassed a lot of mining operations and industrial development, the municipality, however, holds the highest levels of inequality in the entire district, with a Gini coefficient of slightly above 0,64. Subsequently, Makhuduthamaga had the lowest Gini coefficient, indicating relatively lower income inequality.

While disparities persist, the overall Gini coefficients across the district remained fairly stable over the three years, subtly pointing to structural patterns in income distribution that may require long-term policy attention.

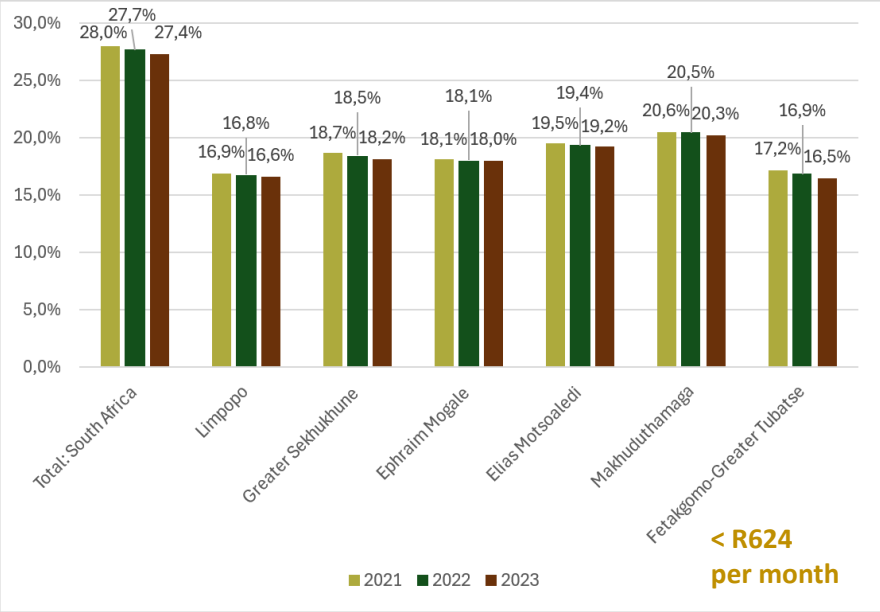
Diagram 12.8: Gini Coefficient for the Greater Sekhukhune District Municipality



Source: Quantec EasyData, 2024

According to the 2024 data, the “Food Poverty Line” is R624 per person per month, which refers to the amount of money required to afford the minimum daily energy intake mentioned above. The diagram below illustrates the percentage of the population living below the food poverty line across South Africa, Limpopo, and the municipalities within the Greater Sekhukhune District from 2021 to 2023. While the national average declined slightly from 28.0% in 2021 to 27.4% in 2023, all local municipalities in Sekhukhune recorded lower food poverty rates than the national figure. The Makhuduthamaga LM consistently had the highest rate in the district, averaging around 20%, while Fetakgomo–Tubatse and Limpopo Province had the lowest, dropping to 16.5% and 16.6% respectively in 2023.

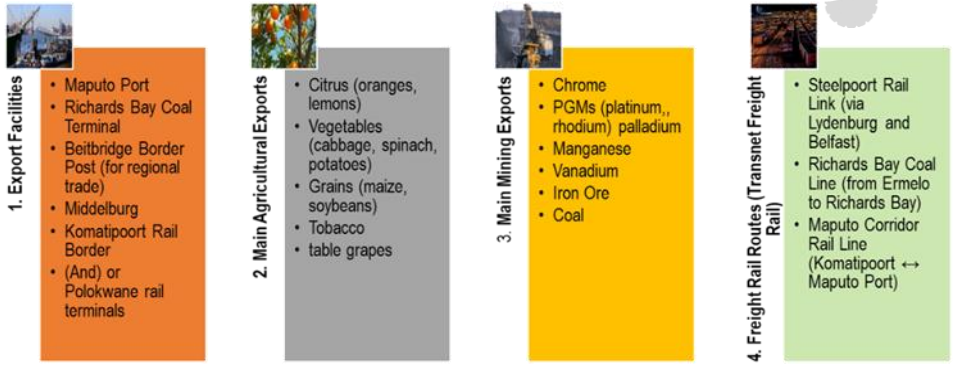
Diagram 12.9: Food Poverty Line



Source: Quantec EasyData, 2024

3.4.3.10.District-wide Export Cycle

The following section examines the economic distribution of goods and services produced within the district municipality, along with the transport routes utilised to access both domestic and export markets. The diagram below summarises trade routes and products exported from the Sekhukhune District Municipality, as well as those linked to other parts of the country, neighbouring countries, and abroad, refer to **Figure 12.2**



1. Mining Logistics and Channels

Mining products are transported from the district to export and logistics hubs using rail and road transportation. The R37 serves as a key corridor for transporting mining goods from Steelpoort and Burgersfort to Polokwane and Lydenburg. From there, road transportation moves these goods to freight terminals in Polokwane and Middelburg, continuing towards Maputo Port. To the south, the road connects with the N4 (Maputo Corridor), which heads west towards Gauteng for rail hubs and eastward towards Mozambique, where goods are shipped internationally to China, India, Europe, and the USA.

To the north, the road links to the N1 (North-South Corridor), heading east towards Zimbabwe via the Polokwane–Musina–Beitbridge border post, primarily used for exports to Zimbabwe, the Southern African Development Community (SADC), and other neighbouring countries. The R555 route is utilised to transport mining goods from Steelpoort to Middelburg and connects to the N11, leading towards Richards Bay.

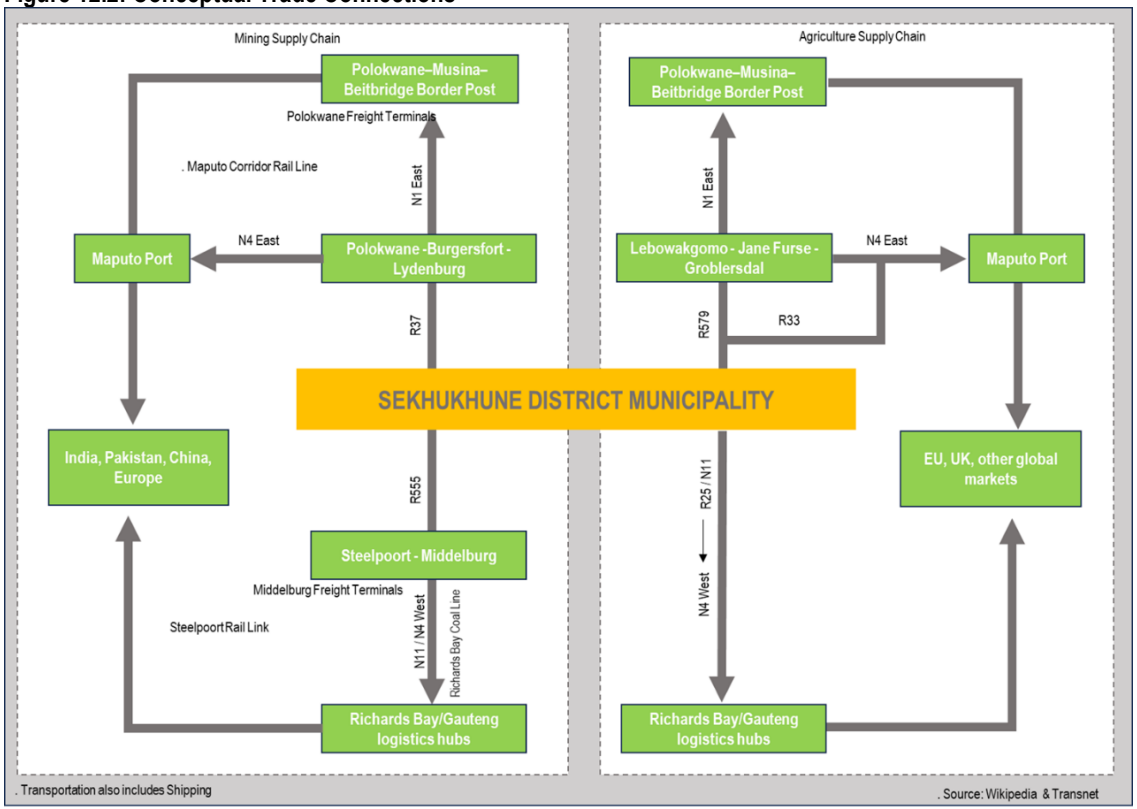
2. Agricultural Logistics and Channels

Agricultural goods from Jane Furse are primarily transported along the R579 route, connecting to the R33 and R25, and eventually joining the N11 and N4 towards export hubs. The N11 passes through Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi, with agricultural goods from these regions mainly transported along this route. The N11 connects southwards with the N4, facilitating transportation of goods east to Mozambique and west toward Gauteng.

3. Freight Rail Routes

The Steelpoort rail link feeds into the Maputo Corridor rail and the Richards Bay export railway via Lydenburg and Belfast. The Richards Bay Coal Line, running from Ermelo to Richards Bay, serves as a rail-road intermodal hub for bulk goods from Waterburg and Sekhukhune in Middelburg. The Maputo Corridor Rail is a vital export rail line, providing cost-effective mineral transportation from Limpopo and Mpumalanga to Asia and Europe.

Figure 12.2: Conceptual Trade Connections



3.5. ENVIRONMENTAL FEATURES

The following section provides a critical component of spatial planning, highlighting the ecological characteristics, natural systems, and environmental constraints of the District Municipality that influence land use and development within the SDM. The analysis will assess the current state of the environment, including elements such as climate, topography, water resources, soil conditions, biodiversity, and environmental sensitivities.

3.5.1. Topography and Hydrology

Figure 13.1 depicts the topography of the Sekhukhune District, which consists of strongly undulating plains, that transition into the Springbok Flats of the Waterberg District to the west. Dominating the north-eastern and eastern areas is the Klein Drakensberg Mountain range, a prominent physical feature that significantly shapes the district's spatial structure. This range acts as a natural barrier, particularly limiting east–west movement in the central and northern areas, impacting connectivity between key towns such as Burgersfort, Jane Furse, Groblersdal, and Marble Hall.

The Olifants, Moses, and Elands Rivers enter the district from the southwest and converge to form the Olifants River, which flows north-northeast along the district's boundary. The Tubatse (Steelpoort) and Ngwaritsi (Spekboom) Rivers traverse the eastern and central parts of the district, eventually joining the Olifants River further north.

Vital dams are fed by these rivers and this includes the Rooikraal, Piet Gouws, and Flag Boshielo Dams within the Olifants River system, as well as the recently constructed De Hoop Dam on the Tubatse River. These watercourses are vital to the Loskop and Ohrigstad Irrigation Schemes, supporting both commercial and subsistence agriculture in the region.

The district municipality experiences a semi-arid climate, typical of the Olifants River Valley, characterised by hot and dry conditions. Summer temperatures average around 23°C, while winters are cooler, with an average of 13.5°C. Rainfall is unevenly distributed, with the southern and southeastern parts of the district receiving the highest levels (approximately 600–800 mm per year). These areas also support the majority of the district's commercial agriculture.

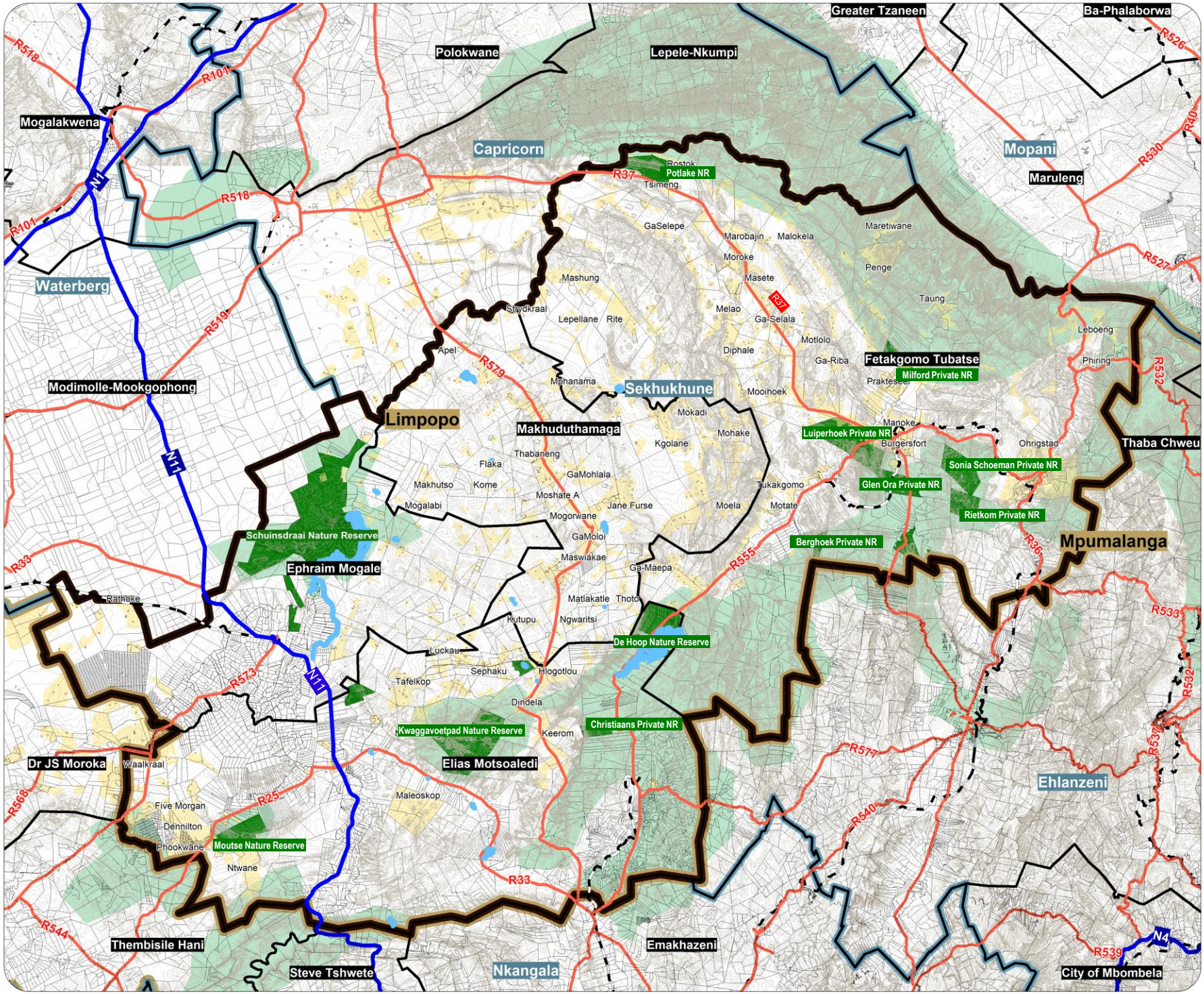
In terms of annual rainfall, the northern and central-northern extents of the area are not well suited to intensive commercial agriculture. There is considerable variability in terms of rainfall intensity, duration, and frequency. This exacerbates the water shortage problem, which is a key developmental constraint in the district. Furthermore, increasingly sparse rainfall and a high evaporation rate are currently limiting subsistence farming in the district, a situation that has contributed to food insecurity.

3.5.2. Geology

Figure 13.2 Sekhukhune district is home to one of the largest reserves of platinum Group Metals (PGMs) in the world. The famous Bushveld Complex that forms part of the Merensky Reff is found in the north and north-eastern parts of the district municipality (The western limb is found in the area between Rustenburg and Northam in North West Province). Sekhukhune has a highly complex geological structure, characterised by a diverse range of rocks and soils. It consists of the eastern Bushveld and Springbok Flats region, located along the western boundary of the district.

The figure depicts that the areas have layers of bronzite, claystone, pockets of dolomite, indicating higher development expenses in such areas, feldspathic

Figure 13.1: Natural Features: Protected Areas & Nature Reserves



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

TOPOGRAPHY AND NATURAL FEATURES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Nature Reserves
- Protected Areas
- Dams
- Regional Roads
- National Road
- Railway line

N

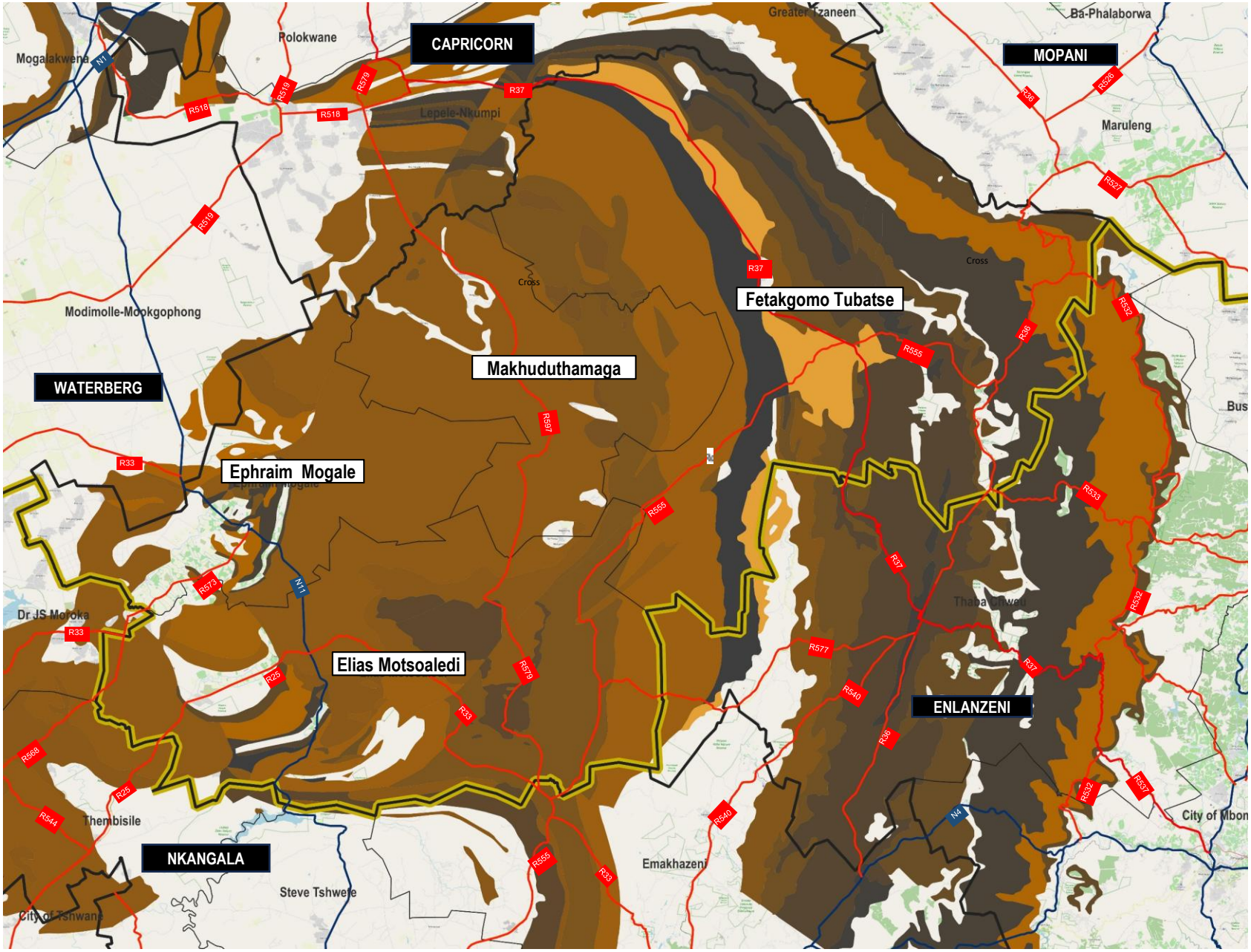
0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
Sekhukhune District Municipality
3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

13.1

Figure 13.2: Geology



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

GEOLOGY

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Rural Settlement
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms, Parent Farm)
- Regional Roads
- National Road

- Bronzite
- Claystone, Siltstone
- Dolomite
- Feldsphathic Arenite
- Fine-to-Very Coarse grained
- Gabbro
- Gneiss
- Granite
- Homogenous granophyre
- Metamorphosed Mudstone
- Olivine diorite
- Pebbly quartzite
- Minor shale
- Siltstone
- Quartzite
- Rhyolite
- Minor limestone
- Basalt
- Conglomerate
- Tuff and agglomerate overlain by pillow basalt

N

0 10 20 km

13.2

arenite, and gabbro, which is mainly found in areas with platinum deposits. Although the district features a variety of rock formations, the overall geology is classified as Gabbro, Anorthosite band, Clinopyroxenite and Arenite. This means that the district is an advantageous place for construction, industrial use and mining activities. The district also comprises of heavy metal soils derived from predominantly pyroxenite, norite, and anorthosite formations, resulting in very limited agricultural potential. Areas with the highest soil sensitivity are located along the eastern escarpment, which hosts a significant amount of commercial and subsistence farming.

This area is also characterised by foothills and Drakensberg mountains, which have a significant influence on the real estate sector within the area.

3.5.3. Vegetation, Nature Reserves and Protected Areas

Sekhukhune's vegetation is mostly tropical bush and savannah. More specifically, the dominant vegetation type (also classified as sensitive) is Sourish Mixed Bushveld, which contains the false grassveld types. Several nature reserves, conservation areas and private nature reserves are found throughout the district. These include the Schuinsdraai Nature Reserve at Flag Boshielo Dam, the Potlake Nature Reserve to the north, the Kwaggavoetpad Nature Reserve, centrally located in Elias Motsoaledi, the Moutse and Loskop Dam Nature Reserves to the south, and Blyderivierspoort Nature Reserve at the north-eastern end of the district.

There are also several small clusters of Private Nature Reserves along the Olifants River in the eastern parts of Ephraim Mogale, a cluster in the south-western extents of Elias Motsoaledi (forming part of a larger cluster located in the Nkangala District (Loskop Dam to Rust de Winter), around the new De Hoop Dam along the Steelpoort/ Tubatse River in the east, and another cluster around Burgersfort/ Tubatse.

3.5.4. Climate Change

South Africa has been experiencing an increase in temperatures in recent years, which has a significant impact on its environmental, economic, and social sectors. This raises a serious concern for planning in South Africa, a country already plagued by numerous socio-economic and environmental issues. The CSIR reported that in 2015, the country experienced the largest El Niño event in its history, with temperatures in the region increasing by an average of 5°C in its monthly climatological temperature report.

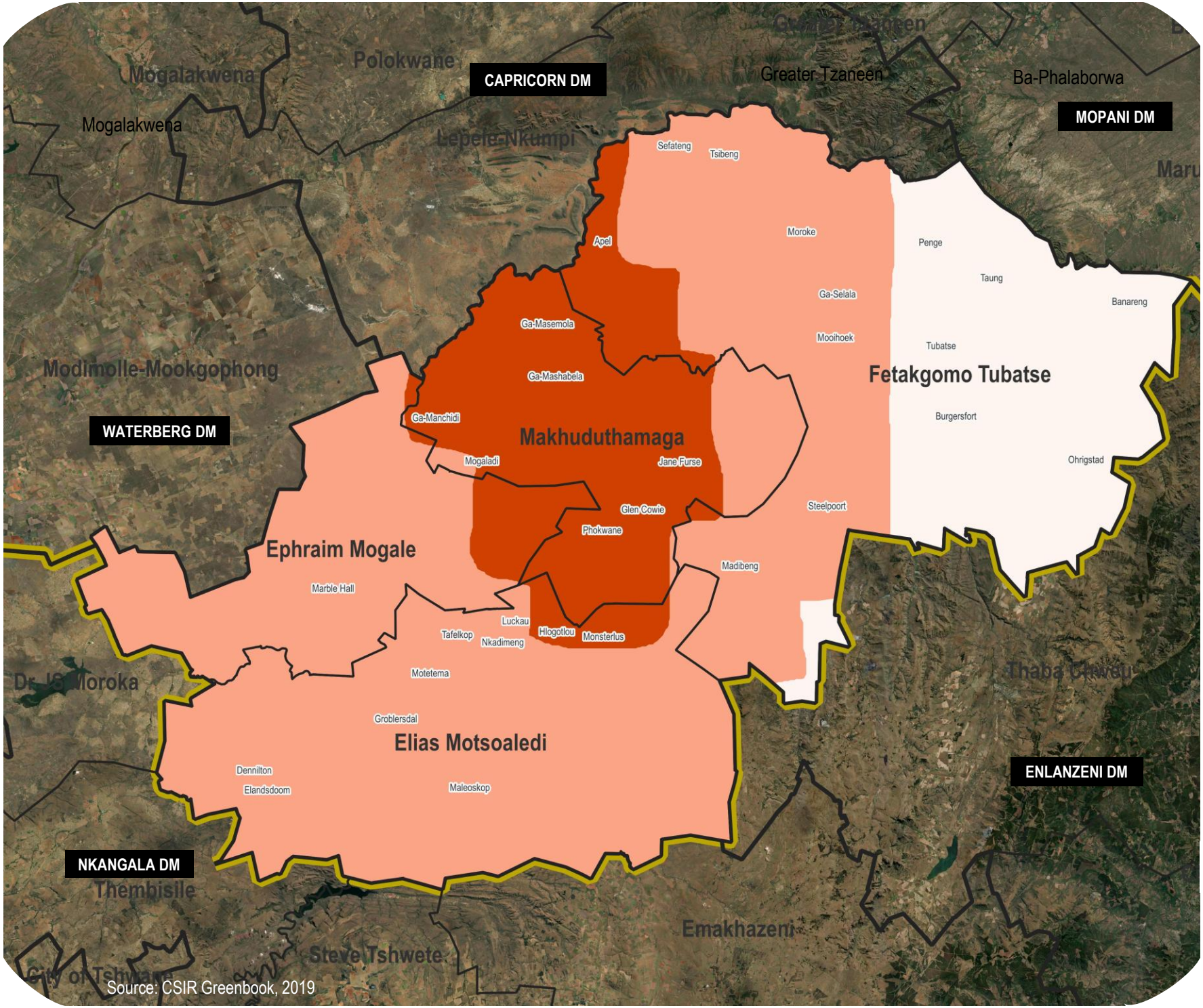
This continued to be the case for several years (more specifically, 2017), where parts of the country experienced an all-time low in rainfall, and dams dropped to critical low levels. This led to a critical water shortage and significant losses in the agricultural sector, forcing farmers to sell their land and livestock in an effort to recover financially.

Therefore, this section discusses the current and projected climate conditions in the Sekhukhune District Municipality and the development conditions in the region, as well as the necessary actions to address/mitigate, and adapt to the issues outlined in the following subsections.

3.5.4.1. Current Drought Levels

In terms of drought, **Figure 13.3** illustrates the risk levels of drought over 10-year periods for the period from 1995 to 2024. This illustrates that the north-eastern parts of the district (specifically the eastern regions of Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM) experienced a low risk of drought. This suggests that the region has no major temperature increases and experiences good rainfall. The central parts of the district, particularly the Makhuduthamaga LM, experienced the region's highest level of drought, which is detrimental to community well-being due to extreme dry conditions and the agricultural sector in that area. The remaining parts of the district,

Figure 13.3: Drought Risk Levels (1995 – 2024)



Source: CSIR Greenbook, 2019

SEKHUKHUNE District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DROUGHT RISK LEVELS (1995-2024)

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Municipal Boundary

Drought Risk Levels

- Low
- Medium
- High

N

0 10 20 km

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mainly the municipalities of Ephraim Mogale LM, Elias Motsoaledi LM, and the far western part of the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, are at intermediate risk of drought, as evidenced by medium levels of drought, indicating relatively dry weather conditions.

3.5.4.2. Projected Drought Risk Level

This section provides an in-depth examination of the various climate projections for the Sekhukhune district municipality, as outlined in the Green Book, and discusses their implications for regional development. The focus will be on projected temperatures and rainfall for each local municipality.

In terms of Drought, as shown in **Figure 13.4**, the drought risk levels are depicted between 2035 and 2064. As shown, the eastern part of the region is at high risk of severe drought, indicating that the region will likely experience significant temperature increases, leading to extreme dry weather conditions. Limpopo SDF states that the temperature change is 3^{o} Celsius.

Regarding rainfall, the map indicates that the area is expected to experience a decrease in rainfall. This drastic change can be attributed to the mining activities in Steelpoort. Which will result in areas such as Jane Furse being affected. This will make it hard for farmers to continue agricultural activities.

Regarding rainfall, the map indicates that the area is likely to experience a decline in rainfall levels. This significant change may be attributed to mining activities in Steelpoort, which are expected to have a negative impact on surrounding areas such as Jane Furse. As a result, farmers in these areas may face increasing challenges in continuing their agricultural activities.

The drought map also shows that the area southwest of the region where large-scale commercial farming is taking place will not be that affected by drought, however rain is projected to decrease drastically, which will have a severe impact on agricultural activities, which could threaten the food security of the area and the economic sector as agriculture is the largest contributing industry in the region.

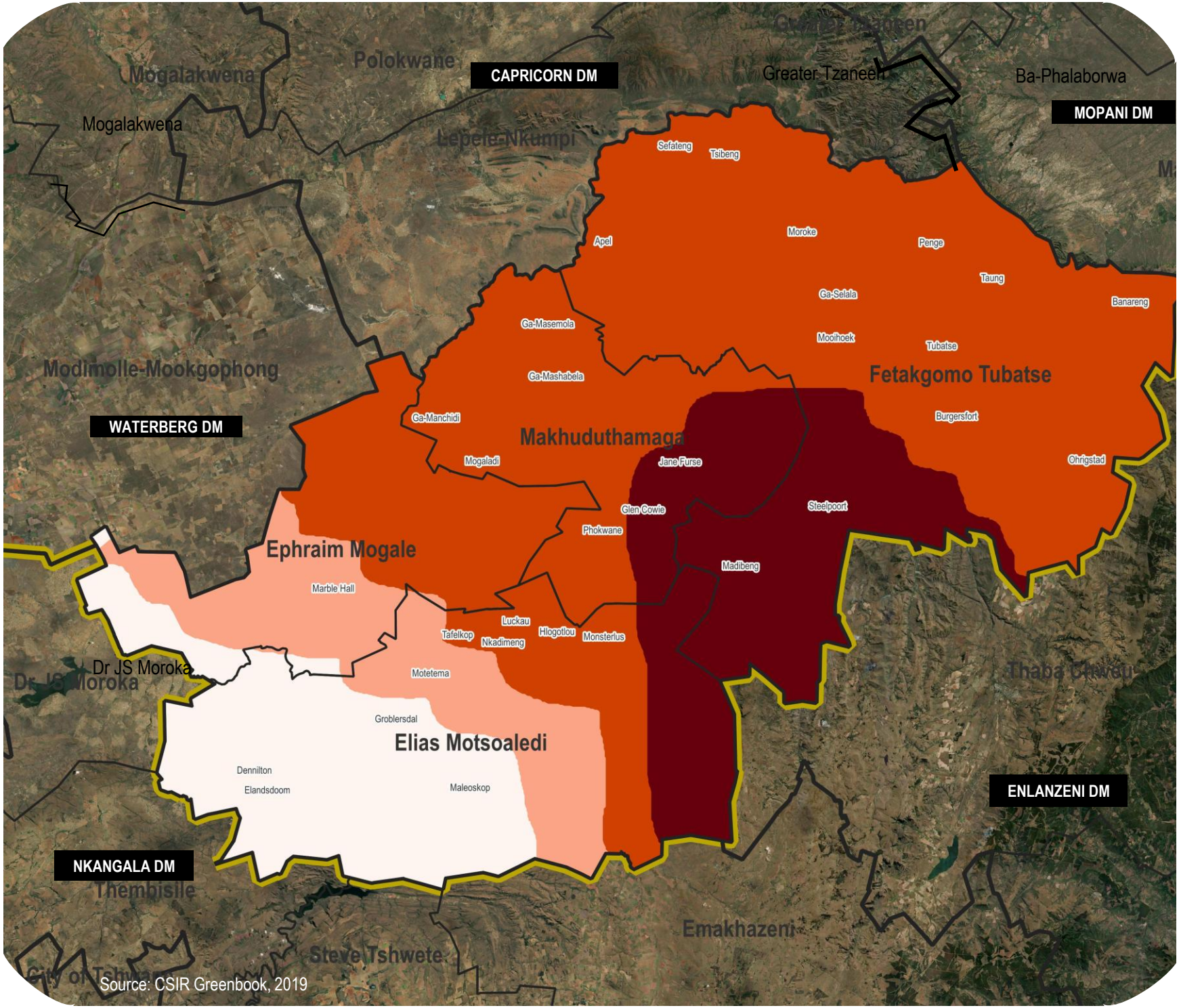
Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality

The LM is projected to experience the least amount of hot weather conditions, with average temperatures projected to change between 2.27 and 2.72 degrees Celsius, meaning less extreme hot days, see **Figure 13.5**. The local municipality is expected to experience hot climate conditions for between 2 and 42 days. However, the projections for rainfall suggest that the area will experience several rainy days, with average rainfall projections expected to change between -12.08mm and 39.64 mm. According to the GreenBook, anything around 20mm is considered a worst-case scenario, where rain is expected to accompany severe thunderstorms and lightning, especially in areas such as Groblersdal.

Ephraim Mogale Local Municipality

Average temperatures in the Ephraim Mogale LM are expected to range between 2.34 and 2.77 degrees Celsius, indicating cool weather conditions. The entire municipality is expected to receive an average rainfall of approximately 1.05 mm to 9.13 mm, while the northern part of the municipality is expected to experience significant rainfall, lasting more than 2 days. The central area is likely to experience moderate rainfall lasting less than a day, while the southern part will see the least amount of rain. This suggests that agricultural activities and initiatives should be concentrated in the northern part of the municipality.

Figure 13.4: Drought Risk Levels (2035 – 2065)



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DROUGHT RISK LEVEL (2035-2065)

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality

Drought Risk Levels

- Low
- Medium
- High
- Extremely High Drought Risk

N

0 10 20 km

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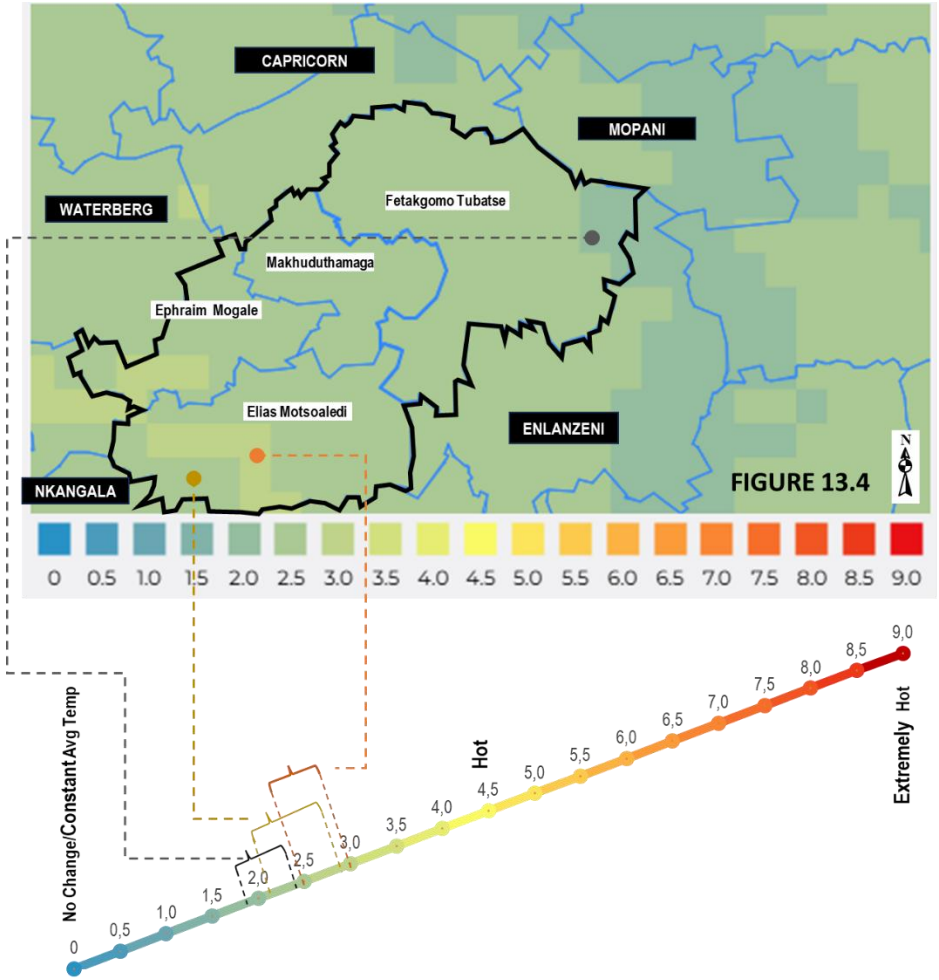
Figure 13.5: Projected Average Temperatures



Makhuduthamaga Local Municipality

Temperatures in the Makhuduthamaga LM are expected to change on average by 2.22 to 2.66 degrees Celsius annually. Extreme changes are expected to be between 2.65 to 2.93 degrees Celsius, meaning that the municipality will experience a lot of extremely hot days. On average, the municipality might experience 8 to 54 days of extreme hot weather, especially in areas around Jane Furse. Other areas north west of the municipality might experience more with between 10 to 63 days of hot weather in a year. With regards to rain, the area is expected to and 9.97mm of rainfall, meaning the area will experience at most 2 days of extreme rainfall.

Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality

Out of the four municipalities, the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM is expected to experience the largest increase in average temperatures, with changes ranging between 2.09 to 2.66 degrees. In the worst-case scenario, temperatures could rise alarmingly between 2.52 and 2.99 degrees Celsius. This indicates that if the area is already hot, temperatures could worsen by 2.52 to 2.99 degrees, with such extreme conditions occurring an average of 2 to 56 days annually. Areas most at risk are Burgersfort and the northern regions of the municipality. Rainfall projections show very little rainfall for the municipal area, with rain falling anywhere between -16.48mm and 38.21mm, mostly confined to small areas like Praktiseer and Ohrigstad.

Projections indicate that by 2050, most of the district's land will experience severe drought, especially in areas near mining operations. This has a negative impact on the environment, society, and the local economy. These effects include increased soil dryness, leading to low soil moisture that hampers agriculture and often results in wildfires. Such wildfires severely threaten food security and the livelihoods of subsistence farmers. Rising temperatures also endanger local flora and fauna, risking their mortality. This threat extends to people as well, with heat-related health issues, such as skin cancer and other serious conditions, which can be fatal,

especially for the elderly. Additionally, higher temperatures cause more evaporation, drying up dams and leading to water shortages for animals, livestock, and residents.

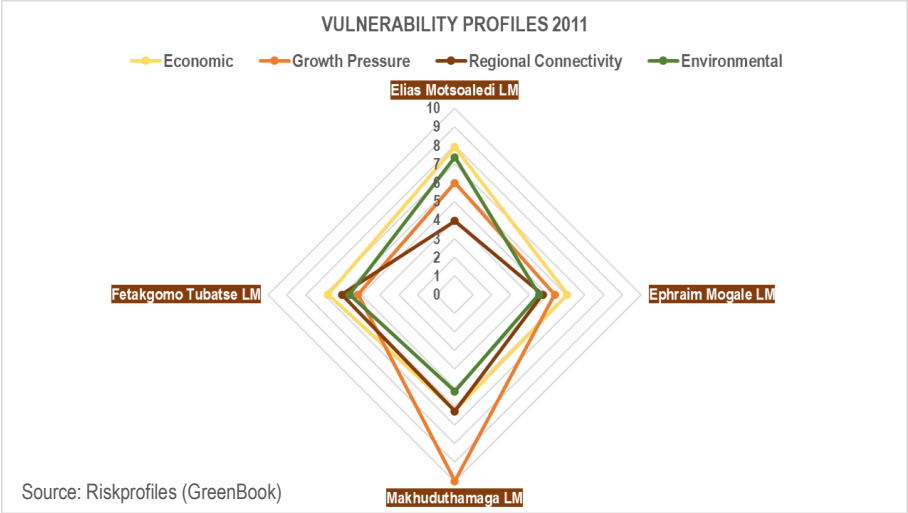
These issues not only harm the agricultural economy but also drive businesses and investments out of the region, increasing socio-economic pressures. Therefore, proactive measures and strategies must be implemented to prepare the region for these scenarios and enable adaptation. One possible approach is to enhance food security through targeted agricultural investments, particularly in areas most likely to avoid drought risks. Investing in initiatives such as smart irrigation systems can help maximise the productivity of limited farmland. Despite low rainfall levels, heavy rain is expected in the northeast of the district, such as in Leboeng, which traditionally receives less rain.

3.6. SETTLEMENT VULNERABILITY

The section below presents settlement vulnerability information derived from analysis by the CSIR's Greenbook dated 2019 illustrating the spatial settlement pattern within the four local municipalities possessing economic and settlement growth pressures, limited regional connectivity, and mismanagement of the environment. The diagrams illustrates the vulnerability ratings of each municipality, with each LM rated on a scale from 1 to 10, where 10 represents the highest level of vulnerability and 0 indicates no vulnerability.

Notably, the profiles of the various municipalities may have shifted in the past 5 years, either improving or deteriorating, particularly in relation to environmental and economic pressure. However, this information is useful as it assists in identifying areas that are most at risk and thus require some form of mitigation to reduce further regression, especially considering global trends such as rapid population growth, urbanisation, climate change, and possible global hostilities.

Diagram 13.1: Local Municipal--Settlement Vulnerability Level



In terms of settlement growth pressures, the Makhuduthamaga LM experienced the highest vulnerability growth pressure, rated at the maximum of 10. This is because the municipality experiences significant rural settlement sprawl, while infrastructure services cannot keep pace with the demand of the growth in areas such as Hlogotlou, Jane Furse, Glen Cowie, and the traditional areas, all of which have a growth pressure rating of 10. The Makhuduthamaga LM ranked second in population change, just behind the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM. It's reasonable to conclude that these areas experienced the most growth over the past 11 years.

The diagram also reveals an interesting and concerning change: that the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM, which had a lower growth pressure than Makhuduthamaga LM with a vulnerability rating of 5, encompassed the highest population change, ranking first in 2022 (according to Census 2022). The Steelpoort area was identified as the primary area contributing to the economy of the LM, hence the population surge, as it was the only area with a growth pressure rating 10. Notably, the impact

of mining activity in the area places not only the Steelport area but the entire municipality in a predicament should industrialisation not be further explored in the region.

In terms of economic vulnerability, the Elias Motsoaledi LM had the highest rating at 8, followed by the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM at 6.78 and the Makhuduthamaga at 6.21. Ephraim Mogale LM had the lowest vulnerability with a rate of 6.04. This is due to the Elias Motsoaledi LM's economy, which is largely founded on agriculture and is thus vulnerable to unpredictable weather patterns and reliant on exports, making it sensitive to global markets. Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM on the mining and exporting of raw minerals.

In terms of economic vulnerability, the Ephraim Mogale LM continued to show economic resilience, with recent data indicating growth between 2016 and 2017, though this was followed by sharp declines in subsequent years. During the 2019-2020 COVID-19 pandemic, Ephraim Mogale's economy grew by 26%, followed by Fetakgomo-Tubatse at 23%. Meanwhile, the Elias Motsoaledi LM and Makhuduthamaga LM experienced economic declines. This pattern has persisted over the past nine years, with these two municipalities remaining the most vulnerable to economic pressures, as also seen during the pandemic.

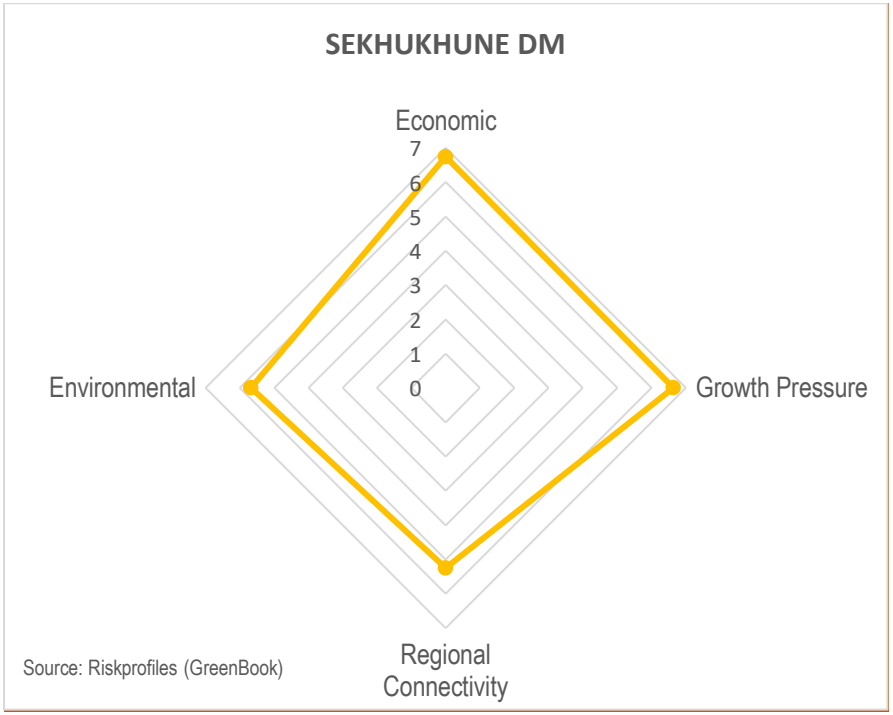
The 2023-2024 data show that all municipalities except Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM experienced sharp economic declines, with their gross value added (GVA) dropping below zero. This indicates ongoing economic vulnerability across the district. The most at-risk areas include Laerdrift, Marapong, Sehlakwane, Kgobokwane, and the traditional areas of Elias Motsoaledi LM, where 70% of the population lives rating between 9 and 10. In Makhuduthamaga LM, Hlogotlou was the only area with a rating of 10, while in Ephraim Mogale LM, Leeuwfontein held the highest rating of 10.

These areas are dispersed, located far from economic centres, and have very limited regional connectivity. To address these issues, the district municipality should prioritise initiatives aimed at strengthening the economy and ensuring sustainability, especially in the Elias Motsoaledi LM, Ephraim Mogale LM, and Makhuduthamaga LM, where agriculture remains the main economic driver.

The Elias Motsoaledi LM has consistently shown the highest environmental vulnerability, with an average rating of 7.35 based on both old and recent data. The district must take measures to reduce these pressures and secure these areas, particularly in relation to agriculture. During that period, all settlements in the municipality had vulnerability ratings above 5, which is the second-lowest among the identified areas. Other areas showed ratings above 7, with Dennilton at 10, followed by Sehlakwane at 9.7, Monsterlus at 9.6, and Malaeneng at 9.5. Fetakgomo Tubatse ranked second for environmental vulnerability, with an average of 5.47. Within this municipality, Fetakgomo-Tubatse scored the highest with a rating of 10, followed by Mashung and Moroke at 8.9 and 9.5, respectively.

The municipalities of Ephraim Mogale and Makhuduthamaga have the lowest vulnerability ratings at 5.3 and 5.2, although areas like Matlerekeng and Ga-Mosetla were rated 10. Improving regional connectivity in Makhuduthamaga should be a priority to help boost and sustain the local economy by enabling better access to markets outside the district. The only settlements with good regional connectivity are Groblersdal, Marble Hall, Ohrigstad, Motetema, Hlogotlou, Aquavile, Leeuwfontein, and Waalkraal. Some of these are regional economic centres, which explains their connectivity advantage, while others, such as Hlogotlou, benefit mainly from their location but are not necessarily doing well economically.

Diagram 13.2: District-wide Settlement Vulnerability Level



At the district scale, settlement growth pressure and economic vulnerability rates are the highest compared to the other two significant components. From a growth pressure perspective, the district is largely framed by fragmented settlement patterns, which are challenging to plan and provide bulk infrastructure services for, and due to the majority of the population residing on tribal authority land, planning to develop these areas can be complex. Moreover, the mountainous terrain prevalent in the district, particularly in the northern, eastern and southern regions, restricts development expansion in most parts of the district.

In terms of economic vulnerability, although the district comprises several economic bases, the mining industry, which is predominantly in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM (FTLM), is short-lived and on its own without exploring the industrial value chain, from extracting raw minerals, processing, manufacturing, to end-user products. The FTLM economy is prone to collapse should the mining and industrial sector fail to diversify into processing and manufacturing activities. Within the agricultural sector, climate change poses significant threats, with reduced and minimal production now occurring due to delayed rainy seasons and extended periods of extreme heat. Additionally, subsistence farming suffers from inadequate access to water supply support.

The environmental vulnerability in the district is a result of several factors, including the mismanagement of the environment from human settlements, farming, and mining perspectives. In terms of farming, most subsistence farmers in the region tend to overgraze, particularly in communal areas with open access, which depletes vegetation cover, and human settlements in traditional authority areas tend to be unplanned and encroach on sensitive areas. Both events compromise the natural environment and living organisms. The intensity of mining activity in the regions encroaches on high-potential agricultural land, reducing available farming areas, undermining food production capacity, and threatening the long-term effects on the agricultural sector.

Regional Connectivity vulnerability stems from the reality that although the district is fairly well-connected in terms of road infrastructure, it is also encompassed by some constraints. Road connectivity is well-established mainly in the far northern, eastern and southern parts. Whereas, the central parts of the district have limited regional access (road and rail infrastructure), which restricts lucrative economic activity in the inner regions and adequate linkage through the district to prominent external economic hubs, as well as enforcing the spatial integration of the rural settlement areas.

3.7. KEY CHALLENGES AND ISSUES

The section below outlines the key challenges and issues faced in the Sekhukhune District Municipality; these are detailed per local municipality as well as those affecting the entire district.

3.7.1. Local Municipal Key Challenges and Issues

The summary below presents a SWOT analysis, highlighting the Strengths, Weaknesses, Threats, and Opportunities for each local municipality.

STRENGTHS

- National and regional road connectivity through the municipal area
- Well-located, central to markets (hampered by poor road conditions)
- Groblersdal is an established economic node
- Established commercial agriculture sector with irrigation schemes
- The De Hoop dam supplies the community and mining industry with water
- Planned Agri-hub in Groblersdal to aid farmers' in value-added production

WEAKNESS

- Low-level access to water and sanitation, especially in rural areas
- Weak on adhering to the principle of spatial justice – land reform process lagging largely due to lack of communal land and tenure legislation
- Weak on adhering to the principle of spatial efficiency – scattered rural settlements are difficult to service, not conducive to economic development
- Weak on adhering to the principle of spatial sustainability – sprawling settlements in high-quality agricultural land, few nature reserves, and the potential impact of mining is not managed.
- Tourism potential is not being fully explored.
- Population distribution in EMLM: A large percentage of the poor live in scattered rural villages
- High unemployment and high dependency ratio
- Poor road conditions hamper regional accessibility

OPPORTUNITIES

- High-quality agricultural land in northern traditional areas – potential for higher output farming and food security
- High-potential grazing land in most of EMLM
- Groblersdal identified as Agri Hub by DRDLR
- Points can be identified in rural settlements where densities can be increased and local service nodes created.
- High tourism potential – can be better utilised
- Large are of natural beauty and sensitive ecosystems, e.g. mountainous areas near De Hoop Dam – potential for more nature reserves as associated economic development
- Unknown degree of mining potential (balanced with threat to natural environment)
- Part of the multi-nodal east-west District corridor passes through EMLM
- Strategic public land available for development adjacent to existing nodes

THREATS

- Lack of land reform threatens long-term security of tenure and economic development
- High level of reliance on intergovernmental cooperation, as many functions such as service provision, roads, district tribunal, etc. performed by other spheres of government
- Large environmentally sensitive areas that could be negatively impacted by mining
- Illegal land occupation, partly driven by housing shortage
- Relatively high population growth for rural areas – more pressure on services, housing provision and sprawl of settlements
- Infrastructure maintenance challenges

STRENGTHS

- Large-scale commercial agriculture
- N11 links municipality to Botswana and Durban, and R573 links to Gauteng and Moloto Corridor
- Railway line and Station in Marble Hall
- High-Potential Agricultural land within Crop Farming Zone that can be utilised to secure food security and extract more value from the agricultural sector.
- Marble Hall is identified as a functional region in the SDM Rural Development Plan.
- Freight Corridor (Railway line crossing the N11 up to the R573 intersection) can be explored as an alternative mode of transport for local exports.
- The industrial corridor (intersection between N11 and R573) opens the door for logistics and industrial investments.

WEAKNESS

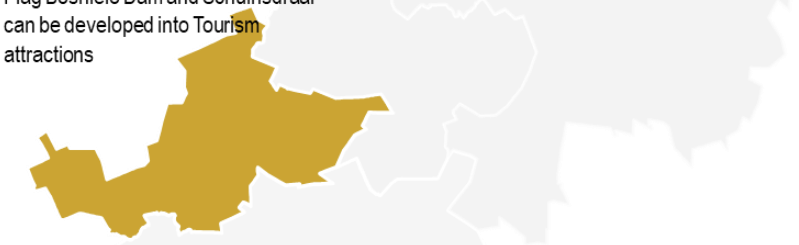
- Low supply of water and sanitation services which hampers development growth.
- Backlog in terms of service provision in rural settlements, exacerbating social inequities
- Lack of an LED strategy to drive development within the region
- Shortage of personnel in planning and finance, which allows for uncontrolled development and misallocation of funds for development.
- Poor road and stormwater infrastructure make accessibility harder for pedestrians.
- Poor environmental management allows for illegal dumping and polluting of key development areas.
- High crime rate raises safety concerns for locals and potential investors.
- Limited public transportation and facilities limit accessibility and mobility for locals.
- Shortage of community/social facilities exacerbate social pressures
- Shortage of land for development, especially for residential development exacerbating housing backlog.
- Skilled personnel shortage: the is a shortage of skills for key technical services.
- Poor maintenance of bulk infrastructure: potholes, sewerage blocks etc.
- Slow development growth in Marble Hall
- Uncontrolled/unregistered solid waste disposal at towns and larger settlements
- Vandalism and theft of electrical equipment
- Majority of the roads are gravel (968.0km)

OPPORTUNITIES

- Eco-tourism and outdoor recreation can be explored in Flag Boshielo Dam, Makotwana and Lola Montes Dams.
- Mining zone east of Marble Hall can be exploited to add to boost local economic development.
- Rural Development Areas, Future Development Areas and Incremental Upgrading Areas in growth points allows for effective population concentration and compactness,
- Underused industrial land in Marble Hall
- Land claim processes in progress
- There are proposals for a fish processing plant at Tompi Seleka
- Proposed freight precinct
- Zamenkomst-Rathoke-Malebitsa seen as a future development corridor
- The development of the Moloto Corridor will open up economic growth.
- Flag Boshielo Dam and Schuinsdraai can be developed into Tourism attractions

THREATS

- Drought threatens water availability and the agricultural sector
- Land Degradation will bring about irreversible modifications to land, which could limit future development.
- Wildfires
- An increase in the crime rate leads to safety and security concerns.
- Pollution of water bodies affects ground and underground water reserves.
- Unresolved and competing land claims threaten future development
- Unplanned and Proclaimed land limit growth potential.
- Climate change threatens the local agricultural economy
- Overgrazing may lead to desertification and threaten the livestock industry



EPHRAIM MOGALE LM

STRENGTHS

- Rich in Biodiversity (Rich in ultramafic-induced endemic plant species found in the Leolo mountains), which can contribute to tourism.
- Jane Furse is a retail and SMME development hub
- Agricultural Potential can address food security concerns
- Cultural Heritage (can contribute to tourism through educational tourism etc)
- Human Capital (will supply the demand for the labour that comes with new investments).
- Solar potential (hot temperatures make it attractive for solar renewable energy)

WEAKNESS

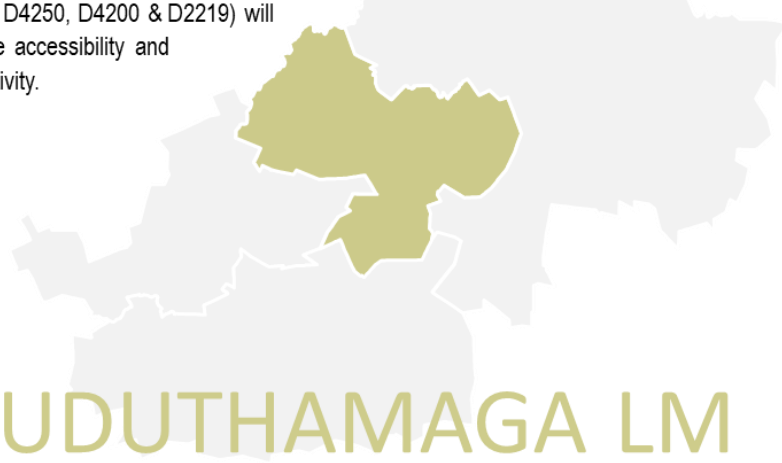
- Limited economic base reliant on public employment and retail.
- High Unemployment (66.7%) leads to a high dependency ratio and poverty levels.
- Poor Coordination between the Municipality and TA is inhibiting local development.
- 83% (176,393 ha) of land under the custodianship of TA constrains development potential.
- Lack of environmental management (reports of environmental pollution and uncontrolled wildfires).
- Poor enforcement of municipal by-laws
- Unplanned developments, competing land uses, and sprawl affect the prospects of sustainable development.
- Inadequate water supply limits development investments.
- Irrigation schemes along the Oliphant's river are currently not operational
- Illegal occupation of municipal land in Jane Furse CBD and Jane Furse and Moji integrated human settlements.
- Poor regional connectivity (accessible only via the R579)

OPPORTUNITIES

- High-potential arable land in Leolo and villages along the Nebo maize belt can be exploited for food security and economic development.
- There is an opportunity for a local produce market.
- Sorghum production in Schoonoord, Ga-Masemola, Diphagane, Phaahla towards Mamone, Madibong, Moretsele, and Makgane can be capitalized upon to strengthen the local economy.
- Supporting subsistence farmers in accessing markets.
- Good market for retail investment
- Upgrading of arterial roads (D4280, D4379, D4250, D4200 & D2219) will increase accessibility and connectivity.

THREATS

- Loss of irreplaceable land due to competing land uses that will bring about irreversible modifications
- The consumer-driven economy will lead to trade imbalances such as chronic trade deficits.
- Increase in unemployment
- Increased crime rate
- Drought will affect subsistence farmers, further exacerbating poverty.
- The agricultural economy, which is the largest source of income for the self-employed individuals not employed in public or retail, is at the mercy of climate change



STRENGTHS

- Mining Region/Region's Ming Hub, with vast and rich deposits of platinum ore, which are linked to the international value chain
- Minerals extracted at competitive cost
- Functional governance framework and system
- Community-driven business support programmes
- Vibrant SMME and Cooperative business development model
- Solid financing partnerships with the government and lucrative private sector partnerships
- Willingness of community leaders to boost economic growth
- Several rivers which can be used for water purification
- Land availability for further development
- Recent upgrading of the R37 provincial road
- Close to the Olifants River (water supply)
- Situated on the Dilokong Corridor, close to the smelter
- Favourable climate conditions

WEAKNESS

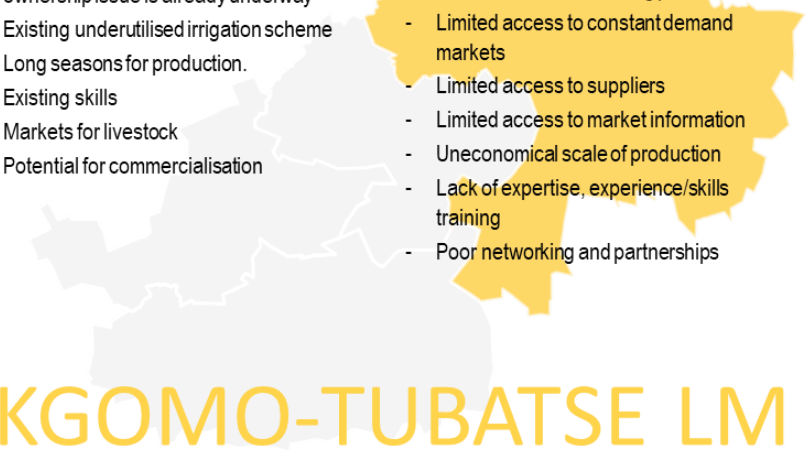
- Economy dependent on Mining and Retail
- Water Shortage and Poor Sanitation Services
- Poor Waste Management
- Vulnerable Labour force: Weak to pandemics
- High Unemployment, Poverty and crime rate.
- Little to no mining skills within the municipality
- There is a shortage of skills
- Uncoordinated presidential node status and fragmented planning
- Limited access to telecommunication infrastructure
- Local priorities are not linked effectively to District and Provincial priorities
- Opportunities related to mine are not being utilised
- Uncertainty around land availability for expansion and housing
- Inability to anticipate and manage community development expectations.
- Opportunities to diversify the mining economy have not been fully explored.
- Little investment due to uncertainty and the scale of production in the agricultural sector is not fully being explored due to the risks associated with periods of drought
- High transportation costs (residents spend a lot of money on transportation)
- No proper research has been done on the type of crop potential for the area
- Ineffective technical support to farmers
- Poor Land Use Management: The municipality is not monitoring and regulating how land is being utilized.

OPPORTUNITIES

- Plans for the refurbishment of the Steelpoort sewerage plant
- There are planned sewerage works downstream for Steelpoort and Winterveldt.
- Upgrading of existing sewage plants
- Industrial potential
- Youthful population: highly active labour force.
- The government's willingness to support economic development initiatives.
- The tourism sector has the potential to grow
- there are SMME-friendly policies and support mechanisms in place for emerging entrepreneurs.
- Economy showing signs of recovery
- The process to address the land ownership issue is already underway
- Existing underutilised irrigation scheme
- Long seasons for production.
- Existing skills
- Markets for livestock
- Potential for commercialisation

THREATS

- Soil and underground water pollution due to pit toilets.
- Overloading of waste treatment due to chemical and septic tank discharge.
- Mining is not a sustainable economic sector (the region may face economic decline should mining end)
- Increase in unemployment, Demographics, and rate.
- Economic activities are not benefiting the local communities.
- Environmental degradation (CBA, ESA & PA) will continue if poor land use management continues.
- Illegal dumping, which could lead to soil and water pollution
- Backlog in basic infrastructure due to increased population numbers
- Subsistence-level farming persists
- Limited access to constant demand markets
- Limited access to suppliers
- Limited access to market information
- Uneconomical scale of production
- Lack of expertise, experience/skills training
- Poor networking and partnerships



FETAKGOMO-TUBATSE LM

3.8. DISTRICT-WIDE KEY CHALLENGES AND ISSUES

The key challenges and issues of the district municipality are summarised below.

3.8.1. Spatial and Economic Development

- The spatial structure is characterised by dispersed and fragmentedsettlement patterns (disintegration).
- Unresolved land claims deter future development and discourage potential investors from participating and contributing effectively to the local economy.
- There is uncertainty with regard to the status of land ownership, particularly when distinguishing between state-owned land andtribal authority land.
- Housing expansion as a result of sprawling and mining activity is impeding the high-potential agricultural land.
- The occurrences of competing land uses (mining and housing) hinder the agricultural sector, which suggests that there is a lack of environmental conservation.
- There are high levels of poverty as a result of the lack of education,particularly in higher educational levels.
- There is an increasing number of informal settlements in areas close to mining and commercial agricultural activity.
- The Gross Value Added (GVA) of the agriculture sector in 2022 was 1.2% and 15.2% in the district and Limpopo Province, respectively. This sector, being an essential foundation for economic growth and employment in the district, indicates a setback in achieving the district's economic growth and job creation.
- Global decline in the demand of mineral resources threatens the district economy and its potential to be significant in the national economy.
- Commercial agriculture is under immense pressure as a result of water scarcity, low commodity pricing and external competition.
- The tourism sector is ineffectively established due to the lack of infrastructure, funding and adequate marketing strategy.
- There is a need for the district to align their tourism plans and marketing strategies with those of their neighbouring districts, in order to create a comprehensive tourism plan and ensure asynergised tourism development in the province.
- There is a need to support subsistence farmers to become commercial farmers.
- There is a rise in illegal mining, particularly for platinum and chrome, is a growing concern. With several residents resorting to illicit mining as a result of unsuccessful applications for mining applications, approval rights and licenses.
- The mining sector has not translated into broad-based socio-economic upliftment, as it operates in rural environments. Focusing more on mineral extractions and minimal local beneficiation or industrial development.
- There is a lack of skills development and low levels of higher education among residents, which restricts their ability to access skilled positions within the mining value chain. As a result, the majority of locals remain unemployed while skilled workers are brought in from outside the district, deepening inequality and social tension in mining-affected communities.
- Severe environmental degradation as a result of mines encroaching on sensitive areas / ecological network.
- Conflicting economic activities between mining, agricultural and tourism activities, over the use of land. This results in the loss of valuable agricultural land, which often features high biodiversity and/or eco-tourism and conservation potential.

- The rural settlements situated within the dispersed parts of the region are isolated from the local markets of Groblersdal, Burgersfort, Jane Furse and Marble Hall due to poor road conditions and the lack of effective public transport services.

3.8.2. Roads and Transport Infrastructure

- The road infrastructure incurs deterioration as a result of frequent use by heavy haul vehicles.
- There is a notable absence of a north-south road link through the central areas of the district, limiting accessibility and connectivity within this core region.
- Local roads extending to the village areas are unpaved and in poor condition, which limits the rural communities' access to areas of opportunity.
- There is a lack of designated truck stops in the area.
- The lack of railway infrastructure throughout the district area limits existing and future economic activity, particularly for the mining and agricultural sectors.
- There are limited transport systems, such as air and rail services, available in the district to help alleviate pressure from the roads to transport commercial goods.

3.8.3. Engineering

- Water scarcity in the municipality threatens current and future development.
- Water-related infrastructure, such as reticulation systems and stormwater runoff systems, requires regular monitoring and maintenance.
- The majority of the village areas do not have access to waste removal services, and this results in spillage in river systems and waste pollution along the roads.
- Existing landfill sites are unmaintained. Additional landfill sites need to be identified.
- There is a need to educate communities residing in the village areas on appropriate and sustainable waste management practices, and also as a means of job creation.

3.8.4. Community Facilities

- There is a need to establish urban and rural nodes to promote targeted investment in the district.
- Existing sports and recreational facilities are poorly maintained.
- There are insufficient arts and cultural centres available throughoutthe district municipality. These are also not linked to the tourism industry.
- There is a shortage of tertiary educational institutions within the district municipality, as a result, learners migrate to other areas to advance their education.
- Community-based recycling projects often fail due to the lack of basic infrastructure, continued support and vandalism at recycling facilities.

SEKHUKHUNE
DISTRICT MUNICIPALITY

SECTION FOUR

SPATIAL PROPOSALS

4. SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

The vision statement for the Sekhukhune District Municipality
"An innovative leader in integrated economic development and sustainable service delivery".

Mission Statement

The district aims to improve the quality of life for all communities through:

- provision of a democratic and accountable government;
- promotion of inclusive and egalitarian economic transformation;
- promotion of a safe and healthy environment;
- fostering of community involvement and stakeholder engagement; and
- Strengthening institutional capacity.
- Promotion of social cohesion

SPATIAL VISION:

The District Spatial Vision aims to address the challenges faced by the district, particularly the high unemployment rate amongst the young, and capitalise on its mining activities, while leveraging its unique geographical and socio-economic characteristics. The SDF review aims to achieve the following;

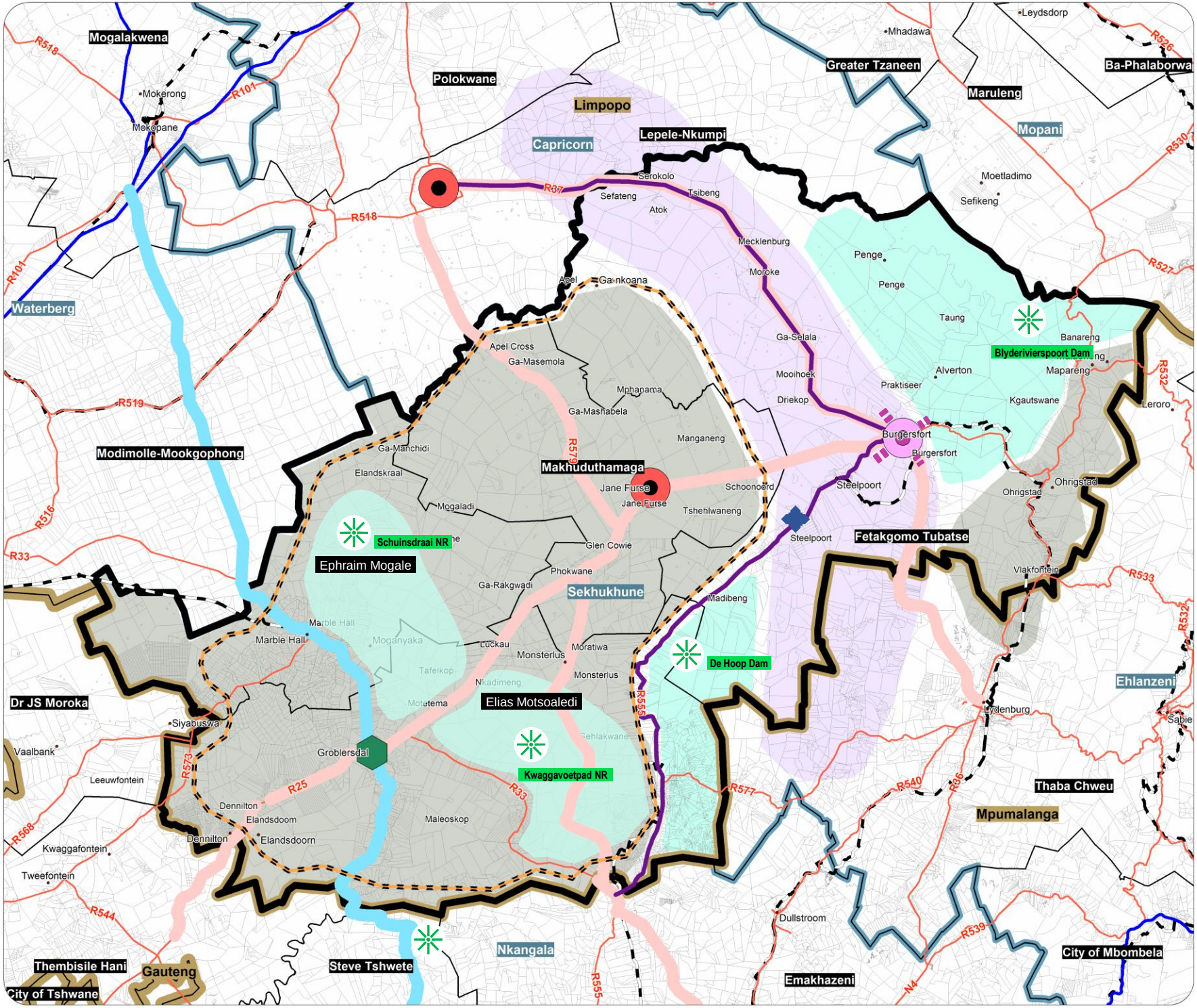
- Consolidating government investment (spatial targeting) around a number of prioritised urban and rural nodes.
- Linking into the commercial opportunities offered by the tourism industry bordering the district to the north, east and south.
- Becoming a commercial agricultural hub of choice in the southern extents of the district and focusing on agrarian transformation in the central parts.
- Maximising the economic benefits to be derived from the Dilokong platinum Belt and consolidating mining beneficiation industries around the Steelpoort and Burgersfort nodal point.
- A developed platinum city for a sustainable human settlement around Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM.
- Promoting integrated economic growth and sustainable development across all four local municipalities
- Enhance inter- and intra-district transport linkages.

4.1. DISTRICT SPATIAL CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

The following section illustrates the spatial concept for the District Municipality, which provides a spatial representation for the municipality's future development of both the urban and rural environments. Depicting the spatial vision of the municipality that anticipates future development, and potential zones that can be further utilised to realise economic growth, attract investment, and address the community's needs and aspirations. Subsequent to the spatial concept are development objectives outlining the desired outcomes, pertaining to natural resource management, economic and development expansion area, infrastructure and transportation planning. These development objectives will be embodied in the Spatial Development Framework plan and stimulate detailed development proposals that are measurable based on the projected population and required infrastructural plans.

As shown in **Figure 14**, the conceptualised plan displays the prominent key development components prevalent within the DM and their interrelation with one another across the broader municipal area.

Figure 14: Spatial Conceptual Framework



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

SPATIAL CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Regional Road
- National Road
- Railway Line

Transport Corridors

- National Transport Corridor
- Provincial Freight Corridor
- Platinum Stream

Economic Nodes / Production Hubs

- Mining-Industrial Hub
- Sekhukhune Agri-Park
- Administrative and Service Hub
- Tubatse Special Economic Zone
- Spatial Development Initiative (SDIs)
- National Resource Production Zone
- Tourism Focus Zone
- Nature Reserves / Prominent Dams
- Spatial Transformation Region

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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In terms of significant transport and corridors developments. The N11, identified as a National Transport Corridor traversing the southern extents, serves as the leading freight and logistics corridor linking the Mpumalanga Province, especially the Steve Tshwete Local Municipality, which houses several mining and manufacturing industries. The route traverses Polokwane in the north (the Provincial Growth Point), which also holds manufacturing industries, trade and logistics, as well as agro-processing industries.

Three Provincial Freight Corridors are proposed within the District area, namely

- The R579 route moves through the central parts of the District in a north-south direction. The R579 connects the Lebowakgomo CBD to the growing economic and administrative node of Jane Furse, and further south to Belfast and Middleburg.
- The R25 route which connects the District to the Gauteng Province conveys goods and services to the Limpopo Province, through Groblersdal to various regions. It is recommended that the frames a continuous network which connects Groblersdal - Jane Furse and further north to Burgersfort.
- Route R37 is the third Provincial Freight Corridor, supports key industries such as mining, and the growth of local nodes between Burgersfort to Lebowakgomo and Polokwane in the north, and Lydenburg in the southern extents.
- The R37 route from Lebowakgomo to Burgersfort, and Burgersfort through Steelpoort area is identified as a Platinum Stream is a critical road in the DM from which the majority of mining companies operate in the region, and the transferring of the respective raw minerals extracted.

In terms of economic and production hubs, the region;

- Burgersfort especially along the mining belt framed along the R37. The area is identified as a Spatial Development Initiative zone (SDI), which stimulates much of the region's economic wealth, and over time, has attracted new industries such as manufacturing and industrial investments. The extent of mining activity in the areas, is the driving force of the area's economic growth, providing employment opportunities, boosting local business and spatial transformation. As such, Burgersfort is earmarked as the district's manufacturing and industrial hub.
- Linked to the SDI area within the Burgersfort/ Steelpoort vicinity, a Special Economic Zone is proposed in the region to help stimulate economic growth for both local and international investors, and enable a more diverse economy from an economy that depended on mining activity. The envisioned intent of the Tubatse SEZ is to solidify the manufacturing, construction, logistics, and industrial sectors as part of the region's economy.

The section below highlights agricultural-based spatial elements anticipated in the District Municipality;

- As a means to support and advance surrounding farmers, a Sekhukhune Agri-park is envisioned in the Groblersdal region. The purpose of the Agri-park will be to support local and emerging farmers through information sharing, training, providing access to regional markets, machinery for value-added products, storage and logistics. To strengthen the rural economy, particularly of the agricultural sector, and bridge the gap of high unemployment, illiteracy and skilled workers.
- With the significant population growth in the Jane Furse area, the strategically positioned node in the central part of the district is designated as an Administrative and Service Hub to serve the dispersed surrounding rural population.
- It is recommended that the spatial transformation be promoted within the broader rural communities in the local municipalities of Makhuduthamaga, Ephraim Mogale and Elias Motsoaledi local Municipalities. This will be achieved by way of advocating for well-connected routes linking rural settlements; infill development, and ensuring socio-economic initiatives are met to serve the daily needs of communities. Furthermore, due to the majority of the population residing in the region, the National Spatial Development

Framework suggested the area as a Natural Resource Production Region to improve the livelihoods of communities by administering land management practices, sustainably utilising natural resources and conducting agricultural activities where feasible.

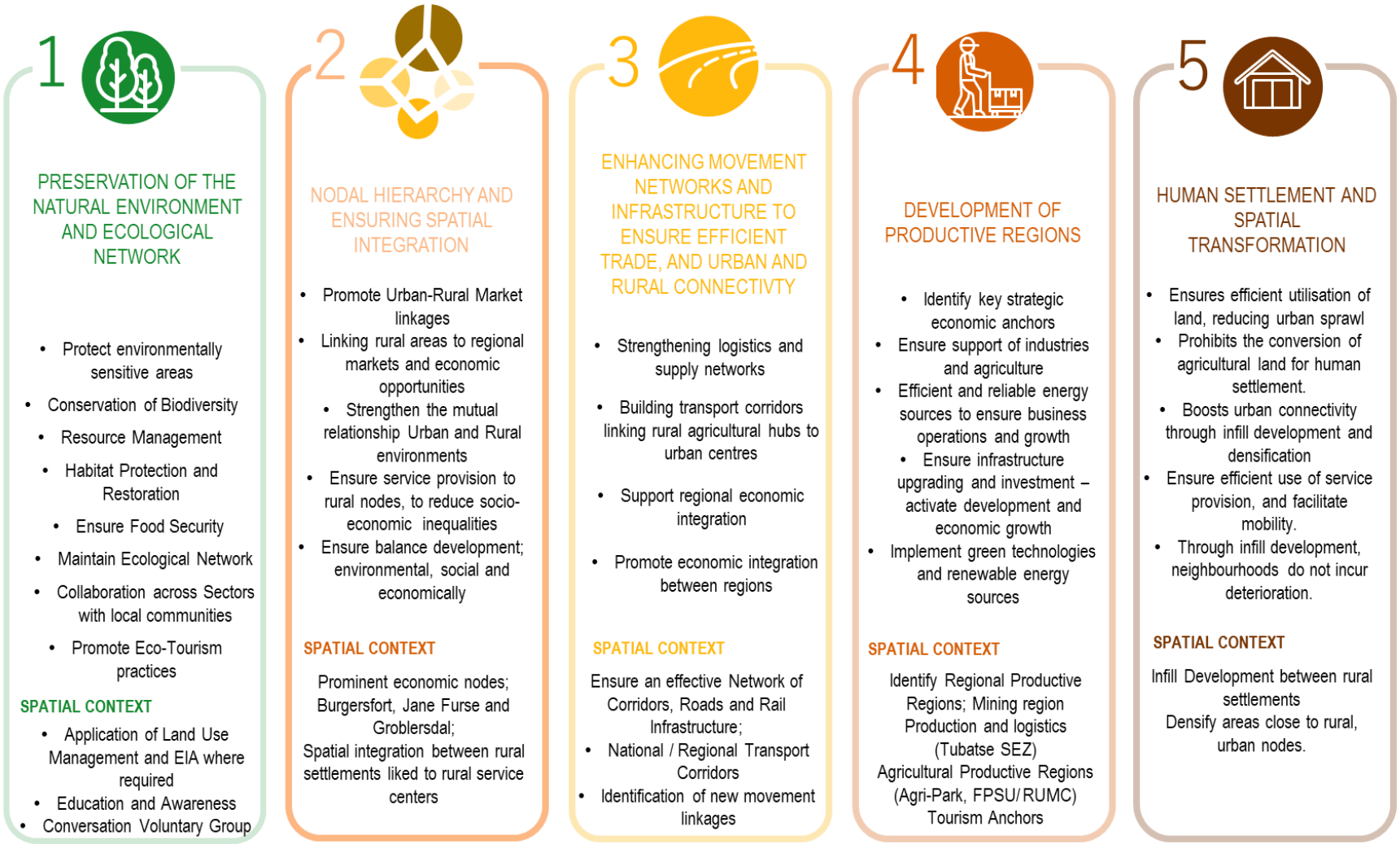
- The northern part of the district east of Burgersfort, especially the area of Ohrigstad, is an active farming community, which is to be supported and conserved.

Furthermore, it is proposed that the existing Nature Reserves, namely, Besveld and Kwaggavoetpad, be conserved and promoted for eco-tourism. Intensive development relating to rural settlement expansion, business, and industry should be prohibited in order to maintain the ecological footprint of the environment and species. Similarly, the area in close proximity to the Blyderivierspoort and De Hoop Dams is to be preserved and accommodate tourist opportunities such as boating, fishing, hiking, low-density resorts and accommodation.

4.2. DISTRICT DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVES

The following section will outline the Development Objectives of the District Spatial Development Framework, highlighting the strategic goals and priorities that guide sustainable growth, land use, infrastructure development, and socio-economic progress within the district.

Diagram 14: Spatial Development Objectives



4.2.1. Development Objective 1: Preservation of the Natural Environmental and Ecological Network

The ecological network within the Sekhukhune District Municipality serves as the fundamental backbone of the region's natural environment, playing a crucial role in sustaining both human life and the District economy, which is broadly overlaid by the Provincial-wide economy. The preservation of natural resources is not only vital for maintaining the ecological balance but also for supporting industries such as agriculture, tourism, and mining, which are central to the district's economic activity. It is therefore imperative that sustainable strategies are developed and implemented to protect natural resources, ensuring their continued availability for future generations. This section will explore spatial strategies and development guidelines aimed at preserving the region's ecological infrastructure, with a focus on identifying key areas that require protection from unsustainable development practices.

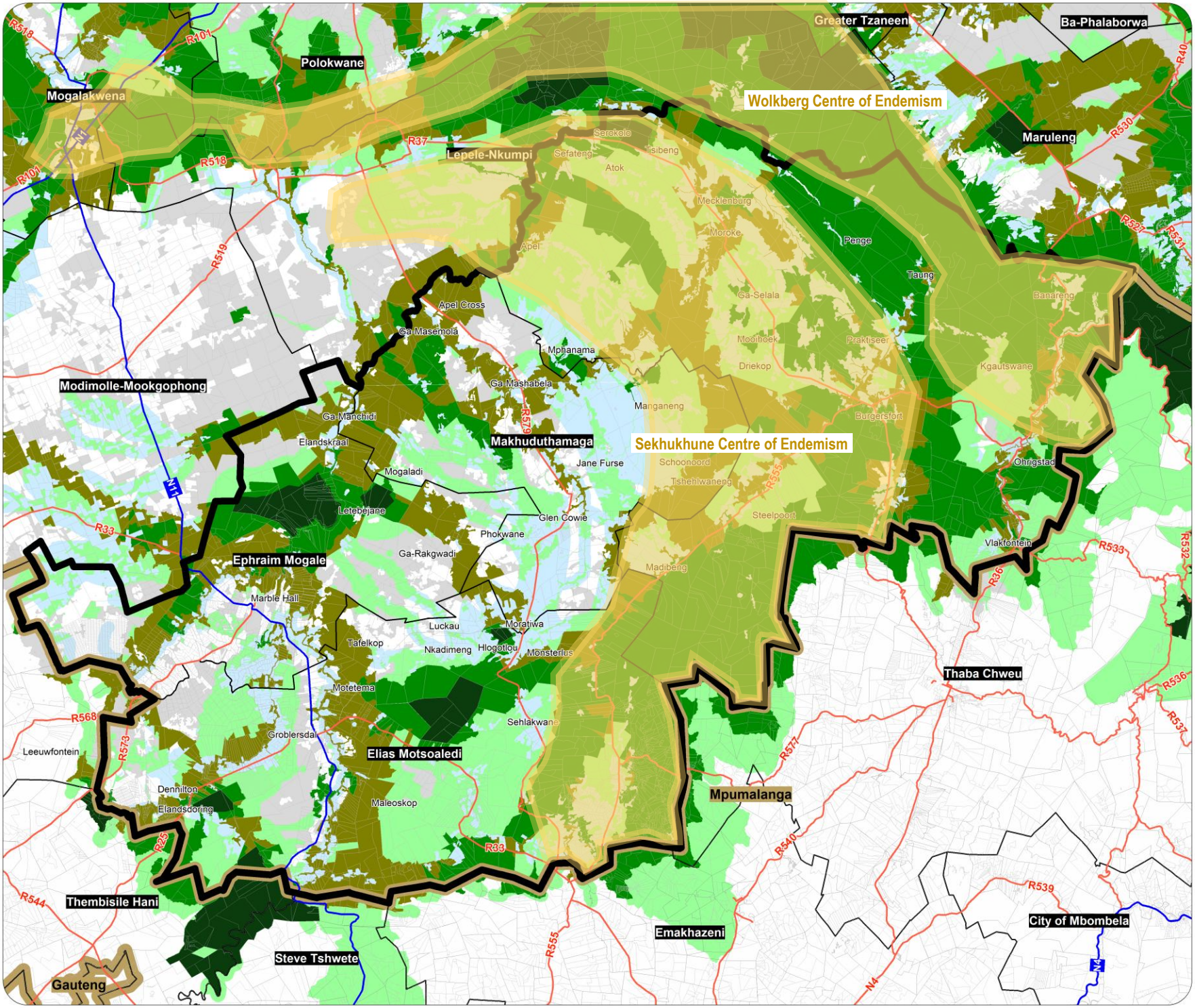
A core aspect of the conservation effort is the identification of areas prohibiting intensive development, housing expansion and mining activity. As such, developments will degrade sensitive areas, resulting in species decline due to loss of habitat, and fewer opportunities available in the agricultural sectors. As a result, areas characterised by high ecological sensitivity are to be preserved as they are essential to the District's environmental health; economically, minimising the effects of climate change, and human and ecological well-being.

The session below highlights the importance of the Critical Biodiversity Areas (CBA) identified through the Limpopo Conservation Plan, which serves as an integrated biodiversity sector input layer to guide multi-sectoral decision-making. The identification of CBAs ensures that areas crucial for biodiversity conservation are prioritised in decision-making processes across various sectors. The three biodiversity categories essential for protection to maintain ecological integrity and support sustainable development goals are also referred to below:

1. Critically Endangered Ecosystems: These are ecosystems that are severely threatened, often facing irreversible degradation. Protecting them is critical to prevent species extinction and maintain vital ecological functions. Consequently, further distinctions within the CBA classification per category are highlighted.
2. Irreplaceable Areas: These are regions where biodiversity cannot be replaced or restored if lost. These areas are often unique in their species composition or ecological role, and their conservation is essential for long-term biodiversity preservation.
3. Ecologically Sensitive Areas: These areas are particularly vulnerable to disturbances or changes in environmental conditions. They often support key ecosystem services, such as water filtration and carbon sequestration, and their preservation is critical to maintaining environmental health and resilience.

Table 3 highlights land use guidelines in the broader land-use planning and administrative efforts for areas within Critical Biodiversity Areas (CBA), refer also to **Figure 15**. It is recommended that the CBA guidelines be used in conjunction with existing municipal Land Use Management Schemes (LUMS) as a baseline for environmental inputs in any strategic planning or land-use decisions within the district. This approach ensures that environmental considerations, particularly the protection of sensitive biodiversity areas, are taken into account in all planning processes, promoting sustainable development that aligns with conservation goals, ensuring the preservation of these sensitive environmental areas.

Figure 15: Critical Biodiversity Areas and Ecological Network



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

CRITICAL BIODIVERSITY AREAS AND ECOLOGICAL NETWORK

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Regional Road
- National Road

CBA Categories

- Protect Area
- Critical Biodiversity Area 1 (CBA 1)
- Critical Biodiversity Area (CBA 2)
- Ecological Support Areas 2 (ESA 2)
- Other Natural Areas (ONA)
- No Natural Remaining
- Other Natural Area
- Centre of Endemism

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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Table 3: General Description of CBA Map Classifications and Land Use Management Guidelines

CBA MAP CATEGORIES	DESCRIPTION	DESIRED ECOLOGICAL STATE	COMPATIBLE LAND USES	INCOMPATIBLE LAND USES
PROTECTED AREAS	Areas formally protected in terms of legislation. Each protected area has a management plan.	Maintain in a natural state with limited intervention and ensure no biodiversity loss.	Conservation and associated activities (e.g. eco-tourism operations), and required support infrastructure.	All other land-uses.
		Rehabilitate degraded areas to a natural or near natural state, and manage for no further degradation.		
		Development subject to Protected Area objectives and zoning in a NEMPAA compliant and approved management plan.		
CRITICAL BIODIVERSITY AREA 1 (CBA 1)	Areas irreplaceable for meeting biodiversity targets. No other options for conserving the ecosystems, species or ecological processes in these areas.	Maintain in natural state with limited and ensure no biodiversity loss.	Conservation and associated activities. Extensive game farming and eco-tourism with strict control on environmental impacts and carrying capacities, where the overall net biodiversity is not lost. Continuous Urban Open Space System.	Urban land uses including Residential (including golf estates, rural residential, resorts), Business, Mining and Industrial; Infrastructure (roads, power lines, pipelines).
		Rehabilitate degraded areas to a natural or near natural state, and manage for no further degradation.		Intensive Animal Production (all types including dairy farming associated with confinement, imported foodstuffs, and improved/ irrigated pastures).
			Extensive livestock Production with strict control of environmental impacts and carrying capabilities.	
			Required support infrastructure for the above activities.	Arable Agriculture (forestry, dry land and irrigated cropping).
CRITICAL BIODIVERSITY AREA 2 (CBA 2)	Areas that are the best option for meeting biodiversity targets, while avoiding conflict with other land uses.	Maintain in natural state with limited and ensure no biodiversity loss. Maintain current agricultural activities.	Current agricultural practices including arable agriculture, intensive and extensive animal production, and game and ecotourism operations, so long as these are managed to ensure populations of threatened species are maintained and the ecological process that supports them are not impacted. Highlighted activities compatible with CBA 1.	Urban land-uses including Residential (including golf estates, rural residential, resorts), Business, Mining and Industrial; infrastructure (roads, power lines, pipelines).

CBA MAP CATEGORIES	DESCRIPTION	DESIRED ECOLOGICAL STATE	COMPATIBLE LAND USES	INCOMPATIBLE LAND USES
PROTECTED AREAS	Areas formally protected in terms of legislation. Each protected area has a management plan.	Maintain in natural state with limited and ensure no biodiversity loss. Rehabilitate degraded areas to a natural or near natural state, and manage for no further degradation. Development subject to Protected Area objectives and zoning in a NEMPAA compliant and approved management plan.	Conservation and associated activities (e.g. eco-tourism operations), and required support infrastructure.	All other land-uses.
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CRITICAL BIODIVERSITY AREA 2 (CBA 2)	Areas that are the best option for meeting biodiversity targets, while avoiding conflict with other land uses.	Maintain in natural state with limited and ensure no biodiversity loss. Maintain current agricultural activities.	Current agricultural practices including arable agriculture, intensive and extensive animal production, and game and ecotourism operations, so long as these are managed to ensure populations of threatened species are maintained and the ecological process that supports them are not impacted. Highlighted activities compatible with CBA 1.	Urban land-uses including Residential (including golf estates, rural residential, resorts), Business, Mining and Industrial; infrastructure (roads, power lines, pipelines).

The district encompasses two centres of endemism, namely the Sekhukhuneland Centre of Endemism, located in the central and eastern parts of the district, and the Wolkberg Centre of Endemism in the northern extents, which are unique biodiversity hotspots recognised for their extensive plant variety and animal species. The Sekhukhuneland Centre of Endemism encompasses diverse habitats, including grasslands, savannas, and mountain ecosystems. The Wolkberg Centre of Endemism, which forms part of the northern Drakensberg escarpment, is renowned for its exceptional levels of plant and animal endemism. Furthermore contributes to water catchment for surrounding areas, feeding several river systems that sustain both rural communities and agricultural production downstream.

The rich biodiversity of these centres, along with their ecological significance, is a priority for conservation, as they present opportunities for research, eco-tourism (associated with scenic landscapes, overnight accommodation, hiking trails, etc.), and natural resource provision. However, socio-economic occurrences such as mining operations, mine dumps, population growth and sprawling, overgrazing and alien species invasions contribute to the disturbance and gradual extinction of these centres of endemism.

Contributing to the natural environment are essential water sources and tributaries, such as the De Hoop Dam and Flag Boshelo Dam, which support both agriculture and wildlife. These ecosystems provide essential services, such as water purification, flood control, and capturing CO^2 emissions, which are crucial for maintaining the health of the environment and the well-being of local communities. Furthermore, with the ecological belt traversing the eastern edge of the district boundary, emerging from the Loskop Dam within the Mpumalanga Province, through the Kwaggavoetpad Nature Reserve to the De Hoop Protected Nature Reserve, and further towards the Blyderiviersport Nature Reserve. The second ecological belt is framed by the Vlakfontein Private Nature Reserve, Letole Private Nature Reserve and D J Dercksen. These form part of the broader ecological footprint of the district, and where local settlements are deeply embedded.

In order to ensure the longevity of the natural environment and water systems, it is proposed that the existence of both the natural environment and human settlements be harnessed to ensure a balance between ecological preservation and socio-economic development. In **Diagram 15** below, highlight key strategies to be implemented in order to ensure the conservation of the natural environment and the ecological network.

Diagram 15: Environmental Preservation Strategies

1) ECOSYSTEM PRESERVATION AND RESTORATION

It is recommended that sensitive areas be protected by way of establishing conservation zones according to the Critical Biodiversity Area (CBA) at the local level, to enforce stricter land-use regulations, to ensure long-term environmental preservation, and for law enforcement to take effect where procedures are not adhered. As limiting intense development in sensitive area, will ensure that natural ecosystems remain intact and continue to serve both animal and human life. Where necessary, restoration of degraded ecosystems be carried out through the planting of trees, and natural waterbody networks should remain untouched to preserve the natural flow of water.

The Sekhukhune District is one of the country's main food resource areas. It suggested that an in-depth climate and environment assessment be conducted, highlighting vulnerable areas most in need of protection, and agricultural zones, both those endangered (both human and mining activity; harsh climate conditions over time), to ensure the continuity of food security and its longevity and livelihood.

2) DEMARCATION OF URBAN DEVELOPMENT ZONES (UDZ)

The need to define Urban Development Zones in the District is one of the critical steps to ensuring protection of the environment and avoiding further land degradation. The rapid settlement development, inclusive of industrial and mining activity, causes strain for natural resources such as land, food security, water, and a healthy ecological system that mitigates against climate change. By ensuring the demarcation of development zones, settlement planning can foster an integrated spatial development, concentrate the provision of services for efficient utilisation, and stimulate economic opportunities and growth in strategic areas and close proximity to communities. Furthermore, by protecting environmentally sensitive areas through zoning, it also supports eco-tourism and agricultural activities (such as crop rotation, applicable irrigation systems) that evidently provide jobs and a source of income to local communities.

3) STIMULATE ENVIRONMENTAL-AWARENESS

Creating environmental awareness among Municipalities and Local Communities is an effective way to change mindsets, harnessing the environment in a way that will continue to meet our needs while preserving it. This can be achieved through interactive workshops and training, as a means to educate on critical environmental issues such as waste management, water conservation, wood-cutting for a source of energy, and sustainable farming practices. While also introducing effective solutions to meet communities' needs and improve their way of life. This would empower communities to take ownership of their local environment, providing them with the necessary tools to develop a healthier living environment and build a solid community structure.

With that, it is recommended that an Environmental Management Committee be established to oversee the promotion of information and education, create public awareness about the management and use of the environment at a local level, and facilitate collaboration between the community, municipalities, and government departments.

4) ADOPT CLIMATE CHANGE ADAPTIVE AND MITIGATION MEASURES

Outlined below are the climate change adaptation and mitigation tools recommended for implementation in the district municipality, aimed at reducing exposure to climate shocks while fostering resilient communities, safeguarding the environment, and sustaining local economies.

- **Temperature Increase Mitigation through Land Use Planning and Urban Spaces**

To cope with the increase in temperatures, municipalities need to plan and design their urban areas in a way that alleviates the effects of urban heat island (UHI). This means moving away from surfaces that trap heat and allow for the flow of wind to bring about cooling, especially in places like Steelpoort and Burgersfort, where mining activities are happening. Compactness and densification should be

encouraged. Concentrating people in urban areas enables higher development, reduces sprawl, and allows for buildings to be designed in a way that provides shade to pedestrian sidewalks. Permeable surfaces should be encouraged as much as possible on sidewalks, boulevards and courtyards. Mixed-use developments that offer a range of services within walking distance or a short commute should be encouraged to minimise exposure to the sun.

- **Temperature Increase Mitigation through Urban Greening And Infrastructure**

Municipalities should look into promoting green infrastructure and vegetation increase within their local municipalities. Establishing campaign programmes focused on tree planting and water-resistant evergreen trees along public routes (mainly local) where there are large pedestrian activities and traffic, such as sidewalks. Municipalities should include bylaws which require private development to include green infrastructure in their development to further decrease temperatures.

Public open and private spaces can act as cooling systems for urban spaces; therefore, efforts to construct public open spaces and ensure that they receive proper management and aren't misused by the public, especially in spaces where water features are integrated. When designing public open spaces, ample trees need to be planted to provide cooling and where water features are included, they should be designed in a way where evaporation is limited, therefore buildings and trees should provide enough shade to shield these features. Wetlands and waterbodies should be strictly protected from any and all development. Green roofing and greening facades should also be promoted and designed in a way that is aesthetic and enhances the public realm.

- **Wildfires Mitigation**

The figure below examines climate change mitigation measures in the context of extreme heat and strong winds, conditions that heighten the risk of fire outbreaks and highlights proactive strategies.

Diagram 16.1: Wildfire Mitigation

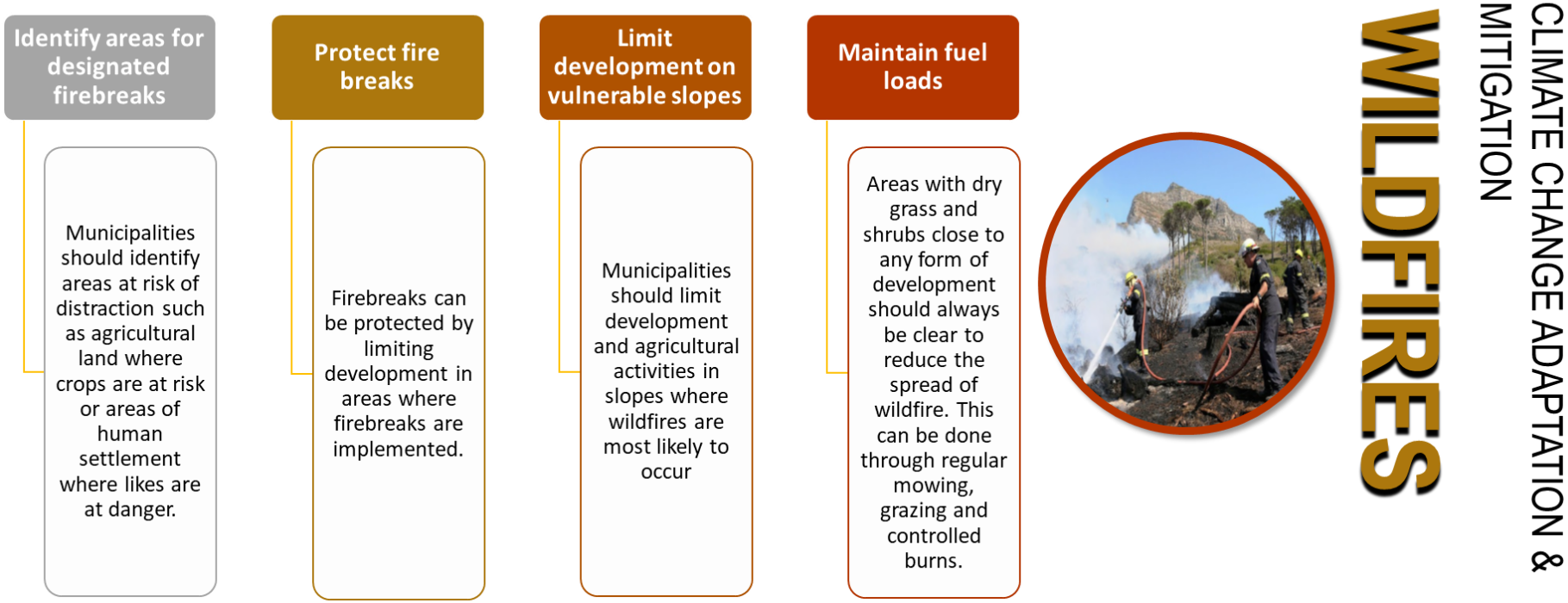
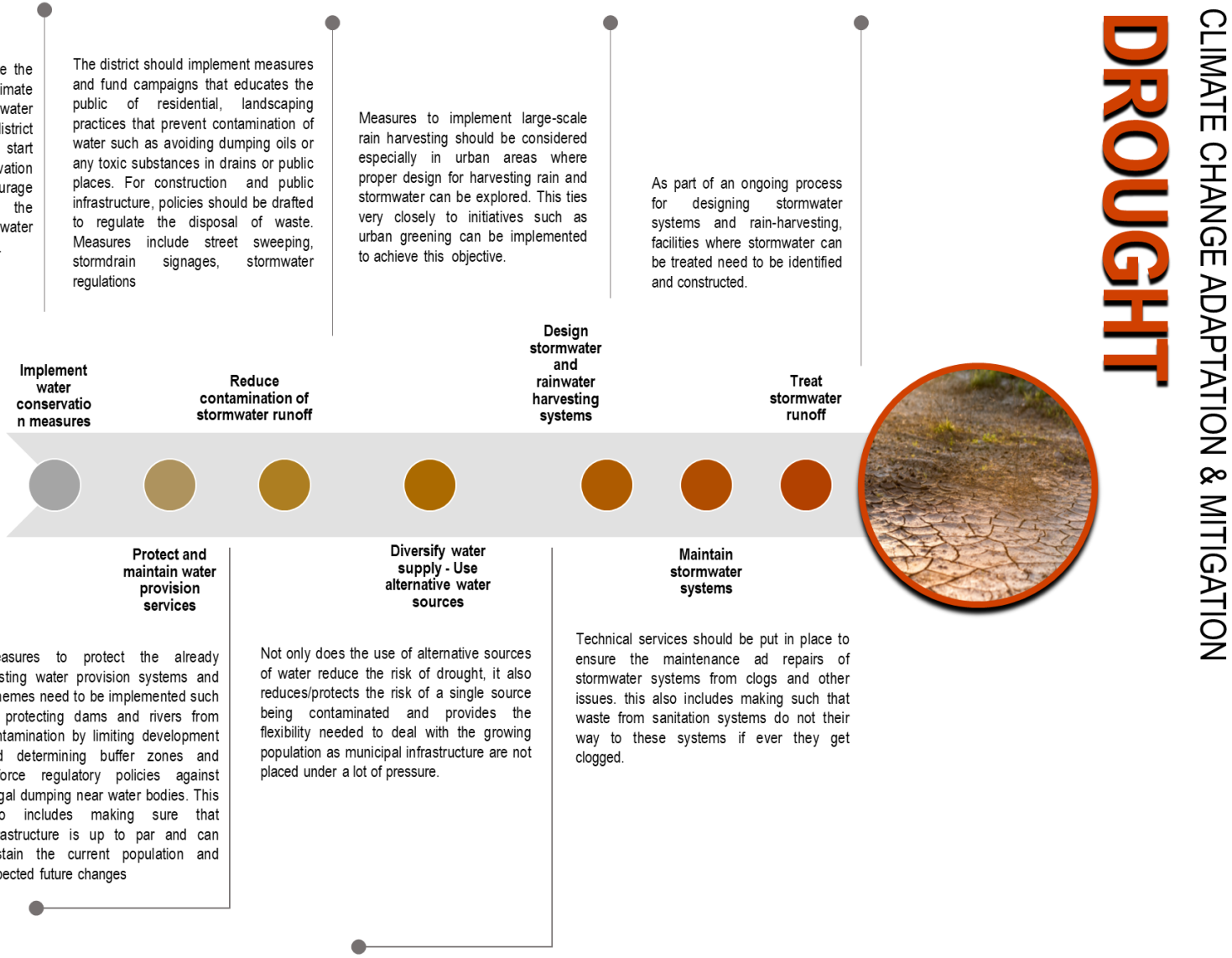


Diagram 16.2: Drought Mitigation



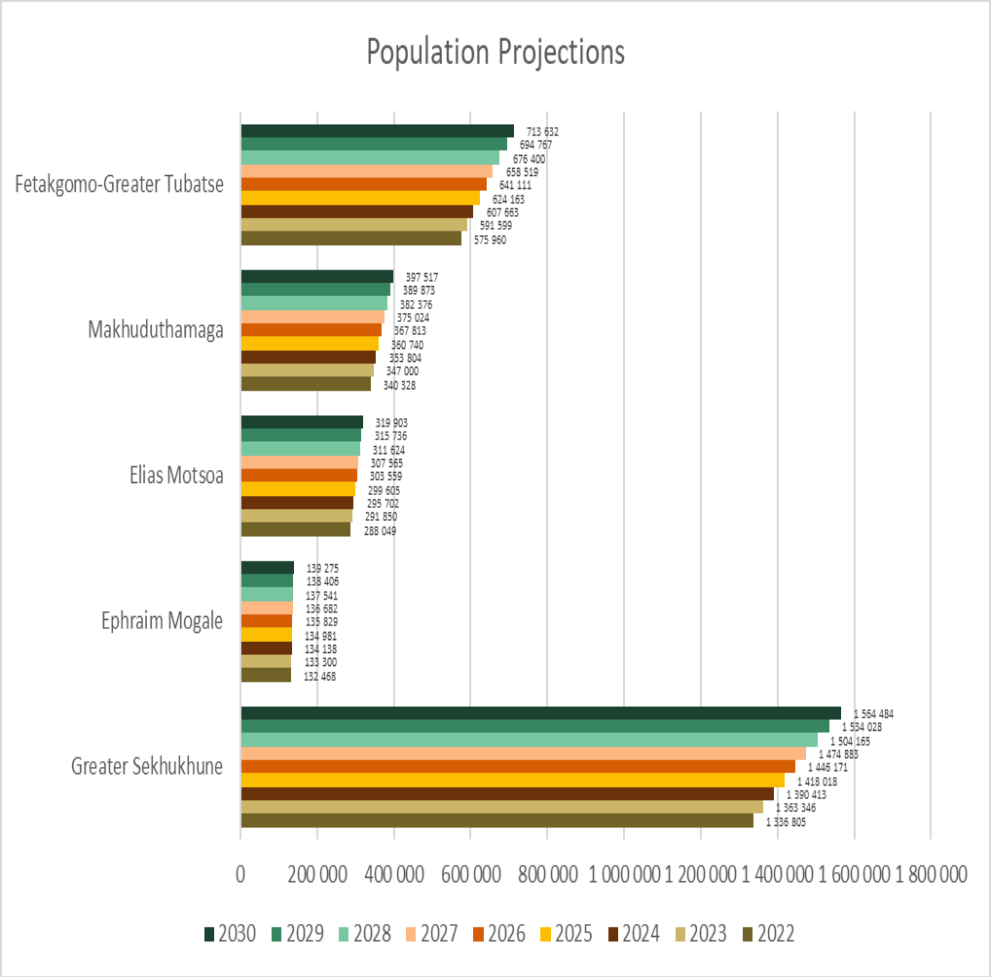
4.2.2. Development Objective 2: Define Nodal Hierarchy and Promote Spatial Integration

In assessing current and future service delivery capacity, it is essential to consider projected population growth to ensure adequate provision of services. The following section outlines the projected population figures for each local municipality.

According to the Census SA, the total District's population totals 1 336 805 in 2022. As shown in the diagram below, the district's population is projected to reach 1 564 484 by 2030, suggesting that the district is anticipated to have approx. 227 679 more people over the next 8 years. At the municipal level, Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM is predicted to have the highest population increase, with roughly 137 672 additional people between the years 2022 and 2030. This may be due to the region's economic sector in the mining and industrial space able to absorb larger volumes of people, compared to agriculture. The expansion of the sector is planned to diversify its economic offerings to include beneficiation initiatives and industrial value-adding products. With that, the municipality is destined to attract more influx. This anticipated growth reinforces the municipality's role as a primary economic hub within the district

Makhuduthamaga LM is projected to experience the second highest population increase by 2030, with an estimated growth of approximately 57,189 people. The projected growth in the Makhuduthamaga LM compared with previous years reflects moderate, stable growth. Elias Motsoaledi LM is expected to record an increase of roughly 31,854 people, while the smallest growth is anticipated in Ephraim Mogale LM, at about 6,807 people.

Diagram 16.3: Population Projections (2022-2030)



Source: Statistics South Africa

Nodal Hierarchy and Spatial Integration

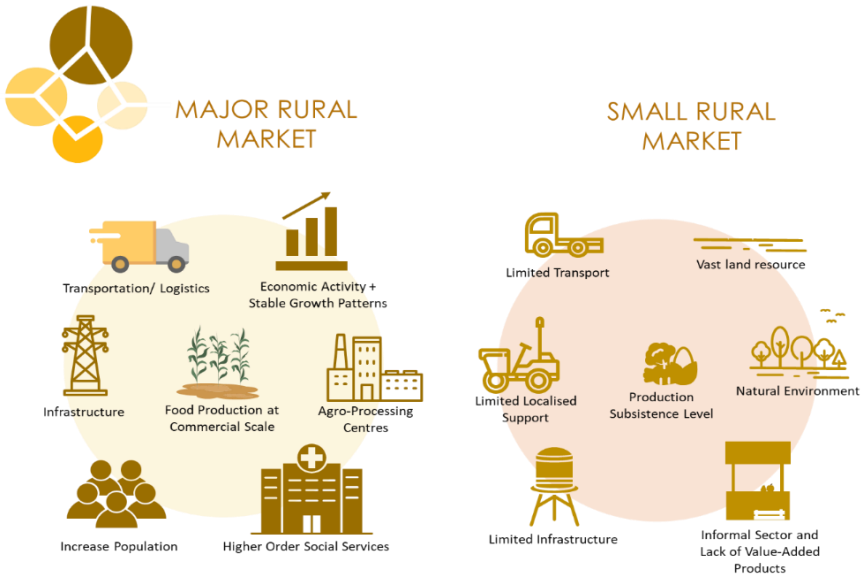
Nodal area refers to unique areas within human settlement areas where economic activities and public transport congregate and thus become spaces that serve people daily. As a result, defining nodal development becomes critical to target infrastructure provision, proper land use management to attract further investment, and productivity and accessibility to drive economic growth. When nodal points are defined, then the integration of the node with other surrounding economic areas becomes key, enabling an integrated network of distinct nodal points that support each other and enable a well-balanced regional development.

In order to ensure the effectiveness of nodal development, the following building blocks must be advocated for solidifying the development concept. It is recommended that human settlements be concentrated around nodes to ensure optimal use of land, infrastructure, and services, reducing the sprawling of housing and bulk infrastructure networks.

By concentrating development in close proximity to nodal development minimises duplication of services, transport costs, and prevents spatial disintegration. Notably, in recent years, technological advancement has gained momentum in society for various reasons. The establishment of nodes has become innovative, enabling spaces within nodes where information and knowledge are shared, and business trading thrives beyond physical presence.

Notably, the National Spatial Development Framework advocates for the concept of nodal development in order to create support between nodal hierarchies to ensure socio-economic support, so lower-order nodes or rural economic markets continue to flourish. **Diagram 17.1** below shows the Conceptual Urban-Rural Market Linkages and Rural-Rural Market Linkages connected via the National Urban System's ‘’strategic movement corridor’’ binding these distinct nodes/ markets. The concept illustrates the interconnected relationship and reliance between these different nodes, in which higher-order nodes, such as Burgersfort, generally hold increased population densities, greater spending power, intensive economic development and logistics services than the town of Groblersdal. Subsequently, Groblersdal encompasses more services and investment than the surrounding rural service nodes/markets.

Diagram 17.1: Relationship between Major Rural Market and Small Rural Market



Additionally, recognises the significance of Rural Marketplace offer resources, labour force and urban areas. This makes the relationship between Urban and Rural markets symbiotic, with rural markets serving as the backbone of production and urban markets driving demand. With the enviable population increase in urban areas, rural areas suffer from the pressure of production, and more so, the need to introduce innovative agricultural practices that will ensure output, improve efficiency, and deliver products.

In terms of nodal development in the District, **Figure 16.1** shows the spatial distribution of the proposed nodal hierarchy based on the current economic landscape. The primary focus is on having the nodal points within walking distance of the majority of the surrounding communities. Table 4 highlights the district nodal hierarchy.

Table 4: District Nodal Hierarchy

	DISTRICT NODAL HIERARCHY					
	Map Representation	Nodal Classification	Local Municipality			
			Elias Motsoaledi	Ephraim Mogale	Makhuduthamaga	Fetakgomo-Tubatse
1.		Provincial Urban Node				Burgersfort
2.		Regional Development Anchors	Groblersdal		Jane Furse	
3.		Local Service Centre	Monsterlus Motetema	Marble Hall	Glen Cowie	Atok Serokolo Mecklenburg
						Steelpoort
						Ohrigstad
4.		Rural Node	Elandsdoring	Leeuwfontein	Moratwa	Driekop Mphanama
			Sehlakwane	Ga-Rakwadi	Vlakfontein	Apel
			Hlogotlou	Letebejane	Tshehlwaneng	Atok
			Rossennekal	Elandskraal	Schoonoord	Praktiseer
					Manganeng	Kgautswana
					Apel Cross	

As rural nodes develop, it is recommended that the provision of community facilities be considered and clustered within these nodes to enhance access and convenience for local communities, particularly where the majority generally rely on foot travel to access municipal and government services. Accordingly, this can be achieved by developing a Thusong Centre that offers a range of services and social facilities within a centralised location for the convenience of local communities. Refer to **Diagram 17.2** for a visual representation of the concept.

Thusong Centre aligned with Nodal Development

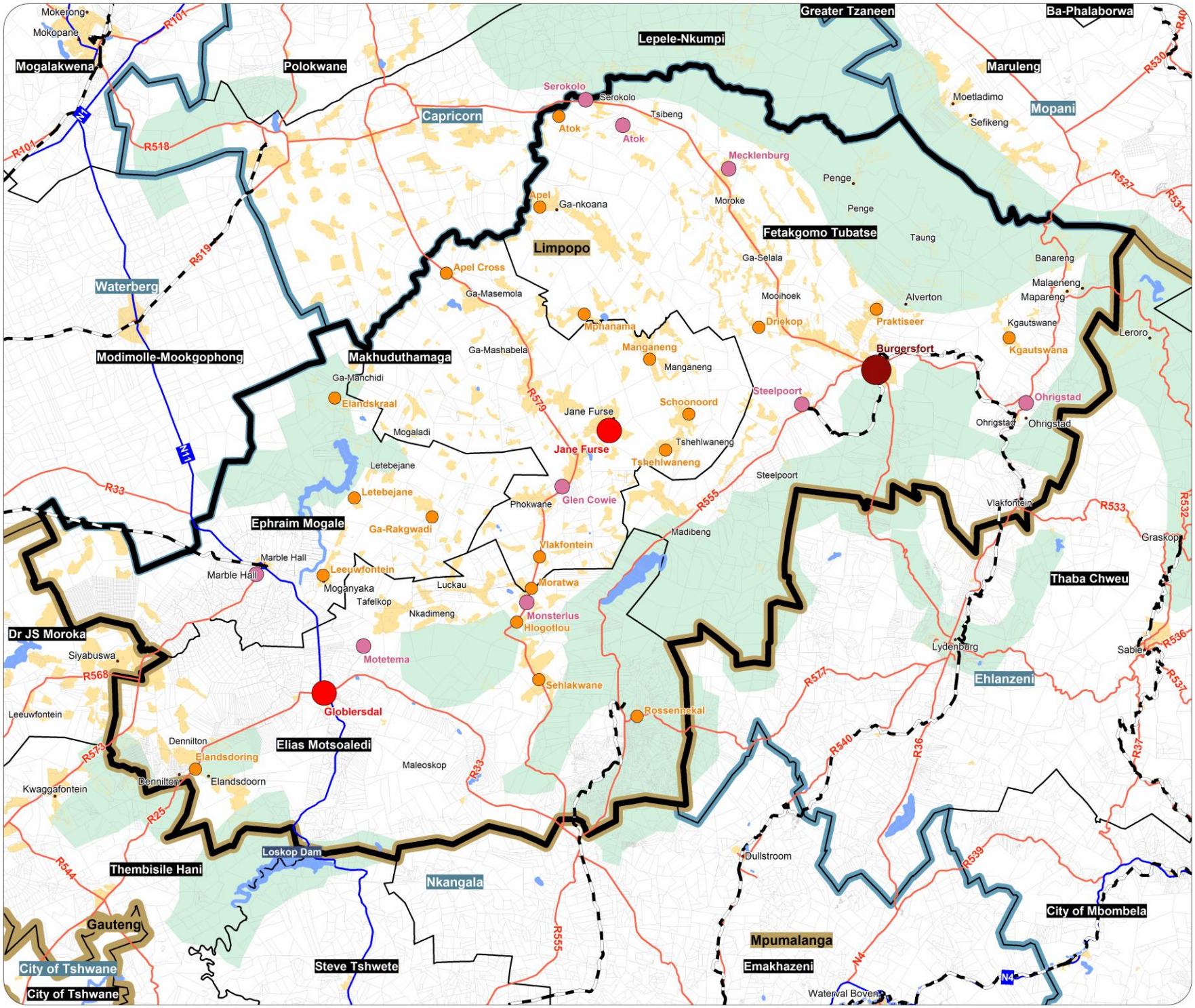
The nature of the Thusong Service Centre is a one-stop centre where government and municipal services are clustered within a single building, or government services in separate buildings close to each other. It is intended to be a multipurpose facility that provides essential government and support services to communities in a more convenient location, especially those in underserved and rural regions. In the context of the nodal area, Thusong Centres play a critical role in consolidating services within accessible, strategically located nodes to serve dispersed populations, many of whom rely primarily on walking and public transport as their primary mode of transportation.

Additionally, the Thusong centre is conveniently located near business activities, public transport, and public spaces, providing easy access and reducing travel costs and time. Situated within a designated development node, the Thusong Centre provides a central point for access to home affairs and municipal services (e.g. community halls, public libraries, ICT, healthcare services, etc. Making the concept of a Thusong Centre a key development approach that supports spatial justice and transformation, particularly in remote rural areas. Acknowledging the realities of distorted spatial structure, limited public transport services in most remote areas, and a lack of access to social services.

Notably, the CSIR suggested that clusters of community facilities represented as a Thusong Center be allocated within a maximum of 15km radius to ensure easy access throughout the region

Retail

Figure 16.1: Development Objective 2 Nodal Hierarchy



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVE 2 NODAL HIERARCHY

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Rural Settlement
- Regional Road
- National Road
- Railway Line
- Provincial Growth Point
- Regional development Anchor
- Local Service Centre
- Rural Service Centre

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

CONCEPT OF A THUSONG CENTRE

Diagram 17.2

CSIR GUIDELINES ON THE PROVISION OF COMMUNITY FACILITIES
Social Facilities Required for a Region (Catchment Size: > 1 000 000)

Table 5: CSIR Guidelines for Community Facilities

District Population Catchment calculations based on population size of : 1 336 805						
Community Facilities	**Average Population**	**Acceptable Travel Distance**	**Provision Criteria**	**Existing No. of Facilities**	**Required No. of Facilities**	**Outstanding No. of Facilities**
Community Halls	60 000	10km	C	27	22	0
Libraries	20 000 -70 000	8km - 10km	C	22	19	0
Postal Services	10 000 -20 000	5 km - 10km	C	3	5	1
Sports Stadiums	200 000 - 300 000	15km	C	0	1	1
Thusong Service Centres	1 centre per municipality	15km; maximum of 25km	C	2	4	2
Primary School	12500	5km	C	14	21	7
Secondary School	7 000	10km	C	8	9	1
Hospitals	300 000 - 900000	30km	C	7	4	0
Local Clinics and Health Centres	24000 - 7000	5km	C	81	19	0

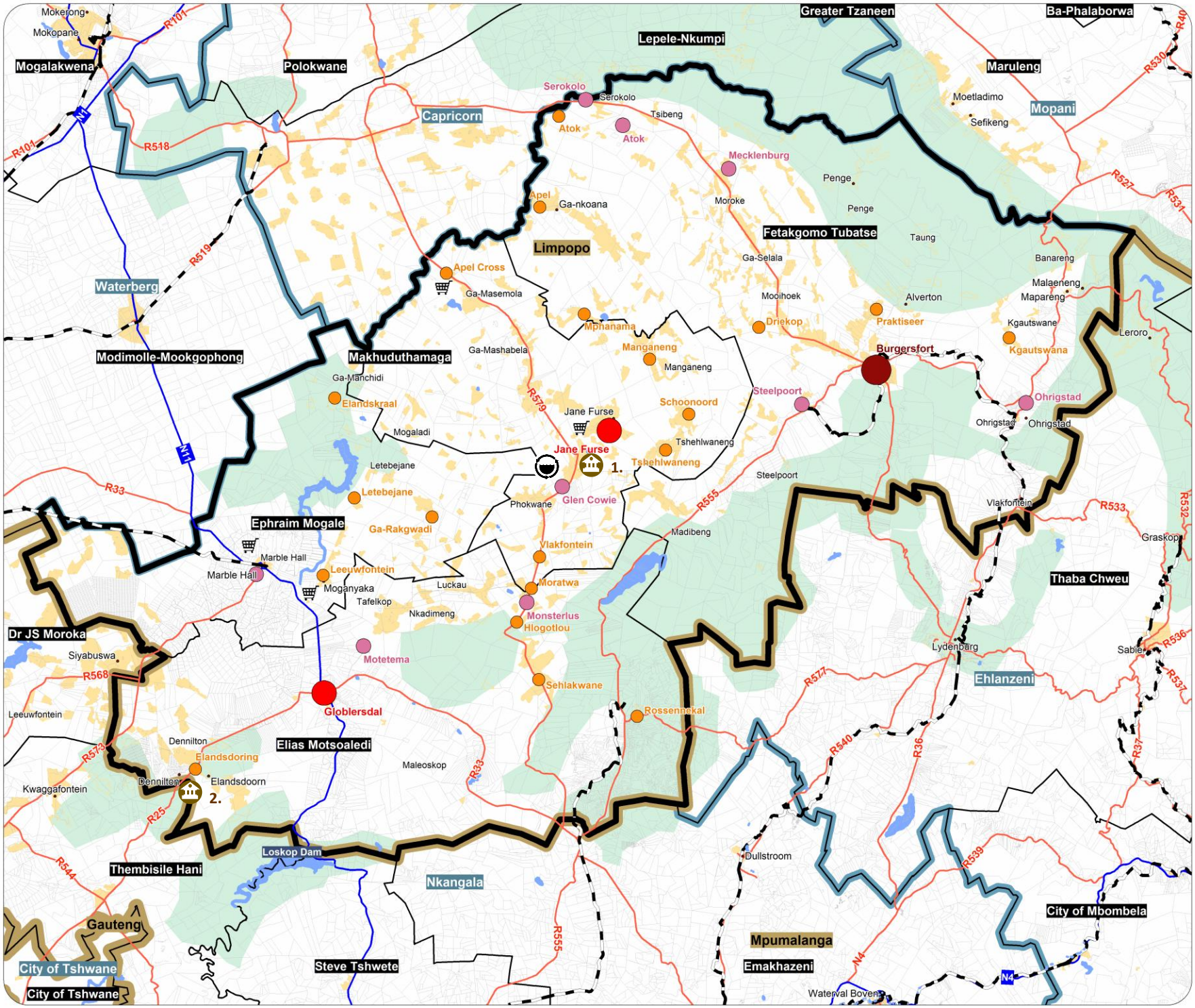
Source: CSIR Guideline for the Provision of Social Facilities in South African Settlements

Based on the CSIR guidelines referenced in the table above, several key social and community facilities are required within the district. This includes the establishment of Thusong Service Centres to address the needs of local communities, particularly in relation to municipal services. With that, a Government/Civic Precinct is proposed within the Jane Furse nodal area, adjacent to the existing hospital, as shown in **Figure 16.2**.

Accordingly, the proposed development aligns with the desired purpose of the node to serve as an Administrative and Services Hub, given that it is centrally positioned in the district and strategically located between Burgersfort, Steelpoort, Lebowakgomo, and Groblersdal. An additional Thusong Centre is recommended for the Marble Hall Node. This facility should include services such as the Department of Agriculture, a Youth Development Centre, a Community Hall, and other essential government services.

The district also faces social services shortfalls, including seven (7) additional primary schools and one secondary school, a postal service, and a sports stadium to accommodate recreational and community events. Additionally, maintaining and performing minor upgrades on existing sports fields is necessary to ensure their continued use.

Figure 16.2: Development Objective 2 Nodal Hierarchy and Proposed Regional Community Services



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVE 2 COMMUNITY FACILITIES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Rural Settlement
- Ecological Network
- Dam
- Regional Road
- National Road
- Railway Line
- Provincial Growth Point
- Regional development Anchor
- Local Service Centre
- Rural Service Centre

Proposed Regional Community Facilities

- Government Precinct
- Planned Major Shopping Centres
- Waste Water Treatment Plan

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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Groblersdal
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In terms of special needs education, there are currently three (3) special education schools within the Greater Sekhukhune area. However, there is a notable shortage of TVET colleges and post-matric education and skills development centres. The establishment of a higher education institution with a specialised focus on renewable energy and agriculture would provide significant long-term benefits to the region.

Furthermore, there is a need for well-equipped cultural centres to promote and exploit tourism and cultural heritage and advance local economic development in the district.

In terms of planned projects, three additional shopping centres are in the pipeline. These are planned in the Jane Furse, Apel-Cross and Marble Hall.

A bulk infrastructure project is planned for the development of a wastewater treatment plant in the Jane Furse area to serve the local community and the broader population, which relies on the area to enhance water and sanitation infrastructure in the region. The project is in its initial stages, with the design of the plant nearing completion. The project, as shown below, is part of the region's broader initiative to enhance supply and sanitation services.

Diagram 17.3: Planned Jane Furse Wastewater Treatment Plant

Informal Trading in Nodal Points

The establishment of informal trading is an essential part of the country's economic fabric, particularly in remote rural areas, as it provides a lucrative source of income to maintain household affordability levels. For a relatively few, there is an opportunity to upscale the informal trade to formalised businesses and, at times, diversify into other business prospects. Within the region itself, numerous informal traders are established in the towns of Burgersfort, Groblersdal, Marble Hall, Jane Furse, and others, where most people generally frequent for retail and social services, as well as the routes linking prominent economic areas. Understandably, informal traders are often drawn to high-traffic areas where they can offer their services daily. However, few places in the District offer a strategy that enables traders to tap into and expand their operations within the formal economy.

The concept below outlines the process of formalising the informal sector, as shown in **Diagram 17.4,** with prospects of scaling to permanent, sizable trading structures. Depicting the process from a hawker trading operating their business along the roadside to working with the public sector towards formalising the informal traders and establishing a forum to ensure the collaborative effort and participation to empower the informal economy while improving the public environment.

As a means to empower and provide necessary aid to informal traders. It is proposed that a database be created for informal traders to capture information that will enable municipalities to be aware of the number of traders in and around the municipality, as well as the type of commodities being traded, to provide suitable stalls for their business operations. Depending on the type of stall and the services provided, an agreement is to be made in which traders contribute on a monthly basis to ensure the provision of these services.

The engagements with traders involve negotiating the allocated space, stall design and the trader’s and public sector obligations. To ensure collaboration and coordination, an informal trading forum will be established, where traders' needs and the municipality's requirements will be expressed, and terms will be agreed upon. The forum could also serve as a space to combat crime in public environments. By working together with municipalities and the police, traders can help ensure public safety and support their businesses by maintaining high pedestrian traffic in public areas.

Diagram 17.4: Informal Trading and Formalisation Strategy

4.2.3. Development Objective 3: Enhance the Movement Networks and Infrastructure to Ensure Efficient Trade, and Urban and Rural Connectivity

Transport networks, both road and rail, are the lifeline to the development of a region, as they facilitate the movement of goods, services, and people, stimulate economic growth, and enhance connectivity between urban and rural areas, thus fostering trade and creating opportunities for social and industrial development. The section below refers to the district-wide priority movement network, which is crucial for stimulating economic vitality, connecting urban nodes, and promoting spatial integration. Improving these priority routes is crucial to the further advancement of the economy, particularly the disconnected and fragmented spatial form between urban and local markets prevalent in the district municipality.

Figure 17.1 illustrates the proposed Priority Transport Movement Network in the Sekhukhune District, highlighting significant routes that require focused attention for upgrading and maintenance due to their pivotal relevance to the economy and the communities they link. These include the following priority routes;

- **NATIONAL CORRIDOR**

The N11 is the district's main transport corridor, supporting interprovincial trade between Mpumalanga and Limpopo, while also providing vital local connectivity for businesses and farming activities around Groblersdal and Marble Hall.

It is proposed that the upgrading of the N11 be prioritised, as parts of the road are a single-carriageway, particularly between Groblersdal and Marble Hall. The section of the road should be upgraded to a dual-carriageway to accommodate the increasing traffic volumes. With the road currently facing significant strain due to high traffic volume, the construction of the road may be insufficient. Consequently, the road requires resurfacing in the town of Marble Hall.

- **PROVINCIAL CORRIDORS**

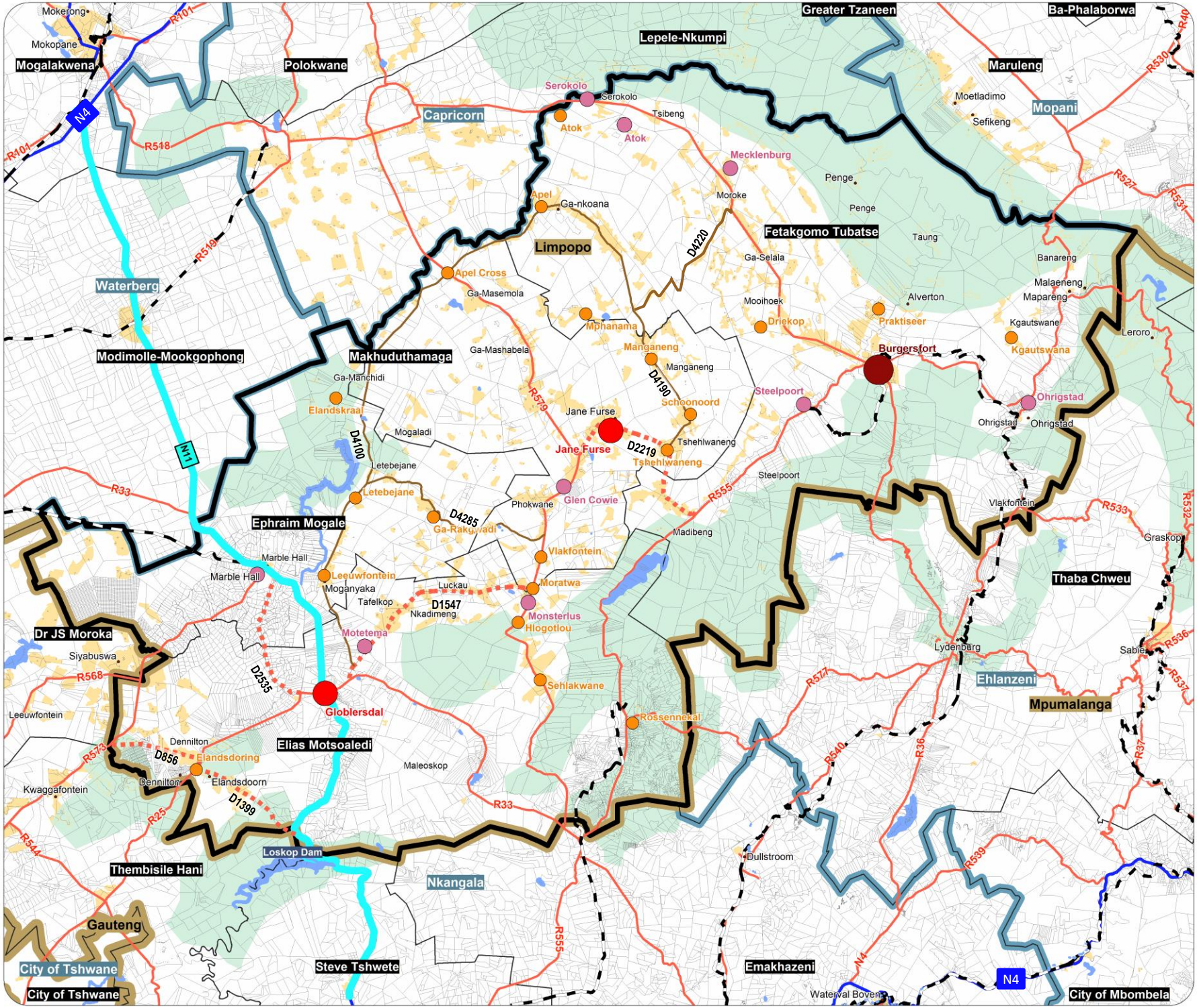
Below highlights six (6) Provincial Corridors identified in the District Municipality;

- **R37 Route** traversing through the northern parts of the District Municipality, and connects Polokwane and Lebowakgomo, and traverses through the District to Lydenburg where the route terminates. The town of Lydenburg is recognised as a tourism destination, with a focus on agriculture and mining. Due to the road's functionality, traversing the Platinum Belt facilitates the movement of goods and services, resources unearthed in the region, and people. The road, formerly a single-carriage way, was in recent years upgraded to a two-carriage way.

- **Route R579** – The R37 is another prominent route that traverses north-south through the central part of the district, and also links the Mpumalanga Province to the Limpopo Province. Within the District itself, the road connects several local communities and nodes to another, and directs traffic to the Lebowakgomo CBD and Polokwane CBD, which are interlinked with the N1 National Road.

- **Route R555** – Recognised as a provincial road and links the Mpumalanga Province through Middleburg, connects the Limpopo Province via Roossenekal-Steelpoort-Tubatse and Ohrigstad, connects to the R36 and further leads to the Maruleng LM (enriched with tourism-related activities).

Figure 17.1: Development Objective 3 Priority Corridors And Strategic Linkages



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVE 3 PRIORITY CORRIDORS AND STRATEGIC LINKS

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Rural Settlement
- Ecological Network
- Dam
- Provincial Growth Point
- Regional development Anchor
- Local Service Centre
- Rural Service Centre
- Railway Line

Priority Corridors

- National Corridor
- Provincial Corridor
- Provincial Corridor Link

Strategic Links

- Strategic Secondary Road

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
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Tel: 013 262 7300

17.1

- **R25 Route** serves a Provincial function that connects the Gauteng Province to the Limpopo Province. This route is key to both hauling trucks, long-short public transport services, conveying people to the region for tourism and agricultural prospects, and linking regional markets (in the Gauteng Province) to local markets in the region. Due to the effects of heavy rains, most roads around Elandsdoring have deteriorated, with numerous potholes, and thus require resurfacing. Sections requiring upgrading are predominantly from Verena in the Mpumalanga Province, right through Elandsdoring and the route D2535 towards Groblersdal.

- **R573 Route**, also referred to as the Moloto Corridor– The road is a key transportation route that connects the provinces of Gauteng, Mpumalanga, and Limpopo. This road serves as an important link for the movement of goods and people between these provinces, facilitating trade, commerce, and access between the City of Tshwane Metropolitan City in the Gauteng Province and Groblersdal through Elandsdoring/ Dennilton. Due to the high volume of traffic, particularly from public transportation, the corridor plays a crucial role in the regional economy and mobility.

- **R33 Route** is a regional road that connects the Sekhukhune District, specifically the town of Groblersdal, where it terminates, to the province of Mpumalanga, passing through the Loskop Dam. This road plays a vital role in linking farming communities in the Groblersdal region with larger urban centres and key commercial hubs in Middleburg CBD, in the Mpumalanga Province.

While the current road network provides the district with strong north-south regional connectivity, it is essential to note that a direct regional east-west route is required to link the local communities in the district's central parts and economic nodes. As a result, upgrading of third-order roads is necessary to strengthen access between several Rural Service Nodes.

It is therefore suggested that the following secondary routes be upgraded as regional roads to harness an efficient, well-connected spatial structure between towns and rural settlements:

- **Route D1547** (Mohlala Road) – Linking Groblersdal CBD and Morwaneng / Monsterlus
- **Route D856** – Linking Regional Routes R573 with the R25 (through Dennilton to Elandsdoring)
- **Route D2219** – Linking the regional routes, R579 and R555 and traversing passed the Jane Furse business node.

Due to the spatial character of the district incurs spatial disintegration, particularly in areas where it most critical for integration via a connected network that ensures the strengthening of nodal development. With that, it is proposed that the upgrading of strategic secondary roads should also be prioritised to ensure connectivity between urban and rural areas, thereby nurturing the local economic growth and increasing access to these nodal points. This includes prioritising the Strategic Secondary Roads for upgrading and adequate maintenance.

- **Route D4100** 'King Mohlala Road' and Route D4250 which both connect to route D1547 and R579 routes, linking several Rural Service Nodes
- **Route D2535** "Nkahloleng Road", which connects the two towns of Groblersdal and Marble Hall
- **Route D4285** connecting R579 and Route D4100 at the Letebejane Rural Service Node
- **Route D4190** which links the R555 with the D4250
- **Route D220** linking Route D37 and route D4190

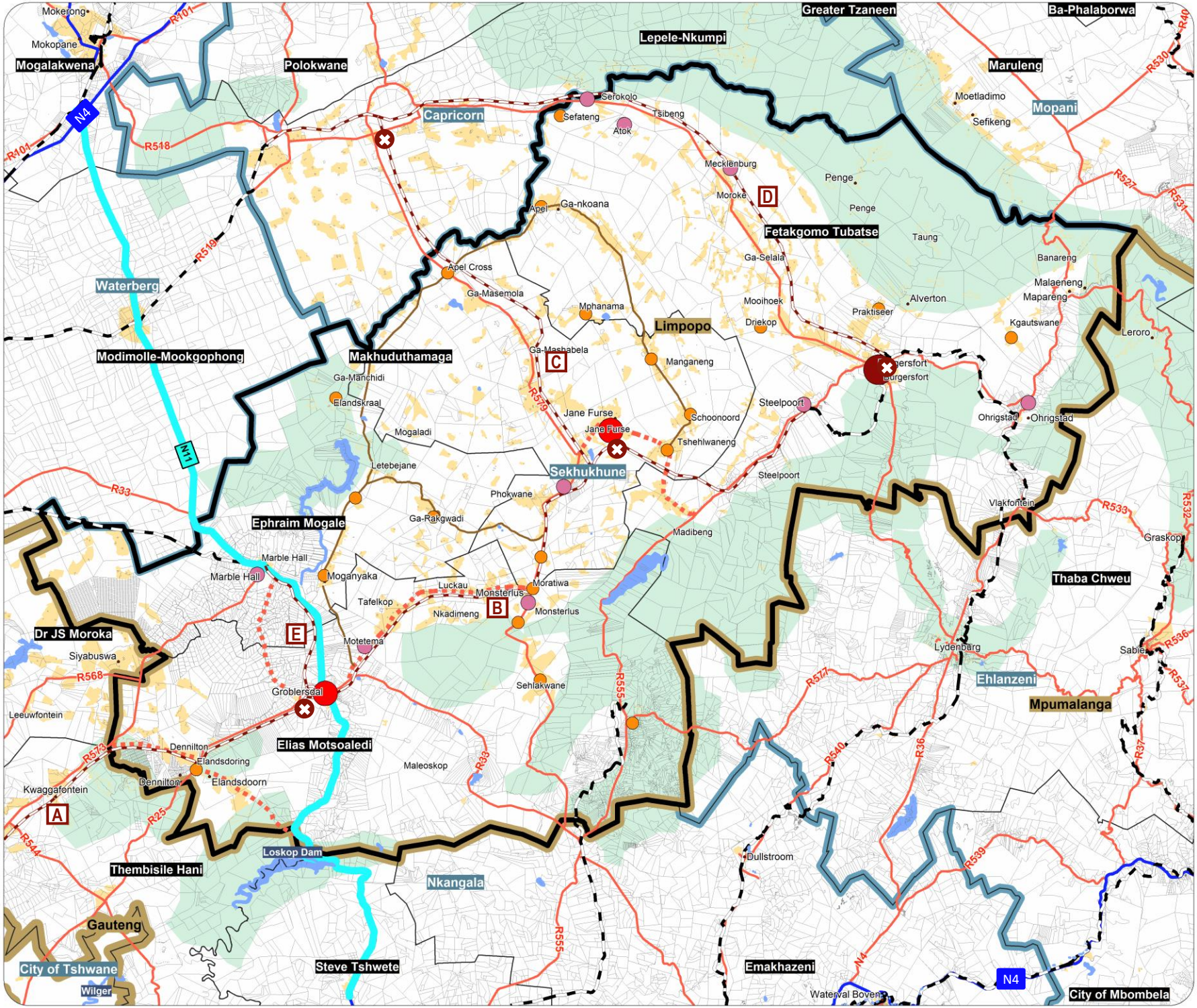
Rail infrastructure in the district is limited to the southwestern region, terminating at Marble Hall, and in the north-eastern parts, serving Ohrigstad and Burgersfort, as

well as the last rail link in the south-western region. The central part of the district, where the majority of the population resides, is not served by rail. Although rail infrastructure exists in parts of the district, it requires adequate maintenance to ensure reliability to support the district's economy, particularly in maintaining logistical value in the mining, industrial, and agro-processing industries.

With the intention to expand the rail network and efficiently maximise the distribution of goods and services to key economic centres in the county and export in the SADC and globally. **Figure 17.2** depicts the proposed railway link expansion through the district. This forms part of the proposed Moloto Corridor initiative, designed to strengthen distribution links between the Gauteng Province and the district, while also improving safety and increasing passenger ridership. Partial studies have been conducted to investigate the feasibility of the proposed passenger rail network, which includes;

- **Railway Link A** from the City of Tshwane-Mamelodi-KwaMhlanga towards Groblersdal, the proposed new railway link is part of the planned Moloto Corridor, anticipated to run parallel to the R573 route. Investigations for the link have already been investigation, with its intention to alleviate traffic and ensure commuter safety from the Moloto road (R573);
- **Railway link B** to traverse from Groblersdal-Jane Furse and connect to the Burgersfort, this will open the central parts of the district and increase connectivity for commuters to other areas of opportunity.
- **Railway Link C** via Lebowakgomo to Jane Furse Regional Rail Corridor. This line has the potential to connect to the Moloto Corridor service, which connects the City of Tshwane MM with the Greater Sekhukhune area.
- **Railway Link D** is proposed from Burgersfort to link to Lebowakgomo and Zebediela, with possible expansion to Polokwane.
- **Railway link E** highlights a recommendation of the railway line between Pienaarsrivier and Marble Hall to be refurbished and reinstated to support the agricultural sector in the Sekhukhune District and the Bela Bela LM, which will improve efficiency and reduce distribution services from national and regional roads, specifically along routes R33, R516 and R576. In addition to upgrading the Marble Hall railway link, it is proposed that a feasibility study and the construction of a new railway line between Marble Hall and Groblersdal be conducted.

Figure 17.2: Development Objective 3 Proposed Passenger Rail Network



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVE 3
PROPOSED PASSENGER RAIL NETWORK

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Rural Settlement
- Ecological Network
- Dam
- Provincial Growth Point
- Regional development Anchor
- Local Service Centre
- Rural Service Centre
- National Corridor
- Provincial Corridor
- Provincial Corridor Link
- Strategic Secondary Road
- Railway Line
- Proposed Railway Line
- Railway Terminals

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

17.2

4.2.4. Development Objective 4: Development of Productive Regions

PROMOTE THE ADVANCEMENT OF TOURISM

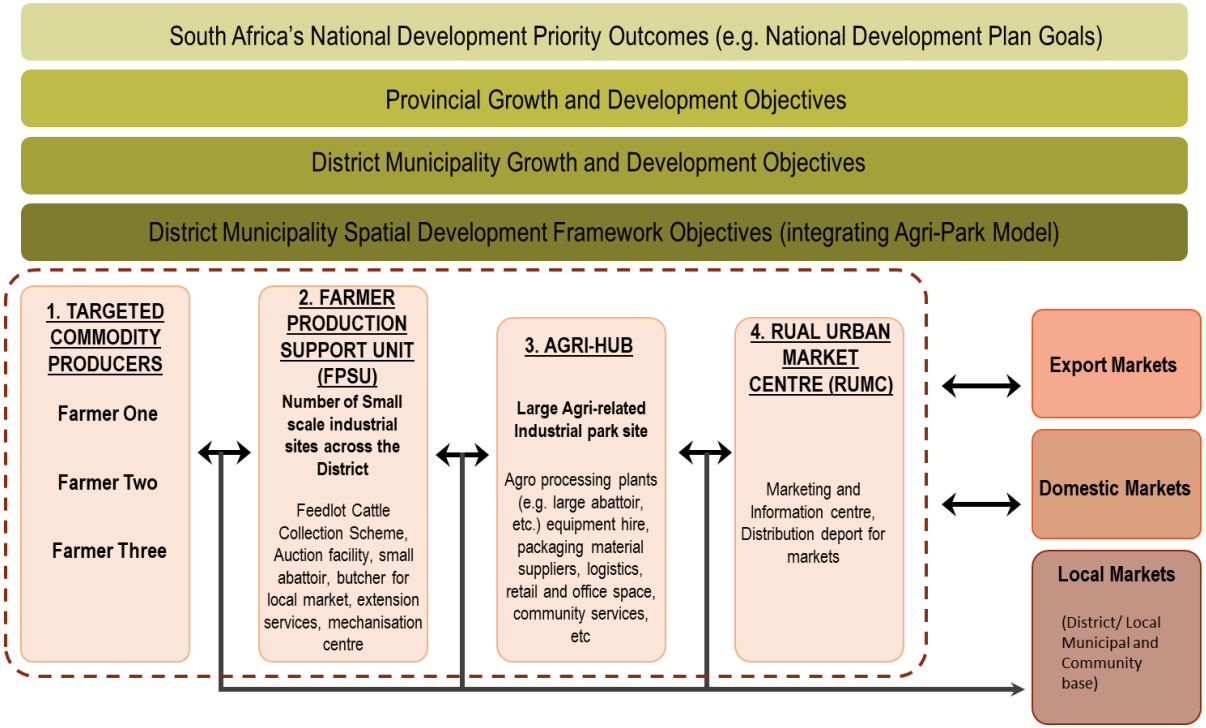
The Sekhukhune District Municipality is profoundly influenced by agriculture, which not only shapes its economic landscape but also serves as the foundation for the communal livelihood. The municipality is exceptionally well-positioned to capitalise on targeted agricultural initiatives to stimulate economic development, given its substantial arable land and long-standing agricultural heritage. These initiatives have the potential to generate substantial employment opportunities for local residents by adopting modern farming practices, enhancing agricultural infrastructure, and implementing supportive policies.

This emphasis on agriculture not only improves the local economy but also significantly contributes to poverty alleviation by ensuring food security and establishing sustainable income streams. Ultimately, the development of agriculture in Sekhukhune presents a promising trajectory for enhancing living standards and establishing long-term socio-economic resilience among its inhabitants. With that, the following agricultural proposals for the district are outlined below.

The concept of Agri-Parks and Farmer Production Support Units (FPSU), as shown in the following diagrams, has been well advocated throughout the country. This is due to the fact that the initiative is fundamental to boosting agricultural productivity and promoting rural economic development. The Agri-Parks strategy is envisioned as a networked innovation system that involves agro-production, processing, logistics, marketing, training, and extension services within a district municipality. This market-driven system incorporates a range of agricultural activities and rural transformation services. Three primary components represent the Agri-Park:

- **Farmer Production Support Unit (FPSU):** The FPSU connects with farmers and markets, serving as a rural outreach and capacity-building unit. It offers extension services, including mechanisation support, and administers primary collection, limited storage, and minor processing for local markets.
- **Agri-Hub (AH):** This entity serves as a central hub for agro-processing activities in the district, covering production, equipment rental, processing, packaging, logistics, innovation, and training.
- **Rural Urban Market Centre (RUMC):** The RUMC has three primary functions: providing market intelligence and information feedback to the Agri-Hub and FPSU using the latest information and communication technologies, acting as a holding facility to release produce to urban markets based on seasonal trends, and linking and contracting rural, urban, and international markets. The concept of an Agri-Park and FPSU is illustrated below, as well as their interlinked relationship.

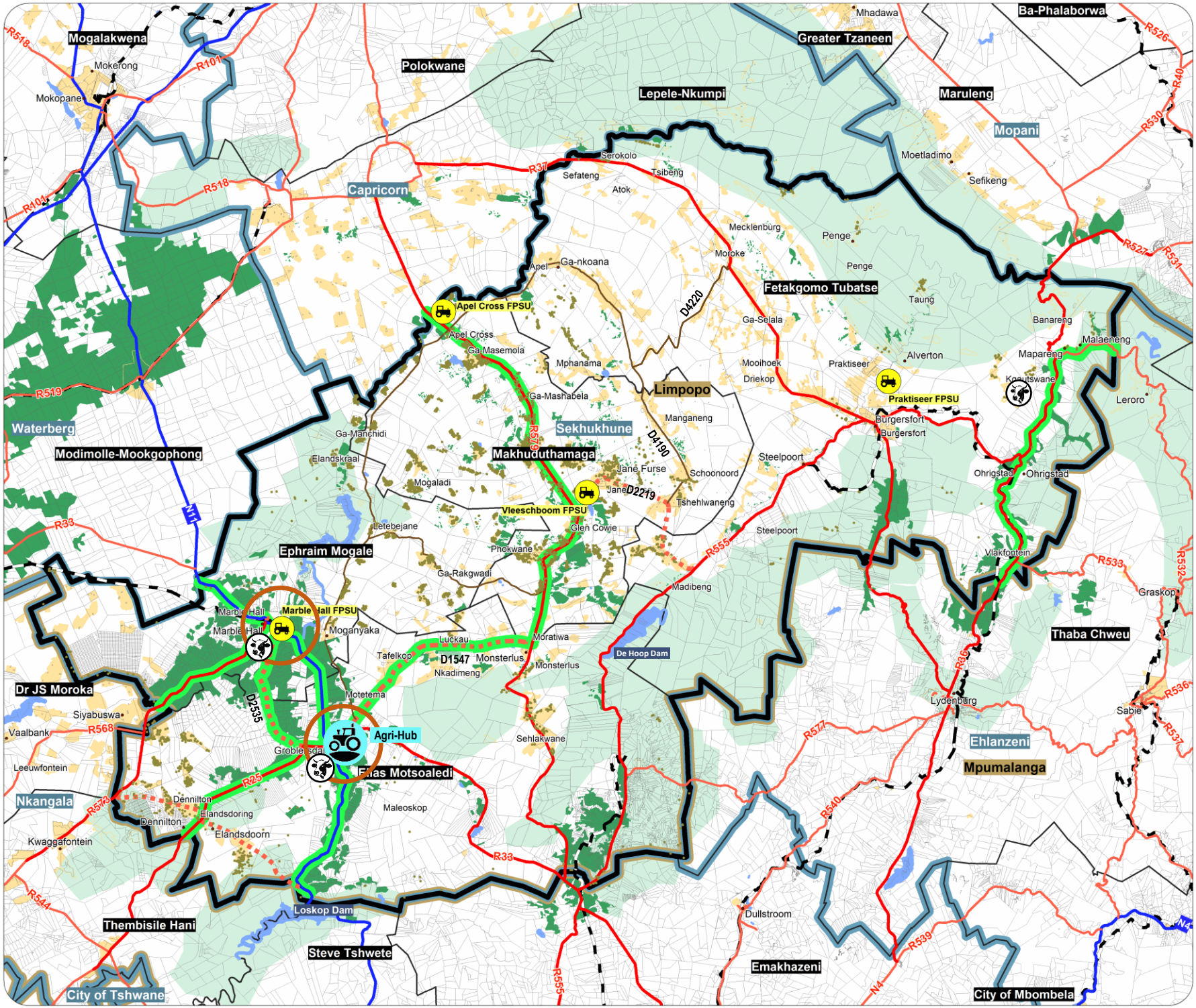
Diagram 18.1: Adapted Agri-Park Model



Source: Department of Rural Development and Land Reform

As illustrated in **Diagram 18.1** above, the Agri-Park initiative is designed to serve as an administrative unit within a district municipality, focusing on high-level production, machinery, distribution, and logistics to regional markets. Whereas the Agri-Hub's inclusion is intended to offer local producers essential services that improve the value of their produce, increase market access, and encourage sustainable farming practices. In terms of agricultural initiatives proposed within the district. As shown in **Figure 18**, the development of an Agri-Hub is proposed near Groblersdal, where commercial farms coexist with subsistence farming, and the proposed initiative in close proximity to the town has the potential to offer essential assistance to the region-wide agricultural community. Moreover, the N11 functions as a crucial national corridor, efficiently channelling goods and services from the Agri Hub to key markets in the Gauteng and Mpumalanga Provinces. **Diagram 18.2** illustrates the concept of the Agri-Hub, and its functionality within the Agri-Park model.

Figure 18: Development Objective 4 Agricultural Initiatives



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVE 4 AGRICULTURAL INITIATIVES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Settlement Pattern
- Ecological Network
- Crop Farming
- Subsistent Livestock Farming
- Dam
- National Corridor
- Railway Line
- Provincial Corridor
- Provincial Corridor Link
- Strategic Secondary Road

Agricultural Proposals

- Agricultural Corridors
- Sekhukhune Agri-Park
- FPSU
- Abattoir
- Agricultural Gateway

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
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Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Diagram 18.2: Agri-Hub Model

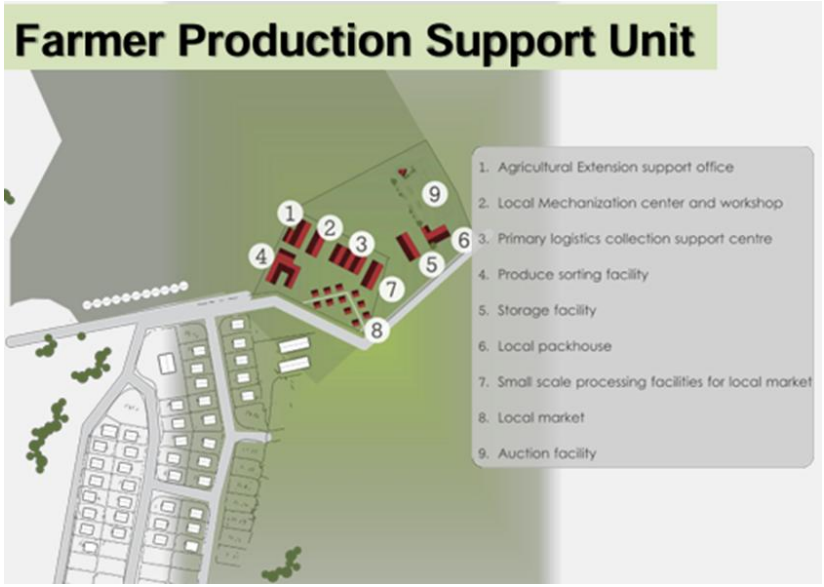
Source: Department of Rural Development and Land Reform

Additionally, the development of a Farmers Production Support Unit (FPSU) is proposed in Marble Hall, where the Sekhukhune Agri-Hub would aggregate produce from the FPSU further to facilitate processing, packaging, and distribution to markets. Moreover, to those previously approved by the Department of Rural Development and Land Reform, three more FPSU sites have been identified in the region to enhance reach and utilisation within the District Municipality. These sites include Vleeschboom, Praktiseer, and Apel Gross, with the Vleeschboom FPSU currently under construction.

As shown in **Diagram 18.3**, a FPSU serves as a rural outreach and capacity-building units that provide primary collection, storage, minor processing, and extension services to smallholder farmers. Essentially, this builds a continuous agricultural production network, from raw production of commodities to value-added produce that is efficiently packaged and stored to be delivered to regional markets for trade and further processing (agro-producing of other consumable food goods

As depicted in **Figure 18**, the town of Groblersdal holds an abattoir which is crucial in supporting the local agricultural economy, servicing livestock farmers and ensuring a steady supply of meat products to the region.

Diagram 18.3: Conceptual Design of Farmers' Production Support Units



Additionally, Groblersdal has been designated as an Economic Development District (EDD) and an Agricultural Gateway, which is key to facilitating the region's economic growth and agricultural development. The purpose of EDD initiatives is to focus infrastructure investments and opportunities at strategic points within the region. In order to stimulate job creation, boost the region's economy, and identify opportunities for economic diversification that ensure the region maintains a competitive advantage. Groblersdal's designation as an EDD gateway suggests that the town serves as a hub for investment, infrastructure development, and market access, particularly in the agricultural sector. This designation of an EDD, coinciding with the development of an Agri Hub, positions Groblersdal as a pivotal driver of regional economic growth and agricultural innovation.

Given the strategic importance of specific routes, shown on figure 84 in linking key agricultural initiatives and improving access to commercial and subsistence farming activities, these routes are proposed to be designated as the district's Agricultural Corridors, namely; N11 national road, R25, R573, route 2535, route 1547, route D4100 and the R579.

By categorising these routes as such, these should be prioritised for infrastructure upgrades to facilitate the efficient movement of agricultural goods from production sites to markets. Additionally, clear signage and targeted marketing of agricultural initiatives, agro-processing industries, and farm names should be placed along these routes to further promote the adjoining agricultural establishments. To further support local farming businesses, it is recommended that the establishment of farm stalls and fresh produce markets along these routes be encouraged, as well as promoting local businesses and showcasing locally produced goods.

The Comprehensive Rural Development Programme (CRDP) is an initiative that aims to revitalise rural areas by addressing infrastructure deficits, stimulating economic development, and empowering local communities. The objective of this initiative is to ensure secure land tenure, improve the quality of life in rural areas through effective service delivery, and ensure stable livelihoods and food security.

Groblersdal is notable for its agricultural activities and thus has smallholder irrigation schemes. These schemes are crucial for enhancing agricultural productivity, ensuring food security, and improving the livelihoods of local farmers. The town of Groblersdal benefits from several smallholder irrigation schemes, enabling farmers to cultivate a variety of crops throughout the year. The Loskop Dam located within the Olifants River just south of Groblersdal, is the key water source for the smallholder irrigation schemes in the area. Through an extensive canal network, the dam supports approximately 19,000 hectares of farmland.

Despite some level of infrastructure being available in Groblersdal, local farmers encounter various obstacles that require additional support. This includes the following

- Access to water is the most critical; emerging farmers face challenges in obtaining reliable irrigation water. Regulations and current water allocations make it challenging for emerging farmers to effectively utilise the available water resources;
- Limited financial resources prevent farmers from investing in essential infrastructure, such as irrigation equipment and sustainable water delivery systems. Financial constraints lead to underutilised or ineffective farming techniques;
- High electricity costs hinder water pump operation. Farmers sometimes use diesel generators, which are expensive and unsustainable;
- Insufficient commercial farming expertise and limited information to knowledge about farming, particularly in light of climate change.

The following presents agricultural-based proposals to enhance the effectiveness of farmers in the region, this include;

- Prioritise access to water for farming activity**,** and simplify the process to obtain a water license; The region tends to incur frequent water cuts, which hamper production, and at times, the cuts take as long as 2 weeks. This should be addressed as the majority of the farmers in the region, do not have large water storage facilities. The process of applying for a water licence can take 3 to 6 months to process and reach approval, depending on the complexity of the application, which includes emerging farmers having access to irrigated water.
- Financial Support to provide targeted financial assistance to assist in agricultural infrastructure and equipment, the types of financial support could be through grants, incentive programs and upskilling local communities, schools, or subsidies. As this will assist farmers to have adequate irrigation, enhanced automation (depending on the size of their production area, and most importantly, large water storage to ensure continuous water availability. Alternatively, efficient watering techniques such as rainwater harvesting and storage solutions, which are cost-effective, may not be feasible for large crop fields.
- Introduce alternative and educate farmers on sustainable energy solutions. By implementing sustainable and cost-effective energy alternatives, which include bioenergy, off-grid solar, and wind energy systems, to mitigate dependence on expensive diesel generators and electricity. This may result in the agricultural sector being sustainable in the long term while also increasing productivity and reducing operational costs for emerging producers.
- Equipping emerging farmers with the necessary skills and knowledge in commercial farming practices, irrigation management, and sustainable agricultural techniques through targeted training programs that promote capacity building for farmers. By offering farmers practical learning experiences and expert guidance, they can improve farm management, promote environmentally sustainable practices, and increase productivity, thereby facilitating their transition to successful and competitive agricultural enterprises.

Consequently, the potential for agricultural productivity in Groblersdal can be fully realised by addressing these challenges through coordinated efforts from the

farming community, non-governmental organisations, and government agencies. This will result in the region's socio-economic development and increased agricultural productivity.

- **Promote the Growth of Small-Scale Farming in the Region**

Promoting small-scale farming in the region is essential for driving economic growth, reducing poverty, and decreasing dependence on social grants. By supporting local farmers, we foster a self-sufficient community, enhance food security, and stimulate the local economy.

As such it is recommended that new agricultural commodities be introduced and invested in, particularly those that appeal to local producers, in addition to the current agricultural commodities produced in the district. These commodities are cost-effective, do not require extensive infrastructure, and are not affected by climate change. The value chains highlighted in **Diagrams 19.1–19.3** illustrate the proposed agricultural initiatives, which aim to facilitate the expansion of farming opportunities for local, emerging, or subsistence farmers and their entry into commercial markets. These value chains highlight commodities, namely, aloe vera, snail and mushroom farming.

- **Aloe vera farming and product formulation**

Aloe Vera plants are native to the Sekhukhune District Municipality, where they thrive in the region's hot, dry climate. Known for its wide range of uses in the health and beauty industries. Aloe vera cultivation and sustainable harvesting could stimulate local economies by creating jobs, supporting small-scale farming, and providing communities with opportunities to engage in sustainable agricultural practices while utilising local natural resources. Refer to **Diagram 19.1**, which illustrates the aloe vera value chain.

It is recommended that emerging farmers in the District Municipality establish Aloe Vera farms as part of a cooperative to enhance local production capacity. Aloe Vera farming can create job opportunities, from harvesting to product manufacturing, packaging, distribution, and propagation, in order to ensure the sustainability of the plants in the region. Such activities would support local businesses and establish a sustainable value chain that benefits the entire community.

- **Snail Farming**

The initiative of introducing snail farming to emerging farmers in the region is a lucrative venture due to its cost-effectiveness and high profit potential. With minimal investment in terms of infrastructure, food sources (which are vegetables and plants) and secure pens, see the value chain in **Diagram 19.2**. Snail farming appeals to small-scale farmers seeking a viable industry that is resilient to climate change and offers a low-investment start-up with higher returns.

- **Mushroom Farming**

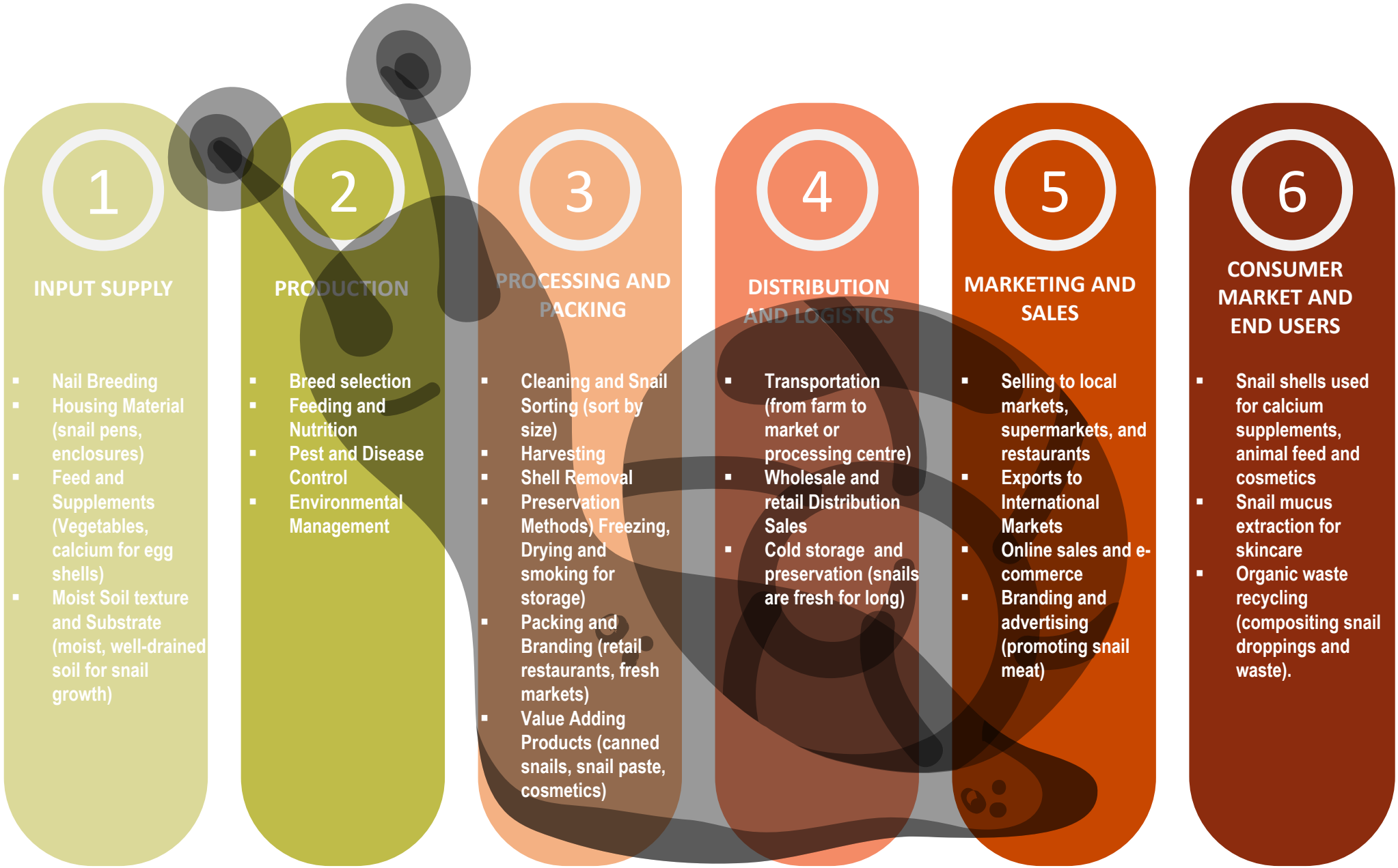
Mushroom farming is becoming increasingly popular among emerging farmers due to its relatively low start-up costs and fast-growing cycle, refer to **Diagram 19.3**. Mushrooms require little space, making them ideal for small-scale and large-scale farming operations. The growing demand for fresh mushrooms, as well as other methods of processing and packaging, such as dried mushrooms and mushroom-based sauces, has created a lucrative market. The farming practice is grown year-round, producing a high yield in relatively small areas, making it an attractive and profitable opportunity for emerging farmers.

ALOE VERA VALUE CHAIN

DIAGRAM 19.1

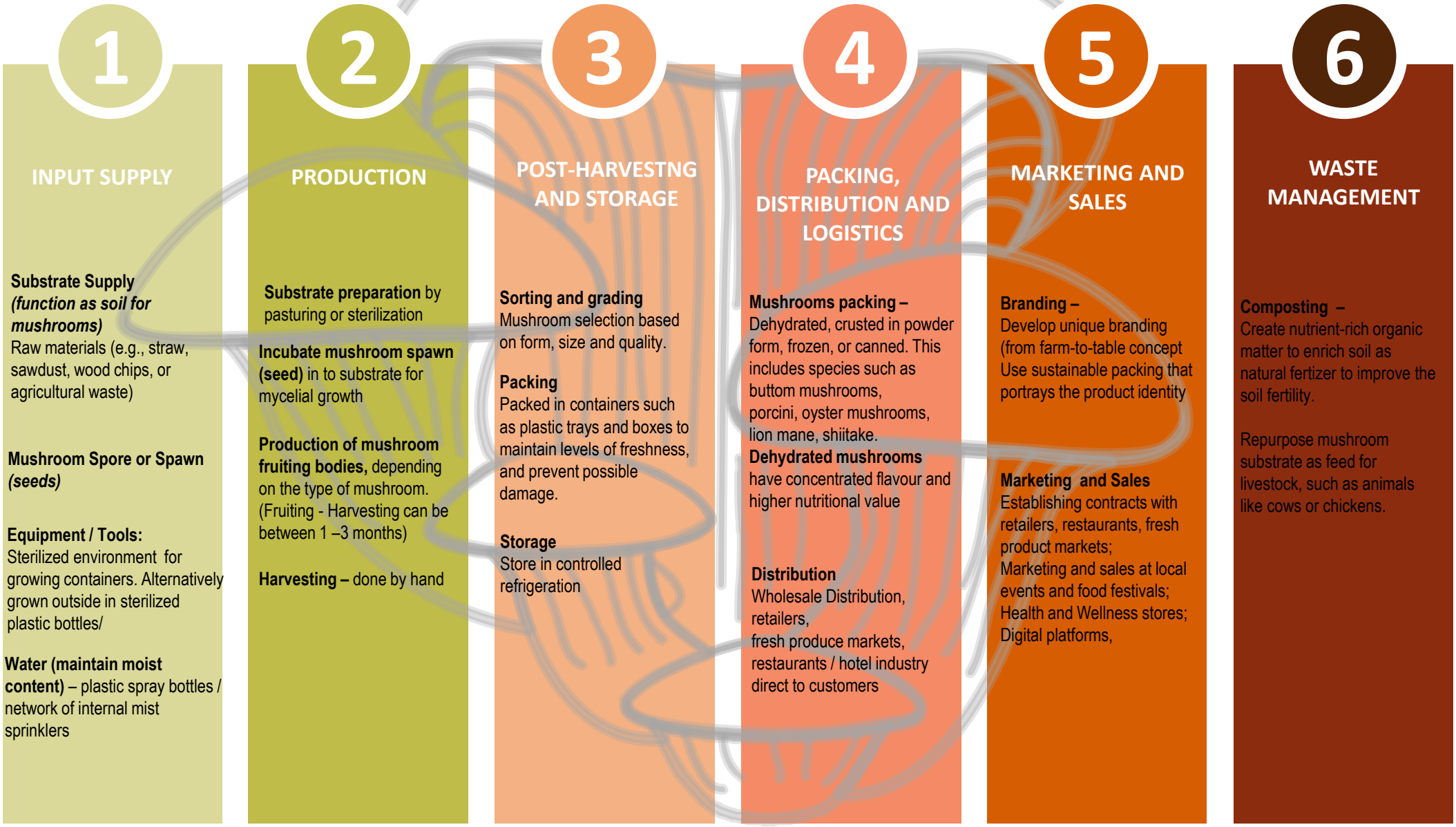
SNAIL FARMING VALUE CHAIN

DIAGRAM 19.2



MUSHROOM FARMING VALUE CHAIN

DIAGRAM 19.3



PROMOTE THE ADVANCEMENT OF TOURISM

The District Municipality possesses immense tourism potential that, if properly developed, can transform the local economy. By enhancing nature reserves, establishing tourism corridors, and improving infrastructure, the region can attract both domestic and international tourists, thereby increasing revenue and creating new employment opportunities. Strategic investment and sustainable tourism development will be key in positioning Sekhukhune as a leading tourism destination.

Figure 19 illustrates the three prominent Tourism Corridors within the District, notably linked to prominent tourism anchors and associated tourist destinations. They include the following tourism routes;

DISTRICT-WIDE TOURISM CORRIDORS;

- **Mafulo a Matala Route;** traverses along the N11 from Middelburg and the R25 from Pretoria, reaching the Schuinsdraai Nature Reserve and the Flag Boshielo Dam
- **The Marota Route;** The tourism route traverses the central region of the District Municipality. Passing through areas such as Ga-Motodi and Marota A, and connects to towns like Burgersfort. Another link runs through Apel, Manganeng, and Schoonoord via route D4190 and through route R579, linking the Apel Cross, Glen Cowie, and Jane Furse and joining the R555 route.
- **Platinum Stream Route; the Platinum Stream route** traverses along routes R555 and the R37, in the northern extents of the district and eastern borders.

The following section provides a comprehensive overview of the tourism corridors, along with the necessary development initiatives that aim to unlock their full potential. These proposed efforts are designed to maximise the appeal and functionality of the corridors, ensuring they attract and accommodate more visitors while enhancing the overall tourism experience.

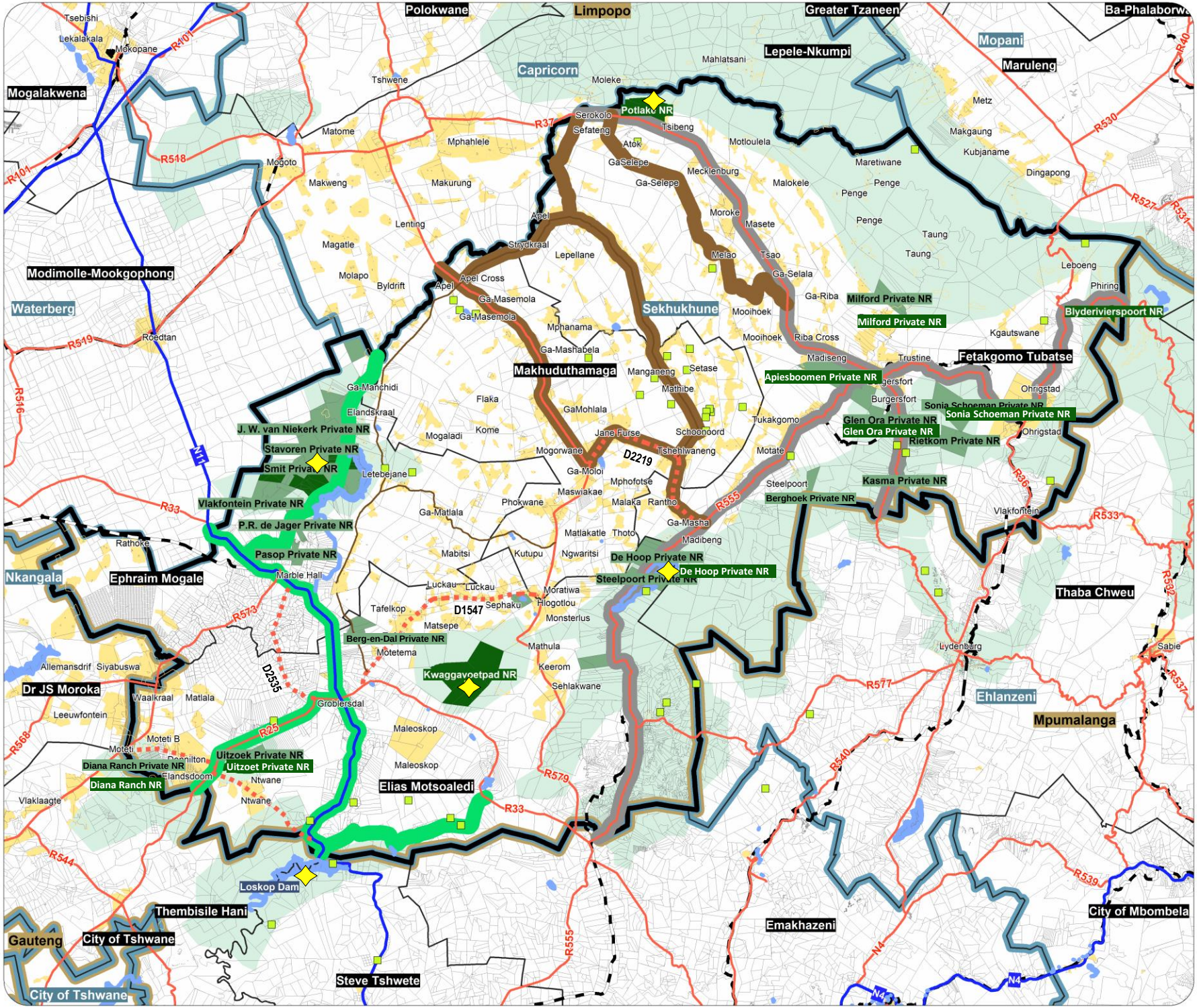
The Mafulo a Matala Route – Along Loskop Dam - Flag Boshielo Dam - Olifants River Valley

Meaning "animals grazing on green land," displays Sekhukhune's ecological splendour. The route features the region's magnificent sights and adventurous thrills. The Flag Boshielo Dam and Schuinsdraai Nature Reserve are prominent water recreation hotspots along the route featuring fishing activity, several lodges, and game farms. The route encompasses mountain views, valleys, and winding rivers framed by wildlife. Recreational activities established encompass wilderness hikes, game drives, and water-based sports.

In order to enhance and develop the tourism route further, to create a more enriching experience for visitors while showcasing the best of the region's natural beauty and cultural heritage. It is recommended that development associated with the development of localised accommodation and hotels with conference facilities, the restaurant industry, be considered along the route. Additionally, holds potential for water-related activities such as kayaking tours, floating restaurants, and picnic areas

In terms of critical infrastructure upgrades, route D1547, which leads from Marble Hall to the Schuinsdraai and the Flag Boshielo Dam, requires upgrading, including signage placement of surrounding tourist establishments. Subsequently, upgrading of bulk infrastructure, such as water, sanitation, and electrification, is required. These upgrades will ensure this tourism route functions more efficiently, providing a better experience for tourists and supporting the development.

Figure 19: Development Objective 4 Agricultural Initiatives



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVE 4 TOURISM INITIATIVES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Settlement Pattern
- Ecological Network
- Private Nature Reserve
- Proclaimed Nature Reserve
- Tourism Activities
- Dam
- National Corridor
- Railway Line
- Provincial Corridor
- Provincial Corridor Link
- Strategic Secondary Road

Tourism Proposals

- Platinum Stream Tourism Route
- Mafulo a Matala Tourism Route
- Marota Tourism Route
- Tourism Anchors

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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The Marota Route – Along Apel - Manganeng - Jane Furse - Drakensberg Escarpment

The Marota Route enables tourists to discover the district's rich cultural heritage, which encompasses the remnants of ancient civilisations preserved only through archaeological evidence. Located in sites such as the Hlako Heritage Site and Matjeding Fortress in Ga-Marishane, as well as the Hlako Mountain, where much of the Khoi San rock art can be viewed. Notably, the route requires improvement, which includes enhancing historic and cultural sites, as well as associated facilities and tourism markets that exhibit arts and crafts. Ensuring a well-rounded supply of tourist activities to increase the offering of tourist products, the involvement of the private sector and the local communities is required. Tourist products offered along the route include overnight accommodation, nature reserves, and guided tours. The route has the potential to include traditional dances and performances, local crafts markets, a display of indigenous games, and African storytelling.

Pertaining to recommended upgrades for the tourism corridor, it is proposed that SMME opportunities be identified and supported along the route in order to advance the local economy, increase the effectiveness of the route, increase job opportunities, and advance visitor experience. It is proposed that the respective culture and heritage sites be upgraded and continuously maintained to be effective. Notably, some cultural and heritage sites have commenced upgrading, including the Tjale Heritage Site.

Several roads leading to key heritage and cultural sites need upgrading, including the D4170, which connects the Potlake Nature Reserve to Driekop at the intersection of Route R37. It is recommended that adequate signage be installed along the corridor to highlight key tourist attractions and points of interest. As this will enhance the route's functionality and raise awareness of the region's distinctive offerings, it will ensure that visitors maximise their stay and appreciate the region's rich cultural heritage. Equally important is the upgrade of service infrastructure; such as water, sanitation, electricity, and the installation of telecommunications at the heritage and cultural sites. These improvements are crucial to enhance the appeal and boost the visitor experience.

Platinum Stream Route – route along Potlake NR – Tubatse – Steelpoort - Roossenekal

The mining route offers the opportunity to visit the oldest mine in the region, where ancient mine workings can be explored and knowledge is shared pertaining to historical mining-related facts. The corridor leads to several mines within the area that will provide tourists with mining information and experience. The Marula Merensky Mine, owned by Implants and the Lebowa Platinum Mine are among the oldest mines in the region, both of which hold potential to become intriguing tourist sites. While the Lebowa Platinum Mine remains an active commercial operation and is generally inaccessible to the public, special permission may be granted for those interested in an educational or industrial visit. These mines offer a unique opportunity to explore the region's mining heritage, and with the right access, they could provide valuable insights into the industry's history and progression over time.

With the tourism corridor such as the Mafulo a Matala Route connecting prominent neighbouring tourist anchors; Loskop Dam and the Mabuza Nature Reserve, which border the district. It is essential that the network of tourism corridors be effectively upgraded where necessary to ensure seamless access and connectivity that interlinks across regions.

The following discussion highlights the prominent nature reserves in the district, focusing on their current challenges and exploring their potential for growth and development as key attractions. By promoting an interconnected network of tourism corridors that link the key tourism anchors across the region, it will play a pivotal role in positioning the district as a leading eco-tourism destination.

This interconnected network will not only attract investment but also foster regional development, stimulating the local economy. Below, outline the nature and offerings of the district's primary tourism anchors, which include:

i. **Schuinsdraai Nature Reserve and Flag Boshielo Dam**
ii. **De Hoop Dam and Nature Reserve**
iii. **Kwaggavoetgat Nature Reserve**
iv. **Potlake Nature Reserve**

Each of these sites offers unique experiences, from wildlife viewing and outdoor activities to cultural exploration, and together they form a compelling attraction for eco-tourism.

i. THE SCHUINSDRAAI NATURE RESERVE AND FLAG BOSHIELO DAM

The Schuinsdraai Nature Reserve, in conjunction with the Flag Boshielo Dam situated in the Ephraim-Mogale Local Municipality on the western borders is a key tourism hub in the district, highlighting one of the region's most significant water resources. The reserve is a beloved destination for water-based recreation, attracting families and anglers who enjoy activities along the shores of Flag Boshielo Dam. With its stunning natural beauty and abundant wildlife, the area holds immense potential for expanding water-focused tourism ventures.

It is envisioned that the nature reserve will be developed as a prime destination and will necessitate the establishment of luxury housing options, including time-share or fully owned properties, a prestigious golf estate, a resort, and a hotel with conference facilities. Additionally, the eastern end of the dam is envisioned as the perfect site for a resort, thus offering a unique tourism experience. The vision for the Schuinsdraai Nature Reserve is one with harmonious integration of eco-friendly water and green ecological activities throughout the reserve.

It is suggested that nature reserve and dam, encompass the initiative of a smart city, so as to create a balance between eco-tourism developments and the environment, and ensure the preservation of natural resources. This would entail the development of eco-friendly buildings, green infrastructure, and systems that prioritise smart water usage and waste management. These initiatives are intended to create a destination that is both sustainable and environmentally conscious, thereby fostering a positive relationship with the environment and attracting tourists.

ii. DE HOOP NATURE RESERVE AND DAM

The De Hoop Nature Reserve is located within the far northern parts of Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality. The nature reserve is a significant natural landmark contributing to the region's ecological and tourism appeal. This reserve is part of the broader conservation efforts within the district, offering a blend of natural beauty, diverse wildlife, and opportunities for sustainable tourism. As one of the key ecological areas within the Sekhukhune District, De Hoop Nature Reserve plays a vital role in preserving the region's unique flora and fauna, while also attracting visitors interested in eco-tourism, wildlife viewing, and outdoor activities. Its strategic location within the Sekhukhune District positions it as an important asset for both local conservation efforts and economic development through tourism.

With its immense potential for economic growth and destination development, the De Hoop Nature Reserve is envisioned as one of the district's tourism anchors. In order to unlock the potential around the dam, it is proposed that a dedicated tourism precinct be established to position the area as a vibrant recreational, leisure, and a tourism destination.

The proposed De Hoop Nature Reserve tourism area would serve as a catalyst for local economic development that attracts visitors, stimulates investment opportunities, creates employment opportunities, and supports surrounding communities through tourism-related enterprises. In addition, the development

would enhance the district's tourism profile by offering a diverse range of nature adventures (both water based and on-land) and family-oriented activities.

The De Hoop Nature Reserve is also recommended to integrate smart city solutions to support the preservation of the area's ecological footprint. With that, it is suggested that the design of overnight stay be integrated with green infrastructure to support low-density accommodation, thereby maximising the utilisation of natural resources and enhancing the overall visitor experience. Furthermore, it is proposed that the use of electric vehicle (EV) transit services be implemented in order to mitigate the carbon footprint.

Additionally, improvement involves the construction of well-designed signage throughout the reserve, the upgrading of access roads, and the provision of visitor parking areas. Water-based activities, such as kayaking and canoeing, as well as social activities like bird-watching and trekking, should be encouraged.

iii. KWAGGAVOETPAT NATURE RESERVE

As shown in the figure, the Kwaggavoetgat Nature Reserve is situated in the Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality, in a more secluded area within the LM. The reserve is located in a region encompassing historical significance, a landscape framed by deep valleys and numerous mountainous areas, and filled with extensive grasslands, bushveld, and riverine environments. Although the region is less well-known than other renowned reserves, it is of significant ecological significance and has the potential to support conservation and ecological research opportunities.

In addition, the nature reserve has the potential to become an eco-tourism destination, providing a variety of outdoor activities that enable visitors to interact with nature while also contributing to the local economy. These include the exploration of unique flora, wildlife viewing, bird observing, hiking, nature trails, and photography.

With the nature reserve remaining undeveloped. The area is largely inaccessible and lacks infrastructure. Consequently, it will be paramount to improve the safety and accessibility of visitors by enhancing the reserve's infrastructure, which includes roads, signage, and facilities. By promoting eco-friendly accommodations, such as lodges, campsites, or self-catering units, that appeal to tourists seeking a nature-based experience, the reserve's tourism potential could be further developed.

iv. POTLAKE NATURE RESERVE

The Nature Reserve is located in the far northern parts of the Fetakgomo Tubatse Local Municipality and is served by the Platinum Stream tourism corridor (specifically along the R37), making it relatively accessible via the regional road. The reserve is located in close proximity to the town of Driekop. The reserve's geography is defined by a combination of open savannah, wooded areas, and small wetlands, offering diverse habitats for both plant and animal species. The area's rich diversity of flora and fauna is representative of the Limpopo Province's natural ecosystems. Although the reserve is not as large in area, it still plays a crucial role in preserving local biodiversity.

The nature reserve is characterised by natural beauty, diverse wildlife, and recreational opportunities. The reserve holds the potential to become a key eco-tourism destination. The reserve is an ideal location for visitors seeking tranquillity, nature walks, and opportunities to connect with the surrounding landscape. Activities provided include game viewing, bird watching, hiking, exploring natural beauty, and photography.

The following holds opportunities that will ensure the long-term success of the nature reserve. Infrastructure upgrading is important to accommodate more visitors, including improved roads, signage, and visitor facilities. This would help to enhance accessibility and improve the visitor experience.

The development of tourism infrastructure, including accommodation options like overnight lodges within proximity to the district's nature reserves, will encourage longer stays, allowing visitors to explore cultural heritage offerings and social activities throughout the district.

PROMOTE THE EXPANSION AND DIVERSIFICATION OF INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT

In the Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality, industrial development is vital for the enhancement of the overall quality of life, the creation of employment opportunities, and the expansion of the economy. The municipality has the potential to significantly alter its economic landscape by leveraging industrialisation, given its abundance of mineral resources. The local economy can be diversified by expanding mining, manufacturing, and related industries, which will reduce reliance on basic material exports and promote value-added production.

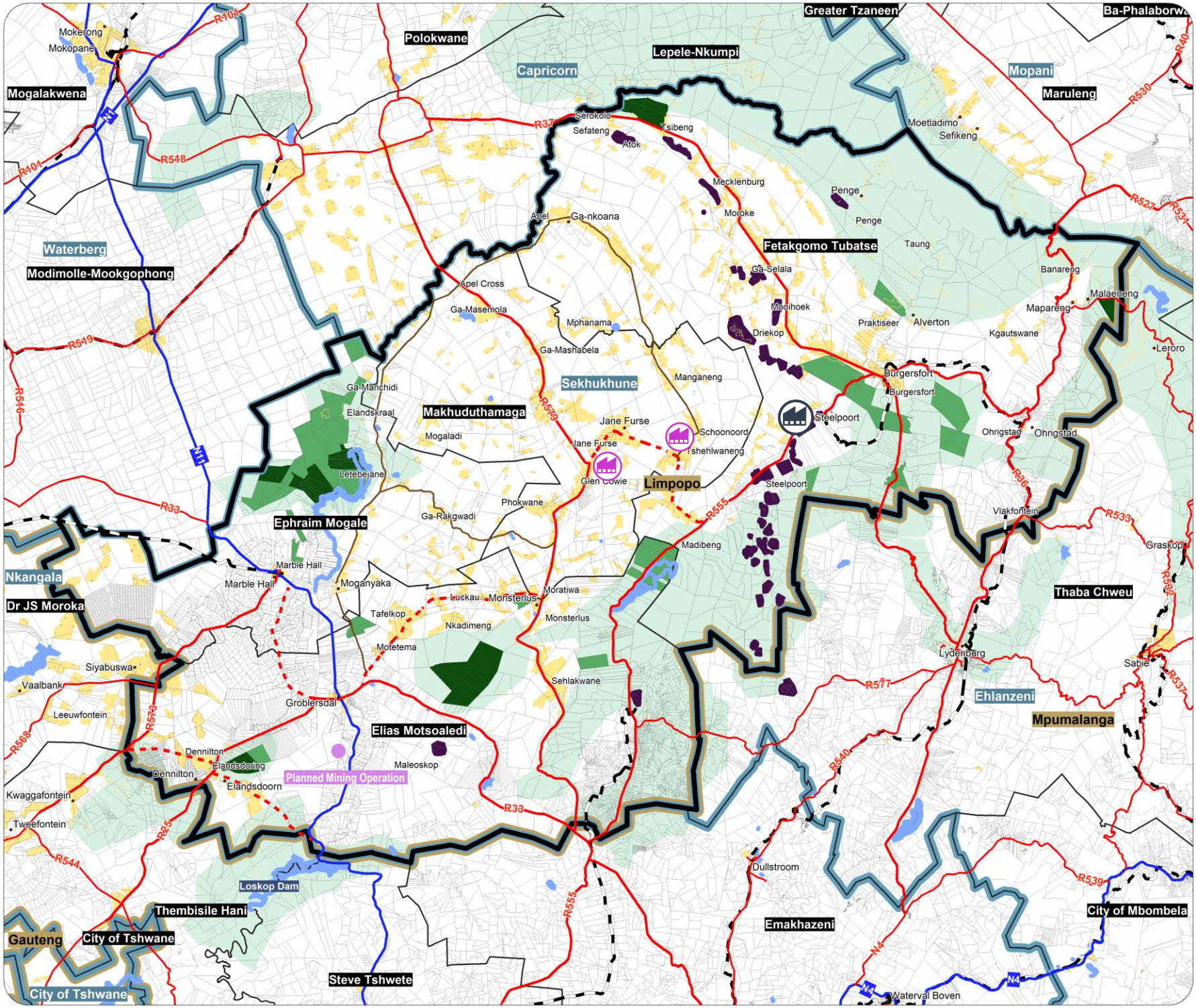
As a means to diversify the stringent mining economy in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality. Refer to **Figure 20**. The development of the Tubatse Special Economic Zone (SEZ) is proposed near Steelpoort along the R555. The proposed SEZ measures approximately 1220 ha and is intended to attract investment into the area, both local and international investors.

Diagram 20.1: Fetakgomo-Tubatse SEZ Conceptual Design

In order to expand economic offerings in the district, advance the economy, alleviate poverty through job creation, capitalise on industries and resources in the region and promote value-adding products from minerals extracted in the region. The conceptual design of the Tubatse SEZ is illustrated in **Diagram 20.1** and **Diagram 20.2,** which depicts the FTSEZ Layout Plan.

The proposed development aims to expand existing mining and manufacturing activities while promoting mineral beneficiation to increase revenue from mineral resources. This initiative seeks to reduce reliance on raw material exports and diversify the local municipality's economic activities. The development will include manufacturing and production operations, such as a platinum refinery, automotive component manufacturing and assembly, warehousing and storage facilities, and processing plants for timber, coal, and pharmaceuticals. Additionally, logistics and distribution services will be integrated to support these industries.

Figure 20: Development Objective 4 Industrial Initiatives



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVE 4 INDUSTRIAL INITIATIVES

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Settlement Pattern
- Ecological Network
- Private Nature Reserve
- Proclaimed Nature Reserve
- Dam
- National Corridor
- Railway Line
- Provincial Corridor
- Provincial Corridor Link
- Strategic Secondary Road

Industrial Proposals

- Mining Activities
- Tubatse SEZ
- Service / Light Industrial Hub

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

Client Contact:
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3 Wes Street
Groblersdal
0470

Tel: 013 262 7300

Diagram 20.2: Proposed Tubatse SEZ Layout PLan

To enhance sustainability and self-sufficiency, the site will incorporate renewable energy solutions, including solar and biomass energy, to power operations within the SEZ.

The following actions towards the establishment of the Fetakgomo-Tubatse SEZ have been achieved;

- Land acquired measuring 1 220ha, and fencing and security personnel have been in place around the perimeter.
- Development of bulk infrastructure, water and sewer treatment plants and reticulation systems.
- An interim board and CEO have been appointed
- An Environmental Impact Application has been granted.
- The municipal tribunal has conditionally approved a township establishment application.
- Skills training and SMME capacitation plans are in place (Supplier activation programmes)
- A quadripartite agreement has already been signed between DTIC, Limpopo, Sekhukhune district, and Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM.

- An Environmental Impact Assessment process is currently underway;
- The application for a Record of Decision (RoD) process has commenced;
- Completion of the SEZ Master Plan (Development Framework) and layout plan. This is inclusive of bulk infrastructure designs and implementation costs;
- Letters of intent from 16 companies to operate within the SEZ;
- Four companies have shown a readiness to commence operation in the SEZ in the short term.

From an investor's perspective, industries establishing operations within the SEZ in the Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality will benefit from four key advantages that maximise returns on investment in the region. These include tax incentives, world-class infrastructure, regulatory flexibility, and investment promotion.

I. Tax Incentives

Investors will benefit from a range of tax incentives, including reduced corporate tax, VAT reliefs, and accelerated depreciation. The reduced corporate tax ensures that companies operating within the SEZ are exempt from paying the full 27% corporate rate, thereby shortening the period required to achieve a return on investment. VAT reliefs provide additional benefits by offering exemptions or near-zero rates on specific imports, thereby reducing operational costs and improving cash flow. Furthermore, accelerated depreciation allows investors to write off assets more quickly and claim higher tax deductions, enabling faster recovery of their initial capital investment.

II. World-Class Infrastructure

World-class infrastructure serves as a major attraction for investors, as it enhances operational efficiency and business performance. Transport infrastructure extends beyond connectivity—it ensures seamless access to key facilities such as ports, airports, and cargo handling centres. A dependable supply of essential utilities, including electricity, water, sewerage, and waste management services, guarantees uninterrupted operations and consistent service delivery.

Additionally, advanced digital connectivity and smart technologies enable investors to operate more efficiently while maintaining strong connections with both local and global markets. The availability of ready-to-use industrial facilities such as factories, serviced land, warehouses, and shared amenities like laboratories, testing centres, and packaging facilities further reduces operational costs by minimising the need for additional investment or outsourcing.

III. Regulatory Flexibility

Distinct from traditional industrial parks, investors in the SEZ benefit from efficient administrative processes, including faster licensing approvals and simplified customs clearance at borders and ports. This efficiency extends to project or facility expansions, ensuring that investors can begin operations or scale up with minimal delays.

IV. Investment Promotion

Investors will benefit from free marketing and advertising on both the local and global levels when the government promotes the SEZ at international trade fairs, expos, and trade-related gatherings. This increases investor credibility and recognition. Investors also benefit from government support in terms of tax breaks, networking opportunities, and expanded operations, as the government opens channels for investors to network with local suppliers, SMMEs, and other institutions.

In accordance with the proposed Fetakgomo-Tubatse SEZ development and the distinct industrialisation model planned linked to the mining industry, the following skill sets are expected to be required for the operation and servicing of the zone, as illustrated in **Diagram 20.3.**

Diagram 20.3: Proposed Required Skills in the FTSEZ

Source: Limpopo Development Plan, 2025-2023

In addition to supporting economic diversification and driving economic development in the region, nodal precinct plans have earmarked strategic sites for commercial and industrial development in Jane Furse, Phokwane, and Schoonoord. These locations are designed to cater to the growing population in the central part of the district, with the goal of stimulating employment and economic growth through the development of well-planned, integrated commercial and industrial zones.

4.2.5. Development Objective 5: Human Settlement and Spatial Transformation

The District Municipality is primarily characterised by numerous rural communities or low-density settlement areas that are widely scattered across vast distances, making them difficult to reach and connect. The lack of spatial integration in the region presents significant challenges in terms of developing cohesive infrastructure and providing basic services.

The dispersed nature of these communities necessitates effective settlement planning that considers the geographical challenges and diverse needs of each area. With that, the fundamental objective is that human settlement development in the region fosters spatial integration and transformation, promotes adequate provision of social services, and ensures an efficient transport network connecting rural settlements with the expectation of drawing in public transport services. As illustrated in **Figure 21**, the Strategic Development Areas (SDAs) are intended to integrate communities near key economic nodes and along main roads to advance region-wide, spatially integrated human settlements.

The following highlights essential strategies to enhance human settlements, focusing on creating sustainable, integrated communities with improved living conditions and access to critical services and opportunities.

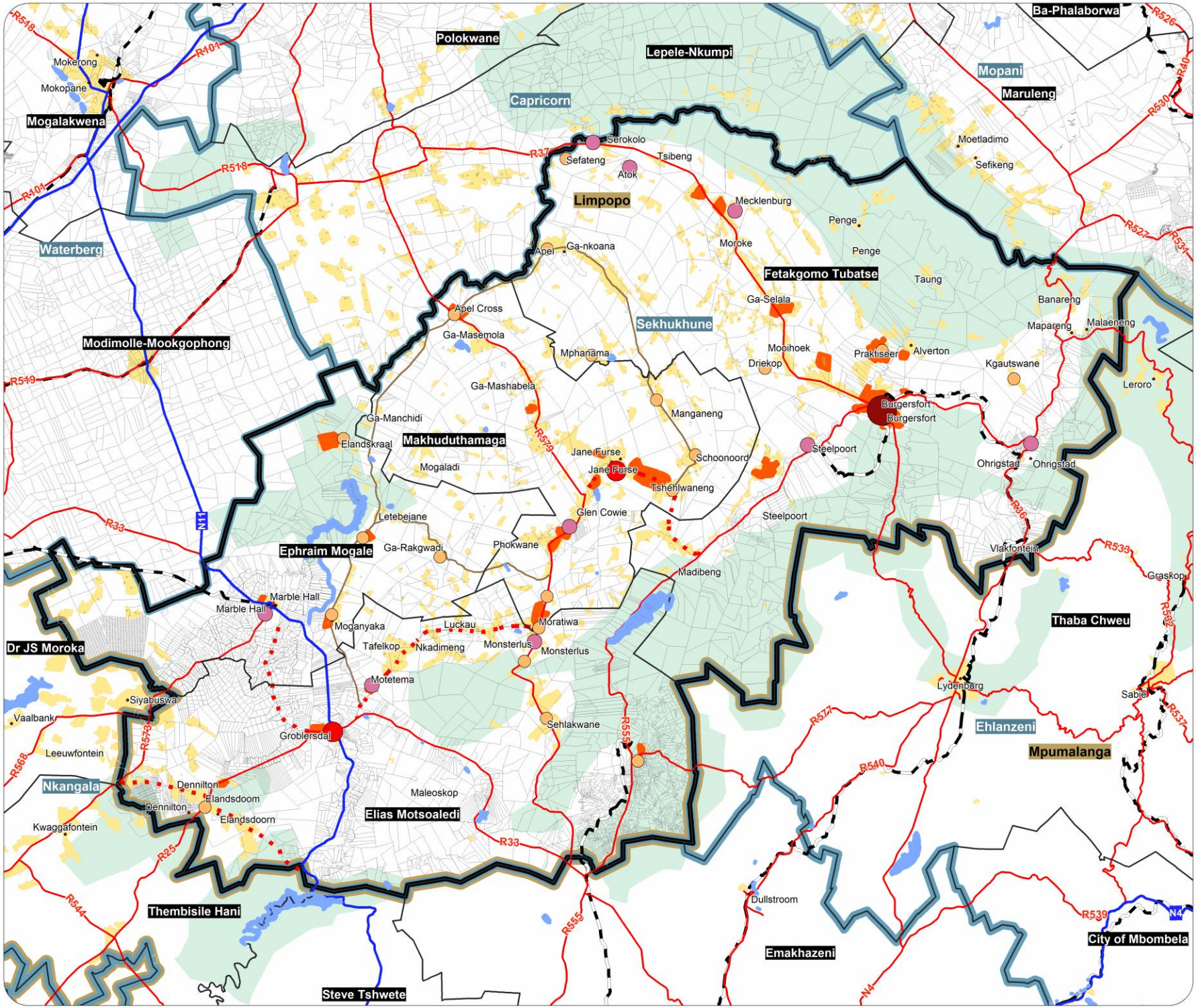
Encourage the development of integrated human settlements, ensuring that well-planned, interconnected communities promote long-term economic, social, and environmental benefits.

- Develop comprehensive strategic planning frameworks that address housing, infrastructure, services, and environmental considerations simultaneously. This ensures that all aspects of the community are well-integrated and that there is no delay or segregation of essential services.
- Engage various stakeholders, including various spheres of government departments and local municipalities, traditional authorities, and local communities in the planning process. This collaborative approach ensures that development is aligned with the needs of the people and the region's broader objectives.
- By providing access to essential services like healthcare, education, and social amenities, integrated settlements enhance the overall quality of life for residents.
- Compact, well-planned communities reduce urban sprawl, with services and job opportunities being more accessible.
- Discourage the establishment of fragmented towns that rely completely on local industries such as mining, energy, manufacturing, construction, and agriculture without long-term economic alternatives.

Promote infill development and the identification of Strategic Development Areas (SDAs) for human settlement

- Infill development and identifying strategic SDA areas foster well-connected neighbourhoods, thus reducing the need for extensive new land developments;
- Leverages on existing road infrastructure, and bulk infrastructure, reducing the need for costly new infrastructure, reducing the need for costly new infrastructure;

Figure 21: Development Objective 5 Human Settlement



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DEVELOPMENT OBJECTIVE 5 HUMAN SETTLEMENT

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Settlement Pattern
- Strategic Development Areas (SDA)
- Provincial Growth Point
- Regional development Anchor
- Local Service Centre
- Rural Service Centre
- Ecological Network
- Dam
- National Corridor
- Provincial Corridor
- Provincial Corridor Link
- Strategic Secondary Road
- Railway Line

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- The impact of infill development helps revitalise underdeveloped neighbourhoods, thus reinjecting economic growth in settlement areas, improving property values and maximising the land that was allocated for development.

Enhance rural tenure security and facilitate title restoration through lease agreements, the Permission to Occupy Certificate

- Advocating for secure land tenure encourages communities to invest in their land, leading to better agricultural practices, improved infrastructure, and overall economic development in rural areas;
- Fosters a sense of security and social cohesion, as it empowers marginalised groups;
- Secure land tenure encourages long-term land stewardship, where emerging farmers are more likely to invest in farming techniques and long-term crops, leading to more stable food production and improved food security;
- Housing developments in the District should offer diverse tenure alternatives to ensure equal access and enable all income groups to dwell inside them;
- Safeguard culturally significant lands, ensuring that communities retain control over ancestral territories and maintain traditional practices, customs, and values associated with the land.

Projected Housing Demand

This section highlights projected housing demand by municipality, alongside projected population growth. As shown, the projected housing demand takes into account the income bracket and, accordingly, is associated with the type of housing typology and expected demand.

Across all local municipalities, it is evident that the highest number of housing units in demand throughout the 10years is largely fully subsidised housing units (Breaking New Ground), followed by partially subsidised housing units, either FLISP or GAP housing, and affordable housing. As depicted in **Diagrams 22-25**, Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM is expected to experience the highest demand for housing, with fully subsidised housing projected at 17 550 units across both bonded and rental ownership options by 2030. This demand is anticipated to nearly double by 2035, reaching approximately 29 543 units. Notably, bonded housing is expected to be in greater demand than rental housing.

Followed by Elias Motsoaledi LM with the second projected housing demand in fully subsidised housing, roughly 7 357 units in 2023 for bonded and rental, and approx. 12 212 units in 2035. Makhuduthamaga LM although projected to have the highest population increase when compared with the Elias Motsoaledi LM, is anticipated to require approximately 5 098 units in 2030 of the same housing category (rental and ownership), and in 2035 is expected to increase to approx. 8 280 units. This is largely due to Makhuduthamaga LM being predominantly rural, with most land under the control of traditional tribal authorities. As a result, residents typically construct their own homes rather than relying on formal housing developments.

Ephraim Mogale LM is expected to have the lowest housing demand.

The requirement for partially subsidised housing is highest in Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM (18 679 units) in 2035, followed by the Elias Motsoaledi LM (6 658 housing units), and the least in Makhuduthamaga LM and Ephraim Mogale LM.

Diagram 22 – Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM – Housing Demand (2026-2035)

DEMAND					
Typology		Price	2026	2030	2035
Bonded					
Fully Subsidised Housing - Breaking New Ground (BNG)	D Zero	<± R39,999	2 974	9 784	16 471
	D Low	Approx. R40,000 - R109,999	2 380	7 830	13 180
Partially Subsidised Housing (FLISP/GAP)	D	Approx. R110,000 - R399,999	1 880	6 186	10 414
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R400,000 - R700,000	481	1 584	2 666
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R700,000 - R1,300,000	282	928	1 562
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R1,300,000 - R2,500,000	125	410	690
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R2,500,000 - R5,000,000	27	88	148
Luxury	A++	More than R5,000,000	18	59	99
Bonded Total			**8 167**	**26 869**	**45 229**
Rental					
Fully Subsidised Housing - Community Rental Units (CRU)	D Zero	<±R300 per month	2 360	7 766	13 073
	D Low	Approx. R300 - R900 per month	1 889	6 214	10 461
Partially Subsidised Housing (Social Housing)	D	Approx. R900 - R3,000 per month	1 492	4 910	8 266
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R3,000 - R5,000 per month	382	1 257	2 116
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R5,000 - R10,000 per month	224	736	1 239
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R10,000 - R20,000 per month	99	325	548
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R20,000 - R40,000 per month	21	70	117
Luxury	A++	More than R40,000 per month	14	47	78
Rental Total			**6 482**	**21 326**	**35 899**
Total					
Fully Subsidised Housing	D Zero	<± R39,999	5 334	17 550	29 543
	D Low	Approx. R40,000 - R109,999	4 269	14 044	23 641
Partially Subsidised Housing	D	Approx. R110,000 - R399,999	3 373	11 097	18 679
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R400,000 - R700,000	863	2 841	4 782
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R700,000 - R1,300,000	506	1 664	2 801
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R1,300,000 - R2,500,000	224	735	1 238
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R2,500,000 - R5,000,000	48	158	265
Luxury	A++	More than R5,000,000	32	105	177
Total			**14 648**	**48 194**	**81 128**

Diagram 23: Makhuduthamaga LM – Housing Demand (2026-2035)

DEMAND					
Typology		Price	2026	2030	2035
Bonded					
Fully Subsidised Housing - Breaking New Ground (BNG)	D Zero	<± R39,999	1 209	3 816	6 198
	D Low	Approx. R40,000 - R109,999	1 182	3 730	6 058
Partially Subsidised Housing (FLISP/GAP)	D	Approx. R110,000 - R399,999	524	1 654	2 685
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R400,000 - R700,000	99	314	510
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R700,000 - R1,300,000	70	223	361
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R1,300,000 - R2,500,000	28	88	142
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R2,500,000 - R5,000,000	5	17	27
Luxury	A++	More than R5,000,000	5	17	27
Bonded Total			**3 123**	**9 858**	**16 009**
Rental					
Fully Subsidised Housing - Community Rental Units (CRU)	D Zero	<±R300 per month	406	1 282	2 082
	D Low	Approx. R300 - R900 per month	397	1 253	2 034
Partially Subsidised Housing (Social Housing)	D	Approx. R900 - R3,000 per month	176	555	902
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R3,000 - R5,000 per month	33	105	171
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R5,000 - R10,000 per month	24	75	121
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R10,000 - R20,000 per month	9	29	48
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R20,000 - R40,000 per month	2	6	9
Luxury	A++	More than R40,000 per month	2	6	9
Rental Total			**1 049**	**3 311**	**5 377**
Total					
Fully Subsidised Housing	D Zero	<± R39,999	1 615	5 098	8 280
	D Low	Approx. R40,000 - R109,999	1 578	4 983	8 092
Partially Subsidised Housing	D	Approx. R110,000 - R399,999	700	2 209	3 587
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R400,000 - R700,000	133	419	681
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R700,000 - R1,300,000	94	297	483
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R1,300,000 - R2,500,000	37	117	190
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R2,500,000 - R5,000,000	7	23	37
Luxury	A++	More than R5,000,000	7	23	37
Total			**4 171**	**13 168**	**21 386**

Diagram 24: Elias Motsoaledi LM – Housing Demand (2026-2035)

DEMAND					
Typology		Price	2026	2030	2035
Bonded					
Fully Subsidised Housing - Breaking New Ground (BNG)	D Zero	<± R39,999	1 388	4 492	7 456
	D Low	Approx. R40,000 - R109,999	1 457	4 716	7 828
Partially Subsidised Housing (FLISP/GAP)	D	Approx. R110,000 - R399,999	757	2 449	4 066
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R400,000 - R700,000	147	475	788
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R700,000 - R1,300,000	104	335	556
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R1,300,000 - R2,500,000	50	163	271
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R2,500,000 - R5,000,000	11	34	57
Luxury	A++	More than R5,000,000	8	25	41
Bonded Total			3 920	12 690	21 064
Rental					
Fully Subsidised Housing - Community Rental Units (CRU)	D Zero	<±R300 per month	885	2 865	4 755
	D Low	Approx. R300 - R900 per month	929	3 008	4 992
Partially Subsidised Housing (Social Housing)	D	Approx. R900 - R3,000 per month	482	1 562	2 593
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R3,000 - R5,000 per month	94	303	503
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R5,000 - R10,000 per month	66	214	355
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R10,000 - R20,000 per month	32	104	173
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R20,000 - R40,000 per month	7	22	36
Luxury	A++	More than R40,000 per month	5	16	26
Rental Total			2 500	8 093	13 432
Total					
Fully Subsidised Housing	D Zero	<± R39,999	2 272	7 357	12 212
	D Low	Approx. R40,000 - R109,999	2 386	7 724	12 821
Partially Subsidised Housing	D	Approx. R110,000 - R399,999	1 239	4 011	6 658
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R400,000 - R700,000	240	778	1 291
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R700,000 - R1,300,000	170	549	911
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R1,300,000 - R2,500,000	83	267	444
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R2,500,000 - R5,000,000	17	56	93
Luxury	A++	More than R5,000,000	12	40	67
Total			6 419	20 782	34 496

Diagram 25: Ephraim Mogale LM – Housing Demand (2026-2035)

DEMAND					
Typology		Price	2026	2030	2035
Bonded					
Fully Subsidised Housing - Breaking New Ground (BNG)	D Zero	<± R39,999	122	373	702
	D Low	Approx. R40,000 - R109,999	130	397	745
Partially Subsidised Housing (FLISP/GAP)	D	Approx. R110,000 - R399,999	55	169	318
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R400,000 - R700,000	10	30	57
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R700,000 - R1,300,000	7	22	41
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R1,300,000 - R2,500,000	3	9	17
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R2,500,000 - R5,000,000	1	2	4
Luxury	A++	More than R5,000,000	1	3	5
Bonded Total			328	1 005	1 889
Rental					
Fully Subsidised Housing - Community Rental Units (CRU)	D Zero	<±R300 per month	222	685	1 093
	D Low	Approx. R300 - R900 per month	236	728	1 161
Partially Subsidised Housing (Social Housing)	D	Approx. R900 - R3,000 per month	101	311	496
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R3,000 - R5,000 per month	18	55	88
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R5,000 - R10,000 per month	13	40	63
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R10,000 - R20,000 per month	5	17	27
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R20,000 - R40,000 per month	1	4	7
Luxury	A++	More than R40,000 per month	2	5	8
Rental Total			597	1 845	2 943
Total					
Fully Subsidised Housing	D Zero	<± R39,999	344	1 059	1 795
	D Low	Approx. R40,000 - R109,999	365	1 125	1 906
Partially Subsidised Housing	D	Approx. R110,000 - R399,999	156	480	814
Affordable Market	C	Approx. R400,000 - R700,000	28	86	145
Low Middle Income Market	B	Approx. R700,000 - R1,300,000	20	61	104
High Middle Income Market	A	Approx. R1,300,000 - R2,500,000	8	26	44
Up-Market	A+	Approx. R2,500,000 - R5,000,000	2	6	11
Luxury	A++	More than R5,000,000	2	8	13
Total			926	2 850	4 832

Notably, Up-market housing and Luxury housing are in the least demand and thus favourable in the district municipality. These types of housing are characterised by estates, upmarket townhouses, villas and penthouses, which are most appropriate for larger towns, nature reserves and tourism areas. With that, Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM illustrates the highest demand in high-end housing types, approximately 442 units (Up-Market and Luxury housing) anticipated in 2035, followed by Elias Motsoaledi LM with approximately 160 Up-market and luxury housing.

Planned Housing

Informal settlements can be found in various areas of the region, notably in Burgersfort and Groblersdal, primarily on the outskirts of these towns.

In terms of significant human settlement expansion, Phokwane and Jane Furse incur significant growth patterns. Phokwane, in particular, has been recognised at the national level as one of the key human settlement catalytic projects, with additional provincial housing initiatives planned for the area. The table below outlines housing projects earmarked within the Fetakgomo-Tubatse Local Municipality. Notably, several projects are only partially implemented, while others remain unimplemented due to the need for bulk infrastructure upgrades.

Table 6.1: Fetakgomo_Tubatse Planned Housing Projects

Local Municipality	Township Name	Residential 2	Residential 2	Residential 3	Business	Industrial	Educational/ Institutional	Open Space
Fetakgomo-Tubatse LM	Steelpoort Ext 13	133 Units	-	503 Units	Business 1 (3 Shopping Centres)	-	1 Educational + 1 Hospital	6 Private Open Spaces
	Steelpoort Ext 15	404 Units	1248 Units	-	-	-	-	4 Private Open Spaces
	Steelpoort Ext 16	224 Units	-	-	Resort	-	-	3 Private Open Spaces
	Burgersfort Ext 95	-	-	-	Business 1 (21 Spaces)	Industrial 1 (11 spaces)	-	2 Private Open spaces
	Steelpoortsdrift 296 KT	1620 Units	-	16 Units	Business 1 (6 Spaces)	-	2 Educational	13 Public Open Spaces
	Steelpoort Ext 24	-	-	-	Business 3 (52 Spaces)	Industrial 1 (91Spaces) Industrial (31 Spaces)	-	11 Public Open Spaces
	Burgersfort Ext 61	157 Units	2 Units	-	Business 2 (15 Spaces)	Industrial 2 (3)	-	6 Public Open Spaces & 1 Private
	Tubatse Ext 1	1032 Units	-	13 Units	Business 1 (3 Retail/Shops)		2 Primary Schools	3 Public Open Spaces
	Tubatse B Ext 1	1057 Units	-	13 Units	Business 1 (3 Spaces)		2 Educational	2 Public Open Spaces
	Apies Townships	2 988 Units						
	Tubatse B Ext 2	288 Units	-	3 Units	Business 1 (4 Spaces)	-	-	1 Public Open Spaces
	Tubatse B Ext 3	280 Units	-	6 Units	Business 1 (10 Retail/Shops)	-	1 Combined School	-
	Tubatse B Ext 4	452 Units	-	2 Units	-	-	1 Creche	1 Public Open Space
	Tubatse B Ext 5	467 Units	-	62 Units	Business 1 (6 Retail/Shops)	-	1 Creche	-
	Tubatse B Ext 6	12 Units	-	-	Business 1 (6 Retail/Shops)	-	1 Community Facility	-
	Tubatse B Ext 7	1028 Units	-	18 Units	Business 1 (11 Retail/Shops)	-	2 Primary School	-
	Tubatse B Ext 8	854 Units	-	22 Units	Business 1 (11 Retail/Shops)	-	2 Creche	1 Public Open Space

In Makhuduthamaga Local Municipality, several new housing settlements have been approved (refer to the table below), with most intended as expansion areas of adjacent rural settlement areas. However, many of these planned residential expansions remain undeveloped. This lack of implementation is largely attributed to insufficient bulk infrastructure capacity, which restricts the delivery of adequate living conditions for the affected communities.

Table 6.2: Makhuduthamaga LM Planned Housing Projects

Local Municipality	Township Name	Residential 1	Residential 2	Residential 3
Makhuduthamaga LM	Thabampshe North	189 Units		
	Ga-Masemola	509 Units		
	Moji	1 030 Units		
	Mamatsekele	208 Units		
	Sehuswane	198 Units		
	Hopefield-Sehuswane	266 Units		
	Hopefield-Semahlakole	+297 Units		
	Ga-Mampane	331 Units		
	Kome Village	297 Units		
	Mathapisa	269 Units		
	Ga-Maboke	238 Units		
	Kgaruthuthu Ext 1	329 Units		
	Diphagane	+394 Units		
	Jane Furse Ext 1	Large Vacant		
	Mohlwarekoma	+299 Units		
	Thoto	240 Units		
	Ntoane	280 Units		
	Maila Segolo	365 Units		
	Gamaila-Segolo	167 Units		

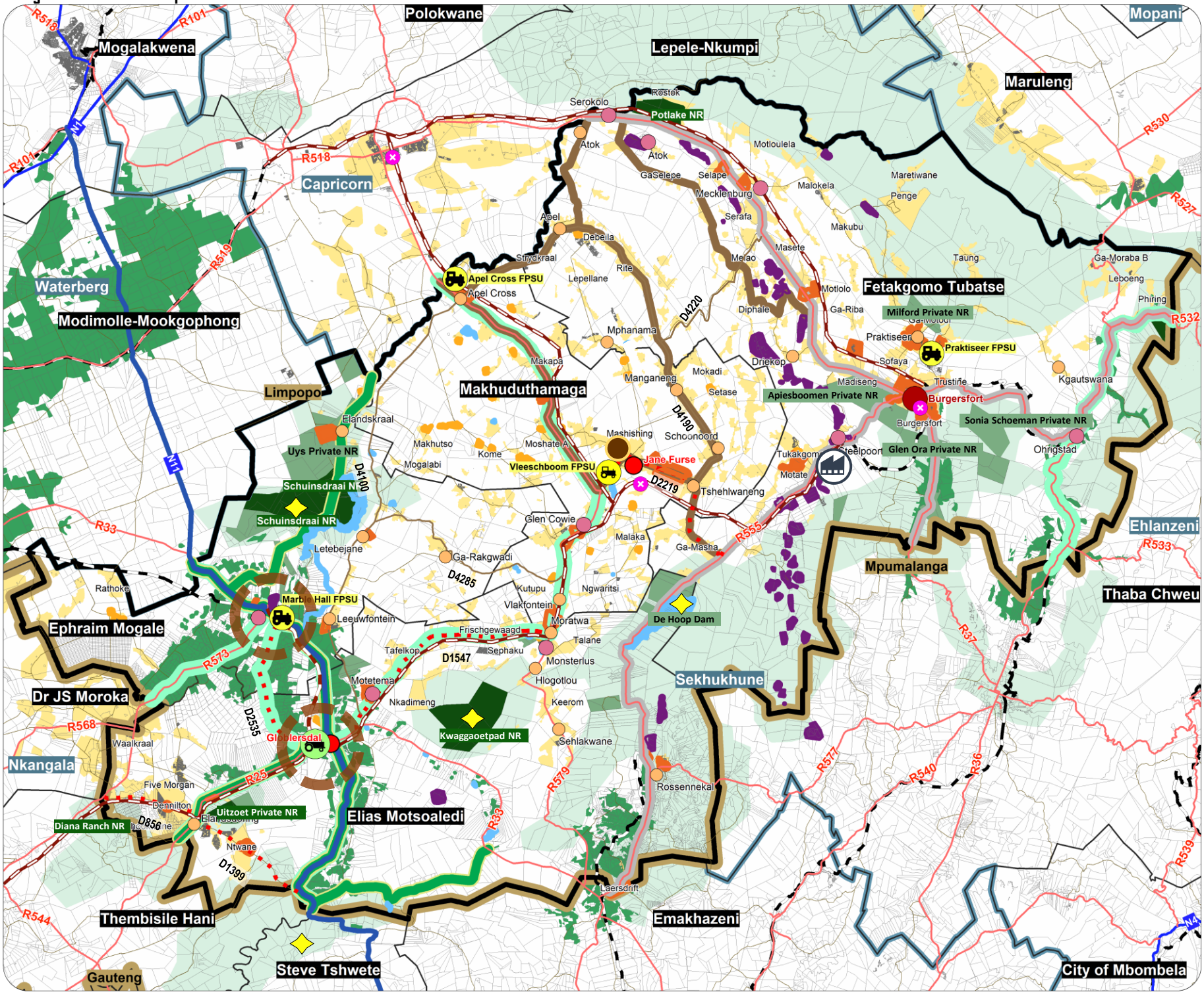
Within the Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality, the Human Development Agency (HDA), in collaboration with the Limpopo Department of Cooperative Governance, is supporting the municipality in demarcating sites for human settlements. This includes Portion 14 of the Farm Welverdiend 24 JS. Furthermore, the municipality, with the assistance of HDA, is planning to formalise the informal settlement on Erf 677 Motetema A, as referred to in **Table 6.3** below.

Table 6.3: Elias Motsoaledi LM Planned Housing Projects

Local Municipality	Township Name	Residential 1	Residential 2	Residential 3
Elias Motsoaledi LM	Erf 677 Motetema A	Unknown		
	Welverdiend 24 JS	Unknown		
	Walkraal Ext 1	Unknown		
	Walkraal Ext 3	Unknown		

Figure 22 illustrates the Sekhukhune SDF Composite map, depicting all spatial elements of the municipal spatial plans.

Figure 22: District Composite SDF



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

DISTRICT COMPOSITE SDF

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Settlement Pattern
- Ecological Network
- Protected Nature Reserves
- Private Nature Reserves
- Commercial Agriculture
- Mining Activity
- Dam
- National Corridor
- Provincial Corridor
- Strategic Secondary Road
- Railway Line

Development Proposals

- Strategic Development Areas (SDA)
- Provincial Growth Point
- Regional development Anchor
- Local Service Centre
- Rural Service Centre
- Provincial Corridor Link
- Proposed Railway Line
- Proposed Railway Terminals
- Tubatse SEZ
- Regional Government Precinct
- Agricultural Corridors
- Sekhukhune Agri-Park
- FPSU
- Agricultural Gateway
- Platinum Stream Tourism Route
- Mafulo a Matala Tourism Route
- Marota Tourism Route
- Tourism Anchors

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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SEKHUKHUNE
DISTRICT MUNICIPALITY

SECTION FIVE

IMPLEMENTATION

5. IMPLEMENTATION FRAMEWORK

The following section presents the implementation plan, highlighting the Capital Investment Framework, district-wide projects, the associated prioritisation phase, and the estimated project costs.

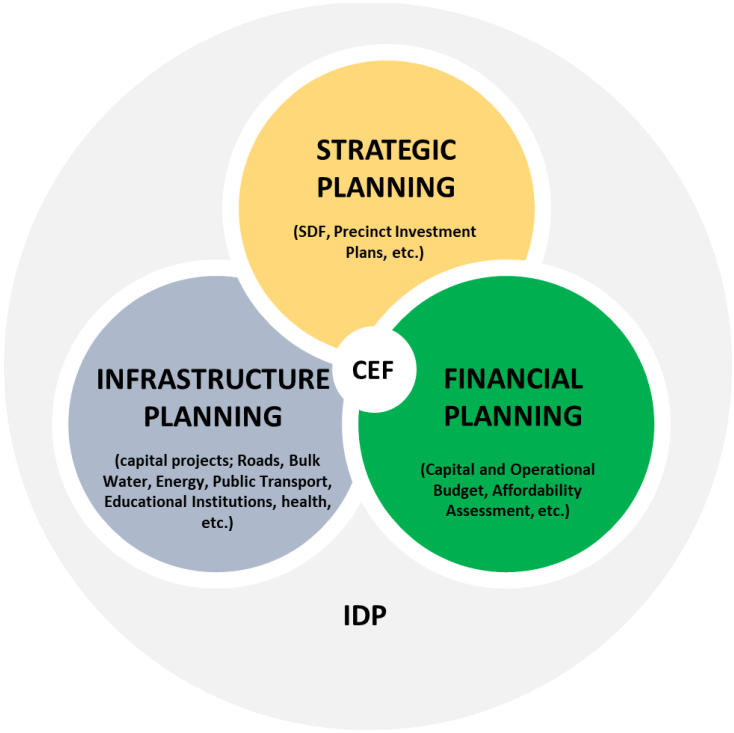
The Capital Expenditure Framework aims to spatially link the Municipality's development strategies with its budget, based on existing and future infrastructure backlogs, demands, and the affordability envelope outlined in the Long-Term Financial Plan.

5.1. LEGISLATIVE REQUIREMENTS:

The Spatial Planning and Land Use Management Act 16 of 2013 requires that municipal spatial development frameworks determine a capital expenditure framework (CEF) for the municipality's development programmes, depicted spatially. SPLUMA does not elaborate on the content or purpose of a capital expenditure framework or distinguish between the focus of such a CEF in district versus local municipal SDFs. With that, the 'Capital Expenditure Framework' is introduced in the Spatial Planning and Land Use Management Act of 2013 (SPLUMA) in section 21, where it states that a Capital Expenditure Framework is to be devised for the municipality's development programmes. **Diagram 21** indicates three critical foundations upon which the CEF is framed.

Furthermore, the Local Government: Municipal Planning and Performance Management Regulations (2001) require that an SDF set out a Capital Investment Framework for the municipality's development program.

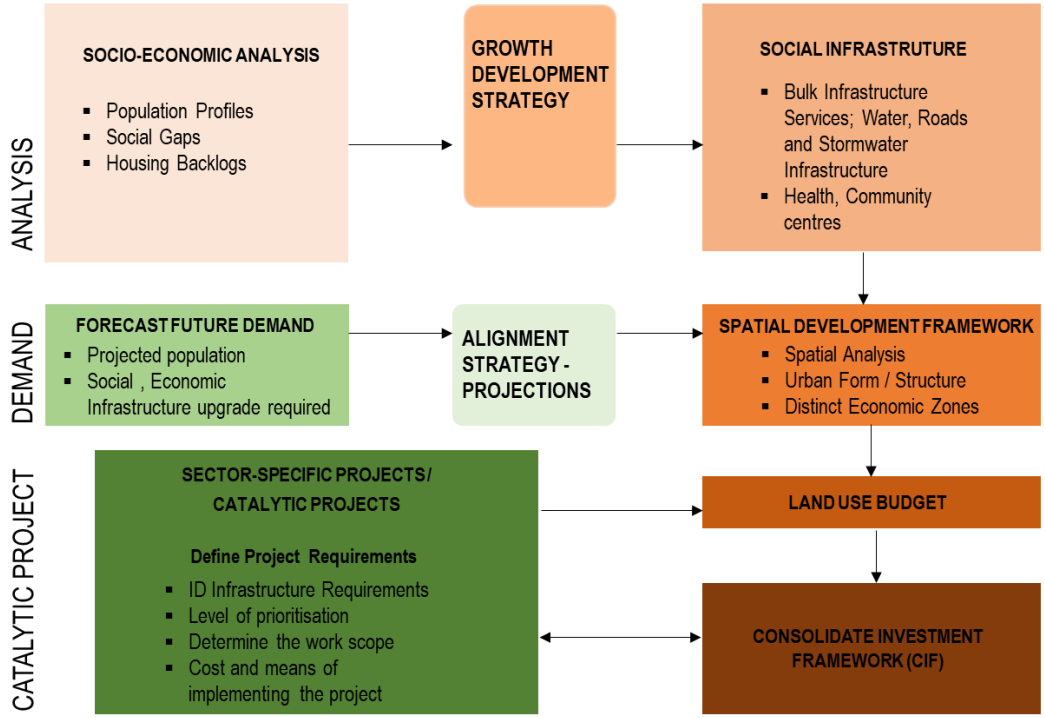
Diagram 21: Inter-relationship of Capital Expenditure Framework (CEF)



5.2. SPATIAL ALIGNMENT TO CAPITAL INVESTMENT FRAMEWORK

The investment framework supports this Spatial Development Framework (SDF) on two interrelated components. First, it proposes a foundation for a Capital Investment Framework intended to guide and align infrastructure spending with the district's spatial vision. Complementing the implementation agenda to become strategic, actionable projects. In outlining key interventions across policy, institutional, and identified projects. Each action is briefly described, linked to a responsible agency, assigned an indicative timeframe, and associated with preliminary budget estimates. Together, these elements provide a pathway for moving from planning to execution, ensuring coordinated and practical implementation efforts support the district's spatial ambitions.

Diagram 26: Spatial Alignment with CIF



The following outlines the stages required when compiling a CIF which is aligned to spatial development. The identification and definition of infrastructure requirements form a critical foundation of the Capital Investment Framework (CIF). These requirements serve as strategic enablers of spatial development, enhance service delivery, and support sustainable economic growth. This section outlines the methodology and approach used to determine infrastructure needs within the district, laying the groundwork for targeted and coordinated investment planning.

Conduct Analysis

The process of identifying infrastructure needs began with a comprehensive assessment of the existing infrastructure base across the district. This assessment focused on:

- Reviewing the current infrastructure's capacity to influence societal well-being and stimulate economic activity.
- Determining infrastructure performance levels, identifying capacity constraints, and establishing requirements for maintenance or upgrading.
- Highlighting gaps, especially in underserved rural communities and informal settlements, where access to basic services remains limited

Alignment with Spatial Development Priorities

Infrastructure requirements were aligned with the spatial vision and development priorities outlined in the approved Spatial Development Framework (SDF). Key focus areas include:

- Areas identified for concentrated growth and investment.
- Locations earmarked for population growth, housing delivery, and economic activities such as mining, agriculture, and tourism.
- Areas requiring spatial transformation to redress historical inequalities and promote inclusive development.

Forecasting Future Demand and Infrastructure Requirements

This is to inform long-term planning, future infrastructure demands were projected based on various growth and development trends, to ensure adequate capacity of the infrastructure is calculated and considered in the financial plan. They include aspects such as population growth, migration patterns, planned housing, and social and economic developments.

These projections enable the identification of "trigger points" that signal when infrastructure upgrades or expansions will become necessary to support growth. Infrastructure needs have been categorised by sector, with key priorities identified as follows:

- Identify the type of project
- Project capacity/extent
- Level of prioritisation

Catalytic and Strategic Infrastructure Projects

Several infrastructure projects have been identified for their potential to act as catalysts for development, unlocking broader spatial and economic opportunities. These include:

- Strategic Regional Road Infrastructure that will unblock further development;
- Water Infrastructure project, such as irrigation, agricultural productivity, and rural livelihoods;
- Energy Infrastructure project that will facilitate industrial development and unlock growth in mining and related sectors.

  These investments are expected to play a pivotal role in stimulating local economic activity, attracting further investment, and improving the quality of life across the district.

5.3. DISTRICT SDF PROJECT LIST

The District Implementation Framework sets out the key actions and interventions required across all government institutions to achieve the spatial objectives and realise the envisioned spatial patterns outlined in the District Spatial Development Framework (SDF). It serves as a guiding tool to ensure that strategic planning, budgeting, and public-sector infrastructure investments are aligned with the district's spatial development priorities. Effective implementation depends on coordinated efforts across all spheres of government, fostering integrated development and long-term spatial transformation. **Figure 22** depicts the composite District Spatial Development Framework plan.

The table below depicts a list of projects for the District Municipality to improve infrastructure provision and drive economic growth, thereby ensuring long-term viability.

These projects are further categorised by priority, from high to low, based on their potential to stimulate economic growth and improve community livelihoods. **Figures 23.1** and **23.2** display the spatial representation of projects listed below.

Table 10.1: Project List

	PROJECT NAME	RESPONSIBILITY	PRIORITY			LEVEL OF PRIORITISATION	ESTIMATED PROJECT COST
			Short-Term (1-3Years)	Medium-Term (4-6 Years)	Long-Term (7-10 years)		
1.	**DO 1: PRESERVATION OF THE NATURAL ENVIRONMENT AND ECOLOGICAL NETWORK**						
1.1	Implement CBA Guidelines in all land use applications	SDM / Local Municipalities				Medium	In House
1.2	Establishment of District Environmental Management Unit/ Office	SDM				Low	In House
1.3	Compilation of a Detailed District Environmental Management Framework (EMF) and Plan (EMP) incorporating District SDF proposals	SDM				Medium	R800 000,00
1.4	Coordination between the District and Province to ensure that existing Critical Biodiversity Areas, Reserves and Conservancies are consolidated and protected	SDM				Low	In House / Operational
1.5	Delineate and identify high-potential agricultural land in the Sekhukhune Environmental Management Framework to ensure its protection thereof	SDM				Medium	In House
1.6	Environmental Awareness Campaigns to Local Communities on Water and Environmental Conservation	SDM / Local Municipalities				Medium	In House
1.7.	Conduct a detailed Feasibility and Implementation of Climate-Change Mitigation and Adaptation Measures	SDM / Local Municipalities				High	To Be Determined

	PROJECT NAME	RESPONSIBILITY	IMPLEMENTATION TIMEFRAME			LEVEL OF PRIORITISATION	ESTIMATED PROJECT COST
			Short-Term (1-3 Years)	Medium-Term (4-6 Years)	Long-Term (7-10 Years)		
2.	**DO 2: NODAL HIERARCHY AND ENSURING SPATIAL INTEGRATION**						
2.1	Development of the Nodal Precinct Plans for Groblersdal, Marble Hall, and Burgersfort CBD-Steelpoort (per precinct)	SDM / Local Municipalities				Medium	R1 000 000,00
2.2	Implementation of ICT Infrastructure in Thusong Centres	SDM / Local Municipalities				Medium	To Be Determined
2.3	Development of the Jane Furse Hospital	Provincial Dept. of Health				-	R200 000,00
2.4	Design and Construct the Jane Furse Government Precinct	Dept. of Public Works				High	To Be Determined
2.5	Development of the Jane Furse Waste Water Treatment Plant	National and Provincial Dept of Water and Sanitation				High	R100 000 000,00
2.6	Revitalisation Tompi-Seleka College of Agriculture	Dept of Higher Education and Training				=	To Be Determined
2.7	Develop a Database for Informal Traders in the SDM	SDM / Local Municipalities				Medium	In House
2.8	Formalise Informal Traders (in nodal areas)	SDM / Local Municipalities				Medium	To Be Determined
2.9	Review of the Local Municipal Spatial Development Frameworks	SDM / Local Municipalities				High	R1 500 000,00 (Per Local Municipality)
2.10	Development of an Urban and/or Rural regeneration Master Plan for 1. Makhuduthamaga Local Municipality (1st Priority) 2. Fetakgomo Tubatse Local Municipality (2nd Priority) 3. Elias Motsoaledi Local Municipality (3rd Priority) 4. Ephraim Mogale Local Municipality (3rd Priority)	SDM				High Medium Low Low	R4 000 000.00 (Per Local Municipality)
2.11	Development of the Makhuduthamaga Infrastructure Master Plan	SDM				High	R4 000 000.00
2.12	Development of a Precinct Plan and Township Establishment for De Hoop Dam	SDM/SDA				High	R3 000 000.00
2.13	Township Establishment for Government Officials at Vergelegen in support of the Government Office precinct in Jane Furse	SDM/ Makhuduthamaga Local Municipality				High	R1 500 000.00
3.	**DO 3: ENHANCING MOVEMENT NETWORKS AND INFRASTRUCTURE**						
3.1	Upgrade and ensure maintenance of the N11 into a dual-carriage way (approx. 68km).	SANRAL				Medium	R413 000 000,00
3.2	Pot-hole and resurface maintenance of route R25 between Elandsdoring and route D2535 (approx. 26km).	National Road Agency/ Provincial Department of Roads and Transport				High	R50 000 000,00
3.3	Pot-hole and resurface maintenance of route D2535 (approx. 23,9km).	Provincial Department of Roads and Transport/ SDM/ Local Municipalities				Medium	R47 800 000,00

3.4	Widening and maintenance of route D1547 between the intersection of R33 and D1547 to Moratwa (approx. 38,7km).	Provincial Department of Roads and Transport / SDM / Local Municipalities				High	R139 320 000,00
3.5	Intrusive road maintenance along route R555 between the intersection R37 and R555, and convergence of R33 and R555 (approx. 108,8km).	Provincial Department of Roads and Transport/ SDM / Mining Houses				High	R218 600 000,00
3.6	Pot-hole and resurface maintenance of route D1399 (approx. 14,5km).	Provincial Department of Roads and Transport / SDM / Local Municipalities				Medium	R46 440 000,00
3.7	Rail Upgrades and maintenance of the rail line through Steelpoort, Burgersfort and Ohgristad.	Transnet				Medium	To Be Determined
3.8	Operationalise Pienaarspoort-Marble Hall rail line (and possibly extension to Groblersdal)	Transnet				Medium	To Be Determined
3.9	Feasibility Assessment and construction of the Motolo Corridor Rail through Sekhukhune District Municipality; Railway Link A - City of Tshwane MM-Groblersdal-Jane Furse-Burgersfort Railway Link B - Groblersdal-Jane Furse-Burgersfort Railway Link C - Jane Furse-Lebowakgomo/Zebediele Railway Link D - Burgersfort-Lebowakgomo/Zebediele	Transnet				Low	To Be Determined

Table 10.3: Project List

	PROJECT NAME	RESPONSIBILITY	IMPLEMENTATION TIMEFRAME			LEVEL OF PRIORITISATION	ESTIMATED PROJECT COST
			Short-Term (1-3 Years)	Medium-Term (4-6 Years)	Long-Term (7-10 Years)		
4.	**DO 4: DEVELOPMENT OF PRODUCTIVE REGIONS**						
4.1	Establish the two Agricultural Gateways: Groblersdal and Marble Hall Agri Gateways	Provincial Department of Agriculture / SDM / Local Municipality				Low	To Be Determined
4.2	Design and Establishment of the Sekhukhune Agri-Park, in Groblersdal	Provincial Department of Agriculture / SDM				High	R150 000 000,00
4.3	Design and Establishment of the Farmers Production Support Units (FPSU); sites in Marble Hall, Vleeschbloom/ Glen Cower, Apel Cross and Praktiseer	Provincial Department of Agriculture / SDM				Medium	R50 000 000,00
4.4	Agricultural Corridors; Upgrade and maintain agricultural corridors along the following routes; N11, R25, R573, R579 route D2535, route D4100 and route D1547	Provincial Department of Agriculture / SDM				Low	To Be Determined
4.5	Africonnect / Digital Smart Farming; Development of an online application that enables local farmers to trade on a central digital platform, within a specific radius	SDM / Local Municipalities LM/ Private Sector				Medium	To Be Determined
4.6	Feasibility Studies and Financial Assessment of Value-Chains: Snail Production, Aloe Vera and Mushroom Farming	SDM / Local Municipalities				Low	R5 000 000,00
4.7	Development of a District-wide Tourist Marketing Strategy	Provincial, District and Local - Dept of Tourism				Medium	R2 500 000,00
4.8	Establishment of Tourism Offices in Marble Hall and Groblersdal (per office)	Limpopo Dept of Tourism				Low	R12 000 000,00
4.9	Development of the De Hoop Tourism Precinct Plan	SDM/SDA				High	R 1 000 000.00
4.10	Branding and Road Upgrading of 3 three Tourism Routes through signage:	Tourism Agency, Dep. of Tourism, Limpopo Dep of Transport					
4.10.1	Establishment of the Mafulo a Matala Route					Medium	To Be Determined
4.10.2	Establishment of the Marota Route					Medium	To Be Determined
4.10.3	Establishment of the Platinum Stream Route					Medium	To Be Determined
4.11	Facilitate the development of the Fetakgomo-Tubatse SEZ	Provincial, District and Local - Dept. of Local Economic Development (LED)				High	To Be Determined
4.12	Development of a District-Wide Rural Development Strategy	Provincial Department of Agriculture / SDM				High	R2 200 000,00

5.	DO 5: HUMAN SETTLEMENT AND SPATIAL TRANSFORMATION						
5.1	Demarcate Urban Development Boundaries (UDB) to safeguard settlements from sprawling into agricultural potential land	Local Municipalities				Low	In House
5.2	Alignment of mine housing and living conditions plans with the municipal spatial development framework and housing sector plans	Dept of Human Settlement / SDM/ Mining				Low	To Be Determined
5.3	Township Establishment of Informal Settlements in the District Municipality	Provincial Dept. of Human Settlements / SDM / Local Municipalities				High	TBC

Figure 22.1: Nodal And Movement Networks – Projects

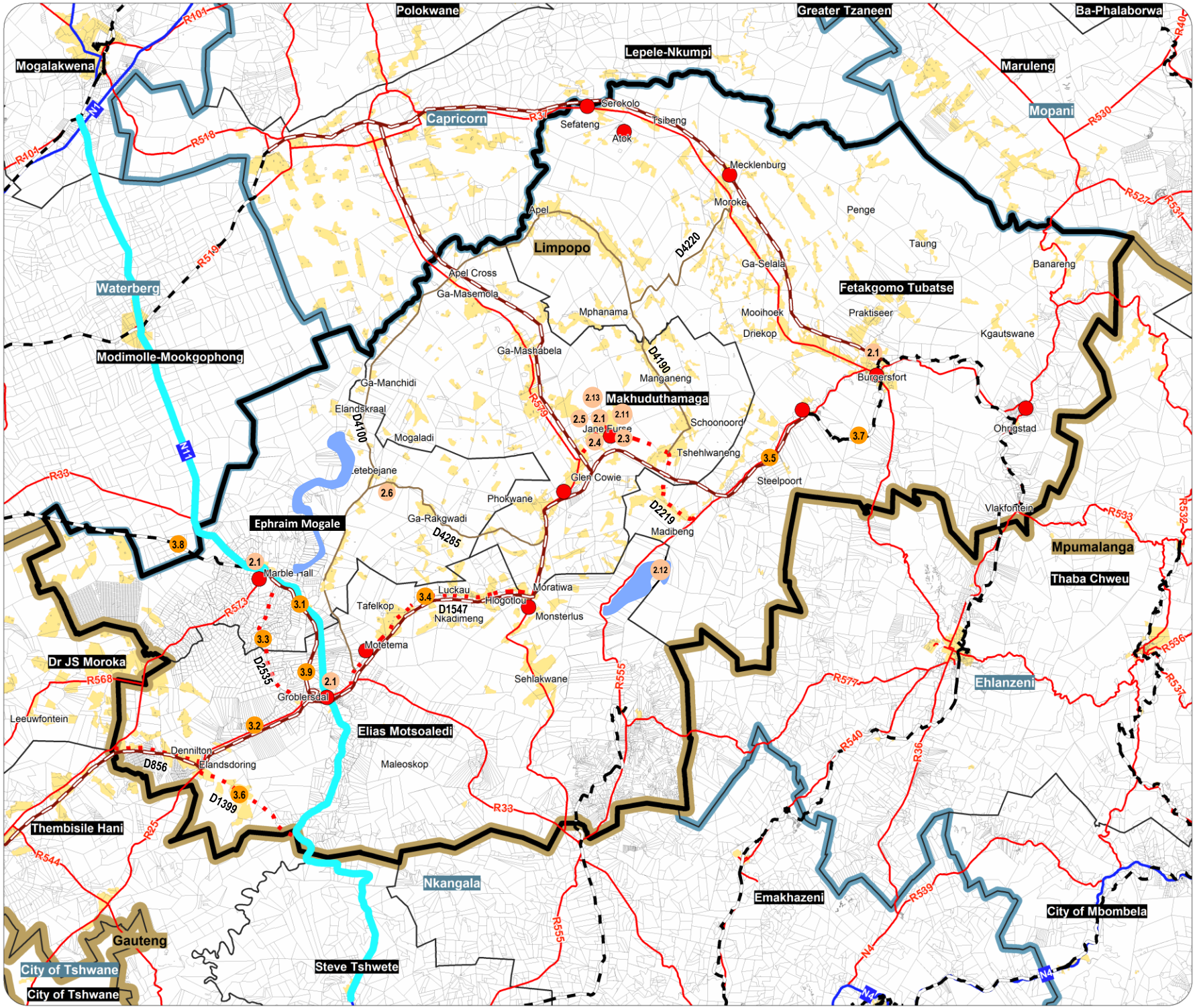


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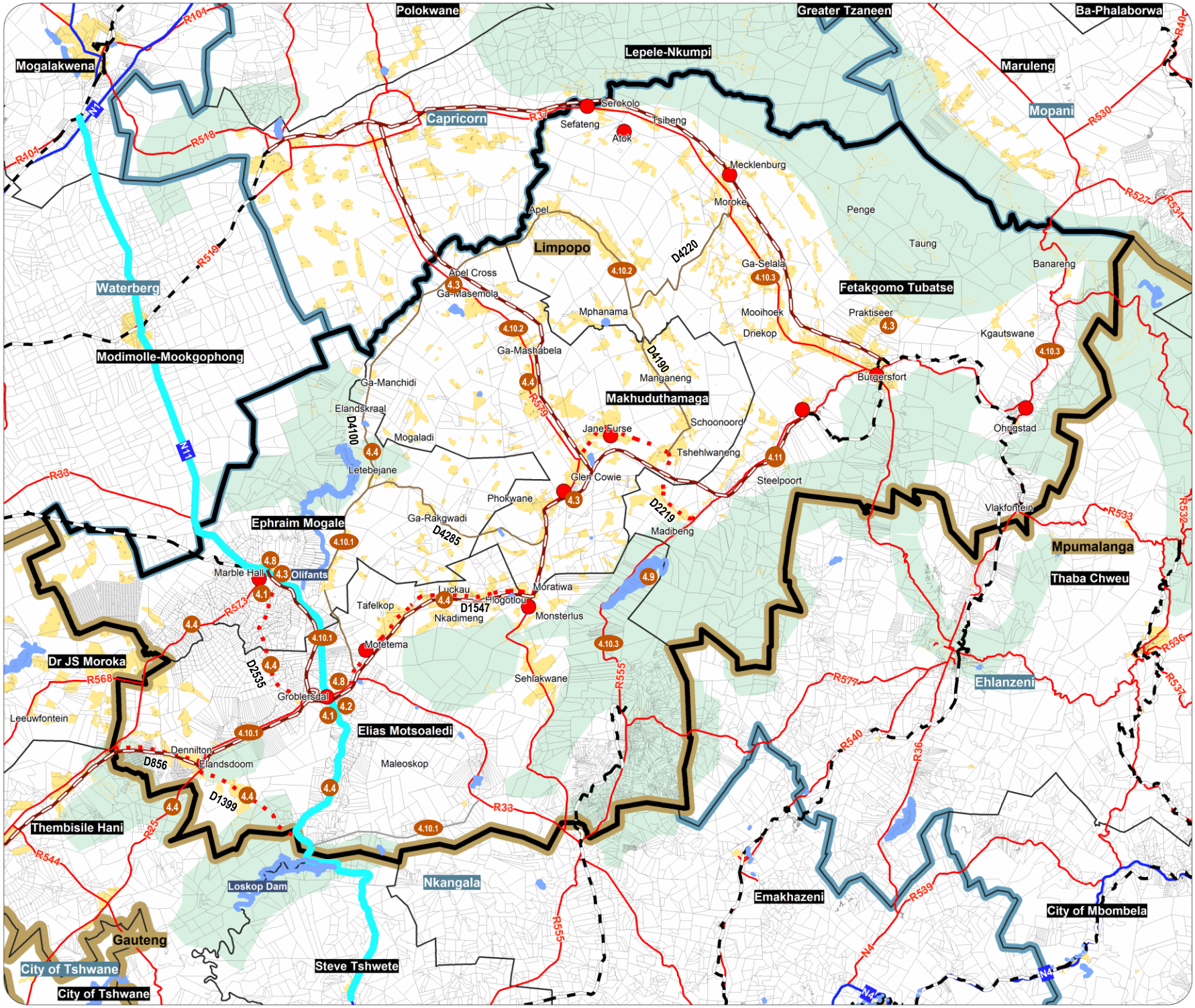
Figure 22.2: Productive Areas– Projects



SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

SEKHUKHUNE SPATIAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK REVIEW

PRODUCTIVE AREAS– PROJECTS

Legend

- Provincial Boundary
- District Boundary
- Local Municipal Boundary
- Sekhukhune District Municipality
- Cadastral (Erven, Farms)
- Settlement Pattern
- Towns
- National Corridor
- Provincial Corridor
- Provincial Corridor Link
- Strategic Secondary Road
- Railway Line
- Proposed Railway Line

District-Wide Projects

4.5 4.6 4.7 4.11 5.1 5.2 5.3

N

0 3 6 12 18 24 30 km

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SEKHUKHUNE
District Municipality

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And Engineers